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2 Kings - Introduction

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Part 1: General Introduction

Outline of 2 Kings

1. King Ahaziah of Israel (1:1–18)
2. Elijah is taken up into heaven (2:1–25)
3. King Jehoram of Israel (3:1–27)
4. Stories of the miracles and prophecies of Elisha (4:1–8:15)
5. King Jehoram of Judah (8:16–24)
6. King Ahaziah of Judah and King Jehoram of Israel (8:25–9:29)
7. King Jehu of Israel (9:30–10:36)
8. King Joash of Judah (11:1–12:21)
9. King Jehoahaz of Israel (13:1–9)
10. King Jehoash of Israel (13:10–25)
11. King Amaziah of Judah (14:1–22)
12. King Jeroboam of Israel (14:23–29)
13. King Azariah of Judah (15:1–7)
14. King Zechariah of Israel (15:8–12)
15. King Shallum of Israel (15:13–15)
16. King Menahem of Israel (15:16–22)
17. King Shallum of Israel (15:23–26)
18. King Ahaz of Judah (16:1–20)
19. King Hoshea of Israel (17:1–6)
20. Conquest of Israel by the Assyrians (17:7–31)
21. King Hezekiah of Judah (18:1–20:21)
22. King Manasseh of Judah (21:1–18)
23. King Amon of Judah (21:19–26)
24. King Josiah of Judah (22:1–23:30)
25. King Jehoahaz of Judah (23:31–35)
26. King Jehoiakim of Judah (23:36–24:7)
27. King Jehoiachin of Judah (24:8–17)
28. King Zedekiah of Judah (24:18–25:7)
29. Conquest of Judah and destruction of Jerusalem by the Babylonians (25:8–30)

What is the book of 2 Kings about?
The book of 2 Kings of continues the story that 1 Kings tells about what happened to the people of Israel after King David died. It tells what the kings were like who ruled over the two kingdoms, Israel and Judah, into which David's kingdom split. It uses David's conduct as a standard to measure the conduct of these later kings. It often says whether or not a king did what was "right in the eyes of Yahweh his Yahweh, like David his father" (that is, his ancestor). While some of the kings were godly and righteous, others were wicked. The book describes how Yahweh sent prophets to the kings and people of Israel and Judah to call them back to obedience to him. The book relates how, unfortunately, both kingdoms disobeyed Yahweh so badly that he finally allowed foreign empires to conquer them and take their people into exile.

What is the purpose of the book of 2 Kings?
The book of 2 Kings is part of a long history that includes the preceding books of 1 Samuel, 2 Samuel, and 1 Kings. The purpose of the entire history is to show that Yahweh was not at fault when the Israelites were conquered and exiled from their land. Instead, this happened because the people disobeyed Yahweh and broke their covenant with him.

Who wrote the book of 2 Kings?
The author of 2 Kings does not identify himself by name in the book. However, many interpreters believe that the prophets in Israel recorded the events that are related in this book, and in the entire history of which it is a part, in order to demonstrate that the people had disobeyed Yahweh. These prophets wanted to encourage the people to obey Yahweh once more. It is possible that a prophet, or several prophets, or someone connected with the prophets, wrote or compiled 1–2 Samuel and 1–2 Kings in the form in which we have them today. While different people may therefore have written different parts of the book, these notes will refer to whoever wrote any given part of 2 Kings as "the author."

What title should translators use for this book?
Translators can use the traditional title of 2 Kings or Second Kings. Translators may also consider a different title such as "The Second Book about the Kings of Israel and Judah."

Is it all right to translate the book of 2 Kings before translating 1 Samuel, 2 Samuel, or 1 Kings?
It is best to translate the books of 1 Samuel, 2 Samuel, and 1 Kings in that order, before 2 Kings, since 2 Kings continues from where 1 Kings ends.

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Part 2: Important Religious and Cultural Concepts

The role of the king

The book of 2 Kings focuses on the lives of various kings. Their role was not just political. The king in ancient Israel was Yahweh's appointed representative, entrusted with the task of leading the people to obey the covenant Yahweh had made with them. His success or failure was directly tied to his faithfulness to Yahweh. The king was responsible for upholding justice, protecting vulnerable people, and ensuring that the Israelites remained faithful to Yahweh as their God. When the king sinned or worshiped other gods, the entire nation suffered the consequences, because the king was no longer leading the people to live in the way that Yahweh wants people to live.

The centrality of the temple

The preceding book of 1 Kings established that Yahweh's temple in Jerusalem was to be the central place of worship for the Israelites, rather than the "high places" where the Canaanites had previously worshiped their foreign gods. The temple was supposed to be the location for sacrifices, prayers, and festivals. It symbolized the covenant relationship between Yahweh and the Israelites. Its neglect by unfaithful kings and the establishment of rival places of worship on those "high places" directly led to the nation's spiritual decline.

The significance of the prophets

Throughout 2 Kings, Yahweh speaks to the kings and people of Israel and Judah through prophets who serve as his messengers. The book relates how prophets such as Elijah, Elisha, Jonah, Isaiah, Huldah, and others whose names are not given spoke truth to powerful leaders and held them accountable for their actions. The prophets often challenged the king's actions when those conflicted with Yahweh's law. However, they also encouraged kings who were obeying Yahweh. They performed signs to authenticate their message and demonstrate Yahweh's power. They did this to confront the idolatry and worship of foreign gods that plagued the kingdom. The prophets' words and deeds served as a powerful reminder that Yahweh's power and authority were greater than those of any human ruler, and so it was vital for the king and people to live in a faithful and obedient covenant relationship with Yahweh.

Part 3: Translation Issues in This Book

"And it happened"

While the phrase "And it happened" can sometimes just indicate ongoing action (as in 4:6, "And it happened, as she filled the containers), the author uses it at other times to introduce a new event in the story or a new development within an episode. For example, he uses the phrase in 2:1 to introduce the entire event of Yahweh taking Elijah up to heaven. Within that event, he uses it in 2:9 to introduce the development of Elijah asking Elisha what he can do for him before Yahweh takes him away. To translate this phrase in its various occurrences, use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event or a new development within an event. (See: Introduction of a New Event)

"behold"

The author and characters often use the word "behold" to focus their listeners' attention on what they are about to say. While the word literally means "look," the speakers do not want their listeners to look at something. Instead, they want them to pay careful attention to something they are about to say. For example, the Shunamite woman says "Behold" in 4:9 in order to call her husband's attention to the holy character of Elisha that she has observed. When the author is calling attention to a sudden or unexpected development, it may be appropriate to translate "behold" as "suddenly." For example, when the author says in 2:11, "behold, a chariot of fire and horses of fire," the meaning is that "a chariot of fire and horses of fire suddenly appeared." (See: Metaphor)

"to this day"

In several places, the author uses the phrase "to this day." By that phrase, he is referring to the time at which he was writing. Translators should be aware that "to this day" refers to a time that is now in the past. They should avoid giving the impression that "to this day" means the present day of the translation's readers. Translators might decide to say something such as "at the time when this is being written" or "at the time of this writing." (See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information)

"in the eyes of"

The author and characters often speak of something having a certain characteristic "in the eyes of" someone. This means that that person considered this thing to have that characteristic. For example, when the captain of fifty pleads with Elisha in 1:14 "let my life be valuable in your eyes," he means that he wants Elisha to consider his life to be valuable. When the author says in 3:2 that Jehoram "did evil in the eyes of Yahweh," he means that Jehoram did what Yahweh considered to be evil. (See: Idiom)

"face"

The expression "to the face of" can have different shades of meaning depending on the context.

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- The author and characters often use the word "face" to represent the presence of a person or group, since people can see the face of someone who is present. For example, when Elisha speaks in 3:14 of "Yahweh of armies, to whose face I stand," he means "in whose presence I stand."
- The focus may also be on something being in front of or before a person or thing, either in space or in time. For example, when the author says of Elisha in 4:12 that the Shunamite woman stood "to his face", he means that she stood in front of him.
- The focus may also be on the relationship or interaction between people or groups, as in 3:24, where the author says of the Israelite soldiers that the Moabites "fled from their face." He means that as the Moabites opposed the Israelites in battle, they fled from them. (See: Metonymy)

In other contexts, the author or a character may use the word "face," describing part of a person, in order to represent the whole person. For example, the angel of Yahweh tells Elijah in 1:15 regarding the hostile king Ahaziah, "do not be afraid of his face," meaning "do not be afraid of him." (See: Synecdoche)

"father" meaning "ancestor"
The author and characters often use the term "father" to mean "ancestor." For example, the author frequently reports that a king died by saying that he "lay down with his fathers," that is, he joined his ancestors in death, as in 8:24 and comparable passages. If your language uses a similar expression to describe someone dying, you could use it in your translation but say "ancestors" rather than "fathers." In 12:18, the author speaks of Jehoshaphat, Jehoram, and Ahaziah as the "fathers" of Joash, but while Ahaziah was his actual father, Jehoram was his grandfather and Jehoshaphat was his great-grandfather. If it would be helpful in your language, in such instances you could state the meaning plainly in your translation. (See: Metaphor)

"hand"
The author and characters often use the word "hand" to represent power, capability, or control. For example, in 3:10, King Jehoram laments that Yahweh has apparently given him and his allies "into the hand of Moab," meaning that he believes the Moabites are going to overpower them and defeat them.

The word "hand" may also represent possession or conveyance, as when the author says in 5:5 that Naaman "took in his hand" silver and gold and expensive clothes as a gift for Elisha.

The word "hand" may also represent agency, as when Jehu refers in 9:36 to the prophecy that Yahweh "spoke by the hand of his servant Elijah the Tishbite" about Jezebel. He means that Yahweh spoke this prophecy through the agency of Elijah.

Translation notes will help distinguish the difference between these shades of meaning when that may not be clear from the context. (See: Metonymy)

In other contexts, the author or a character may use the word "hand," describing part of a person, in order to represent the whole person. For example, the word "hand" may represent an entire person in the act of possessing and offering something, as when Gehazi says in 5:20 that he will take "from the hand of Naaman" some of the gifts he brought for Elisha. He means that he will take them from Naaman. (See: Synecdoche)

"house" meaning "temple" or "family"
The author and characters often use the term "house" to mean the temple in which the Israelites worshiped Yahweh, as if that temple were a house in which Yahweh lived. For example, when the author says in 15:35 that King Jotham "built the upper gate of the house of Yahweh," he means that he built the upper gate of the temple of Yahweh. The author or characters may also speak of a temple in which another people group worshiped its deity as a "house," as if that temple were a house in which that god lived. For example, in 5:17 Naaman speaks of the temple of Rimmon as the "house of Rimmon." If it would be clearer in your language, you could say "temple" in your translation rather than "house."

The author and characters may also use the term "house" to mean all the people who live in the same house, including family members and servants. This is the meaning in 7:9 when the lepers speak of "the house of the king" to mean his household. In many other contexts where the term "house" is applied to a king, it is envisioning his descendants who succeed him as king. This is the case, for example, in 8:18, where the author speaks of "the house of Ahab." It may be helpful to translate the term "house" as "dynasty" in these contexts. (See: Metaphor)

"listen"
The author and characters sometimes use the term "listen" to mean complying with what someone has said. For example, when Jehu says to the leaders of Jezreel in 10:6, "If ... you are listening to my voice," he means, "If ... you agree to do what I say." When the author says of Jehoahaz's prayer in 13:4 that "Yahweh listened to him," he means that Yahweh answered his

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prayer by giving him what he asked for. (See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information)

"my lord" or "your servant"
Many times throughout the book, even though people are addressing a king or other leader directly, they speak of him in the third person as "my lord" to show respect. For example, in 2:19 a spokesman for the men of Jericho addresses Elisha respectfully as "my lord." If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a respectful form in the second person. You might have people say, for example, "you, my lord." Some cultures may have a specific form that they use to address rulers, and if your culture does, you could use that form in your translation. The UST models one way to do that. It has people say to kings, "Your Majesty."

Similarly, many times throughout the book, people speak of themselves in the third person as "your servant" to show humility. For example, in 2:16 the sons of the prophets in Jericho speak of themselves to Elisha humbly as "your servants." If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a humble form in the first person. You might have people say, for example, "with us, your servants," "I, your servant," and so forth. (See: First, Second or Third Person)

name of a person representing that person and associated with or accompanying people
The author and characters often use the name of a person to represent that person and others who are associated with or accompanying that person. For example, when the king of Aram says of Elisha in 6:13, "I will take him," he is using himself to represent everyone who would be involved in taking or capturing Elisha. He would give the command, but his soldiers would make the actual capture. (See: Synecdoche)

name of nation, tribe, or city representing its people or army
The author and characters often use the name of a nation, tribe, or city to represent its people or its army. For example, when the author says in 1:1 that "Moab rebelled against Israel," he means that the people of the kingdom of Moab rebelled against their rulers, the king and people of Israel. When the author says in 3:6 that King Jehoram mustered "all of Israel," he means that the king mobilized the entire Israelite army. (See: Metonymy)

"saying" or "and said"
The author and characters frequently use the term "saying" to introduce direct quotations. In addition, the author sometimes uses the phrase "and said" to introduce direct quotations after other verbs of speaking such as "answered," "spoke," "prayed," "cried out," or "pleaded." In these instances, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent these expressions explicitly. (See: Quotations and Quote Margins)

"shall"
The ULT represents the Hebrew instructional verb form with the English helping verb "shall." For example, when Elijah tells King Ahaziah's messengers in 1:6 "you shall say to him," he is instructing him to tell the king what he says next. Other ways to say this are "you are to say to him" and "I want you to say to him." Translate this form with the most natural way in your language for giving instructions.

"sons of" or "son of"
The author and characters often speak of "the sons of" a person to mean the nation or tribe that consists of his descendants. For example, in 8:12 Elisha speaks of the "sons of Israel" to mean the Israelites. In 23:13, the author speaks of the "sons of Ammon" to mean the Ammonites. In such cases, "sons" means not first-generation offspring but later descendants. You may wish to translate these expressions with the word "descendants" or with the name of the people group that consists of the descendants of the named person. (See: Metaphor)

In other contexts, the authors and characters use the expression "son of" to indicate that a person has the characteristic of something. For example, in 6:32 Elisha calls King Jehoram a "son of a murderer," meaning that he is a murderous person. In a specialized use of this expression, the author typically says that a person was "a son of" a certain number of years to mean that the person was that many years old. For example, he says in 8:17 that Jehoram was "a son of 32 years" to mean that he was 32 years old when he became king. Unless your language uses the term "son" in the same sense, we recommend that you translate these expressions with corresponding characteristic expressions from your own language. (See: Idiom)

"strike" or "struck"
In many places, the author says that soldiers "struck" an opposing army, city, or king, as if they had only hit them. But in various contexts, he means that they either destroyed, killed, defeated, or attacked those opponents. For example, when Yahweh tells the Israelites and their allies in 3:19 that "you will strike every fortified city," he means that they will destroy every city. When the Moabites say in 3:23 that the opposing soldiers have "struck" one another, they mean that they have killed one another. When the author

says in 3:24 that the Israelite army "struck" Moab, he means that it defeated the Moabite army. And when the author says later in 3:24 that the Israelites advanced into Moab and "struck" it, he means that they attacked that country. Consider carefully how to translate the terms "strike" and "struck" in each context where they do not actually mean "hit." (See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information)

travel descriptions marked for change in elevation ("went up," "went down")
In keeping with what was usual in the biblical language and culture, the author and characters typically indicate whether people are going up to a higher elevation or going down to a lower elevation when they travel. For example, in 2:23 the author says of Elisha, who had been in Jericho, that "he went up to Bethel." But in 2:2 he says of Elijah and Elisha, who had been in Gilgal in the hill country of Ephraim, that "they went down to Bethel." If your language does not mark travel for change in elevation, you can translate instances with simple expressions such as "went" or "came." (See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit)

"walking" representing "living"
The author and characters often speak of how a person lives as if that were a way or path along which the person was walking. For example, in 8:18 the author says of Jehoram that "walked in the way of the kings of Israel." He means that Jehoram lived as the kings of Israel had lived. He says in 23:3 that Josiah made a covenant "to walk after Yahweh." He means that Josiah made a covenant to live the way Yahweh has said people should live. (See: Metaphor)

"word"
In many contexts, the author and characters use the term "word" or "words" to represent what a person said by using words. For example, in 1:7, King Ahaziah asks his messengers, "What was the custom of the man who ... spoke these words to you?" It is unlikely that the messengers had repeated all of Elijah's words to him exactly. Rather, they told him generally what Elijah had said to them. So Ahaziah means "the man who ... said these things to you." When the author then reports in 1:17 that Ahaziah died "according to the word of Yahweh that Elijah had spoken," he means that he died "according to the message from Yahweh that Elijah had delivered." (See: Metonymy)

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Structure and Formatting

The author or authors of this long historical narrative began the account of the reign of King Azariah of Israel at the end of the previous book, in 1 Kings 22:51–53. That account continues and concludes in this chapter.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

How did Ahaziah fall through a window?
The author says in 1:12 that "Ahaziah fell through the lattice in his upper chamber." How might this have happened? Ancient Middle Eastern palaces often had upper rooms whose windows had decorative lattices for ventilation and privacy. These lattices were made of interwoven strips of thin wood or metal, and so they were fragile. They could break if someone leaned against them. It appears that Ahaziah accidentally leaned against the lattice of a window, perhaps not realizing that it was not solid, and he fell at least one floor to a courtyard or roof below, badly injuring himself.

2 Kings 1:1 (#1)

וַיִּפְשַׁ֥ע מוֹאָ֖ב בְּיִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

"And Moab rebelled against Israel"

See the discussion in the Introduction to 2 Kings of how the author and characters often use the name of a nation, tribe, or city to represent its people. Alternate translation: [And the Moabites rebelled against the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 1:3 (#1)

קוּם֙ עֲלֵ֣ה

"Arise, go up"

The angel of Yahweh is not telling Elijah to get up from sitting or lying down. He is saying **Arise** to tell Elijah to take action. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [Take action and go up]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 1:3 (#2)

עֲלֵ֣ה

"go up"

See the discussion in the Introduction to 2 Kings of how speakers in this culture marked travel for change in elevation. Alternate translation: [go]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 1:3 (#3)

מֶלֶךְ־שֹׁמְרוֹן

“the king of Samaria”

The angel of Yahweh assumes that Elijah will know that by **the king of Samaria** he means the king of Israel, who ruled from the city of Samaria. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the king who rules Israel from the city of Samaria]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 1:3 (#4)

וְדַבֵּר אֲלֵהֶם הֲמִבְּלִי אֵין־אֱלֹהִים בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל אַתֶּם הֹלְכִים לִדְרֹשׁ בְּבַעַל זְבוּב אֱלֹהֵי עֶקְרוֹן

“and say to them, ‘{Is it} because there is no God in Israel you are going to inquire of Baal Zebub, the god of Ekron”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and tell them to ask Ahaziah whether he has sent them to inquire of Baal-Zebub, the god of Ekron, because there is no God in Israel.]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 1:3 (#5)

וְדַבֵּר אֲלֵהֶם

“and say to them”

The angel of Yahweh assumes that Elijah will understand that he is telling him something that the messengers are to ask Ahaziah. Elijah is not to ask the messengers to answer this question. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and tell them to ask Ahaziah]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 1:3 (#6)

הֲמִבְּלִי אֵין־אֱלֹהִים בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל אַתֶּם הֹלְכִים לִדְרֹשׁ בְּבַעַל זְבוּב אֱלֹהֵי עֶקְרוֹן

“Is it} because there is no God in Israel you are going to inquire of Baal Zebub, the god of Ekron”

The angel is using the question form to rebuke the king. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [There is a God in Israel, so you should not be going to inquire of Baal-Zebub, the god of Ekron!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 1:4 (#1)

וְלָכֵן כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה הַמִּטָּה אֲשֶׁר־עָלִיתָ שָּׁם לֹא־תֵרֵד מִמֶּנָּה כִּי מוֹת תָּמוּת

“And therefore, thus says Yahweh, “The bed where you have gone up there, you will not come down from it, for dying, you will die”

There are three levels of quotation here. The author is quoting what the angel said to Elijah (level 1), continuing from the previous verse. This includes what Elijah was supposed to say to the messengers, also continuing from the previous verse (level 2). The angel then tells Elijah what he wants the messengers to say to Ahaziah (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or third-level quotations.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 1:4 (#2)

וְלָכֵן כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה הַמִּטָּה אֲשֶׁר־עָלִיתָ שָּׁם לֹא־תֵרֵד מִמֶּנָּה כִּי מוֹת תָּמוּת

“And therefore, thus says Yahweh, “The bed where you have gone up there, you will not come down from it, for dying, you will die”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And tell him that because he has done this, Yahweh says that he will never get off the bed that he is lying on. Instead, dying, he will die.]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 1:4 (#3)

הַמִּטָּה אֲשֶׁר־עָלִיתָ שָּׁם

“The bed where you have gone up there”

People of this culture typically spoke of a person going up onto a bed. Your language may have an expression of its own for this that you can use in your translation, here and in verse 15. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [The bed that

you have climbed into] or [The bed on which you are lying]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 1:4 (#4)

מָמֹות תָּמוּת

“dying, you will die”

Yahweh is repeating forms of the verb **die** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification, here and in verse 16. Alternate translation: [you will surely die]

See: Reduplication

2 Kings 1:5 (#1)

אֵלָיו

“to him”

The pronoun **him** refers to King Ahaziah. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [to King Ahaziah]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 1:5 (#2)

מַה־זֶּה שַׁבְתֶּם

“What {is} this, you have returned”

The king is using **What is this** as a common expression of his culture to ask the reason why something has happened. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [How is it that you have returned] or [Why have you returned]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 1:6 (#1)

וַיֹּאמְרוּ אֵלָיו אִישׁ ׀ עָלָה לִקְרָאתֵנוּ וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלֵינוּ֮ לְכוּ שׁוּבוּ֒ אֶל־הַמֶּלֶךְ אֲשֶׁר־שְׁלַחַ אֶתְכֶם וְדַבַּרְתֶּם אֵלָיו כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה הֲמִבְּלִי אֵין־אֱלֹהִים֮ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל אַתָּה שֹׁלֵחַ לִדְרֹושׁ בְּבַעַל זְבוּב אֱלֹהֵי עֶקְרוֹן לָכֵן הַמִּטָּה אֲשֶׁר־עָלִיתָ שָּׁם לֹא־תֵרֵד מִמֶּנָּה כִּי־מוֹת תָּמוּת

“And they said to him, “A man came up to meet us, and he said to us, ‘Go, return to the king who sent you, and you shall say to him, “Thus says Yahweh: ‘{Is it} because there is no God in Israel you are sending to inquire of Baal Zebub, the god of Ekron? Therefore the bed where you have gone up there, you will not come down from it, for dying, you will die”

There are four levels of quotation here. The messengers are telling the king how they met Elijah (level 1). They quote what Elijah said to them (level 2). This includes what Elijah told them to tell the king (level 3). And that includes something that Yahweh said (level 4). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or third-level quotations.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 1:6 (#2)

וַיֹּאמְרוּ אֵלָיו אִישׁ ׀ עָלָה לִקְרָאתֵנוּ וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלֵינוּ֮ לְכוּ שׁוּבוּ֒ אֶל־הַמֶּלֶךְ אֲשֶׁר־שְׁלַחַ אֶתְכֶם וְדַבַּרְתֶּם אֵלָיו כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה הֲמִבְּלִי אֵין־אֱלֹהִים֮ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל אַתָּה שֹׁלֵחַ לִדְרֹושׁ בְּבַעַל זְבוּב אֱלֹהֵי עֶקְרוֹן לָכֵן הַמִּטָּה אֲשֶׁר־עָלִיתָ שָּׁם לֹא־תֵרֵד מִמֶּנָּה כִּי־מוֹת תָּמוּת

“And they said to him, “A man came up to meet us, and he said to us, ‘Go, return to the king who sent you, and you shall say to him, “Thus says Yahweh: ‘{Is it} because there is no God in Israel you are sending to inquire of Baal Zebub, the god of Ekron? Therefore the bed where you have gone up there, you will not come down from it, for dying, you will die”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And they told him that a man came up to meet them and told them to go back to the king who sent them and tell him that Yahweh said that there was a God in Israel and so he should not have sent them to inquire of Baal-Zebub, the god of Ekron, and because he did that, he would not recover from his illness but instead would certainly die]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 1:6 (#3)

וְדַבַּרְתֶּם אֵלָיו

“and you shall say to him”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the ULT represents the Hebrew instructional verb form with the English helping verb “shall.” Decide as a team how you will represent this form in your trans-

lation in various contexts. Alternate translation: [and you are to say to him] or [and I want you to say to him]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

2 Kings 1:6 (#4)

כֹּֽה אָמַ֣ר יְהוָ֗ה הֲמִבְּלִ֤י אֵין־אֱלֹהִים֙ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל אַתָּ֥ה שֹׁלֵ֖חַ לִדְרֹ֣שׁ בְּבַ֣עַל זְבוּ֔ב אֱלֹהֵ֖י עֶקְרֽוֹן לָ֣כֵן ׀ הַמִּטָּ֗ה אֲשֶׁר־עָלִ֤יתָ שָּׁם֙ לֹֽא־תֵרֵ֣ד מִמֶּ֔נָּה כִּי־מ֥וֹת תָּמֽוּת

“Thus says Yahweh: ‘{Is it} because there is no God in Israel you are sending to inquire of Baal Zebub, the god of Ekron? Therefore the bed where you have gone up there, you will not come down from it, for dying, you will die”

See how you translated the similar expressions in 1:3–4. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that there is a God in Israel, so you should not have sent to inquire of Baal-Zebub, the god of Ekron! He says that because you have done that, you will never get off the bed that you are lying on. Instead, you will certainly die]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 1:7 (#1)

וַיְדַבֵּ֖ר & אֶת־הַדְּבָרִ֥ים הָאֵֽלֶּה

“and spoke these words”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author and characters may use the terms “word” or “words” to represent something that someone said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly, here and in similar instances throughout the book. Alternate translation: [and said these things]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 1:8 (#1)

אִ֣ישׁ בַּ֔עַל שֵׂעָ֖ר

“A man, a master of hair”

This could mean: (1) that Elijah wore a garment made of untanned animal skin with the hair outward. Alternate translation: [The man was wearing a hairy coat] or (2) that Elijah had long hair and a long beard. Alternate translation: [The man had long hair and a long beard]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 1:8 (#2)

וְאֵזֹ֥ר עֹ֛ר אָזְר֖וּר בְּמָתְנָ֑יו

“and a belt of skin was tied around his waist”

The expression **was tied** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and he was wearing a leather belt around his waist]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 1:9 (#1)

שַׂר־חֲמִשִּׁ֖ים וַחֲמִשָּׁ֑יו

“a captain of fifty and his fifty”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [a captain of fifty men and his fifty men]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 1:9 (#2)

שַׂר־חֲמִשִּׁ֖ים וַחֲמִשָּׁ֑יו

“a captain of fifty and his fifty”

In ancient warfare, officers were often described by the number of troops that were generally under their command. However, the actual number could vary. There were not necessarily exactly **fifty** soldiers who accompanied this **captain of fifty** on this occasion as he went to capture Elijah. You may be able to state this in more general terms, using an equivalent expression from your language and culture. Alternate translation: [a platoon leader and his soldiers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 1:9 (#3)

וְהִנֵּה֩

“and behold”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author and characters often use the term “behold” to focus their listeners’ attention on what they are about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation.

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 1:9 (#4)

רֹ֣אשׁ הָהָ֔ר

“the head of a hill”

The author is using the term **head** to mean the top of this **hill**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the top of a hill]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 1:9 (#5)

וַחֲמִשָּׁשָׁיו & וַיְדַבֵּ֥ר אֵלָ֖יו

“and his fifty & And he said to him”

The pronoun **he** refers to the captain, while the pronoun **him** refers to Elijah. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the captain said to Elijah]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 1:9 (#6)

הַמֶּ֣לֶךְ דִּבֶּ֔ר יֶרֶד

“the king says, ‘Come down”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [the king orders you to come down]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 1:10 (#1)

וַיְדַבֵּ֣ר

“and said”

See the discussion of this phrase in the Introduction to 2 Kings. It introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this phrase explicitly, here or in its other instances in the book.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

2 Kings 1:10 (#2)

וְאִם־אִ֖ישׁ אֱלֹהִ֣ים אָנִ֑י

“And if I {am} a man of God”

Elijah is speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If a speaker of your language would not state something as a condition if it were certain or true, or if your readers might think that what Elijah is saying is uncertain, then you could translate this as a confident statement, here and in verse 12. Alternate translation: [Since I am a man of God]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

2 Kings 1:11 (#1)

וַיָּ֣שָׁב וַיִּשְׁלַ֤ח

“And he returned and sent”

The phrase **returned and sent** expresses a single idea. The word **returned** tells in what way the king **sent** soldiers, that is, for a second time. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way, here and in verse 13. Alternate translation: [And once again he sent]

See: Hendiadys

2 Kings 1:11 (#2)

וַיַּ֨עַן וַיְדַבֵּ֤ר אֵלָיו֙

“And he answered and said to him”

This **captain** was not answering something that Elijah said to him. He was responding to the situation of seeing Elijah still sitting on top of the hill. It may be helpful to clarify that for your readers. Alternate translation: [And when this captain saw Elijah still sitting on the hill, he said to him]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

2 Kings 1:11 (#3)

כֹּה־אָמַ֥ר הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ מְהֵרָ֥ה רֶֽדָה

“thus says the king, ‘Come down quickly”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [The king orders you to come down quickly]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 1:12 (#1)

אֲלֵיהֶ֔ם

“to them”

The author says that Elijah spoke these words to **them**, meaning the captain and all of his soldiers, because what he said affected them all. However, since Elijah addresses the captain directly (the pronouns **you** and **your** that he uses are singular), it may be more natural in your language to use a singular pronoun here. Alternate translation: [to him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 1:13 (#1)

וַיַּ֥עַל

“And & went up”

The author assumes that readers will understand that the third captain **went up** the hill to where Elijah was sitting. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And … went up the hill]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 1:13 (#2)

וַיִּכְרַ֤ע עַל־בִּרְכָּיו ׀ לְנֶ֙גֶד֙ אֵ֣לִיָּ֔הוּ

“and knelt on his knees in front of Elijah”

The captain **knelt on his knees** as a symbolic action by which he showed humility and submission to Elijah. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [knelt in front of Elijah to show his respect] or [bowed down on his knees before Elijah in humble submission]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 1:13 (#3)

וַיִּכְרַ֤ע עַל־בִּרְכָּיו

“and knelt on his knees”

It might seem that the expression **knelt on his knees** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [and knelt down]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 1:13 (#4)

וַיִּתְחַנֵּ֥ן אֵלָ֖יו וַיְדַבֵּ֣ר אֵלָ֑יו

“and he pleaded with him and said to him”

The phrase **pleaded with him and said to him** expresses a single idea. The word **pleaded** tells how the third captain **said** the following words to Elijah. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [and he said pleadingly to him]

See: Hendiadys

2 Kings 1:13 (#5)

תִּיקַר־נָ֣א נַפְשִׁ֔י וְנֶ֥פֶשׁ עֲבָדֶ֖יךָ אֵ֣לֶּה חֲמִשִּׁ֑ים בְּעֵינֶֽיךָ

“please let my life and the life of these your fifty servants be valuable in your eyes”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author and characters often speak of something as having a certain quality “in the eyes of” someone. They mean that the person considered this thing to have that quality. Alternate translation: [please consider my life and the life of these your fifty servants to be valuable]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 1:13 (#6)

עֲבָדֶ֖יךָ אֵ֣לֶּה חֲמִשִּׁ֑ים

“these your fifty servants”

By calling his soldiers Elijah’s **servants**, the captain is indicating that the soldiers will not harm him. Instead, they will do whatever he wants them to do. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 1:15 (#1)

רֵ֥ד אוֹתּ֛וֹ אַל־תִּירָ֥א מִפָּנָ֖יו

“Go down with him. Do not be afraid of his face”

The pronoun **him** refers to the third captain, while the pronoun **his** refers to the king. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Go down with this captain. Do not be afraid of the king’s face]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 1:15 (#2)

מִפָּנָ֖יו

“of his face”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author or a character may use the word “face,” part of a person, to represent the whole person in the act of doing something. Here the author is using King Ahaziah’s **face** to mean all of him in the act of trying to arrest Elijah and possibly punish or kill him. Alternate translation: [of him] or [of what he might do to you]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 1:16 (#1)

וַיְדַבֵּ֥ר אֵלָ֖יו

“And he said to him”

The pronoun **he** refers to Elijah, while the pronoun **him** refers to King Ahaziah. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Elijah said to King Ahaziah]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 1:16 (#2)

כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה יַ֗עַן אֲשֶׁר־שָׁלַ֤חְתָּ מַלְאָכִים֙ לִדְרֹ֔שׁ בְּבַ֥עַל זְבוּב֖ אֱלֹהֵ֣י עֶקְרוֹ֑ן הֲמִבְלִ֣י אֵין־אֱלֹהִ֗ים בְּיִשְׂרָאֵ֛ל לִדְרֹ֥שׁ בִּדְבָרֽוֹ׃ לָכֵן֮ הַמִּטָּה֒ אֲשֶׁר־עָלִ֣יתָ שָּׁ֔ם לֹא־תֵרֵ֖ד מִמֶּ֑נָּה כִּי־מ֥וֹת תָּמֽוּת

“Thus says Yahweh, ‘Because you sent messengers to inquire of Baal Zebub, the god of Ekron—{was it} because there is no God in Israel to inquire of his word?—therefore, the bed where you have gone up there, you will not come down from it, for dying, you will die”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that there is a God in Israel, and you should have inquired of his word. Because you sent messengers instead to inquire of Baal-Zebub, the god of Ekron, therefore, the bed where you have gone up there, you will not come down from it, for dying, you will die]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 1:16 (#3)

לִדְרֹ֥שׁ בִּדְבָרֽוֹ

“to inquire of his word”

Here Yahweh’s **word** represents what he would say to provide guidance. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to ask for guidance]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 1:17 (#1)

וַיִּמְלֹ֥ךְ יְהוֹרָ֛ם תַּחְתָּ֖יו & בִּשְׁנַ֣ת שְׁתַּ֑יִם לִיהוֹרָ֛ם בֶּן־יְהוֹשָׁפָ֥ט מֶֽלֶךְ יְהוּדָ֖ה כִּֽי־לֹא־הָיָ֥ה לֹ֖ו בֵּֽן

“And Jehoram reigned in his place in the year of two to Jehoram, the son of Jehoshaphat, the king of Judah, because a son was not to him”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And because a son was not to him, Jehoram reigned in his place in the year of two to Jehoram, the son of Jehoshaphat, king of Judah]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 1:17 (#2)

וַיִּמְלֹ֥ךְ יְהוֹרָ֛ם תַּחְתָּ֖יו & בִּשְׁנַ֣ת שְׁתַּ֑יִם לִיהוֹרָ֛ם בֶּן־יְהוֹשָׁפָ֥ט מֶֽלֶךְ יְהוּדָֽה

“And Jehoram reigned in his place in the year of two to Jehoram, the son of Jehoshaphat, the king of Judah”

The author is introducing **Jehoram** as a participant in the story as the new king of Israel. His characteristic method throughout this book, as shown here, is to refer to a year in the reign of the king of one kingdom, Israel or Judah, in order to identify when a king of the other kingdom began to reign. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the same kind of introduction in 1 Kings 15:1 and similar instances throughout that book.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 1:17 (#3)

יְהוֹרָ֔ם

“Jehoram”

The author describes Jehoram in 8:16 (where he calls him “Joram”) as “the son of Ahab.” This means that Jehoram was Ahaziah’s younger brother. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [his younger brother Jehoram]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 1:17 (#4)

בִּשְׁנַ֣ת שְׁתַּ֑יִם לִיהוֹרָ֛ם

“in the year of two to Jehoram”

If your language would not describe a year of a king’s reign in a form such as **the year of two**, you could represent this year in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [in the second year of Jehoram]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 1:18 (#1)

וְיֶ֣תֶר דִּבְרֵ֣י אֲחַזְיָ֔הוּ אֲשֶׁ֥ר עָשָׂ֖ה הֲלוֹא־הֵ֑מָּה כְּתוּבִ֗ים עַל־סֵ֛פֶר דִּבְרֵ֥י הַיָּמִ֖ים לְמַלְכֵ֥י יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“Now the rest of the matters of Ahaziah that he did, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel”

This is the way the author regularly concludes accounts of kings’ reigns. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the same expressions in 1 Kings 11:41 and similar contexts throughout that book. Alternate translation: [Now you can read about the rest of the things that Ahaziah did in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel]

See: End of Story

2 Kings - Chapter 2 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter relates the end of the ministry of Elijah and the beginning of the ministry of Elisha.

1. Yahweh takes Elijah to heaven in a whirlwind (1–18)
2. Elisha provides safe water for Jericho (19–22)
3. Boys mock Elisha, and bears maul them (23–25)

The author formally concludes his account of the reign of King Ahaziah of Israel at the end of chapter 1. But he does not formally begin his account of his successor, King Jehoram, until the beginning of chapter 3. So within the overall outline of the book, the story of the transition of prophetic leadership from Elijah to Elisha seems to take place within a special kind of time, a sacred time outside of the reigns of kings.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did Elisha not want the sons of prophets from Bethel and Jericho to say anything more about Elijah being taken up?

In 2:3 and 2:5, prophets from Bethel and Jericho ask Elisha whether he knows that Yahweh is going to take Elijah away that day. In each case, Elisha replies, “I also know. Be quiet.” Elisha probably knew through prophetic revelation about Yahweh’s plan to take Elijah up in a whirlwind. His repeated instruction to be quiet suggests that this was a difficult and emotional time for him. The departure of Elijah marked not only the end of a great prophet’s ministry but also the loss of a beloved spiritual mentor. Elisha’s silence expressed reverence and grief. He probably wanted the other prophets to express the same things through their own silence. Elisha already knew what was going to happen to Elijah, and he anticipated this as a sacred, private, and emotional event that called for quiet, reverent faith.

Why did the young men who came out from Bethel mock Elisha for being bald?

In 2:23, as Elisha is returning from seeing Elijah being taken up into heaven, he passes by the city of Bethel, where there was a community of prophets. Some of them came out and started chanting, “Go up, bald one!” The phrase “Go up” meant “Keep on walking up that road,” in other words, “Get out of here.” So the young men were rejecting Elisha as a successor to Elijah as a leader and teacher of their community. But why did they cite his baldness as a reason for that rejection? In 1:8, when King Ahaziah asks his messengers what the prophet was like who spoke to them, they say that he was a “master of hair.” One possible meaning of that expression is that he had long hair and a long beard. By contrast, Elisha evidently had gone bald at a younger age. Insulting Elisha as “bald” may therefore have implied that he lacked divine power compared with Elijah. The mockers were essentially saying, “You are no Elijah, so we do not want you as our leader!” But since Yahweh had told Elijah to appoint Elisha as his successor, these young men were rejecting Yahweh’s choice and denying Elisha’s spiritual authority rather than submitting to it. That seems to be the reason why they suffered a divine judgment, being mauled by bears, that might otherwise seem to be a very harsh punishment for speaking an insult.

Why did Elisha travel to Jericho, Bethel, and Mount Carmel before returning to Samaria?

It is clear from 2:3 and 2:5 that there were communities of prophets in Jericho and Bethel. Elijah seems to have wanted to visit with them one more time before he was taken up to heaven. After he was taken up and Elisha succeeded him, Elisha returned to the community in Jericho, and he tried to return to the one in Bethel, apparently to confirm what had happened to Elijah, to encourage the communities and to begin his work among them as Elijah’s successor. It appears from 4:25 that there was also a community of prophets at Mount Carmel with whom Elisha stayed from time to time. So he apparently also made a visit to that community before returning to the city of Samaria, where his permanent residence was, as passages such as 6:32–33 suggest.

2 Kings 2:1 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author uses the phrase “And it happened” to introduce new events in his story. To translate this phrase here and in similar occurrences in the book,

use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 2:1 (#2)

הַגִּלְגָּל

“Gilgal”

Since the author says in the next verse that Elijah and Elisha “went down” to Bethel, the **Gilgal** he speaks of here cannot be the city in the Jordan River valley near Jericho, which was at a lower elevation than Bethel. The author must mean the city of Gilgal that was in the territory of the tribe of Ephraim, where there was a community of prophets, as the author indicates in 4:38. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 2:2 (#1)

שֶׁב־נָנָא פֹּה כִּֽי יְהוָה שְׁלָחַנִי עַד־בֵּית־אֵֽל

“Stay here, please, because Yahweh has sent me to Bethel”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since Yahweh has sent me to Bethel, stay here, please]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 2:2 (#2)

חַי־יְהוָה וְחֵי־נַפְשְׁךָ אִם־אֶעֱזָבֶךָּ

“The life of Yahweh, and the life of your soul, if I should leave you”

Following the custom of his culture, Elisha is swearing an oath by guaranteeing it by something that he holds sacred and by stating the first part of a condition (“if”) but not the second part (“then”). Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. In a context such as this, it may be natural to express just the first part of the condition as a negative statement, here and in verses 4 and 6. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh and I swear by your own life that I will not leave you]

See: Oath Formulas

2 Kings 2:2 (#3)

וְחֵי־נַפְשְׁךָ

“and the life of your soul”

Elisha is using one part of Elijah, his **soul**, to mean all of him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and your own life]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 2:2 (#4)

וַיֵּרְדוּ בֵּית־אֵֽל

“And they went down {to} Bethel”

In keeping with what is usual for his language and culture, the author is marking travel for change in elevation. If this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language, you could shorten it. See how you translated the similar expression “go up” in 1:3. Alternate translation: [And they went to Bethel]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 2:3 (#1)

בְּנֵי־הַנְּבִיאִים

“sons of the prophets”

The phrase **sons of the prophets** refers to members of groups of young men who were being trained to become prophets by older men who were experienced prophets. If your readers would not be familiar with what this phrase means, you could use a more general term or explain it in a footnote. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Kings 20:35. Alternate translation: [some young prophets in training]

See: Translate Unknowns

2 Kings 2:3 (#2)

לֹקֵחַ אֶת־אֲדֹנֶיךָ מֵעַל רֹאשֶׁךָ

“is taking your master from over your head”

The author is speaking of Elijah as if he were **over** Elisha’s **head** in the sense of being physically above him. He means that Elijah is Elisha’s master and leader. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly, here and in verse 5. Alternate translation: [is taking away the master who is in authority over you]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 2:3 (#3)

גַּם־אֲנִ֣י יָדַ֔עְתִּי

“I, I also know”

Elisha is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I ... know** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize his personal awareness of what Yahweh will do that day. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here and in verse 5. Alternate translation: [For my part, I also know]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 2:7 (#1)

וְחֲמִשִּׁ֣ים אִ֔ישׁ

“And fifty men”

In this context, **fifty** may be an approximate number rather than an exact one. The idea may be that this was a large group of men and so a credible body of witnesses to what happened in this episode. Your language may have a way of indicating that this may be an approximate number, for example, by using a word rather than digits to represent it.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 2:8 (#1)

וַיֵּחָצְו֣וּ

“and they were divided”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and they moved apart]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 2:8 (#2)

הֵ֥נָּה וָהֵ֖נָּה

“here and here”

The author is using **here and here** as a common expression to indicate that some of the water moved away to one side of Elijah and Elisha and the rest of the water moved away to the other side. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [some to one side and some to the other side]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 2:9 (#1)

וַיְהִ֗י

“And it happened”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author also uses the phrase “And it happened” to introduce new developments within events that he is relating in his story. To translate this phrase here and in similar occurrences in the book, use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new development within an event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 2:9 (#2)

אֶלָּקֵ֖חַ

“I am taken”

The expression **am taken** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh takes me]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 2:9 (#3)

פִּֽי־שְׁנַ֥יִם בְּרוּחֲךָ֖

“a double portion of your spirit”

Elisha is asking Elijah to treat him as if he were his firstborn son. Elisha is alluding to Deuteronomy 21:17, which specified that fathers were to give their firstborn sons twice as much inheritance as their other sons, since the firstborn would need those resources to be the leaders of the next generation. Elisha is aware of his role as Elijah’s appointed successor. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 2:10 (#1)

אִם־תִּרְאֶ֣ה אֹתִ֔י לֻקָּ֖חַ

“If you see me being taken”

The expression **being taken** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way

that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [If you see Yahweh taking me]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 2:10 (#2)

וְאִם־אַיִן לֹא יִהְיֶה

“But if not, it will not be”

Elijah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from earlier in the verse if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [But if you do not see me being taken from you, it will not be thus for you]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 2:11 (#1)

הֵהָמָּה הֹלְכִים הָלוֹךְ וְדַבֵּר

“they were going, going and speaking”

The author is using the term **walking** in its second instance to indicate ongoing action. That was a common usage of this culture. Represent this meaning with an expression that would be natural in your culture. Alternate translation: [they continued on, speaking as they went]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 2:11 (#2)

וְהִנֵּה

“and behold”

See how you translated the term “behold” in 1:9.

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 2:12 (#1)

אָבִי ׀ אָבִי

“My father, my father”

Elisha is referring to Elijah by a respectful title. Use a comparable title or expression for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [My master, my master]

See: Politeness

2 Kings 2:12 (#2)

אָבִי ׀ אָבִי

“My father, my father”

Elisha is repeating the term **My father** in order to intensify his expression of grief and loss. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [My dear father] or [My dear master]

See: Reduplication

2 Kings 2:12 (#3)

רֶכֶב יִשְׂרָאֵל וּפָרָשָׁיו

“the chariotry of Israel and its horsemen”

Elisha is speaking as if Elijah had actually been **chariotry** and **horsemen** defending **Israel**. He means that Elijah’s spiritual leadership, prayers, counsel, and presence provided strength and security for the kingdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Israel’s mighty defender]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 2:12 (#4)

וַיַּחֲזֵק בִּבְגָדָיו וַיִּקְרָעֵם לִשְׁנַיִם קְרָעִים

“And he seized his clothes and tore them into two pieces”

Tearing **his clothes** was a symbolic action by which Elisha showed that he was grieving deeply over the departure of Elijah. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And he grabbed his clothes and tore them into two pieces to show his grief]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 2:13 (#1)

שְׂפַת

“the lip of”

The author is using the term **lip** to mean the bank of the **Jordan** River. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the bank of]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 2:14 (#1)

אַיֵּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי אֵלִיָּהוּ אַף־הוּא

“Where {is} Yahweh, the God of Elijah, even he”

In this instance, Elisha is not using the question form to make a confident statement. He is asking this question because he is seeking information. (Elisha gets the information he is seeking in the form of the waters of the Jordan River parting.) You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Is Yahweh, the God of Elijah, even he, still here with me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 2:14 (#2)

אַיֵּ֥ה יְהוָ֖ה אֱלֹהֵ֣י אֵלִיָּ֑הוּ אַף־הֽוּא

“Where {is} Yahweh, the God of Elijah, even he”

Elisha is emphasizing his question about Yahweh by adding the pronoun **he** at the end. Your language may have its own way of using a pronoun for emphasis. Alternate translation: [Where is Yahweh, he who was the God of Elijah]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 2:14 (#3)

וַיֶּחָצוּ֙ הֵ֣נָּה וָהֵ֔נָּה

“and they were divided, here & here, and”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:8. Alternate translation: [and they moved apart, some to one side and some to the other side]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 2:16 (#1)

אֶת־עֲבָדֶ֔יךָ

“with your servants”

The sons of the prophets are referring to themselves in the third person as **your servants** to show humility and respect toward Elisha. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a humble and respectful form in the first person. Alternate translation: [us, your servants,]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 2:16 (#2)

חֲמִשִּׁ֣ים

“fifty”

As in 2:7, the number **fifty** here may be approximate rather than exact. Alternate translation: [several dozen]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 2:16 (#3)

בְּנֵי־חַ֖יִל

“sons of valor”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author or a character may use the phrase “sons of” to indicate that people have the characteristic of something. Alternate translation: [valiant men] or [strong men]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 2:18 (#1)

הֲלֹ֥וֹא־אָמַ֖רְתִּי אֲלֵיכֶ֑ם אַל־תֵּלֵֽכוּ

“Did I not say to you, ‘Do not go”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Did I not tell you not to go]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 2:18 (#2)

הֲלֹ֥וֹא־אָמַ֖רְתִּי אֲלֵיכֶ֑ם אַל־תֵּלֵֽכוּ

“Did I not say to you, ‘Do not go”

Elisha is using the question form to rebuke the sons of the prophets for not listening to his warning. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I told you that you should not go!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 2:19 (#1)

מוֹשַׁ֣ב הָעִ֔יר טֹ֖וב

“the dwelling place of the city {is} good”

The men of Jericho are speaking as if their city were **dwelling** in its location. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the situation of the city is good] or [the city is in a good location]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 2:19 (#2)

אֲדֹנִ֔י

“my lord”

One of the **men of the city** is speaking to Elisha, so he says **my lord**. However, since he is speaking on behalf

of all of them, it may be more natural in your language to use a plural pronoun. Alternate translation: [our lord]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 2:19 (#3)

אֲדֹנִי

“my lord”

Even though this spokesman for the men of the city is addressing Elisha directly, he is speaking of him in the third person as **my lord** to show respect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a respectful form in the second person. Alternate translation: [you, my lord] or [you, our lord]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 2:19 (#4)

וְהָאָרֶץ מְשַׁכָּלֶת

“so the land is miscarrying”

Here, **the land** represents the people and animals who live on the land. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [so the people and animals who live here are miscarrying]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 2:20 (#1)

קְחוּ־לִי צְלֹחִית חֲדָשָׁה וְשִׂימוּ שָׁם מֶלַח

“Bring to me a new bowl, and put salt there”

Elisha is describing one event, the people putting salt in the bowl, before describing another event that preceded it, bringing the bowl to him. If it would be helpful in your language, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they would happen. Alternate translation: [Put some salt in a new bowl, and bring it to me]

See: Order of Events

2 Kings 2:20 (#2)

צְלֹחִית חֲדָשָׁה

“a new bowl”

Using a **new bowl** for this task, an object unaffected by any previous use, was a symbolic action by which Elisha showed that he was carrying out a holy purpose in Yahweh’s service. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [a bowl that is appropriate for this special purpose because it has never been used before]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 2:20 (#3)

מֶלַח

“salt”

The **salt** that Elisha asked for and used to cleanse the spring symbolized Yahweh’s purifying power, which actually healed the waters. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain this in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [salt, a symbol of Yahweh’s power to purify,]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 2:21 (#1)

כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה רִפֵּאתִי לַמַּיִם הָאֵלֶּה לֹא־יִהְיֶה מִשָּׁם עוֹד מָוֶת וּמְשַׁכָּלֶת

“Thus says Yahweh, ‘I have healed these waters. Death and miscarrying will not still be from there”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that he has healed these waters. Death and miscarrying will not still be from there]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 2:21 (#2)

מָוֶת וּמְשַׁכָּלֶת

“Death and miscarrying”

The phrase **Death and miscarrying** expresses a single idea. The word **miscarrying** tells what is the cause of **Death** in this case. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [Deaths from miscarriages]

See: Hendiadys

2 Kings 2:22 (#1)

וַיֵּרָפְאוּ הַמַּיִם

“And the waters were healed”

The expression **were healed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh healed the waters]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 2:22 (#2)

עַ֚ד הַיּ֣וֹם הַזֶּ֔ה

“to this day”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and that has been the case to this day]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 2:22 (#3)

עַ֚ד הַיּ֣וֹם הַזֶּ֔ה

“to this day”

The author is using the phrase **to this day** to refer to the time at which he is writing. Translators should bear in mind that the phrase refers to a time that is now in the past. They should avoid giving the impression that it means the present day of the translation’s readers. Alternate translation: [at the time when this is being written] or [at the time of this writing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 2:22 (#4)

כִּדְבַ֥ר אֱלִישָׁ֖ע אֲשֶׁ֣ר דִּבֶּֽר

“according to the word of Elisha that he spoke”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:7. Alternate translation: [according to what Elisha said when he spoke]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 2:23 (#1)

קָרֵֽחַ

“bald {one”

These **young men** were using the adjective **bald** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. The ULT indicates that by supplying the word **one**. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent word or phrase. Alternate translation: [baldy]

See: Nominal Adjectives

2 Kings 2:24 (#1)

בְּשֵׁ֥ם יְהוָ֖ה

“in the name of Yahweh”

Here, **the name of Yahweh** represents Yahweh’s power and authority. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by the authority of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings - Chapter 3 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter describes how King Jehoram of Israel led an attack to reconquer Moab, a former vassal state that had rebelled against him, with the help of King Jehoshaphat of Judah and the king of Edom.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did Jehoshaphat want to attack Moab through Edom?

In 3:8, Jehoram asks Jehoshaphat what route their armies should take to reconquer Moab. Jehoshaphat replies that they should go through Edom. There were two main advantages to this route. First, while the northern route across the Jordan River was shorter, it led to a border of Moab that was heavily fortified. While the southern route through the desert was longer and more difficult and dangerous, it led to a border of Moab that was less defended. That made it a strategic route for a surprise attack that caught the Moabites unprepared. Second, this route led through Edom, allowing the two kings to pick up the king of Edom and his army as a further ally along the way, since Edom was a vassal state under Judah’s influence. This strengthened their army and ensured Edom’s loyalty during the campaign.

Why was Elisha traveling with the armies?

King Jehoram of Israel probably did not ask Elisha to accompany his army. Their relationship was strained and marked by mutual distrust. Jehoram was an idolatrous king who continued in the sinful ways of his father, Ahab. Elisha openly rebuked him for following false gods. However, Elisha, as Yahweh’s prophet, did not need to have the king’s approval or invitation to accompany the army. His authority came from Yahweh, and so he came and acted as a spiritual guide to the Israelite soldiers. In the end, his presence was necessary to bring Yahweh’s help to the campaign, including the miraculous provision of water in the desert. As a prophet, Elisha’s authority and purpose enabled him to join the military expedition and represent Yahweh.

Why did Elisha ask for a harpist?
In 3:15, when the kings ask him for direction from Yahweh, Elisha tells them to bring him a harpist. He probably wanted to listen to soft, beautiful music to help prepare his mind and spirit to receive Yahweh's word clearly. This may have been especially helpful on this occasion, since Elisha had just sternly rebuked King Jehoram (3:13). Elisha may have become agitated, and he may have needed to still his thoughts and calm his emotions in order to hear a prophetic message from Yahweh.

Why did the Moabite king try to break through to where the Edomite king was?
In 3:26, the author says that as a final desperate tactic to escape the siege in Kir Hareseth, the king of Moab led 700 swordsmen to try to break through the enemy lines surrounding the city. The author says that he was specifically trying to reach the place where the Edomite army was. He may have done this because he believed the Edomite contingent was the weakest or most vulnerable part of the allied army that was attacking him. He may also have hoped that he could turn the Edomites against the Judeans and Israelites, since Edom was a vassal state of Judah that had rebelled against it in the past, just as he had now rebelled against Israel. However, his attempt was not successful.

What does "great wrath was against Israel" mean?
In 3:27, the author says that after the Moabite king sacrificed his firstborn son publicly on the city wall, "great wrath was against Israel," and the invading army abandoned its siege of Kir Haraseth and left Moab. Interpreters have suggested many different understandings of what this might mean. The following are some of the possibilities. However, since the meaning is so uncertain, we recommend that you leave this as a general statement in your translation. The UST models one way to do that.

- The statement could mean that the Moabite king's sacrifice of his firstborn son made the Moabite soldiers so angry with the Israelites that they fought very hard against them.
- It could mean that the Judean and Edomite kings and their soldiers became angry with the Israelite king for starting a war against Moab that had led to such an outrage, so they refused to keep helping him.
- It could mean that this sacrifice unleashed the evil forces that lie behind idol worship (as the Bible explains in places such as 1 Corinthians 10:20–21) and, because the war against Moab had been instigated by Jehoram, who worshiped Baal, Yahweh would not help him and his allies overcome those forces (compare what Elisha says in 3:14).

2 Kings 3:1 (#1)

וְיֹהוֹרָם בֶּן־אַחְאָב מָלַךְ עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל֙ בְּשֹׁמְר֔וֹן בִּשְׁנַ֖ת שְׁמֹנֶ֑ה
עֶשְׂרֵ֤ה לִיהוֹשָׁפָט֙ מֶ֣לֶךְ יְהוּדָ֔ה וַיִּמְלֹ֖ךְ שְׁתֵּ֥ים־עֶשְׂרֵ֖ה שָׁנָֽה

"Now Jehoram, the son of Ahab, reigned over Israel in Samaria in the year of 18 to Jehoshaphat, the king of Judah. And he reigned {for} 12 years"

In this verse and the next two verses, the author is introducing **Jehoram** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Israel**. In the preceding book of 1 Kings, the author introduced each new king in this same way, and he will introduce each new king this way throughout this book. It would be good to show this in your translation by representing his characteristic phrases the same way each time. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated these phrases in 1 Kings 15:1 and similar instances throughout that book.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 3:1 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַ֖ת שְׁמֹנֶ֑ה עֶשְׂרֵ֤ה לִיהוֹשָׁפָט֙

"in the year of 18 to Jehoshaphat"

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **18**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [in the eighteenth year of Jehoshaphat's reign]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 3:2 (#1)

וַיַּ֥עַשׂ הָרַ֖ע בְּעֵינֵ֣י יְהוָ֑ה

"And he did evil in the eyes of Yahweh"

See how you translated the similar expression "in your eyes" in 1:13. Alternate translation: [And he did what Yahweh considered to be evil]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 3:2 (#2)

הָרַ֖ע

"evil"

The author is using the adjective **evil** as a noun to mean things of a certain kind. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate

this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [evil things] or [what was evil]

See: Nominal Adjectives

2 Kings 3:3 (#1)

בְּחַטֹּאוֹת יָרָבְעָם & דָּבֵק

“he clung to the sins of Jeroboam”

The author is speaking of Jehoram continuing to do sinful things as if he had **clung** to them physically. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he persisted in the sins of Jeroboam] or [he continued to commit the sins of Jeroboam]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 3:3 (#2)

לֹא־סָר מִמֶּנָּה

“He did not turn away from it”

Since the pronoun **it** refers back to the **sins** of Jeroboam, it may be more natural in your language to use a plural pronoun. Alternate translation: [He did not turn away from them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 3:3 (#3)

לֹא־סָר מִמֶּנָּה

“He did not turn away from it”

The author is speaking of Jehoram’s continuing sins as if they were something he could have turned away from physically. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [He did not stop committing them] or [He did not abandon them]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 3:4 (#1)

וּמֵישַׁע מֶלֶךְ־מוֹאָב הָיָה נֹקֵד וְהַשֹּׁשִׁיב לְמֶלֶךְ־יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵאָה־אֶלֶף כָּרִים וּמֵאָה אֶלֶף אֵילִים צָמֶר

“Now Mesha, the king of Moab, was a sheep breeder. And he rendered to the king of Israel 100, 000 lambs and 100, 000 rams {with} wool”

Here the author is providing background information about **Mesha** and his relationship with Israel to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

2 Kings 3:5 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:1.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 3:6 (#1)

בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא

“on that day”

The author is using the term **day** to mean a specific time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at that time]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 3:6 (#2)

אֶת־כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“all of Israel”

See the discussion in the Introduction to 2 Kings of how the author and characters often use the name of a nation, tribe, or city to represent its army. Alternate translation: [the whole Israelite army]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 3:7 (#1)

וַיֵּלֶךְ

“And he went”

In this context, the author does not mean that Jehoram **went** somewhere. He means that he took the action that he describes next. Alternate translation: [And he took action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 3:7 (#2)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

See the discussion of this term in the Introduction to 2 Kings. In contexts such as this, it introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may

not be necessary to represent this phrase explicitly, here or in its other instances in the book.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

2 Kings 3:7 (#3)

אֶעֱלֶה

“I will go up”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [I will go]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 3:7 (#4)

כָּמֹנִי כָמוֹךָ כְּעַמִּי כְעַמֶּךָ כְּסוּסַי כְּסוּסֶיךָ

“Like me, like you. Like my people, like your people. Like my horses, like your horses”

Jehoshaphat is using a common expression of his culture to agree to join Jehoram in an attack against Moab. If this expression does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Kings 22:4, where Jehoshaphat says the same thing to Jehoram’s father Ahab. Alternate translation: [I and my army with its horses will fight alongside you and your army with its horses]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 3:8 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר & וַיֹּאמֶר

“And he said & And he said”

The pronoun **he** refers to Jehoram in the first instance in this verse, while it refers to Jehoshaphat in the second instance. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Jehoram said … And Jehoshaphat replied]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 3:8 (#2)

אֵי־זֶה הַדֶּרֶךְ נַעֲלֶה

“Where {is} this, the way we shall go up”

Jehoram is using **Where is this, the way we shall go up** as a common expression of his culture to ask what **way** or route they should take. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [By what way should we go up]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 3:9 (#1)

וַיָּסֹבּוּ

“and they went around”

The author assumes that readers will understand that by **they went around**, he means that these armies went around the southern end of the Dead Sea. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. You may wish to use the name that this body of water had in biblical times, “the Sea of the Arabah.” Alternate translation: [and they went around the Dead Sea] or [and they went around the Sea of the Arabah]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 3:9 (#2)

לַמַּחֲנֶה

“for the camp”

Here, **the camp** represents the soldiers who were camped there. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for the soldiers]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 3:9 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר בְּרַגְלֵיהֶם

“that {were} at their feet”

The author is using the expression **at their feet** to represent that these **animals** were walking behind the soldiers as they marched. As 3:16 suggests, these probably included cattle to eat, horses to ride into battle, and animals to carry supplies. Alternate translation: [that were walking behind them]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 3:10 (#1)

אֲהָהּ

“Alas”

The king of Israel is using a phrase that expresses a strong feeling, dismay or distress. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you

can use in your translation to convey this feeling. If not, you could say what the king of Israel was feeling, or you could say what made him distressed. Alternate translation: [What a disaster] or [This makes me distressed]

See: Exclamations

2 Kings 3:10 (#2)

כִּי

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [It certainly appears that]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 3:10 (#3)

בְּיַד־מוֹאָב

“into the hand of Moab”

Here, **hand** represents the power or control of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly, here and in verse 13. Alternate translation: [into the power of Moab]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 3:11 (#1)

וַיֹּ֫אמֶר

“and said”

See how you decided at 1:10 to represent the phrase **and said** when it introduces a direct quotation.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

2 Kings 3:11 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר־יָצַק מַ֫יִם עַל־יְדֵי אֵלִיָּהוּ

“who poured water onto the hands of Elijah”

The servant is using **poured water onto the hands of** as a common expression of his culture to mean “served as a personal attendant to.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who was a personal attendant of Elijah]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 3:12 (#1)

יֵ֫שׁ אוֹתָ֥וֹ דְּבַר־יְהוָ֑ה

“The word of Yahweh is with him”

Here, **the word of Yahweh** represents Yahweh speaking through Elisha. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh speaks through him]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 3:12 (#2)

וַיֵּרְדֵ֥ו אֵלָ֛יו מֶ֥לֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל וִיהוֹשָׁפָ֑ט וּמֶ֥לֶךְ אֱדֽוֹם

“And, the king of Israel, and Jehoshaphat and the king of Edom went down to him”

The tents of these kings were probably on a height overlooking the camp of their soldiers, while Elisha was probably staying down within the camp. The author is marking travel for change in elevation. See how you translated the comparable expression “go up” in 1:3. Alternate translation: [And the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat and the king of Edom went to him]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 3:13 (#1)

מַה־לִּ֥י וָלָ֛ךְ

“What to me and to you”

Elisha is using **What to me and to you** as a common expression of his culture to insist that he has nothing in common with the **king of Israel** when it comes to seeking divine guidance. As Elisha notes, King Jehoram worships Baal, and so Elisha says he should ask prophets of Baal to help him rather than a prophet of Yahweh. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated the same expression in 2 Samuel 16:10. Alternate translation: [I want to have nothing to do with your request that I seek divine guidance for you!]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 3:13 (#2)

לֵ֚ךְ אֶל־נְבִיאֵ֣י אָבִ֔יךָ וְאֶל־נְבִיאֵ֖י אִמֶּ֑ךָ

“Go to the prophets of your father and to the prophets of your mother”

Elisha actually means to communicate the opposite of the literal meaning of what he is saying. He does not actually want the king of Israel to consult false prophets. Rather, he is rebuking him for his idolatry. If, for such a purpose, a speaker of your language would not say the opposite of what he meant, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You had no right to come to me, since you and your family worship false gods]

See: Irony

2 Kings 3:14 (#1)

חַי־יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת אֲשֶׁר עָמַדְתִּי לְפָנָיו כִּי לוּלֵי פְּנֵי יְהוֹשָׁפָט מֶלֶךְ־יְהוּדָה אֲנִי נֹשֵׂא אִם־אַבִּיט אֵלֶיךָ וְאִם־אֶרְאֶךָּ

“The life of Yahweh of armies, to whose face I stand, that unless I were lifting the face of Jehoshaphat, the king of Judah, if I would look at you and if I would regard you”

Following the custom of his culture, Elisha is swearing an oath by guaranteeing it by something that he holds sacred and by stating the first part of a condition (“if”) but not the second part (“then”). Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. In a context such as this, it may be natural to express just the first part of the condition as a negative statement. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh of hosts, to whose face I stand, that unless I were lifting the face of Jehoshaphat, the king of Judah, I would not look at you and I would not regard you]

See: Oath Formulas

2 Kings 3:14 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר עָמַדְתִּי לְפָנָיו

“to whose face I stand”

Here, **to whose face I stand** represents being in the presence of Yahweh and serving him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in whose presence I stand] or [whose servant I am]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 3:14 (#3)

לוּלֵי פְּנֵי יְהוֹשָׁפָט מֶלֶךְ־יְהוּדָה אֲנִי נֹשֵׂא אִם־אַבִּיט אֵלֶיךָ וְאִם־אֶרְאֶךָּ

“unless I were lifting the face of Jehoshaphat, the king of Judah, if I would look at you and if I would regard you”

If it would appear in your language that Elisha was making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [I am only looking at you and regarding you because I am lifting the face of Jehoshaphat, the king of Judah]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

2 Kings 3:14 (#4)

לוּלֵי פְּנֵי יְהוֹשָׁפָט & אֲנִי נֹשֵׂא

“unless I were lifting the face of Jehoshaphat”

Elisha is using **lifting the face of** as a common expression of his culture to mean “showing respect to” or “showing favor toward.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [if I did not respect Jehoshaphat]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 3:14 (#5)

אִם־אַבִּיט אֵלֶיךָ וְאִם־אֶרְאֶךָּ

“if I would look at you and if I would regard you”

Elisha is saying he would actually not even **look at** or **regard** the king of Israel. He means that he would not do the slightest thing to help him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I would not do the slightest thing to help you]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 3:14 (#6)

אִם־אַבִּיט אֵלֶיךָ וְאִם־אֶרְאֶךָּ

“if I would look at you and if I would regard you”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [I would not even look at you at all]

See: Parallelism

2 Kings 3:15 (#1)

כְּנַגֵּן הַמְנַגֵּן

“when the harpist harped”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [when the harpist played]

See: Poetry

2 Kings 3:15 (#2)

וַתְּהִי עָלָ֖יו יַד־יְהוָֽה

“that the hand of Yahweh was upon him”

Here, **hand** represents the power of Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that the power of Yahweh came upon him]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 3:16 (#1)

כֹּ֚ה אָמַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה עֲשׂ֥וּ הַנַּ֖חַל הַזֶּ֑ה גֵּבִ֖ים ׀ גֵּבִֽים

“Thus says Yahweh: ‘Make this valley ditches, ditches”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says to make this valley ditches, ditches]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 3:16 (#2)

עֲשׂ֥וּ הַנַּ֖חַל הַזֶּ֑ה גֵּבִ֖ים ׀ גֵּבִֽים

“Make this valley ditches, ditches”

The author is repeating the word **ditches** in order to intensify the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [Dig ditch after ditch in this valley] or [Make this valley full of ditches]

See: Reduplication

2 Kings 3:17 (#1)

כִּֽי־כֹ֚ה ׀ אָמַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה לֹֽא־תִרְא֥וּ רוּחַ֙ וְלֹֽא־תִרְא֣וּ גֶ֔שֶׁם וְהַנַּ֖חַל הַה֣וּא יִמָּלֵ֑א מָ֚יִם וּשְׁתִיתֶ֣ם אַתֶּ֔ם וּמִקְנֵיכֶ֖ם וּבְהֶמְתְּכֶֽם

“For thus says Yahweh, ‘You will not see wind, and you will not see rain, but this valley will be filled {with} water. And you will drink, you and your cattle and your animals”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that you will not see wind, and you will not see rain, but this valley will be filled with water, and you and your cattle and your animals will drink]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 3:17 (#2)

לֹֽא־תִרְא֣וּ רוּחַ֙ וְלֹֽא־תִרְא֣וּ גֶ֔שֶׁם

“You will not see wind, and you will not see rain”

Elisha is referring to all of a rainstorm by naming its two major components, **wind** and **rain**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [You will not see a rainstorm]

See: Merism

2 Kings 3:17 (#3)

וְהַנַּ֖חַל הַה֣וּא יִמָּלֵ֑א מָֽיִם

“but this valley will be filled {with} water”

The expression **will be filled** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but water will fill this valley]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 3:18 (#1)

וְנָקֵ֥ל זֹ֛את בְּעֵינֵ֖י יְהוָ֑ה

“And this is easy in the eyes of Yahweh”

Elisha is using **in the eyes of Yahweh** as a common expression of his culture to mean “in the judgment of Yahweh” or “from Yahweh’s perspective.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And this is easy from Yahweh’s perspective]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 3:18 (#2)

בְּיֶדְכֶֽם

“into your hand”

Here, **hand** represents power or control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent

expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [into your power]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 3:19 (#1)

וְהִכִּיתֶֽם

“And you will strike”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author and characters may use the term “strike” to mean “destroy.” Alternate translation: [And you will destroy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 3:20 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened”

The author is using this phrase to introduce a new development within an event. See how you translated the same phrase in 2:9.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 3:20 (#2)

כַּעֲלֹ֣ות הַמִּנְחָ֔ה

“when the grain offering went up”

The author is speaking of **the grain offering** as if it were a living thing that **went up** by itself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when they offered up the grain offering]

See: Personification

2 Kings 3:20 (#3)

וְהִנֵּה

“that behold”

See how you translated the term “behold” in 1:9.

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 3:20 (#4)

וַתִּמָּלֵ֥א הָאָ֖רֶץ אֶת־הַמָּֽיִם

“and the land was filled with the waters”

The expression **was filled** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [and waters filled the land]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 3:21 (#1)

וְכָל־מֹואָ֑ב

“And all of Moab”

The author is saying **all of Moab** as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [And people throughout Moab]

See: Hyperbole

2 Kings 3:21 (#2)

וַיִּצָּעֲק֥וּ

“And they were summoned”

The expression **were summoned** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the Moabite leaders summoned their soldiers]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 3:21 (#3)

מִכֹּ֖ל חֹגֵ֣ר חֲגֹרָ֑ה

“from every one tying a belt”

Here, **tying a belt** represents being old enough to fight in battle. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from those who were just old enough to bear arms]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 3:22 (#1)

אֲדֻמִּ֥ים כַּדָּֽם

“red like blood”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and they looked red, as if they had been blood]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 3:23 (#1)

הָחֳרֵ֥ב נָחֲרבוּ֙ הַמְּלָכִ֔ים

“Destroying, the kings have destroyed themselves”

The Moabites are repeating forms of the verb “destroy” in order to intensify their expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [The kings have certainly destroyed themselves]

See: Reduplication

2 Kings 3:23 (#2)

הָחָרֵב נָחֲרבוּ֙ הַמְּלָכִ֔ים

“Destroying, the kings have destroyed themselves”

Here, **the kings** represents the opposing kings and the armies they are leading. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The kings have certainly led their armies to fight each other’s armies]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 3:23 (#3)

וַיַּכּ֖וּ אִ֣ישׁ אֶת־רֵעֵ֑הוּ

“and they have struck, a man his fellow”

The pronoun **they** refers to the soldiers. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and their soldiers have all struck each other]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 3:23 (#4)

וַיַּכּ֖וּ אִ֣ישׁ אֶת־רֵעֵ֑הוּ

“and they have struck, a man his fellow”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author may use the term “struck” to mean “killed.” Alternate translation: [and they have killed, a man his fellow]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 3:23 (#5)

וַיַּכּ֖וּ אִ֣ישׁ אֶת־רֵעֵ֑הוּ

“and they have struck, a man his fellow”

The Moabites are using **a man his fellow** as a common expression of their culture to mean that each soldier has killed his opponent. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they have each killed their opponents] or [and they have all killed each other]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 3:23 (#6)

וְעַתָּ֥ה

“And now”

And now was an expression that speakers in this culture commonly used to introduce the implications of what they had been saying. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 3:23 (#7)

מוֹאָ֖ב

“Moab”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:1. Alternate translation: [you Moabites]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 3:24 (#1)

וַיָּקֻ֖מוּ יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“and Israel arose”

See how you translated the term “arose” in 3:7. Alternate translation: [and Israel took action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 3:24 (#2)

וַיַּכּ֥וּ אֶת־מוֹאָ֖ב & וְהַכּ֥וֹת אֶת־מוֹאָֽב

“and they struck Moab & and they struck Moab”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author may use the term “struck” to mean “defeated” or “attacked.” Alternate translation: [and they defeated the Moabite soldiers ... and they attacked the kingdom of Moab]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 3:24 (#3)

מִפְּנֵיהֶ֔ם

“from their face”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author may use the term **face** to put focus on

the interaction between people or groups. Alternate translation: [as they opposed them]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 3:24 (#4)

וַיָּבוֹ־בָהּ וְהַכּוֹת אֶת־מוֹאָב

“And they came into it, and they struck Moab”

It may be more natural in your language to use the noun **Moab** in the first part of this sentence and the pronoun **it** in the second part of the sentence. Alternate translation: [And they came into Moab, and they struck it]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 3:25 (#1)

וְכָל־חֵלֶקָה טֹבָה יַשְׁלִיכוּ אִישׁ־אַבְנוֹ

“and they threw, a man his stone, {on} every good portion”

The author is using **a man his stone** as a common expression of his culture to mean “each of the soldiers threw stones.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and each of the soldiers threw stones on every good portion]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 3:25 (#2)

עַד־הִשְׁאִיר אֲבָנֶיהָ בַּקְקִיר חֲרֶשֶׂת

“until one left its stones {only} in Kir Hareseth”

The author is using the pronoun **one** in a general sense, not to refer to a specific person. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [until the only city whose stone walls were still intact was Kir Hareseth]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 3:25 (#3)

וַיַּכּוּהָ

“and they struck it”

In this context, the word **struck** has the same meaning as in its second instance in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [and they attacked it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 3:26 (#1)

חָזַק מִמֶּנּוּ הַמִּלְחָמָה

“the battle was stronger than him”

The author is speaking of this **battle** as if it had been a living thing that could have been **stronger than** the king of Moab. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he was losing the battle]

See: Personification

2 Kings 3:27 (#1)

וַיְהִי קֶצֶף־גָּדוֹל עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיִּסְעוּ

“And great wrath was against Israel, and they departed”

See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of what this statement could mean.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 3:27 (#2)

וַיְהִי & וַיִּסְעוּ

“And & was & and they departed”

The pronoun **they** refers to the Israelite, Judean, and Edomite soldiers. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the Israelite, Judean, and Edomite soldiers departed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings - Chapter 4 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter begins a section of the book that describes the miracles and prophecies of Elisha.

1. Elisha miraculously provides for a widow (1–7)
2. Elisha helps a woman miraculously have a son (8–17)
3. Elisha raises the woman’s son from the dead (18–37)
4. Elisha makes poisonous food safe (38–41)
5. Elisha multiplies food to feed a crowd (42–44)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

In 4:12–13, why does Elisha call for the Shunammite woman but then have Gehazi speak to her?

Prophets often maintained a degree of separation from direct communication, especially with women, to preserve modesty, reverence, and formality in their ministry. The author says that the Shunammite

woman "stood to his face," likely meaning that she stood outside the door to his room out of respect and humility. Elisha probably remained inside the room while Gehazi acted as messenger between them. This reflected both prophetic custom and social decorum in the ancient Near Eastern culture. However, in 4:15–16, once Elisha had a specific message for her from Yahweh that she would conceive a child, he spoke to her directly, apparently through the open door of his room. This shows that in some contexts, divine messages were so vital and timely that a male prophet would speak them directly to a woman. (Gehazi was present, so the two of them were not alone.)

2 Kings 4:1 (#1)

וְאִשָּׁה אַחַת מִנְּשֵׁי בְנֵי־הַנְּבִיאִים צָעֲקָה אֶל־אֱלִישָׁע

"Now a woman from the wives of the sons of the prophets cried out to Elisha"

The author is introducing this **woman** as a new participant in the story. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants, you could use it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [Now a certain woman, the widow of one of the sons of the prophets, cried out to Elisha]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 4:1 (#2)

לֵאמֹר

"saying"

See how you decided at 3:7 to represent the term **saying** when it introduces a direct quotation.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

2 Kings 4:1 (#3)

וְאַתָּה יָדַעְתָּ

"and you, you know"

The woman is stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the verb translated as **you know** already includes this meaning. She is doing that to emphasize Elisha's personal awareness of her late husband's faith. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [and you know personally]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 4:2 (#1)

אֵין לְשִׁפְחָתְךָ כֹּל֙ בַּבַּ֔יִת כִּ֖י אִם־אָסֹ֑וךְ שָׁמֶן

"There is not to your maidservant anything in the house except a jar of oil"

If it would appear in your language that the woman was making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [The only thing your maidservant has in the house is a jar of oil]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

2 Kings 4:2 (#2)

לְשִׁפְחָתְךָ

"to your maidservant"

The woman is speaking of herself in the third person as **your maidservant** to show humility. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a humble form in the first person. Alternate translation: [me, your maidservant,]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 4:3 (#1)

אַל־תַּמְעִיטִי

"Do not get few"

Elisha is emphasizing a positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with a term, **few**, that is the opposite of his intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could emphasize the positive meaning in a strong way. Alternate translation: [Get as many as you can]

See: Litotes

2 Kings 4:4 (#1)

בָּנַ֔יִךְ

"your sons"

Since the woman uses the term "children" in 4:1, it is likely that the masculine term **sons** has a generic sense here that includes both boys and girls. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that indicates that, here and verses 5 and 7. Alternate translation: [your children]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

2 Kings 4:4 (#2)

וְהַמְלֵא֙ תַּסִּ֔יעִי

"And the full, set aside"

Elisha is using the adjective **full** as a noun to mean a certain kind of vessel or container. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [And the full vessel, set aside] or [And once a vessel is full, set it aside]

See: Nominal Adjectives

2 Kings 4:4 (#3)

וְהַמְּלֵאָ֖ה תַּסִּ֥יעִי

“And the full, set aside”

Elisha assumes that the widow will understand that she should continue pouring oil into each container until it is full before moving on to the next one and that she should set each full container aside to make room for filling empty ones. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And once a vessel is full, set it aside and fill another vessel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 4:5 (#1)

וַתֵּ֤לֶךְ מֵאִתּוֹ֙ וַתִּסְגֹּ֣ר הַדֶּ֔לֶת

“And she went from him, and she shut the door”

The author assumes that readers will understand that the woman followed Elisha’s instructions in verse 3 to borrow containers from her neighbors before she returned home and shut the door. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And she went from him and asked for empty vessels from all of her neighbors, then came home and shut the door]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 4:7 (#1)

וְאַתְּ֥ בניכי תֶּחְיִ֖י בַּנּוֹתָֽר

“And you may live on the rest, you and your sons”

The word **you** is singular in both of these instances because Elisha is addressing the woman directly. So use the singular form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

2 Kings 4:8 (#1)

וַיְהִ֣י הַיּ֔וֹם

“And it was the day”

The author is using the phrase translated **And it was the day** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 4:8 (#2)

לֶ֖חֶם & לֶ֑חֶם

“bread & bread”

The author is using one kind of food, **bread**, to mean food in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [some food ... some food]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 4:9 (#1)

הִנֵּ֣ה

“Behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:9.

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 4:10 (#1)

עֲלִיַּת־קִ֥ירׇ קְטַנָּ֖ה

“a small upper room of a wall”

This expression most likely refers to a room that the woman and her husband built on the flat roof of their house with walls on all sides for privacy and protection from the weather. The roof would have been reached by an exterior stairway, so Elisha would have had privacy, and his comings and goings would not have disturbed the household. You may be able to describe this room in terms of your own culture.

See: Translate Unknowns

2 Kings 4:11 (#1)

וַיְהִ֣י הַיּ֔וֹם

“And it was the day”

The author is using the phrase translated **And it was the day** to introduce a new development within this account of the Shunammite woman. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 4:12 (#1)

לְפָנָ֑יו

“to his face”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author and characters may use the term “face” to mean “in front of.” Alternate translation: [in front of him] or [near his room]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 4:13 (#1)

אֱמָר־נָ֣א אֵלֶ֔יהָ הִנֵּ֥ה חָרַ֖דְתְּ ׀ אֵלֵ֑ינוּ אֶת־כָּל־הַחֲרָדָ֣ה הַזֹּ֔את מֶ֥ה לֵעָשׂ֖וֹת לָ֑ךְ הֲיֵ֥שׁ לְדַבֶּר־לָ֖ךְ אֶל־הַמֶּ֥לֶךְ אוֹ֖ אֶל־שַׂ֥ר הַצָּבָ֖א

“Please say to her, ‘Behold, you have cared all of this care for us. What to do for you? Is there to speak for you to the king or to the commander of the army”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Please tell her that behold, she has cared all of this care for us, and ask her what we may do for her. Ask her if we may speak for her to the king or to the commander of the army]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 4:13 (#2)

חָרַ֖דְתְּ ׀ אֵלֵ֑ינוּ אֶת־כָּל־הַחֲרָדָ֣ה הַזֹּ֔את

“you have cared all of this care for us”

Elisha is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [you have taken such good care of us]

See: Poetry

2 Kings 4:16 (#1)

לַמּוֹעֵ֣ד הַזֶּ֔ה כָּעֵ֖ת חַיָּ֑ה

“In this season, according to the time of reviving”

Elisha is using **according to the time of reviving** as a common expression of his culture to mean “when spring comes again.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [In the spring of next year]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 4:16 (#2)

בְּשִׁפְחָתֶ֖ךָ

“to your maidservant”

The Shunammite woman is speaking of herself in the third person as **your maidservant** to show humility. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a humble form in the first person. Alternate translation: [to me, your maidservant]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 4:17 (#1)

לַמּוֹעֵ֣ד הַזֶּ֔ה כָּעֵ֖ת חַיָּ֑ה

“in that season, according to the time of reviving”

See how you translated the similar expressions in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [in the spring of the following year]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 4:18 (#1)

וַיְהִ֥י הַיּ֖וֹם

“And it was the day”

The author is using the phrase translated **And it was the day** to introduce a new development within this account of the Shunammite woman. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 4:19 (#1)

רֹאשִׁ֥י ׀ רֹאשִׁ֖י

“My head, my head”

The child is repeating the phrase **My head** in order to intensify his expression of the idea he wishes to convey, which is that his head hurts. If your language can repeat phrases for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [Ouch, my head really hurts]

See: Reduplication

2 Kings 4:21 (#1)

וַתְּסְגֹּ֥ר בְּעָדָ֖ו וַתֵּצֵֽא

“And she shut on him, and she went out”

The author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. If it would be helpful in your language, you may wish to relate these events

in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [And she went out, and she shut on him]

See: Order of Events

2 Kings 4:21 (#2)

וַתִּסְגֹּ֥ר בַּעֲדָֽו׃

“And she shut on him”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And she shut the door on him]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 4:22 (#1)

וְאָרֻ֖צָה עַד־אִ֣ישׁ הָאֱלֹהִ֑ים

“and let me run to the man of God”

Since the woman has asked for a donkey to ride on, she does not mean that she will literally **run** to see Elisha. Alternate translation: [and let me hurry to the man of God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 4:23 (#1)

שָׁלֽוֹם

“Peace”

The woman is using **Peace** as a common expression of her culture to mean that she does not want her husband to ask her further questions about why she is going. She wants him to trust her and be confident that she has a good reason. If this expression does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Trust me] or [Do not worry]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 4:24 (#1)

וַתַּחֲבֹ֥שׁ הָאָתֹ֖ון

“And she saddled the donkey”

When the author says that **she** (the Shunammite woman) saddled the donkey, he is using her, as one person who was involved in this action, to represent everyone who was involved. It is likely that she directed a servant to saddle the donkey. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And she had a servant saddle the donkey]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 4:24 (#2)

אַל־תַּעֲצָר־לִ֥י לָרְכֹּ֖ב כִּֽי־אִם־אָמַ֥רְתִּי אֵלָֽיִךְ׃

“Do not slacken for me to ride unless I say to you”

If it would appear in your language that the woman was making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [Only slacken for me to ride if I tell you to do that]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

2 Kings 4:26 (#1)

וֶאֱמָר־לָ֣הּ הֲשָׁלֹ֣ום לָ֔ךְ הֲשָׁלֹ֥ום לְאִישֵׁ֖ךְ הֲשָׁלֹ֣ום לַיֶּ֑לֶד

“and say to her, ‘{Is} welfare to you? {Is} welfare to your husband? {Is} welfare to the child”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and ask her whether she and her husband and her child are all right]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 4:26 (#2)

שָׁלֽוֹם

“Peace”

Although the word **Peace** is the same one that the ULT translates as **welfare** in the three earlier instances in this verse, the woman seems to be using the word to mean the same thing that she meant in 4:23 when she said it to her husband. She is indicating that she does not want to stop to answer Gehazi’s questions. If this word would not convey that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that would convey that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will explain everything when I get to Elisha]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 4:27 (#1)

וַתַּחֲזֵ֥ק בְּרַגְלָ֖יו

“and she held onto his feet”

Grasping Elisha’s feet was a symbolic action by which the woman showed her desperation and humility as she appealed to him for help. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this

action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and she humbly begged him for help by holding onto his feet]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 4:27 (#2)

הַרְפֶּה־לָהּ֙ כִּי־נַפְשָׁ֣הּ מָרָ֔ה לָ֑הּ וַיהוָ֣ה הֶעְלִ֤ים מִמֶּנִּי֙ וְלֹ֣א הִגִּ֔יד לִֽי

“Leave her alone, for her soul {is} bitter to her, but Yahweh has hidden from me, and he has not declared to me”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Her soul is bitter to her, but Yahweh has hidden the reason from me, and he has not declared it to me, so leave her alone]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 4:27 (#3)

וַיהוָ֣ה הֶעְלִ֤ים מִמֶּנִּי֙ וְלֹ֣א הִגִּ֔יד לִֽי

“but Yahweh has hidden from me, and he has not declared to me”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [but Yahweh has not revealed anything about it to me]

See: Parallelism

2 Kings 4:28 (#1)

הֲשָׁאַ֥לְתִּי בֵֽן־מֵאֵ֖ת אֲדֹנִ֑י

“Did I request a son from my lord”

The Shunammite woman is using the question form for emphasis and to deny that she requested a son. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I did not request a son from my lord!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 4:28 (#2)

מֵאֵ֖ת אֲדֹנִ֑י

“from my lord”

Even though the woman is addressing Elisha directly, she is speaking of him in the third person as **my lord** to show respect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a respectful form in the second person. Alternate translation: [from you, my lord]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 4:28 (#3)

הֲלֹ֣א אָמַ֔רְתִּי לֹ֥א תַשְׁלֶ֖ה אֹתִֽי

“Did I not say, ‘Do not deceive me”

The woman is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Instead, I said, ‘Do not deceive me’!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 4:28 (#4)

הֲלֹ֣א אָמַ֔רְתִּי לֹ֥א תַשְׁלֶ֖ה אֹתִֽי

“Did I not say, ‘Do not deceive me”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Did I not tell you not to deceive me.] or [Instead, I told you not to deceive me.]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 4:29 (#1)

חֲגֹ֣ר מָתְנֶ֗יךָ וְקַ֤ח מִשְׁעַנְתִּי֙ בְּיָדְךָ֔ וָלֵ֖ךְ

“Gird your loins, and take my staff in your hand, and go”

By telling Gehazi that he should **Gird** his **loins** (that is, tuck his robe into his belt so that he can run), Elisha means that he should hurry. Alternate translation: [Quickly, take my staff in your hand, and go!]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 4:29 (#2)

כִּֽי־תִמְצָ֣א אִ֔ישׁ

“If you find a man”

Elisha does not mean that Gehazi would be looking for someone and **find** him somewhere. He means that Gehazi might meet someone on his way to Shunem. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [If you meet a man]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 4:29 (#3)

אִישׁ & אִישׁ

“a man & a man”

In both instances, the masculine term **man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [anyone ... anyone]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

2 Kings 4:29 (#4)

לֹא תְבָרְכֶנּוּ וְכִי־יְבָרֶכְךָ אִישׁ לֹא תַעֲנֶנּוּ

“you shall not bless him, and if a man blesses you, you shall not answer him”

Elisha assumes that Gehazi will understand that he is not to stop to greet people or exchange greetings, because doing so would delay his urgent mission to the Shunammite woman’s son. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you shall not stop to greet him, and if a man greets you, you shall not stop to exchange greetings with him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 4:30 (#1)

חַי־יְהוָה וְחֵי־נַפְשְׁךָ אִם־אֶעֱזָבֶךָּ

“The life of Yahweh and the life of your soul, if I should leave you”

Following the custom of her culture, the woman is swearing an oath by guaranteeing it by something that she holds sacred and by stating the first part of a condition (“if”) but not the second part (“then”). Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. In a context such as this, it may be natural to express just the first part of the condition as a negative statement. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh and by the life of your soul that I will not leave you]

See: Oath Formulas

2 Kings 4:30 (#2)

וְחֵי־נַפְשְׁךָ

“and the life of your soul”

The woman is using one part of Elisha, his **soul**, to mean all of him in the act of being alive. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and your life]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 4:30 (#3)

אִם־אֶעֱזָבֶךָּ

“if I should leave you”

The woman is not saying that she will not leave Mount Carmel. She means that when she goes back to her home, she will not leave Elisha behind. In other words, she is insisting that he come with her. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [if I should leave here without you] or [that I will not leave here without you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 4:31 (#1)

לִפְנֵיהֶם

“to their faces”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:12. Alternate translation: [ahead of them]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 4:31 (#2)

וַיָּשָׁב לִקְרָאתוֹ

“And he returned to meet him”

The pronoun **he** refers to Gehazi, while the pronoun **him** refers to Elisha. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Gehazi returned to meet Elisha]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 4:31 (#3)

לֹא הֵקִיץ

“did not awaken”

The author is speaking as though the young man had been asleep and **did not awaken**. He is using sleep to represent death. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [did not come back to life]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 4:32 (#1)

מֻשְׁכָּב עַל־מִטָּתוֹ

“having been laid on his bed”

The expression **having been laid** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [on his bed where his mother had laid him]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 4:34 (#1)

וַיַּ֥עַל

“And he went up”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:4. Alternate translation: [And he got into the bed]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 4:34 (#2)

וַיָּ֨שֶׂם פִּ֜יו עַל־פִּ֗יו וְעֵינָ֤יו עַל־עֵינָיו֙ וְכַפָּ֣יו עַל־כפו

“and he put his mouth on his mouth, and his eyes on his eyes, and his palms on his palms”

Through these actions, Elisha symbolized that he wanted Yahweh to work through him to restore breathing, sight, and feeling to the boy. This was like a prayer that Elisha was acting out. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote.

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 4:35 (#1)

וַיָּ֖שָׁב וַיֵּ֣לֶךְ בַּבַּ֑יִת

“And he returned, and he walked in the house”

This could mean: (1) that Elisha went back down to the house and walked around in it for a while. Alternate translation: [Then Elisha went back down to the house and walked around in it] or (2) that Elisha got off the bed and walked around in the room. Alternate translation: [Then Elisha got off the bed and walked around in the room]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 4:35 (#2)

וַיֵּ֣לֶךְ בַּבַּ֔יִת אַחַ֖ת הֵֽהֵנָּ֑ה וְאַחַ֖ת הֵֽהֵנָּ֑ה

“and he walked in the house, once here and once here”

The author is using **once here and once here** as a common expression of his culture to mean “back and forth.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he walked back and forth in the house]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 4:36 (#1)

וַיִּקְרָ֣אֶה וַתָּבֹ֔וא אֵלָ֖יו

“And he called her, and she came to him”

The pronoun **he** refers to Gehazi, while the pronoun **him** refers to Elisha. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Gehazi called her, and she came to Elisha]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 4:36 (#2)

שְׂאִ֖י בְּנֵֽךְ

“Pick up your son”

This is an imperative, but it communicates permission rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates permission. Elisha is assuring the woman that her son is well enough for her to hold him in her arms. Alternate translation: [Your son is well enough for you to pick him up and hold him]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

2 Kings 4:37 (#1)

וַתִּפֹּ֥ל עַל־רַגְלָ֖יו

“and she fell at his feet”

Be sure that it is clear in your translation that the woman did not fall down accidentally. She knelt down in front of Elisha as a gesture to honor him. She then **prostrated herself** or stretched out flat on the ground to show him even greater honor as a prophet who had done a great miracle by Yahweh’s power. Alternate translation: [and she knelt on the ground in front of Elisha, stretching herself out flat, to honor him greatly]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 4:38 (#1)

וְהָרָעָ֖ב בָּאָֽרֶץ

“and famine {was} in the land”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information

in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

2 Kings 4:38 (#2)

לְפָנָיו

“to his face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:14. Alternate translation: [in his presence]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 4:39 (#1)

וַיְפַלַּח אֶל־סִּיר הַנָּזִיד כִּי־לֹא יָדָעוּ

“and he sliced {them} into the pot of stew, for they did not know”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [and since they did not know, he sliced them into the pot of stew]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 4:39 (#2)

לֹא יָדָעוּ

“they did not know”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [they did not know that the gourds were poisonous]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 4:40 (#1)

כְּאָכְלָם מֵהַנָּזִיד וְהֵמָּה צָעָקוּ

“as they ate from the stew, that they, they cried out”

The author is stating the pronoun **they** separately, even though the verb translated as **they cried out** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that this action took place at the same time as the men’s action of eating **the stew**. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [as soon as they tasted the stew, that they cried out]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 4:40 (#2)

מָוֶת

“Death {is”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **Death**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Something deadly]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Kings 4:42 (#1)

וְאִישׁ בָּא מִבַּעַל שָׁלִשָׁה

“And a man came from Baal Shalishah”

The author is introducing this **man ... from Baal Shalishah** as a new participant in the story. This also serves to introduce a new episode in the overall account of how Elisha fed the sons of the prophets during the famine described in 4:38. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants and new episodes, you could use it here in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 4:42 (#2)

וַיֹּאמֶר

“And he said”

The pronoun **he** refers to Elisha. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Elisha said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 4:43 (#1)

מָה אֶתֵּתֵן זֶה לִפְנֵי מֵאָה אִישׁ

“How shall I set this to the face of a hundred men”

The servant is using the question form to emphasize that the amount of food is not enough. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [This is not enough food to feed a hundred men!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 4:43 (#2)

אֶתֵּתֵן זֶה לִפְנֵי

“shall I set this to the face of”

To translate this expression here and in the next verse, see how you translated the similar expression in 4:12. Alternate translation: [shall I put this in front of] or [shall I serve this to]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 4:43 (#3)

כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה אָכֹל וְהוֹתֵר

“thus says Yahweh, ‘Eating and leaving over”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that they will have enough to eat, and there will be some left over]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 4:44 (#1)

כִּדְבַר יְהוָה

“according to the word of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:7. Alternate translation: [according to what Yahweh had said]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings - Chapter 5 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the section of the book that describes the miracles and prophecies of Elisha. It describes how through him, Yahweh healed the Aramean military commander Naaman of leprosy.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

In his letter, why did the king of Aram ask the king of Israel to cure Naaman’s leprosy?

When Naaman learned from a captured Israelite girl that there was a miracle-working prophet in Samaria, he told the king of Aram about this. The Aramean king then wrote a letter to the king of Israel that said (5:6), “I have sent to you Naaman my servant, and you shall remove him from his leprosy” (that is, “you shall cure his leprosy”). The Aramean king most likely meant that the Israelite king was to use his power and influence to get the prophet to cure Naaman. This was a customary way for people to speak about kings at this time. (Compare the way the author says in this book and in 1 Kings that a king “built” a city or a building, meaning that he had his workers do that.) However, the king of Israel misunderstood what the king of Aram meant, probably because there were already hostile relations between their kingdoms and so he was prepared to suspect that the Aramean king was trying to create an occasion for a fight with him (5:7).

2 Kings 5:1 (#1)

וְנַעֲמָן שַׂר־צְבָא מֶלֶךְ־אֲרָם הָיָה אִישׁ גָּדוֹל לִפְנֵי אֲדֹנָיו וּנְשֻׂא פָנִים כִּי־בוֹ נָתַן־יְהוָה תְּשׁוּעָה לַאֲרָם

“Now Naaman, the commander of the army of the king of Aram, was a great man to the face of his master, and he was lifted of face, because through him Yahweh gave deliverance to Aram”

The author is introducing **Naaman** as a new participant in the story. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants, you could use it here in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 5:1 (#2)

וְנַעֲמָן שַׂר־צְבָא מֶלֶךְ־אֲרָם הָיָה אִישׁ גָּדוֹל לִפְנֵי אֲדֹנָיו וּנְשֻׂא פָנִים כִּי־בוֹ נָתַן־יְהוָה תְּשׁוּעָה לַאֲרָם

“Now Naaman, the commander of the army of the king of Aram, was a great man to the face of his master, and he was lifted of face, because through him Yahweh gave deliverance to Aram”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Now since Yahweh gave deliverance to Aram through Naaman, the commander of the army of the king of Aram, he was a great man to the face of his master, and he was lifted of face]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 5:1 (#3)

לִפְנֵי אֲדֹנָיו

“to the face of his master”

In this context, the phrase **to the face of** means “in front of,” as in 4:12 and similar instances. But here it conveys the further idea that Naaman was where the king of Aram could see him, and so it indicates the regard that the king had for him. Alternate translation: [in the regard of his master]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 5:1 (#4)

וּנְשֵׂא פָנִים

“and he was lifted of face”

The expression **was lifted** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and his master lifted his face]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 5:1 (#5)

וּנְשֵׂא פָנִים

“and he was lifted of face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:14. Alternate translation: [and his master respected him]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 5:1 (#6)

נָתַן־יְהוָה תְּשׁוּעָה לַאֲרָם

“Yahweh gave deliverance to Aram”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **deliverance**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Yahweh delivered Aram from its enemies]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Kings 5:1 (#7)

וְהָאִישׁ הָיָה גִּבּוֹר חַיִל

“And the man was mighty of valor”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **valor**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And he was a valiant man]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Kings 5:1 (#8)

מְצֹרָע

“a leper”

The author intends for readers to understand a contrast between the facts that Naaman was **might of valor** and that he was **a leper**. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but he was a leper]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

2 Kings 5:2 (#1)

וַאֲרַמִּים

“And Aram”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:6. Alternate translation: [Aramean soldiers]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 5:2 (#2)

וַתְּהִי לִפְנֵי אֵשֶׁת נַעֲמָן

“And she was to the face of the wife of Naaman”

In this context, the phrase **to the face of** means that this **girl** was “in front of” the **wife of Naaman**, but it conveys the further idea that she was there because she was her servant. Alternate translation: [And she was a servant of the wife of Naaman]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 5:3 (#1)

אַחֲלֵי

“Oh that”

The servant girl is using a phrase that expresses a strong feeling, a wish. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. If not, you could say what the girl was wishing for. Alternate translation: [I wish that]

See: Exclamations

2 Kings 5:3 (#2)

לִפְנֵי

“was} to the face of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:14. Alternate translation: [was in the presence of] or [could go and see]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 5:3 (#3)

אָז יֶאֱסֹף אֹתוֹ מִצָּרַעְתּוֹ

“Then he would remove him from his leprosy”

The servant girl is using the expression **remove him from his leprosy** to mean “cure him of his leprosy” or “heal his leprosy.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly, here

and in verses 6 and 7. Alternate translation: [Then he would remove his leprosy from him]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 5:4 (#1)

וַיָּבֹ֣א

“And one came”

The pronoun **he** refers to Naaman. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Naaman came]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 5:4 (#2)

לֵאמֹ֗ר כָּזֹ֤את וְכָזֹאת֙ דִּבְּרָ֣ה הַנַּעֲרָ֔ה אֲשֶׁ֖ר מֵאֶ֣רֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“saying, “Like this and like this the girl spoke who {is} from the land of Israel”

Naaman did not actually say the words **Like this and like this**. The author is using that expression to summarize what Naaman told the king of Aram. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see what you decided to do in the case of the same expression in 1 Kings 14:5. Alternate translation: [telling him what the girl who was from the land of Israel had said]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

2 Kings 5:5 (#1)

לֵ֥ךְ־בֹּ֖א

“Go, enter”

The king of Aram is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. (The brevity of this statement may indicate immediate agreement and urgency, and you may wish to show that in your translation.) Alternate translation: [All right, go from here in Aram right away and enter the land of Israel]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 5:5 (#2)

וַיִּקַּ֤ח בְּיָדוֹ֙

“and he took in his hand”

The author does not mean that Naaman somehow held all of this **silver** and **gold** and clothing in his **hand**. He is using the term “hand” to indicate that Naaman was the agent who conveyed these things, probably commanding soldiers who carried them. (The author says in 5:9 that he came with horses and chariots, and the author refers in 5:15 to his “camp,” meaning his soldiers.) If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 2 Samuel 8:10. Alternate translation: [and he had his servants convey]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 5:5 (#3)

עֲשֶׂ֥ר כִּכְּרֵי־כֶ֖סֶף

“10 kikkars of silver”

These 10 **kikkars of silver** weighed over 330 kilograms or about 750 pounds. In your translation, you could use the ancient measurement and spell the word “kikkar” the way it sounds in your language. You could also use the metric measurement given in the UST or use the measurement that your language and culture customarily use. Alternatively, you could use the ancient measurement and put a modern measurement in parentheses in the text or in a footnote.

See: Biblical Weight

2 Kings 5:5 (#4)

וְשֵׁ֣שֶׁת אֲלָפִ֔ים זָהָ֖ב

“and 6,000 gold”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and 6,000 gold shekels]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 5:5 (#5)

וְשֵׁ֣שֶׁת אֲלָפִ֔ים זָהָ֖ב

“and 6,000 gold”

These 6,000 shekels of **gold** would have weighed nearly 70 kilograms or about 150 pounds. In your translation, you could use the ancient measurement and spell the word “shekel” the way it sounds in your language. You could also use the metric measurement given in the UST or the measurement that your language and culture customarily use. Alternatively, you could use the ancient measurement and put a modern

measurement in parentheses in the text or in a footnote.

See: Biblical Weight

2 Kings 5:6 (#1)

לֵאמֹ֖ר

“saying”

The term **saying** introduces a direct quotation, but it is a quotation of what the king of Aram wrote in the letter, not something that Naaman said to the king of Israel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the letter said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

2 Kings 5:6 (#2)

וְעַתָּ֗ה

“And now”

And now was an expression that speakers in this culture commonly used to introduce an important point. Sometimes, as in this case, they would use it at the beginning of a letter. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. See how you translated this expression in 3:23.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 5:6 (#3)

הִנֵּ֤ה

“behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:9.

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 5:7 (#1)

הַאֱלֹהִ֣ים אָ֔נִי לְהָמִ֖ית וְלְהַחֲיֹ֑ות כִּי־זֶ֣ה׀ שֹׁלֵ֣חַ אֵלַ֗י לֶאֱסֹ֛ף אִ֥ישׁ מִצָּרַעְתֹּ֖ו

“Am} I God, killing and making alive, that this {one} is sending to me to remove a man from his leprosy”

The king of Israel is using the question form to emphasize that he cannot heal Naaman. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I am not God, killing and making alive, so this man should not be sending to me to remove a man from his leprosy!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 5:7 (#2)

כִּֽי־אַ֗ךְ

“For surely”

Here the word **For**, together with the word **surely**, introduces what the king believes is an obvious inference. Alternate translation: [Since that is obviously not the case,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 5:7 (#3)

דְּעוּ֙ & וּרְא֔וּ כִּ֥י

“know and see that”

The king of Israel is using **know and see** as a common expression of his culture to mean “consider carefully.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Kings 20:7. Alternate translation: [consider carefully]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 5:7 (#4)

דְּעוּ֙ & וּרְא֔וּ

“know and see”

The implied “you” in the imperatives **know** and **see** is plural because the king is addressing his court officials. So use plural forms in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

2 Kings 5:8 (#1)

לָ֣מָּה קָרַ֔עְתָּ בְּגָדֶ֖יךָ

“Why did you tear your clothes”

Elisha is using the question form to suggest to the king of Israel that he did not need to respond so dramatically to the Aramean king’s letter. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You did not need to tear your clothes!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 5:10 (#1)

וְיָשֹׁ֥ב בְּשָׂרְךָ֖ לְךָ֑

“and your flesh will return to you”

Elisha is speaking of Naaman’s **flesh** as if it were a living thing that could return to him on its own. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and your flesh will be restored to its former condition]

See: Personification

2 Kings 5:10 (#2)

וּטְהָֽר

“and be clean”

While the expression **be clean** is an imperative, this was not a command that Naaman was capable of obeying. Instead, it describes what the result would be if Naaman did obey Elisha’s instructions to **wash** in the **Jordan** River **seven times**. Alternate translation: [and you will become clean] or [and you will no longer be a leper]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

2 Kings 5:11 (#1)

אָמַ֣רְתִּי אֵלַ֔י ׀ יֵצֵ֥א יָצוֹא֙ וְעָמַד֙ וְקָרָ֣א בְּשֵׁם־יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהָ֔יו וְהֵנִ֥יף יָד֖וֹ אֶל־הַמָּקֹ֑ום וְאָסַ֖ף הַמְּצֹרָֽע

“I said to myself, ‘Coming out, he will come out, and he will stand, and he will call on the name of Yahweh his God, and he will wave his hand over the place, and he will remove the leprosy”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [I said to myself that coming out, he would come out, and he would stand, and he would call on the name of Yahweh his God, and he would wave his hand over the place, and he would remove the leprosy]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 5:11 (#2)

יֵצֵ֥א יָצוֹא֙

“Coming out, he will come out”

Naaman is repeating forms of the verb **come out** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [He will certainly come out]

See: Reduplication

2 Kings 5:11 (#3)

וְקָרָ֣א בְּשֵׁם־יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהָ֔יו

“and he will call on the name of Yahweh his God”

Naaman is using **call on the name of** as a common expression of his culture to mean “pray to by name.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the same expression in 1 Kings 18:24. Alternate translation: [and he will call on Yahweh his God by name] or [and he will specifically invoke Yahweh his God]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 5:12 (#1)

הֲלֹ֣א טֹובְ֣ אבנה וּפַרְפַּ֗ר נַהֲרוֹת֙ דַּמֶּ֣שֶׂק מִכֹּל֙ מֵימֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל הֲלֹא־אֶרְחַ֥ץ בָּהֶ֖ם וְטָהָ֑רְתִּי

“Are} not Abanah and Pharpar, the rivers of Damascus, better than all of the waters of Israel? Shall I not bathe in them and become clean”

Naaman is using the question form to express his indignation. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate these questions as statement or as exclamations. Alternate translation: [Certainly Abanah and Pharpar, the rivers of Damascus, are better than all of the waters of Israel! If I want to become clean, I should bathe in them!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 5:12 (#2)

בְּחֵמָֽה

“in heat”

The author is speaking as if Naaman’s anger were actually **heat**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in a rage]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 5:13 (#1)

אָבִי֙

“My father”

While the author says that Naaman’s **servants** approached him, it is clear that one servant is speaking on behalf of all of them, since he uses the singular pronoun **My**. It may be more natural in some languages

to use a plural pronoun, since the servant is speaking for a group. Alternate translation: [Our father]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 5:13 (#2)

אָבִי

“My father”

This servant is referring to Naaman by a respectful title. Use a comparable title or expression for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [Master]

See: Politeness

2 Kings 5:13 (#3)

אָבִי דָּבָר גָּדוֹל הַנָּבִיא דִּבֶּר אֵלֶיךָ הֲלֹוא תַעֲשֶׂה

“My father, {if} the prophet had spoken a great matter to you, would you not have done {it”

Naaman’s servants are using the question form to try to convince him to obey Elisha. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [if the prophet spoke a great matter to you, you would certainly do it!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 5:13 (#4)

וְאַף

“Then how much more”

The servants are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Then how much more should you do it]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 5:13 (#5)

אָמַר אֵלֶיךָ רְחַץ וּטְהָר

“he has said to you, ‘Wash and be clean”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [he has told you to wash and be clean]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 5:13 (#6)

רְחַץ וּטְהָר

“Wash and be clean”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:10. Alternate translation: [Wash, and you will become clean!]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

2 Kings 5:14 (#1)

וַיֵּרֶד

“So he went down”

See how you translated the comparable expression “go up” in 1:3. Alternate translation: [So he went]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 5:14 (#2)

כִּדְבַר אִישׁ הָאֱלֹהִים

“according to the word of the man of God”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:7. Alternate translation: [according to what the man of God had said]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 5:14 (#3)

וַיָּשָׁב בְּשָׂרוֹ כִּבְשַׂר נַעַר קָטֹן

“And his flesh returned like the flesh of a little boy”

Here the author is speaking of Naaman’s **flesh** as if it were a living thing that could have **returned** to him on its own. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And his flesh became once again like the flesh of a little boy]

See: Personification

2 Kings 5:14 (#4)

וַיָּשָׁב בְּשָׂרוֹ כִּבְשַׂר נַעַר קָטֹן

“And his flesh returned like the flesh of a little boy”

The point of this comparison is that just as **a young little boy** has healthy skin, so Naaman did as well. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and his skin became healthy again, just like the skin of a little boy]

See: Simile

2 Kings 5:15 (#1)

לְפָנָיו׃

“to his face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:14. Alternate translation: [in his presence]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 5:15 (#2)

אֵין אֱלֹהִים בְּכָל־הָאָרֶץ כִּי אִם־בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל

“there is no God in all of the earth except in Israel”

If it would appear in your language that Naaman was making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [the only true God in all of the earth is in Israel]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

2 Kings 5:15 (#3)

וְעַתָּה

“And now”

See how you translated this expression in 3:23 and 5:6.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 5:15 (#4)

מֵאֵת עַבְדֶּךָ

“from your servant”

Naaman is speaking of himself in the third person as **your servant** to show humility. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a humble form in the first person, here and in the similar instances in verses 17 and 18. Alternate translation: [from me, your servant]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 5:16 (#1)

חַי־יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר־עָמַדְתִּי לְפָנָיו אִם־אֶקָּֽח

“The life of Yahweh, to whose face I stand, if I should take”

Following the custom of his culture, Elisha is swearing an oath by guaranteeing it by something that he holds sacred and by stating the first part of a condition (“if”) but not the second part (“then”). Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. In a context such as this, it may be natural to express just the first part of the condition as a negative statement. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh, to whose face I stand, that I will not take]

See: Oath Formulas

2 Kings 5:16 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר־עָמַדְתִּי לְפָנָיו

“to whose face I stand”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:14. Alternate translation: [in whose presence I stand] or [whose servant I am]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 5:17 (#1)

וְלֹֽא

“But {if} not”

Naaman is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from earlier in the verse if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [But if you will not take a blessing] or [But if you will not accept a gift]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 5:17 (#2)

יֻתַּן־נָא לְעַבְדְּךָ מַשָּׂא צֶמֶד־פְּרָדִים אֲדָמָה כִּֽי־לֹא־יַעֲשֶׂה עוֹד
עַבְדְּךָ עֹלָה וָזֶבַח לֵאלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים כִּי אִם־לַיהוָה

“let dirt, the burden of a pair of mules, please be given to your servant, for your servant will no longer make a burnt offering or sacrifice to other gods, but rather to Yahweh”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [since your servant will no longer make a burnt offering or sacrifice to other gods, but rather to Yahweh, let dirt, the burden of a pair of mules, please be given to your servant]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 5:17 (#3)

יֻתַּן־נָא לְעַבְדְּךָ מַשָּׂא צֶמֶד־פְּרָדִים אֲדָמָה

“let dirt, the burden of a pair of mules, please be given to your servant”

The expression **let dirt, the burden of a pair of mules, please be given** contains a passive verbal form. If your

language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [please give dirt, the burden of a pair of mules, to your servant]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 5:17 (#4)

יֻתַּן־נָ֣א לְעַבְדְּךָ֗ מַשָּׂ֤א צֶֽמֶד־פְּרָדִים֙ אַדְמָ֔ה

“let dirt, the burden of a pair of mules, please be given to your servant”

Naaman’s request to **be given** a **load** of **earth** was a symbolic action by which he showed that he wanted to worship only Yahweh, not any of the gods of his home country of Aram. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [let dirt, the burden of a pair of mules, please be given to your servant so that I can build an altar to Yahweh on soil from Israel]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 5:18 (#1)

בֵּית־רִמּ֖וֹן

“to} the house of Rimmon”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author and characters often speak of a temple as a “house.” Alternate translation: [to the temple of Rimmon]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 5:19 (#1)

לְשָׁלֹ֑ום

“in peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [peacefully]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Kings 5:20 (#1)

חַי־יְהוָה֙ כִּֽי־אִם־רַצְתִּ֣י אַחֲרָ֔יו וְלָקַחְתִּ֥י מֵאִתּ֖וֹ מְאוּמָֽה

“The life of Yahweh, if I do not run after him and take something from him”

Following the custom of his culture, Gehazi is swearing an oath by something that he holds sacred and by stating the first part of a condition (“if”) but not the second part (“then”). In a context such as this, it may be natural to express just the first part of the condition as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh that I am going to run after him and take something from him]

See: Oath Formulas

2 Kings 5:20 (#2)

מִיָּדֹ֑ו

“from his hand”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author or a character may use the word “hand,” part of a person, to represent the whole person in the act of doing something. In this instance, Gehazi is using the **hand** of Naaman to represent him in the act of having gifts that he wanted to offer to Elisha. Alternate translation: [from him]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 5:21 (#1)

הֲשָׁלֹ֑ום

“Peace”

Naaman is using the term **Peace** as a common greeting of this culture. He is using it in a question form in order to ask Gehazi if everything is all right. In the next verse, Gehazi uses it in a statement form to reply that everything is all right. (The usage here is different from the one in 4:23 and 4:26, where the Shunammite woman used the word to indicate that she did not want someone to ask any further questions.) Alternate translation: [Is all well]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 5:22 (#1)

לֵאמֹ֔ר

“saying”

The term **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In this case, it is a quotation not of what Elisha said to Gehazi but of what Gehazi claims Elisha wanted him to say to Naaman. Alternate translation: [and he told me to tell you]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

2 Kings 5:22 (#2)

לֵאמֹ֔ר הִנֵּ֥ה עַתָּ֛ה זֶ֥ה בָּ֖אוּ אֵלַ֑י שְׁנֵי־נְעָרִ֗ים מֵהַ֙ר אֶפְרַ֔יִם מִבְּנֵ֖י הַנְּבִיאִ֑ים תְּנָה־נָּ֣א לָהֶ֗ם כִּכַּר־כֶּ֙סֶף֙ וּשְׁתֵּ֣י חֲלִפֹ֔ות בְּגָדִֽים

“saying, ‘Behold, even now two young men from the sons of the prophets have come to me from

the hill country of Ephraim. Please give to them a kikkar of silver and two changes of clothes"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [asking me to tell you that two young men from the sons of the prophets had just come to him from the hill country of Ephraim and to ask you to give them a kikkar of silver and two changes of clothing]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 5:22 (#3)

כִּכַּר־כֶּסֶף

"a kikkar of silver"

See how you decided to represent the value of a kikkar in 5:5.

See: Biblical Weight

2 Kings 5:23 (#1)

וַיִּצְרֹ֨ר כִּכְּרַ֤יִם כֶּ֙סֶף֙ בִּשְׁנֵ֣י חֲרִטִ֔ים וּשְׁתֵּ֥י חֲלִפָ֖וֹת בְּגָדִֽים

"and he bound two silver kikkars in two bags and two changes of clothes"

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about the **two changes of clothes** with the information about the **two silver kikkars**. Alternate translation: [and he bound two silver kikkars and two changes of clothes in two bags]

See: Information Structure

2 Kings 5:23 (#2)

לְפָנָיו

"to his face"

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:12. Alternate translation: [in front of him]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 5:24 (#1)

וַיָּבֹא֙ אֶל־הָעֹ֔פֶל & בַּבָּֽיִת

"And he came to the hill & in the house"

The author assumes that readers will know what **hill** he means, so he does not specify which hill this was among the many in Samaria. The idea seems to be that Gehazi believed that if he went any farther, Elisha would be able to see him and Naaman's servants from his house. So this seems to have been a hill that blocked the view from Elisha's house. If that is the case, then the term **house** refers to Gehazi's personal quarters rather than to the house in which Elisha lived. Alternate translation: [to a hill that blocked Elisha's view ... in his own quarters]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 5:24 (#2)

מִיָּדָ֑ם

"from their hand"

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:20. Alternate translation: [from them]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 5:25 (#1)

וְהוּא־בָ֖א

"And he, he came"

The author is stating the pronoun **he** separately, even though the verb translated as **he came** already includes this meaning. He is doing that in order to emphasize a contrast between what Naaman's servants did, as described in the previous verse (leave without being seen), and what Gehazi did (appear before Elisha). Alternate translation: [But he came openly]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 5:25 (#2)

מאן

"From where"

Elisha is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [From where have you come]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 5:25 (#3)

עַבְדְּךָ֔

"Your servant"

Gehazi is speaking of himself in the third person as **Your servant** to show humility. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a humble form in the first person. Alternate translation: [I, your servant,]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 5:25 (#4)

אָנָּה וָאָנָה

“here or here”

Gehazi is using **here or there** as a common expression of his culture to mean “anywhere.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [anywhere]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 5:26 (#1)

לֹא־לִבִּי הָלַךְ כַּאֲשֶׁר הָפַךְ־אִישׁ מֵעַל מֶרְכַּבְתּוֹ לִקְרָאתֶךָ הֲעֵת לָקַחַת אֶת־הַכֶּסֶף וְלָקַחַת בְּגָדִים וְזֵיתִים וְכְרָמִים וְצֹאן וּבָקָר וַעֲבָדִים וּשְׁפָחוֹת

“Did my heart not go when the man turned from upon his chariot to meet you? {Is this} a time to take silver or to take clothing or olives trees or vineyards or sheep or cattle or male servants or female servants”

Elisha is using the question form for emphasis and to rebuke Gehazi. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate these questions as statements or as exclamations. Alternate translation: [My heart went with you when the man turned from upon his chariot to meet you! This is not a time to take silver or to take clothing or olives trees or vineyards or sheep or cattle or male servants or female servants!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 5:26 (#2)

לֹא־לִבִּי הָלַךְ

“Did my heart not go”

Elisha is speaking as if his **heart** had literally traveled to the place where Gehazi met Naaman. He is using his heart to represent his spirit, and he means that he was aware in his spirit of what Gehazi had done. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Was I not with you in spirit]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 5:26 (#3)

וְזֵיתִים וְכְרָמִים וְצֹאן וּבָקָר וַעֲבָדִים וּשְׁפָחוֹת

“or olives trees or vineyards or sheep or cattle or male servants or female servants”

The implication is that Gehazi wanted to use the silver he took from Naaman to buy these things. You could indicate this in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to buy olives trees or vineyards or sheep or cattle or male servants or female servants]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 5:27 (#1)

וְצָרַעַת נַעֲמָן תִּדְבַּק־בְּךָ וּבְזַרְעֶךָ

“Now the leprosy of Naaman will cling to you and to your seed”

Elisha is speaking of **the leprosy of Naaman** as if it were a living thing that could **cling** to Gehazi and his descendants. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Now the leprosy of Naaman will afflict you and your seed]

See: Personification

2 Kings 5:27 (#2)

וּבְזַרְעֶךָ

“and to your seed”

Elisha is speaking as if the descendants of Gehazi were actually **seed**, the way plants produce seed from which other plants grow. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and to your descendants]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 5:27 (#3)

מִלְּפָנָיו

“from to his face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:14. Alternate translation: [from his presence]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 5:27 (#4)

מְצֹרָע כַּשָּׁלֶג

“afflicted with leprosy like snow”

The word **afflicted** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would

be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [leprous like snow]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 5:27 (#5)

מְצֹרָ֥ע כַּשָּׁ֖לֶג

“afflicted with leprosy like snow”

The point of this comparison is that just as **snow** is white, so Gehazi’s skin became white from the leprosy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [as white as snow with leprosy]

See: Simile

2 Kings - Chapter 6 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the section of the book that describes the miracles and prophecies of Elisha.

1. Elisha makes an iron axe head float (1–7)
2. Elisha warns the Israelite king where the Arameans will attack (8–12)
3. Elisha blinds and traps Aramean soldiers (13–23)
4. Elisha prophesies the end of a siege and famine (6:24–7:20)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did the king of Israel want to execute Elisha for the terrible famine in Samaria?

In 6:31, after the king of Israel realizes how terrible the famine is in Samaria because of the Aramean siege, he swears that he will have Elisha executed that day. It is not entirely clear why the king blamed Elisha for the famine. Interpreters have suggested several possibilities.

- Some suggest that the king was angry with Elisha because he knew that Elisha could do miracles, but he had not done a miracle to end the siege or famine.
- Others suggest that the king blamed Yahweh for the siege and famine (what he says in 6:27 may indicate that), and so he was hostile to Elisha as Yahweh’s prophet and representative.
- Still others suggest that since Elisha had encouraged resistance to Aram by telling the king the Arameans’ military plans in advance, the king blamed Elisha for the massive invasion that the Arameans ultimately launched against his kingdom.

However, since the reason is uncertain, we recommend that you do not suggest in the text of your translation why the king felt that Elisha was responsible for the famine.

2 Kings 6:1 (#1)

וַיֹּאמְר֗וּ בְּנֵי־הַנְּבִיאִ֛ים

“And the sons of the prophets said”

The author is referring to the community of **the sons of the prophets** that lived in the city of Jericho. This becomes clear in the next verse when one of them indicates that the Jordan River is nearby. You could indicate that here if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And the sons of the prophets in Jericho said]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 6:1 (#2)

הִנֵּ֣ה

“Behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:9.

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 6:1 (#3)

לְפָנֶ֔יךָ

“to your face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:14. Alternate translation: [in your presence]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 6:2 (#1)

וְנִקְחָ֤ה מִשָּׁם֙ אִ֣ישׁ קוֹרָ֔ה אֶחָ֖ת

“and let us take from there, a man one beam”

The prophets are using **a man one beam** as a common expression of their culture to mean that each of them would carry a log from the forest in the Jordan River valley to the site where they wanted to build a new building. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and let each of us carry a log from there]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 6:2 (#2)

שָׁ֣שָׁם מָקֹ֔ום לָשֶׁ֖בֶת שָֽׁשָׁם

“there a place to sit there”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [there a place to sit]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 6:2 (#3)

לֵ֥כוּ

“Go”

This is an imperative, but it communicates permission rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates permission. Alternate translation: [You may go]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

2 Kings 6:3 (#1)

הָאֹ֖וֶל & וְלֵ֣ךְ

“be willing and go”

The phrase **be willing and go** expresses a single idea. The word **willing** in what way this prophet wants Elisha to **go**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [be willing to go] or [go willingly]

See: Hendiadys

2 Kings 6:3 (#2)

וְלֵ֣ךְ & אֵלֵ֔ךְ

“and go & I will go”

In contexts such as these, your language might say “come” instead of **go**. Alternate translation: [and come … I will come]

See: Go and Come

2 Kings 6:3 (#3)

אֶת־עֲבָדֶ֑יךָ

“with your servants”

The speaker is referring to himself and his fellow prophets in the third person as **your servants** to show humility. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a humble form in the first person. Alternate translation: [with us, your servants]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 6:3 (#4)

אָנֹכִ֥י אֵלֵֽךְ

“I, I will go”

See how you translated the similar expression “you, you know” in 4:1. Alternate translation: [I will personally accompany you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 6:4 (#1)

וַיָּבֹ֖אוּ הַיַּרְדֵּ֑נָה

“And they came to the Jordan”

In a context such as this, your language might say “went” instead of **came**. Alternate translation: [And they went to the Jordan]

See: Go and Come

2 Kings 6:5 (#1)

וְאֶת־הַבַּרְזֶ֖ל

“and the iron”

The author is using the term **iron** to represents an ax head made out of iron. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the ax head]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 6:5 (#2)

אֲהָהָ֔ה

“Alas”

The speaker is using the word **Alas** to express a strong feeling of distress and alarm. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. If not, you could say what the speaker was feeling, or you could say what made him distressed. Alternate translation: [Oh, no] or [How unfortunate]

See: Exclamations

2 Kings 6:5 (#3)

וְהָה֥וּא

“for it”

Here the word **for** introduces an explanation for the man’s distress. In your translation, use a connecting word or phrase in your language that will indicate this. Alternate translation: [you see, it]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 6:5 (#4)

וְהַוּא שָׁאוּל

“for it was lent”

The expression **was lent** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone lent it to me]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 6:7 (#1)

לָֽךְ

“for yourself”

The expression **for yourself** indicates that the action Elisha describes would be to the man’s advantage. It may not be necessary to represent this expression in your translation. However, the UST models one way to represent it.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 6:8 (#1)

וּמֶ֣לֶךְ אֲרָ֗ם הָיָה֙ נִלְחָ֣ם בְּיִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“Now the king of Aram was fighting with Israel”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

2 Kings 6:8 (#2)

לֵאמֹ֕ר אֶל־מְק֥וֹם פְּלֹנִ֖י אַלְמֹנִ֑י תַּחֲנֹתָֽי

“saying, “At such and such a place my camp {shall be”

The king did not actually say the words **such and such**. The author is using that expression to summarize what the king told his **servants** (that is, his military officers). If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [telling them where he wanted his camp to be]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

2 Kings 6:9 (#1)

לֵאמֹ֑ר

“saying”

The implication is that Elisha told the king to what place the Aramean army was coming before telling him not to go near **that place**. You could include this information as part of this introduction to the direct quotation. Alternate translation: [telling him where the Aramean army was coming and warning him]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

2 Kings 6:9 (#2)

הִשָּׁשֵׁ֣מר מֵעָבְרֹ֗ הַמָּקוֹם֙ הַזֶּ֔ה כִּי־שָׁ֥שָׁם אֲרָ֖ם נָחֹתִֽים

“Guard yourself from passing by that place, for Aram is coming down there”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since Aram is coming down there, guard yourself from passing by that place]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 6:9 (#3)

אֲרָ֖ם

“Aram”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:6. Alternate translation: [the Aramean army]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 6:9 (#4)

נָחֹתִֽים

“is coming down”

See how you translated the comparable expression “go up” in 1:3. Alternate translation: [is coming]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 6:10 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁלַ֣ח מֶ֔לֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל אֶל־הַמָּקוֹ֑ם

“And the king of Israel sent to the place”

The author assumes that readers will understand that the king sent soldiers to investigate the place that Elisha had warned him about. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers.

Alternate translation: [And the king of Israel sent soldiers to confirm that the place was dangerous]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 6:10 (#2)

אָמַר־לוֹ & והזהירה

“had said to him and warned him”

The verbs **said** and **warned** together express a single idea. The verb **warned** tells for what purpose Elisha **said** something to the king. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [had communicated a warning to him about]

See: Hendiadys

2 Kings 6:10 (#3)

לֹא אַחַת וְלֹא שְׁתָּיִם

“not once and not twice”

The author is emphasizing a positive meaning by twice using a negative word, **not**, together with words that convey the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an expression that conveys the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [many times]

See: Litotes

2 Kings 6:11 (#1)

וַיִּסְעַר֩ לֵ֨ב מֶֽלֶךְ־אֲרָ֜ם עַל־הַדָּבָ֣ר הַזֶּ֗ה

“And the heart of the king of Aram was enraged about this matter”

The author is using one part of the king, his **heart**, representing his feelings, to mean all of him in the act of becoming **enraged**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the king of Aram was enraged about this matter]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 6:11 (#2)

וַיִּסְעַר֩ לֵ֨ב מֶֽלֶךְ־אֲרָ֜ם עַל־הַדָּבָ֣ר הַזֶּ֗ה

“And the heart of the king of Aram was enraged about this matter”

The expression **was enraged** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And this matter enraged the king of Aram]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 6:11 (#3)

הֲלוֹא֙ תַּגִּ֣ידוּ לִ֔י מִמֵּ֖י מִשֶּׁלָּ֑נוּ אֶל־מֶ֖לֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“Will you not declare to me who from us {is} for the king of Israel”

The king of Aram is using the question form to command his officers to tell him who is revealing his plans to the king of Israel. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [One of us must be for the king of Israel, and I want you to declare to me who that is!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 6:12 (#1)

אֶת־הַדְּבָרִ֥ים אֲשֶׁ֛ר תְּדַבֵּ֥ר בַּחֲדַרְךָ֖ מִשְׁכָּבֶֽךָ

“the things that you speak in the room of your bed”

The officer says **the things that you speak in the room of your bed** as an overstatement for emphasis. He means that Elisha knows even the king’s most private and secret plans. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [the things that you decide and want to keep secret]

See: Hyperbole

2 Kings 6:13 (#1)

וְאֶשְׁלְחָ֖ה

“and I will send”

The king is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and I will send soldiers]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 6:13 (#2)

וְאֶקָּחֶ֑הוּ

“and I will take him”

The king of Aram is using himself to represent everyone who would **take** or capture Elisha. He would give the command, but his soldiers would make the actual capture. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they will capture him for me]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 6:13 (#3)

וַיֻּגַּד־לוֹ

“And it was declared to him”

The expression **was declared** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And someone declared to him]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 6:13 (#4)

בְּדֹתָן

“in Dothan”

The person speaking to the king is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from earlier in the sentence if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [he is in Dothan]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 6:14 (#1)

וַיַּקִּפוּ עַל־הָעִיר

“and they surrounded around the city”

The expression **surrounded around** may seem to contain extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [and they surrounded the city]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 6:15 (#1)

חַיִל סוֹבֵב אֶת־הָעִיר וְסוּס וָרָכֶב

“an army surrounding the city, and horse and chariot”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about the **horse** and **chariot** with the information about the **army**. Alternate translation: [an army with horses and chariots was surrounding the city]

See: Information Structure

2 Kings 6:15 (#2)

וְסוּס וָרָכֶב

“and horse and chariot”

The author is not referring to a specific **horse** or **chariot**. He means the horses and chariots of the Aramean army in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [with horses and chariots]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

2 Kings 6:15 (#3)

אֲהָהָה

“Alas”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:5.

See: Exclamations

2 Kings 6:15 (#4)

אֵיכָכָה נַעֲשֶׂה

“What shall we do”

The servant is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [There is nothing we can do!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 6:16 (#1)

אַל־תִּירָא כִּי רַבִּים אֲשֶׁר אִתָּנוּ מֵאֲשֶׁר אוֹתָם

“Do not fear, for those who {are} with us {are} more numerous than those who {are} with them”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Those who are with us are more numerous than those who are with them, so do not fear]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 6:17 (#1)

פְּקַח & אֶת־עֵינָיו וְיִרְאֶה וַיִּפְקַח יְהוָה אֶת־עֵינֵי הַנַּעַר וַיַּרְא

“open his eyes, that he may see.” And Yahweh opened the eyes of the servant, and he saw”

Elisha is speaking as if his servant’s physical **eyes** were actually closed. He is using eyes to represent the ability to perceive spiritual realities. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [give him spiritual

vision, that he may see spiritual things ... And Yahweh gave the servant spiritual vision, and he was able to see spiritual things]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 6:17 (#2)

הָהָר

“the hill”

By **the hill**, the author means the hill on which the city of Dothan was built. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the hill on which Dothan stood]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 6:18 (#1)

וַיֵּרְדוּ֙ אֵלָ֔יו

“And they came down to him”

The pronoun **they** refers to the Aramean soldiers who had surrounded the city, not to the horses and chariots of fire described in the previous verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the Aramean soldiers came down to him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 6:18 (#2)

וַיֵּרְדוּ֙ אֵלָ֔יו

“And they came down to him”

This expression may seem to contain extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can use a more natural expression. (While Elisha was in the city of Dothan, on a hill above the Aramean soldiers, the author may say that they **came down** to him because they first advanced to some strategic height in the city and then went down among its houses to Elisha’s house. Alternatively, the phrase **came down** may express a continuation of the action of invading this part of Israel from a higher elevation in Aram, as 6:9 describes.) Alternate translation: [And the Aramean soldiers came toward Elisha]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 6:18 (#3)

אֶת־הַגּוֹי־הַזֶּ֖ה

“this nation”

Elisha is using the term **nation** to mean “army” or “soldiers.” (More commonly in this culture, speakers used the term “people” to refer to the soldiers in an army.) You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [this army] or [these soldiers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 6:18 (#4)

כִּדְבַ֥ר אֱלִישָֽׁע

“according to the word of Elisha”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:7. Alternate translation: [according to what Elisha had said]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 6:19 (#1)

לְכוּ

“Go”

In a context such as this, your language might say “Come” instead of **Go**. Alternate translation: [Come]

See: Go and Come

2 Kings 6:20 (#1)

פְּקַ֞ח אֶת־עֵינֵ֣י־אֵ֗לֶּה & וַיִּפְקַ֤ח יְהוָה֙ אֶת־עֵינֵיהֶ֔ם

“open the eyes of these & And Yahweh opened their eyes”

In the first instance, Elisha is speaking as if the physical **eyes** of these soldiers were closed and Yahweh literally **open** them. He means that Yahweh would enable them to see normally again. The author is speaking similarly in the second instance. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [make these men no longer blind ... And Yahweh made them no longer blind]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 6:20 (#2)

פְּקַ֞ח

“open”

This is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as “please” to make this clear. Alternate translation: [please open]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

2 Kings 6:21 (#1)

הַאַכֶּנָּה אַכֶּנָּה אָבִי

“Shall I strike {them}? Shall I strike {them}, my father”

To translate the word “strike” here and in the next verse, how you translated it in 3:23. Alternate translation: [Shall I kill them? Shall I kill them, my father?]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 6:21 (#2)

הַאַכֶּנָּה אַכֶּנָּה

“Shall I strike {them}? Shall I strike {them”

The king is repeating his question **Shall I strike them** in order to intensify his request for permission and to show his eagerness to act. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [Shall I kill them while I have the chance?]

See: Reduplication

2 Kings 6:21 (#3)

אָבִי

“my father”

The king is referring to Elisha by a respectful title. Use a comparable title or expression for addressing someone respectfully in your language.

See: Politeness

2 Kings 6:22 (#1)

הַאֲשַׁשֶּׁר שָׁבִיתָ בְּחַרְבְּךָ וּבְקַשְׁתְּךָ אַתָּה מַכֶּה

“Are you striking those whom you capture with your sword and with your bow”

The author is using the participle form **Are you striking** to describe habitual action. Express this with the verb form that your language would naturally use. Alternate translation: [Do you usually kill those whom you capture with your sword and with your bow]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

2 Kings 6:22 (#2)

הַאֲשַׁשֶּׁר שָׁבִיתָ בְּחַרְבְּךָ וּבְקַשְׁתְּךָ אַתָּה מַכֶּה

“Are you striking those whom you capture with your sword and with your bow”

Elisha is using the question form to get the king to consider that he does not kill soldiers his army has captured in battle, so he should certainly not kill soldiers whom he has captured without a fight. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You do not kill those whom you capture with your sword and with your bow.]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 6:22 (#3)

הַאֲשַׁשֶּׁר שָׁבִיתָ בְּחַרְבְּךָ וּבְקַשְׁתְּךָ אַתָּה מַכֶּה

“Are you striking those whom you capture with your sword and with your bow”

Elisha is implying that since these men were captured without a fight, they should be treated with even greater mercy than soldiers captured in battle, whom the king would not kill. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [You do not kill those whom you capture with your sword and with your bow! So you should not kill these men whom you have captured without a fight.]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 6:22 (#4)

לֶחֶם וָמַיִם

“bread and water”

Elisha is using one kind of food, **bread**, and one kind of drink, **water**, to mean food and drink in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [food and drink]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 6:22 (#5)

לִפְנֵיהֶם

“to their faces”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:12. Alternate translation: [in front of them]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 6:23 (#1)

וַיִּכְרֶה לָהֶם כְּרָה גְדוֹלָה

“And he provided a great provision for them”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [And he made a great feast for them]

See: Poetry

2 Kings 6:24 (#1)

וַיְהִי׀

“And it happened”

The author is using this phrase to introduce a new event. See how you translated the phrase in 2:1.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 6:24 (#2)

מַחֲנֵֽהוּ

“his camp”

Here, **camp** represents the soldiers who would stay in a camp. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his army] or [his soldiers]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 6:25 (#1)

וַיְהִי֙ רָעָ֣ב גָּד֔וֹל בְּשֹׁמְר֑וֹן וְהִנֵּ֤ה צָרִים֙ עָלֶ֔יהָ

“And a great famine was in Samaria, and behold, {they were} besieging against it”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. (In this context, the word **behold** introduces a reason.) Alternate translation: [And because they were besieging against it, a great famine was in Samaria]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 6:25 (#2)

הֱיִיּ֗וֹת & בִּשְׁמֹנִ֤ים כֶּ֙סֶף֙ & בַּחֲמִשָּׁ֣ה־כָ֔סֶף

“was at 80 silver & was} at 5 silver”

The author is using **was at** as a common expression of his culture to mean “sold for.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [sold for 80 silver ... sold for 5 silver]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 6:25 (#3)

הֱיִיּ֗וֹת & בִּשְׁמֹנִ֤ים כֶּ֙סֶף֙ & בַּחֲמִשָּׁ֣ה־כָ֔סֶף

“was at 80 silver & was} at 5 silver”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [sold for 80 silver shekels ... sold for 5 silver shekels]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 6:25 (#4)

הֱיִיּ֗וֹת & בִּשְׁמֹנִ֤ים כֶּ֙סֶף֙ & בַּחֲמִשָּׁ֣ה־כָ֔סֶף

“was at 80 silver & was} at 5 silver”

See how you decided to represent the weight of a shekel at 5:5.

See: Biblical Weight

2 Kings 6:25 (#5)

וְרֹ֣בַע הַקַּ֔קָב

“and a fourth of a kab of”

A **kab** was a liquid measure equivalent to 1.23 liters or just over five cups. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this in terms of modern measurements, either in the text or in a footnote.

See: Biblical Volume

2 Kings 6:25 (#6)

וְרֹ֣בַע

“and a fourth of”

A **fourth** means one part out of four equal parts.

See: Fractions

2 Kings 6:26 (#1)

וַיְהִי׀

“And it happened”

The author is using this phrase to introduce a new development within this event. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 6:26 (#2)

הוֹשִׁ֥יעָה אֲדֹנִ֖י הַמֶּֽלֶךְ

“Save, my lord the king”

The woman is referring to King Jehoram by a respectful title, and she is using the customary expression of her culture to ask him to use his royal power to help her. (She is indicating specifically that she has a case that she wants the king to decide, as he recognizes and acknowledges in 6:28 by asking her, “What is to you?”) Use a comparable title and expression from your language. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated the same expressions in 2 Samuel 14:4. Alternate translation: [Help me, Your Majesty]

See: Politeness

2 Kings 6:27 (#1)

מֵאַ֣יִן אוֹשִׁ֔יעֵךְ הֲמִן־הַגֹּ֖רֶן אִ֣ם מִן־הַיָּֽקֶב

“From where will I save you? From the threshing floor or from the winepress”

The king is using the question form to emphasize that he has no resources with which to help the woman. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate these questions as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I am not able to help you from the threshing floor or from the winepress!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 6:27 (#2)

הֲמִן־הַגֹּ֖רֶן אִ֣ם מִן־הַיָּֽקֶב

“From the threshing floor or from the winepress”

Here, **the threshing floor** and **the winepress** represent the grain and wine that come from them. (The king assumes, generally and correctly, that this woman’s plea has to do with not having enough food.) If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [since we have no more grain or wine]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 6:28 (#1)

מַה־לָּ֔ךְ

“What to you”

The king is using **What to you** as a common expression of his culture to ask the woman what case she wants to bring before him. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [What is your case] or [What is the matter]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 6:28 (#2)

הָאִשָּׁ֥ה הַזֹּ֛את אָמְרָ֥ה אֵלַ֖י תְּנִ֣י אֶת־בִּנֵּ֑ךְ וְנֹאכְלֶ֣נּוּ הַיּ֔וֹם וְאֶת־בְּנִ֥י נֹאכַ֖ל מָחָֽר

“This woman said to me, ‘Give your son, and we will eat him today, and we will eat my son tomorrow”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [This woman told me to give up my son so that we could eat him that day, and she said that we would eat her son the next day]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 6:29 (#1)

וָאֹמַ֣ר אֵלֶ֔יהָ בַּיּ֥וֹם הָאַחֵ֖ר תְּנִ֣י אֶת־בִּנֵּ֑ךְ וְנֹאכְלֶ֣נּוּ

“And I said to her on the next day, ‘Give your son, and we will eat him”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And I told her on the next day to give up her son so that we could eat him]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 6:30 (#1)

וַיִּקְרַ֖ע אֶת־בְּגָדָ֑יו

“that he tore his clothes”

See how you indicated the symbolic significance of this action in 2:12. Alternate translation: [that he tore his clothes to show his great distress]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 6:30 (#2)

הַשַּׂ֥ק עַל־בְּשָׂרֹ֖ו מִבָּֽיִת

“sackcloth {was} on his flesh, from beneath”

Wearing **sackcloth** next to his skin under his royal robes was a symbolic action by which King Jehoram was privately expressing to Yahweh humility and sor-

row over his sins and those of his people. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [he was wearing sackcloth under his robes next to his skin to show humility and sorrow for sin]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 6:32 (#1)

וֶאֱלִישָׁע֙ יֹשֵׁ֣ב בְּבֵיתֹ֔ו וְהַזְּקֵנִ֖ים יֹשְׁבִ֣ים אִתֹּ֑ו וַיִּשְׁלַ֤ח אִישׁ֙ מִלְּפָנָ֔יו

“And Elisha was sitting in his house, and the elders were sitting with him. And he sent a man from his face”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information that the king **sent a man** (to execute Elisha) first in the verse so that it would follow directly from the king’s statement in the previous verse that he was going to execute him. Alternate translation: [And the king sent a man from his face. And Elisha was sitting in his house, and the elders were sitting with him]

See: Information Structure

2 Kings 6:32 (#2)

מִלְּפָנָ֔יו

“from his face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:14. Alternate translation: [from his presence]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 6:32 (#3)

וְהִנֵּ֥ה ׀ אָמַ֖ר

“then he, he said”

The author is stating the pronoun **he** separately, even though the verb translated as **he said** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that this action took place at the same time when the messenger was on his way to Elisha’s house but had not yet arrived. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [Elisha, already knowing that he was coming, said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 6:32 (#4)

הַרְאִיתֶ֗ם כִּי־שָׁלַ֤ח בֶּן־הַמְרַצֵּחַ֙ הַזֶּ֔ה לְהָסִ֖יר אֶת־רֹאשִׁ֑י

“Do you see that this son of a murderer has sent to remove my head”

Elisha is using the question form to inform the elders of an impending danger that he wants them to help protect him from. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I want you to recognize that this son of a murderer has sent to remove my head!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 6:32 (#5)

בֶּן־הַמְרַצֵּחַ֙

“son of a murderer”

See how you translated the similar expression “sons of valor” in 2:16. Alternate translation: [murderous person]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 6:32 (#6)

רְא֣וּ

“See”

In this context, the term **See** has the same significance that the term “behold” does in many contexts, such as the next verse. Elisha is using it to call attention to what he is about to say. See how you translated the term “behold” in 1:9.

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 6:32 (#7)

הֲלֹ֗וא קֹ֚ול רַגְלֵ֣י אֲדֹנָ֔יו אַחֲרָ֖יו

“Is} the sound of the feet of his master not behind him”

Elisha is using the question form to tell the elders emphatically that the king is coming right behind the officer he has sent. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [The sound of the feet of his master is right behind him.]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 6:32 (#8)

הֲלֹ֗וא קֹ֚ול רַגְלֵ֣י אֲדֹנָ֔יו אַחֲרָ֖יו

“Is} the sound of the feet of his master not behind him”

The author is using one part of a person, his **feet**, to mean all of him in the act of walking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Is his master not right behind him?] or [His master is coming right behind him]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 6:33 (#1)

יֹרֵד

“was coming down”

The king’s palace was apparently high up on the hill on which Samaria was built, while Elisha’s house was farther down the hill. The author is marking travel for change in elevation. See how you translated the comparable expression “go up” in 1:3. Alternate translation: [was coming] or [came]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 6:33 (#2)

וַיֹּאמֶר

“And he said”

The pronoun **he** refers to the king of Israel. Readers are meant to understand from the context that he arrived right after the messenger, as Elisha said in the previous verse he would. Alternate translation: [And the king also arrived, and he said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 6:33 (#3)

מֶה־אוֹחִיל לַיהוָה עוֹד

“Why should I wait for Yahweh any longer”

The king is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [So there is no reason for me to wait any longer for Yahweh to rescue us!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings - Chapter 7 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the section of the book that describes the miracles and prophecies of Elisha. It relates the end of the episode in which Elisha prophesied that the famine in besieged Samaria would end in a single day.

2 Kings 7:1 (#1)

שִׁמְעוּ

“Hear”

The implied “you” in the verb **Hear** is plural here because Elisha is addressing everyone who is present. This included elders of Samaria, the king, and some officers he brought with him, as the next verse indicates. So use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

2 Kings 7:1 (#2)

דְּבַר־יְהוָה

“the word of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:7. Alternate translation: [a message from Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 7:1 (#3)

כֹּה ׀ אָמַר יְהוָה כָּעֵת ׀ מָחָר֡ סְאָה־סֹלֶת בְּשֶׁקֶל וְסָאתַיִם שְׂעֹרִים בְּשֶׁקֶל בְּשַׁעַר שֹׁמְרוֹן

“Thus says Yahweh: ‘At {this} time tomorrow, a seah of flour {will be} at a shekel, and two seahs of barley {will be} at a shekel in the gate of Samaria”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that at this time tomorrow, a seah of flour will be at a shekel and two seahs of barley will be at a shekel in the gate of Samaria]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 7:1 (#4)

סְאָה־סֹלֶת

“a seah of flour”

A **seah** was a dry measure equivalent to 7.7 liters or about six quarts. If it would be helpful to your readers,

you could express this in terms of modern measurements, either in the text or in a footnote.

See: Biblical Volume

2 Kings 7:1 (#5)

בְּשֶׁשָׁקֶל & בְּשֶׁשָׁקֶל

“will be} at a shekel & will be} at a shekel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:25. Alternate translation: [will sell for a silver shekel ... will sell for a silver shekel]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 7:2 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר־לַמֶּלֶךְ֙ נִשָּׁעָ֣ן עַל־יָדוֹ֔

“who {was} to the king, leaning himself on his hand”

The author is using one thing that this **captain** did for the **king**, supporting him with his **hand**, to mean everything that he did as the king’s personal attendant. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who was the king’s personal attendant]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 7:2 (#2)

הִנֵּ֤ה יְהוָה֙ עֹשֶׂ֣ה אֲרֻבּ֔וֹת בַּשָּׁמַ֖יִם הֲיִהְיֶ֣ה הַדָּבָ֣ר הַזֶּ֑ה

“Behold Yahweh, making windows in the heavens, may this thing be”

The captain is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Even if Yahweh were to make windows in the heavens, this thing could not be!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 7:2 (#3)

הִנֵּ֤ה יְהוָה֙ עֹשֶׂ֣ה אֲרֻבּ֔וֹת בַּשָּׁמַ֖יִם הֲיִהְיֶ֣ה הַדָּבָ֣ר הַזֶּ֑ה

“Behold Yahweh, making windows in the heavens, may this thing be”

The captain is using a common expression of his culture, saying **Behold**, naming a person, and then using a participle to describe an action, to indicates that a person is about to do that action. The captain may be speaking either conditionally or sarcastically. Alternate translation: [Even if Yahweh is about to make windows in the heavens, this thing could not be!] or [I suppose Yahweh is about to make windows in the heavens. Even so, this thing could not be!]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 7:2 (#4)

הִנָּכָה רֹאֶה בְּעֵינֶ֔יךָ

“Behold you, seeing with your eyes”

Elisha is responding to the captain by using the same common expression. Alternate translation: [You are about to see this with your eyes]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 7:2 (#5)

הִנָּכָה רֹאֶה בְּעֵינֶ֔יךָ

“Behold you, seeing with your eyes”

It might seem that the expression **seeing with your eyes** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could say this in a way that would be natural. Alternate translation: [You are about to witness this personally]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 7:3 (#1)

וְאַרְבָּעָה֙ אֲנָשִׁ֣ים הָי֔וּ מְצֹרָעִ֖ים פֶּ֣תַח הַשָּׁ֑עַר

“Now four men were lepers {at} the entrance of the gate”

The author is introducing these **lepers** as new participants in the story. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants, you could use it here in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 7:3 (#2)

אִ֥ישׁ אֶל־רֵעֵ֖הוּ

“a man to his fellow”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:23. Alternate translation: [to each other]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 7:3 (#3)

מָ֣ה אֲנַ֔חְנוּ יֹשְׁבִ֖ים פֹּ֣ה עַד־מָתְנוּ֑

“Why are we sitting here until we die”

The lepers are using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question

form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [We should not just sit here until we die!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 7:4 (#1)

אִם־אָמַרְנוּ֩ נָבֹ֨וא הָעִ֜יר

“If we say, ‘We will enter the city”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [If we say that we will enter the city] or [If we decide to enter the city]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 7:4 (#2)

וְעַתָּ֗ה

“And now”

See how you translated the same expression in 3:23.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 7:4 (#3)

וְנִפְּלָ֣הּ

“let us fall”

The lepers are using **let us fall** as a common expression of their culture to mean “let us desert.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 29:3. Alternate translation: [and let us desert]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 7:5 (#1)

וַיָּקֻ֖מוּ

“So they arose”

To translate the term **arose** here and in verse 7, how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [So they took action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 7:5 (#2)

וְהִנֵּ֔ה

“and behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:9.

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 7:6 (#1)

אֶת־מַחֲנֵ֥ה אֲרָ֖ם

“the camp of Aram”

Here, **the camp of Aram** represents the Aramean soldiers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Aramean soldiers]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 7:6 (#2)

סוּס֙

“a horse”

The author is not referring to a specific **horse**. He means the horses of the Aramean army in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [horses]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

2 Kings 7:6 (#3)

אָחִ֔יו

“his brother”

The author is using **his brother** as a common expression of his culture to mean “his fellow soldier.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his fellow soldier]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 7:6 (#4)

עָלֵ֑ינוּ֩ & לָבֹ֨וא עָלֵ֜ינוּ

“against us & to come against us”

It might seem that saying **against us** twice would be to express extra information that would not be natural in your language. If so, you can omit the first instance of this phrase.

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 7:6 (#5)

אֶת־מַלְכֵ֣י הַחִתִּ֗ים וְאֶת־מַלְכֵ֤י מִצְרַ֙יִם֙

“the kings of the Hittites and the kings of the Egyptians”

The author is using **the kings of the Hittites and the kings of the Egyptians** to represent these kings and their armies. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the armies of the kings of the Hittites and the kings of the Egyptians]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 7:6 (#6)

וְאֶת־מַלְכֵי מִצְרַיִם

“and the kings of the Egyptians”

At this time, all of Egypt was ruled by one king. This expression is probably plural because it is in parallel with the expression **the kings of the Hittites**. It may be more natural in your language to use a singular expression. Alternate translation: [and the king of Egypt]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

2 Kings 7:7 (#1)

הַמַּחֲנֶה כַּאֲשֶׁר־הָיָא

“the camp just as it {was”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from earlier in the sentence if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [leaving the camp just as it was]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 7:7 (#2)

אֶל־נַפְשָׁם

“for their life”

While the word **life** is singular in form, it refers to the lives of all of the Aramean soldiers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “life.” Alternate translation: [for their lives] or [to save their lives]

See: Collective Nouns

2 Kings 7:8 (#1)

וַיִּשְׂאוּ

“and they carried away”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and they carried away valuable possessions]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 7:9 (#1)

אִישׁ אֶל־רֵעֵהוּ

“a man to his fellow”

See how you translated the similar expression in 7:3. Alternate translation: [to each other]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 7:9 (#2)

וּמְצָאָנוּ עָוֹן

“then punishment will find us”

The lepers are speaking of **punishment** as if it were a living thing that could **find** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [people will punish us]

See: Personification

2 Kings 7:9 (#3)

וְעַתָּה

“And now”

And now was an expression that speakers in this culture commonly used to introduce an important point such as the implications of what they had just been saying. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. See how you translated this expression in 3:23.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 7:9 (#4)

לְכוּ וְנָבֹאָה

“go, and let us come”

The speakers are not telling their fellow lepers to **go** somewhere. They are encouraging them to do what they are suggesting. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Let us go ahead and come]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 7:9 (#5)

וְנָבֹאָה

“and let us come”

In a context such as this, your language might say “go” instead of **come**. Alternate translation: [and let us go]

See: Go and Come

2 Kings 7:9 (#6)

בֵּ֖בֵית הַמֶּ֥לֶךְ

“the house of the king”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author and characters may use the term “house” to mean all the people who live in the same house as a person, including family members and servants. Alternate translation: [the household of the king]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 7:10 (#1)

שֹׁעֲרֵ֣י הָעִ֔ירׇ

“the gatekeeper of the city”

The author is not referring to a specific **gatekeeper**. As the pronoun **them** later in this verse and the plural form in the next verse indicate, there were several gatekeepers on duty. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the gatekeepers of the city]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

2 Kings 7:10 (#2)

כִּֽי־אִם־הַסּ֣וּס אָס֔וּרׇ וְהַחֲמֹ֖ור אָסֽוּר

“but the horse was tied, and the donkey was tied”

The lepers are not referring to a specific **horse** or **donkey**. They mean the Arameans’ horses and donkeys in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but the horses were tied, and the donkeys were tied]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

2 Kings 7:10 (#3)

כִּֽי־אִם־הַסּ֣וּס אָס֔וּרׇ וְהַחֲמֹ֖ור אָסֽוּר

“but the horse was tied, and the donkey was tied”

In both instances, the expression **was tied** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but their horses and donkeys were still at their tethers]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 7:11 (#1)

וַיַּגִּ֖ידוּ בֵּבֵ֥ית הַמֶּֽלֶךְ

“and they informed the house of the king”

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and some people informed the house of the king] or [and house of the king was informed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 7:11 (#2)

פְּנִימָֽה

“within”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [within the city]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 7:12 (#1)

לֵאמֹ֗ר כִּֽי־יֵצְא֤וּ מִן־הָעִיר֙ וְנִתְפְּשֵׂ֣ם חַיִּ֔ים וְאֶל־הָעִ֖יר נָבֹֽא

“saying, ‘For they will come out from the city, and we will capture them alive, and we will enter into the city”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [telling themselves that we will come out from the city, and they will capture us alive, and they will enter into the city]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 7:12 (#2)

כִּ֣י

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces the expected result of an action. Use a connecting word or phrase that will indicate this in your language. Alternate translation: [Because we have done this,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 7:13 (#1)

הַסּוּסִים֙ הַנִּשְׁאָרִ֔ים אֲשֶׁ֥ר נִשְׁאַ֖רוּ־בָּ֑הּ

“the remaining horses that remain in it”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [the horses that remain in the city]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 7:13 (#2)

הִנָּ֣ם כְּכָל־ההמון יִשְׂרָאֵל֮ אֲשֶׁ֣ר נִשְׁאַ֣רוּ־בָ֔בָּה הִנָּ֣ם כְּכָל־הֲמ֔וֹן יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל אֲשֶׁר־תַּ֑מּוּ

“Behold them, like all of the multitude of Israel who remain in it. Behold them, like all of the multitude of Israel who have finished”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second phrase makes the meaning of the first more specific by indicating that those who **remain** in the city **have finished**, that is, they are on the verge of death. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Behold them, like all of the multitude of Israel who remain in it, who are about to die]

See: Parallelism

2 Kings 7:13 (#3)

ההמון יִשְׂרָאֵל֮

“the multitude of Israel”

Here, **Israel** represents “Israelites,” specifically those in the city of Samaria. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the many Israelites]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 7:15 (#1)

אֲרָ֔ם

“Aram”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:6. Alternate translation: [the Aramean soldiers]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 7:16 (#1)

סְאָה־סֹ֥לֶת & וְסָאתַ֖יִם שְׂעֹרִ֑ים

“a seah of fine flour & and two seahs of barley”

See how you decided to represent the quantity of a seah in 7:1.

See: Biblical Volume

2 Kings 7:16 (#2)

בְּשֶׁ֥קֶל & בְּשֶׁ֖קֶל

“was} at a shekel & were} at a shekel”

See how you translated the similar expressions in 7:1. Alternate translation: [sold for a silver shekel ... sold for a silver shekel]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 7:17 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר־נִשְׁעָ֤ן עַל־יָדוֹ֙

“on} whom he was leaning himself on his hand”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:33. Alternate translation: [who was his personal attendant]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 7:17 (#2)

עַל־הַשַּׁ֑עַר

“over the gate”

The author is using **over the gate** as a common expression of his culture to mean “in charge of the gate” or “responsible for supervising the gate.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to be responsible for the gate]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 7:17 (#3)

בְּרֶ֣דֶת הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ אֵלָ֖יו

“when the king came down to him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:33. Alternate translation: [when the king came to him]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 7:18 (#1)

וַיְהִ֗י כְּדַבֵּר֙ אִ֣ישׁ הָאֱלֹהִ֔ים אֶל־הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ לֵאמֹ֑ר סָאתַ֤יִם שְׂעֹרִים֙ בְּשֶׁ֣קֶל וְסָאָה־סֹ֔לֶת יִהְיֶה֙ כָּעֵ֣ת מָחָ֔ר בְּשַׁ֖עַר שֹׁמְר֥וֹן

“And it had happened, when the man of God spoke to the king, saying, “Two seahs of barley {will be} at a shekel, and a seah of flour {will be} at a shekel, it will be at {this} time tomorrow in the gate of Samaria”

Here and in the next two verses, the author is repeating details from 7:1–2 and 7:17. He is using this repetition to signal the end of his account of how the famine in Samaria ended. Use a natural form in your language for concluding an account with a repetition of some of its details. See how you translated the quotations from Elisha and the captain in 7:1–2, and translate them the same way here and in the next verse so that the repetition will be evident to your readers.

See: End of Story

2 Kings - Chapter 8 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter concludes the section of the book that describes the miracles and prophecies of Elisha. It then describes the reign of Jehoram, the son of Jehoshaphat, as king of Judah, and it begins to describe the reign of Ahaziah, the son of Jehoram, as king of Judah.

1. The woman whose son Elisha raised from the dead returns to Israel just as Gehazi is telling the king about her (1–6)
2. Elisha prophesies that Hazael will become the king of Aram (7–15)
3. King Jehoram of Judah (16–24)
4. King Ahaziah of Judah (25–29)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Did Elisha tell Hazael to say something that he knew was not true?

In 8:10, after King Ben Hadad of Aram sends his officer Hazael to ask Elisha whether he will recover from his illness, Elisha tells Hazael, “Go, say to him, ‘Reviving, you will revive.’” But Elisha then adds, “But Yahweh has made me see that dying, he will die.” This was not a contradiction. Elisha was not telling Hazael to lie. Yahweh revealed to Elisha that Ben Hadad’s illness was not fatal, and he would have recovered from it. However, Yahweh also revealed to Elisha that Ben Hadad was going to die of a different cause. Hazael was going to murder him in order to become king himself, as the author describes in 8:15. Elisha was subtly confronting Hazael about his ambitious, murderous character, which Elisha already sensed, and of which he then got a fuller vision after looking into Hazael’s face (8:11–12).

Who became king first, Jehoram (Joram) of Israel or Jehoram of Judah?

The author says in 1:17 that Jehoram became king of Israel in the second year of Jehoram, the son of Jehoshaphat, king of Judah. But he says in 8:16 says that Jehoram, the son of Jehoshaphat, became king of Judah in the fifth year of Joram (Jehoram), the son of Ahab, the king of Israel. This makes it seem as if each one was already king before the other became king, which is impossible. The explanation is that Jehoshaphat made his son Jehoram his co-regent seven years before he died. The author indicates in 3:1 that this was in the eighteenth year of Jehoshaphat’s reign. After Jehoram had ruled Judah with his father for two years, Jehoram son of Ahab became king of Israel. After Jehoram had ruled Israel for five years, Jehoshaphat died and his son Jehoram became the sole king of Judah.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

The names Jehoram and Joram

The author calls the son of Ahab who succeeded him as king of Israel by the name Joram in verses 16, 25, 28, and 29 of this chapter, but in 1:17, 3:1, and 3:6 he calls him Jehoram.

Similarly, the author calls the son of Jehoshaphat who succeeded him as king of Judah by the name Joram in verses 21, 23, and 24, but he calls him Jehoram in verses 16, 25, and 29.

The name Joram is a shortened form of Jehoram. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use each king’s full name in every instance. Alternatively, you could use the same form of the name that the author uses in each place. Decide as a team what approach you will take.

2 Kings 8:1 (#1)

וֶאֱלִישָׁע֙ דִּבֶּ֣ר אֶל־הָאִשָּׁ֔ה אֲשֶׁר־הֶחֱיָ֖ה אֶת־בְּנָ֑הּ

“Now Elisha had spoken to the woman whose son he had made live”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

2 Kings 8:1 (#2)

קוּמִי וּלְכִי אַתְּ וּבֵיתֵךְ וְגוּרִי בַּאֲשֶׁר תָּגוּרִי כִּי־קָרָא יְהוָה לָרָעָב וְגַם־בָּבָא אֶל־הָאָרֶץ שֶׁבַע שָׁנִים

“Arise and go, you and your house, and sojourn in where you will sojourn, for Yahweh has called for a famine, and also it will come upon the land {for} seven years”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since Yahweh has called for a famine, and also it will come upon the land seven years, arise and go, you and your house, and sojourn in where you will sojourn]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 8:1 (#3)

קוּמִי וּלְכִי

“Arise and go”

To translate the term **Arise** here and the term “arose” in the next verse, see how you translated the similar expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [Take action and go]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 8:1 (#4)

וּבֵיתֵךְ

“and your house”

Elisha is speaking as if the woman’s family were actually her **house**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly, here and in the next verse. Alternate translation: [and your household] or [and your family]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 8:1 (#5)

וְגוּרִי בַּאֲשֶׁר תָּגוּרִי

“and sojourn in where you will sojourn”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [and sojourn where you can]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 8:1 (#6)

קָרָא יְהוָה לָרָעָב

“Yahweh has called for a famine”

Elisha is using **has called for** as a common expression of his culture to mean “has determined that there will be.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh has determined that there is going to be a famine]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 8:2 (#1)

כִּדְבַר אִישׁ הָאֱלֹהִים

“according to the word of the man of God”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:7. Alternate translation: [what the man of God had said]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 8:3 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened”

The author is using this phrase to introduce a new development within this event. See how you translated the similar phrase in 2:9, which also introduces a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 8:3 (#2)

לְצְעֹק אֶל־הַמֶּלֶךְ

“out to cry out to the king”

The author is using **to cry out to the king** as a common expression of his culture to mean “to make a formal appeal to the king” or “to petition the king.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to appeal to the king]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 8:4 (#1)

הַגְּדֹלוֹת

“the great {things”

The king is using the adjective **great** as a noun to mean a certain kind of thing. The ULT shows that by supplying the word **things**. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent word or phrase. Alternate translation: [the wonders]

See: Nominal Adjectives

2 Kings 8:5 (#1)

וְהִנֵּה

“and behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:9.

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 8:5 (#2)

אֲדֹנִי הַמֶּלֶךְ

“My lord the king”

Gehazi is referring to the king by a respectful title. Use a comparable title or expression for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [Sire]

See: Politeness

2 Kings 8:6 (#1)

הָשֵׁשִׁיב אֶת־כָּל־אֲשֶׁר־לָהּ

“Return everything that {is} to her”

While the expression **Return** is an imperative, this was not a command that the eunuch was capable of obeying. He did not possess the woman’s house and land. Instead, it describes what the king wanted the eunuch to accomplish. Alternate translation: [Make sure that she gets back everything that belonged to her]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

2 Kings 8:7 (#1)

וַיָּבֹא אֱלִישָׁע דַּמֶּשֶׂק

“And Elisha came to Damascus”

The author is using this travel notice to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [Sometime after this, Elisha made a trip to Damascus]

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 8:7 (#2)

וּבֶן־הֲדַד מֶלֶךְ־אֲרָם חֹלֶה

“Now Ben Hadad, the king of Aram, was sick”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

2 Kings 8:7 (#3)

וַיֻּגַּד־לוֹ

“And it was declared to him”

The expression **was declared** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And someone declared to him]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 8:8 (#1)

בְּיָדְךָ

“in your hand”

To translate the term **hand** here and in the next verse, see how you translated the similar expression in 5:5. Alternate translation: [with you]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 8:8 (#2)

לֵאמֹר הַאֶחְיֶה מֵחֳלִי זֶה

“saying, ‘Will I live from this sickness”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [asking whether I will live from this sickness.]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 8:9 (#1)

מִנְחָה & וְכָל־טוּב דַּמֶּשֶׂק

“a gift and every good {thing} of Damascus”

This phrase expresses a single idea. The expression **every good thing** tells what this **gift** consisted of. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate

translation: [a gift consisting of every good thing of Damascus]

See: Hendiadys

2 Kings 8:9 (#2)

וְכָל־טוּב דַּמֶּשֶׂק

“and every good {thing} of Damascus”

The author is saying **every** as an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [and a wide range of good things from Damascus]

See: Hyperbole

2 Kings 8:9 (#3)

טוּב דַּמֶּשֶׂק

“good {thing} of Damascus”

The author is using the adjective **good** as a noun to mean a certain kind of thing. The ULT shows that by supplying the word **thing**. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent word or phrase. Alternate translation: [fine product of Damascus] or [luxury of Damascus]

See: Nominal Adjectives

2 Kings 8:9 (#4)

לְפָנָיו

“to his face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:14. Alternate translation: [in his presence]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 8:9 (#5)

בִּנְךָ

“Your son”

By calling himself **Your son**, the king is addressing Elisha respectfully. (This is equivalent to the way the king of Israel addressed him as “my father” in 6:21.) Use a comparable expression for addressing someone respectfully in your language.

See: Politeness

2 Kings 8:9 (#6)

לֵאמֹר הַאֶחְיֶה מַחֲלִי זֶה

“saying, ‘Will I revive from this sickness”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [to ask whether he will revive from this sickness]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 8:10 (#1)

אֱמָר־לוֹ חָיֹה תִחְיֶה

“say to him, ‘Reviving, you will revive”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [tell him that reviving, he will revive]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 8:10 (#2)

חָיֹה תִחְיֶה & מָמוֹת יָמוּת

“Reviving, you will revive & dying, he will die”

Elisha is repeating forms of the verbs **revive** and **die** in order to intensify his expression of the ideas that they convey. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [He will certainly recover ... he will certainly die]

See: Reduplication

2 Kings 8:11 (#1)

וַיַּעֲמֵד אֶת־פָּנָיו

“And he made his face stand”

Here, Elisha’s **face** represents the direction in which he was looking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And he looked steadily in one direction] or [And he fixed a stare]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 8:11 (#2)

וַיָּשֶׂם עַד־בּוֹשׁ

“and he set {it} until shaming”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language.

Alternate translation: [and he set his gaze upon Hazael until Hazael felt ashamed]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 8:12 (#1)

מַדּ֣וּעַ אֲדֹנִ֔י בֹּכֶ֑ה

“Why is my lord weeping”

Even though Hazael is addressing Elisha directly, he is speaking of him in the third person as **my lord** to show respect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a respectful form in the second person. Alternate translation: [Why are you, my lord, weeping]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 8:12 (#2)

לִבְנֵ֥י יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

“to the sons of Israel”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author and characters may speak of “the sons of” a person to mean the nation or tribe that consists of his descendants. Alternate translation: [to the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 8:12 (#3)

תְּשַׁלַּ֥ח בָּאֵ֖שׁ

“you will send into fire”

Elisha is speaking as if Hazael will actually **send** these cities **into fire**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you will set on fire] or [you will burn down]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 8:13 (#1)

כִּֽי־מָ֣ה עַבְדְּךָ֣ הַכֶּ֔לֶב כִּ֥י יַעֲשֶׂ֖ה הַדָּבָ֣ר הַגָּדֹ֑ול הַזֶּ֔ה

“But what {is} your servant, a dog, that he should do this great thing”

Hazael is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [But your servant is merely a dog, so he will not do such a great thing!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 8:13 (#2)

כִּֽי־מָ֣ה עַבְדְּךָ֣ הַכֶּ֔לֶב כִּ֥י יַעֲשֶׂ֖ה

“But what {is} your servant, a dog, that he should do”

Hazael is speaking of himself in the third person as **your servant** to show humility. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a humble form in the first person. Alternate translation: [But what am I, your servant, a dog, that I should do]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 8:13 (#3)

עַבְדְּךָ֣ הַכֶּ֔לֶב

“is} your servant, a dog”

Hazael is speaking as if he were actually a **dog**. In this culture, dogs were wild, and people considered them dirty and regarded them with contempt. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is a contemptible person like your servant]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 8:14 (#1)

אָמַ֥ר לִ֖י חָיֹ֣ה תִחְיֶֽה

“He said to me, ‘Reviving, you will revive”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [He told me that reviving, you would revive]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 8:14 (#2)

חָיֹ֣ה תִחְיֶֽה

“Reviving, you will revive”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:10. Alternate translation: [You will certainly revive]

See: Reduplication

2 Kings 8:15 (#1)

וַיִּקַּ֤ח הַמַּכְבֵּרֹת֙ & וַיִּפְרֹ֣שׂ עַל־פָּנָ֔יו

“that he took a cloth & and spread {it} over his face”

The pronoun **he** refers to Hazael, while the pronoun **his** refers to Ben Hadad. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [that Hazael took a cloth ... and spread it over Ben Hadad’s face]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 8:16 (#1)

וּבִשְׁנַ֣ת חָמֵ֗שׁ לְיוֹרָ֞ם בֶּן־אַחְאָ֤ב מֶֽלֶךְ־יִשְׂרָאֵל֙ וִיהוֹשָׁפָ֣ט מֶֽלֶךְ יְהוּדָ֔ה יְהוֹרָ֖ם בֶּן־יְהוֹשָׁפָ֣ט מֶֽלֶךְ יְהוּדָ֑ה

“And in the year of five to Joram, the son of Ahab, the king of Israel, and Jehoshaphat, the king of Judah, Jehoram, the son of Jehoshaphat, the king of Judah, reigned”

In this verse and the next two verses, the author is introducing **Jehoram** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Judah**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 1:17.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 8:16 (#2)

לְיוֹרָ֞ם & יְהוֹרָ֖ם

“to Joram & Jehoram”

See the discussion of these names in the introduction to this chapter. The author sometimes calls the **son of Ahab** who succeeded him as king of Israel by the name Joram, as he does here, but sometimes he calls him Jehoram. Similarly, the author sometimes calls the **son of Jehoshaphat** who succeeded him as king of Judah by the name Jehoram, as he does here, but sometimes he calls him Joram.

See: How to Translate Names

2 Kings 8:16 (#3)

וִיהוֹשָׁפָ֣ט מֶֽלֶךְ יְהוּדָ֑ה

“and Jehoshaphat, the king of Judah”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. (He is referring to the co-regency that Jehoram had had with his father Jehoshaphat for the previous seven years. See the discussion of this in the introduction to this chapter.) You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [after Jehoshaphat had been the king of Judah together with his son for seven years]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 8:17 (#1)

בֶּן־שְׁלֹשִׁ֥ים וּשְׁתַּ֖יִם שָׁנָ֣ה הָיָ֑ה

“He was a son of 32 years”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author says that a person was “a son of” a certain number of years in order to mean that the person was that many years old. Alternate translation: [He was 32 years old]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 8:18 (#1)

וַיֵּ֖לֶךְ בְּדֶ֣רֶךְ ׀ מַלְכֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֗ל כַּאֲשֶׁ֤ר עָשׂוּ֙ בֵּ֣ית אַחְאָ֔ב כִּֽי־בַ֥ת־אַחְאָ֖ב הָיְתָ֣ה־לּ֑וֹ לְאִשָּׁ֔ה

“And he walked in the way of the kings of Israel, just as the house of Ahab did, for the daughter of Ahab was a wife to him”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And since the daughter of Ahab was a wife to him, he walked in the way of the kings of Israel, just as the house of Ahab did]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 8:18 (#2)

וַיֵּ֖לֶךְ בְּדֶ֣רֶךְ ׀ מַלְכֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֗ל כַּאֲשֶׁ֤ר עָשׂוּ֙ בֵּ֣ית אַחְאָ֔ב

“And he walked in the way of the kings of Israel, just as the house of Ahab did”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author and characters often speak of how a person lived as if that were a way or path that the person **walked** along. Alternate translation: [And he lived as the kings of Israel had lived, doing just what the house of Ahab did]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 8:18 (#3)

בֵּ֣ית אַחְאָ֔ב

“the house of Ahab”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author and characters may use the term “house” to mean the descendants of a king who ruled after him. Alternate translation: [the kings in the dynasty of Ahab]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 8:18 (#4)

וַיַּ֥עַשׂ הָרַ֖ע בְּעֵינֵ֥י יְהוָֽה

“And he did evil in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:2. Alternate translation: [And he did what Yahweh considered to be evil]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 8:19 (#1)

לְתֵת לֹו נִיר לְבָנָיו

“to give to him a lamp for his sons”

Yahweh is using the image of a **lamp** to mean a continuing presence, just as the lamp that was kept burning in the sanctuary represented Yahweh’s continuing presence there. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to ensure that his descendants would have a continuing presence as kings]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 8:19 (#2)

לְבָנָיו

“for his sons”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:12. Alternate translation: [for his descendants]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 8:19 (#3)

כָּל־הַיָּמִים

“all of the days”

The author is using the term **days** to mean time, since time is made up of days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all the time] or [perpetually]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 8:20 (#1)

בְּיָמָיו

“In his days”

The author is using the term **days** to refer to the time when Jehoram was ruling. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [During the reign of Jehoram]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 8:20 (#2)

יַד

“the hand of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [the control of]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 8:21 (#1)

וַיְהִי־הוּא קָם לַלַּיְלָה וַיַּךְ אֶת־אֱדֹום הַסֹּבְבִים אֹתֹו וְאֵת שָׂרֵי הָרֶכֶב

“And it happened, he, he arose {at} night, and he struck Edom, having surrounded him, and the commanders of the chariotry”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information that the Edomites had **surrounded** the king before the information that he **struck** them at **night**. You may also want to put the information about the **commanders of the chariotry** with the information that the king **struck** the Edomites. Alternate translation: [And the Edomites surrounded him, but it happened that he, he arose at night, and he and the commanders of the chariotry struck Edom]

See: Information Structure

2 Kings 8:21 (#2)

הוּא קָם

“he, he arose”

The author is stating the pronoun **he** separately, even though the verb translated as **he arose** already includes this meaning. He is doing that in order to emphasize a contrast between what the king did (he **struck Edom**) and what the people did (they **fled**). See how you translated the expression “he, he came” in 5:25, which similarly emphasizes a contrast. Alternate translation: [for his part, he arose]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 8:21 (#3)

קָם

“he arose”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [he took action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 8:21 (#4)

וַיַּךְ

“and he struck”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [and he attacked]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 8:21 (#5)

אֶת־אֱדֹום

“Edom”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:6. Alternate translation: [the Edomite army]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 8:21 (#6)

וַיָּנָס הָעָם לְאׇהָלָיו

“but the people fled to its tents”

In this context, the term **people** refers to the soldiers in the Judean army. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [but the soldiers fled to their tents]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 8:21 (#7)

וַיָּנָס הָעָם לְאׇהָלָיו

“but the people fled to its tents”

The author is using **the people fled to its tents** as a common expression of his culture to mean that the soldiers stopped their military campaign altogether and each of them went back to his home and family. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 2 Samuel 18:17. Alternate translation: [but the rest of the soldiers abandoned the army and returned home]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 8:22 (#1)

עַד הַיֹּום הַזֶּה

“to this day”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from earlier in the sentence if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and it is still in rebellion to this day]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 8:22 (#2)

עַד הַיֹּום הַזֶּה

“to this day”

See how you translated the same expression in 2:22.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 8:22 (#3)

אָז תִּפְשַׁע לִבְנָה בָּעֵת הַהִיא

“Then Libnah rebelled at that time”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could state the meaning in a way that would be natural. Alternate translation: [Libnah also rebelled at that time]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 8:23 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי יוֹרָם וְכׇל־אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה הֲלוֹא־הֵם כְּתוּבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים לְמַלְכֵי יְהוּדָה

“Now the rest of the matters of Joram and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Judah”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is concluding the story of Joram. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar phrases in 1:18.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 8:24 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּב יוֹרָם עִם־אֲבֹתָיו

“And Joram lay down with his fathers”

The author is referring to death in a polite way by saying that Joram **lay down with his fathers**. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [And Joram passed away] or [And Joram died]

See: Euphemism

2 Kings 8:24 (#2)

וַיִּשְׁכַּב יוֹרָם עִם־אֲבֹתָיו

“And Joram lay down with his fathers”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author and characters often use the term "father" to mean "ancestor." Alternate translation: [And Joram joined his ancestors in death] or [And Joram died, as his ancestors had died]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 8:24 (#3)

וַיִּקָּבֵר עִם־אֲבֹתָיו

"and he was buried with his fathers"

The expression **was buried** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people buried him in the same place where people had buried his ancestors]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 8:25 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַתְ שְׁתֵּים־עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה לְיוֹרָם בֶּן־אַחְאָב מֶלֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל מָלַךְ אֲחַזְיָהוּ בֶן־יְהוֹרָם מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה

"In the year of 12, the year to Joram, the son of Ahab, the king of Israel, Ahaziah the son of Jehoram, the king of Judah, reigned"

In this verse and the next two verses, the author is introducing **Ahaziah** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Judah**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:16.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 8:25 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַתְ שְׁתֵּים־עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה לְיוֹרָם

"In the year of 12, the year to Joram"

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **the year of 12**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the same expression in 1 Kings 15:1 and similar places in that book. Alternate translation: [In the twelfth year of Joram]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 8:26 (#1)

בֶּן־עֶשְׂרִים וּשְׁתַּיִם שָׁנָהּ אֲחַזְיָהוּ

"Ahaziah {was} a son of 22 years"

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:17. Alternate translation: [Ahaziah was 22 years old]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 8:26 (#2)

בַּת־עָמְרִי

"the daughter of Omri"

Athaliah was the daughter of Ahab, who was the son of **Omri**. Your language may have its own term or expression for this relationship. Alternate translation: [the grand-daughter of Omri]

See: Kinship

2 Kings 8:27 (#1)

וַיֵּלֶךְ בְּדֶרֶךְ בֵּית אַחְאָב וַיַּעַשׂ הָרַע בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה כְּבֵית אַחְאָב כִּֽי חֲתַן בֵּית־אַחְאָב הוּא

"And he walked in the way of the house of Ahab, and he did evil in the eyes of Yahweh, like the house of Ahab, for he {was} a son-in-law of the house of Ahab"

The author is continuing to introduce Ahaziah. See how you translated the similar expressions in 8:18. Alternate translation: [And he lived as the kings who were descendants of Ahab had lived, and he did what Yahweh considered to be evil, just as the kings who were descendants of Ahab had done, for he was a son-in-law of the house of Ahab]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 8:27 (#2)

וַיֵּלֶךְ בְּדֶרֶךְ בֵּית אַחְאָב וַיַּעַשׂ הָרַע בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה כְּבֵית אַחְאָב כִּֽי חֲתַן בֵּית־אַחְאָב הוּא

"And he walked in the way of the house of Ahab, and he did evil in the eyes of Yahweh, like the house of Ahab, for he {was} a son-in-law of the house of Ahab"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And since he was a son-in-law of the house of Ahab, he walked in the way of the house of Ahab, and he did evil in the eyes of Yahweh, like the house of Ahab]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 8:27 (#3)

בֵּית אַחְאָב

“the house of Ahab”

See how you translated the same expression in 8:18. Alternate translation: [the kings in the dynasty of Ahab]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 8:27 (#4)

חֲתַנְתָן בֵּית־אַחְאָב הִוא

“he {was} a son-in-law of the house of Ahab”

Ahaziah’s father Jehoram had married a daughter of Ahab. Your language may have its own term or expression for this relationship. Alternate translation: [he was a relative by marriage of the family of Ahab] or [he was a grandson of Ahab]

See: Kinship

2 Kings 8:28 (#1)

וַיַּכּוּ אֲרַמִּים אֶת־יוֹרָם

“but the Arameans struck Joram”

In this context, the word **struck** means “wounded.” Alternate translation: [but the Arameans wounded Joram]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 8:29 (#1)

לְהִתְרַפֵּא

“to be healed”

The expression **to be healed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [to recuperate]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 8:29 (#2)

בָּרָמָה

“at Ramah”

The name **Ramah** is a shortened form of the name Ramoth Gilead, which the author uses in the previous verse. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use the full form of the name here. Alternate translation: [Ramoth Gilead]

See: How to Translate Names

2 Kings 8:29 (#3)

וַאֲחַזְיָהוּ בֶן־יְהוֹרָם מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה יָרַד לִרְאוֹת אֶת־יוֹרָם בֶּן־אַחְאָב בְּיִזְרְעֶאל כִּי־חֹלֶה הוּא

“And Ahaziah, the son of Jehoram, the king of Judah, went down to see Joram, the son of Ahab, in Jezreel because he was infirm”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And because Joram, the son of Ahab, had been wounded, Ahaziah, the son of Jehoram, the king of Judah, went down to see him in Jezreel]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 8:29 (#4)

וַאֲחַזְיָהוּ בֶן־יְהוֹרָם מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה יָרַד

“And Ahaziah, the son of Jehoram, the king of Judah, went down”

See how you translated the similar expression “go up” in 1:3. Alternate translation: [And Ahaziah the son of Jehoram, the king of Judah, went]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings - Chapter 9 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter begins the story of how Yahweh fulfilled the prophecy that he spoke through Elijah that Ahab’s entire family would be destroyed because of his wickedness. It tells how Elisha sent a young prophet to anoint as the next king Jehu, one of the military commanders of Ahab’s son Jehoram. It then tells how Jehu went to Jezreel and killed Jehoram as well as his mother, Jezebel, and the Judean king Ahaziah.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Long quotation within quotation

In verses 6–10, as the young prophet whom Elisha sent speaks a message to Jehu from Yahweh, there is a long quotation within a quotation. If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Notes to each verse suggest ways in which you can do this consistently.

The names Jehoram and Joram

In this chapter the author continues to call the son of Ahab who succeeded him as king of Israel by two

different names. He calls him Joram in verses 15, 16, 21, and 29, and he calls him Jehoram in verses 17, 21, 22, 23, and 24. See whether you decided in chapter 8 to call him Jehoram consistently or whether you decided to use the same forms of his name that the author does in each place.

2 Kings 9:1 (#1)

וְחָגַרְתָּ מָתְנֶיךָ וְקַחְתָּ

“Gird your loins, and take”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:29. Alternate translation: [Quickly, take]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 9:1 (#2)

בְּיָדֶךָ

“in your hand”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:20. Alternate translation: [with you]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 9:2 (#1)

שָׁמָּה וּרְאֵה־שָׁם יֵהוּא בֶּן־יְהוֹשָׁפָט בֶּן־נִמְשִׁי

“to there, and see Jehu, the son of Jehoshaphat, the son of Nimshi, there”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [to there, and see Jehu, the son of Jehoshaphat, the son of Nimshi]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 9:2 (#2)

אֶחָיו

“his brothers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 7:6. Alternate translation: [his fellow soldiers]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 9:2 (#3)

חֶדֶר בְּחָדֶר

“to} a chamber in a chamber”

The phrase **a chamber in a chamber** describes an inner room within another room, likely referring to the most secluded or private area of a building. If your readers would not be familiar with rooms that have other rooms inside them, you could use a more general term or explain the arrangement in a footnote. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Kings 20:30. Alternate translation: [an inner room]

See: Translate Unknowns

2 Kings 9:3 (#1)

וְאָמַרְתָּ כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה מְשַׁחְתִּיךָ לְמֶלֶךְ אֶל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“and you shall say, ‘Thus says Yahweh, “I have anointed you as king over Israel”

There are three levels of quotation here. The author is quoting what Elisha said to this young prophet (level 1), continuing from the previous verse. This includes what the prophet was supposed to say to Jehu (level 2). That included a quotation from Yahweh (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or third-level quotations.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 9:3 (#2)

וְאָמַרְתָּ כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה מְשַׁחְתִּיךָ לְמֶלֶךְ אֶל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“and you shall say, ‘Thus says Yahweh, “I have anointed you as king over Israel”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and you shall tell him that Yahweh says that he has anointed him king over Israel]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 9:4 (#1)

הַנַּעַר הַנַּעַר הַנָּבִיא

“the young man, the young man, the prophet”

As this **young man** becomes the main character in this part of the narrative, the author is introducing him more formally as a participant in the story. The phrase **the young man, the prophet** is probably equivalent to “one of the sons of the prophets” in verse 1. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants, you could use it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [So that certain young man who was one of the sons of the prophets went to Ramoth Gilead]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 9:5 (#1)

וְהִנֵּה֙

“and behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:9.

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 9:6 (#1)

כֹּה־אָמַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה אֱלֹהֵ֖י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל מְשַׁחְתִּ֤יךָ לְמֶ֙לֶךְ֙ אֶל־עַ֣ם יְהוָ֔ה אֶל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

“Thus says Yahweh, the God of Israel, ‘I have anointed you as king over the people of Yahweh, over Israel”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh, the God of Israel, says that he has anointed you as king over his people, over Israel]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 9:6 (#2)

עַ֣ם יְהוָ֔ה

“the people of Yahweh”

Yahweh is speaking of himself in the third person because he is making an authoritative proclamation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [my people]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 9:7 (#1)

וְהִכִּיתָ֗ה אֶת־בֵּ֚ית אַחְאָ֣ב אֲדֹנֶ֔יךָ וְנָקַמְתִּ֞י דְּמֵ֤י ׀ עֲבָדַ֙י הַנְּבִיאִ֔ים וּדְמֵ֖י כָּל־עַבְדֵ֣י יְהוָ֑ה מִיַּ֖ד אִיזֶֽבֶל

“And you shall strike the house of Ahab, your master, and I will avenge the blood of my servants the prophets and the blood of all of the servants of Yahweh from the hand of Jezebel”

If you decided in the previous verse to translate this quotation in such a way that there would not be a quotation within a quotation, you can continue doing that here. Alternate translation: [He says that you are to strike the house of Ahab your master so that he may avenge the blood of his servants the prophets and the blood of all of his servants from the hand of Jezebel]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 9:7 (#2)

וְהִכִּיתָ֗ה

“And you shall strike”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:23. Alternate translation: [And you shall kill]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 9:7 (#3)

אֶת־בֵּ֚ית אַחְאָ֣ב

“the house of Ahab”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:1. Alternate translation: [the family of Ahab here and in the next two verses]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 9:7 (#4)

אֲדֹנֶ֔יךָ

“your master”

Even though Jehu was now a military commander for Jehoram, the son of Ahab, what Jehu says in 9:25 shows that earlier Jehu had been one of Ahab’s commanders. That is why Yahweh still refers to Ahab as **your master** when speaking to Jehu. Alternate translation: [who was your master]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 9:7 (#5)

דְּמֵ֤י ׀ & וּדְמֵ֖י

“the blood of & and the blood of”

Here, **blood** represents “death.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the deaths of ... and the deaths of]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 9:7 (#6)

עַבְדֵ֣י יְהוָ֑ה

“the servants of Yahweh”

Yahweh continues to speak of himself in the third person in this authoritative proclamation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [my servants]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 9:7 (#7)

מִיַּד אִיזֶבֶל

“from the hand of Jezebel”

Yahweh says that this **blood** was **from the hand of Jezebel** to indicate that Jezebel’s actions were the source of the blood. In other words, Jezebel was the one responsible for the deaths of Yahweh’s prophets and loyal worshipers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [, which Jezebel shed]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 9:8 (#1)

וְאָבַד כָּל־בֵּית אַחְאָב וְהִכְרַתְתִּי לְאַחְאָבֹ מַשְׁתִּתִּין בְּקִיר וְעָצוּר וְעָזוּב בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל

“And all of the house of Ahab will perish, and I will cut off from Ahab one pissing against a wall, both one restrained and one set free in Israel”

If you decided in the verse 6 to translate this quotation in such a way that there would not be a quotation within a quotation, you can continue doing that here. Alternate translation: [He says that all of the house of Ahab will perish, and he will cut off from Ahab one pissing against a wall, both one restrained and one set free in Israel]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 9:8 (#2)

וְהִכְרַתְתִּי לְאַחְאָבֹ

“and I will cut off from Ahab”

Yahweh is speaking as if, through Jehu, he will actually **cut off** these people, as if they were plants that Jehu would remove from the ground with a sharp tool. He means that he will have Jehu kill them. Alternate translation: [and I will have you kill in Ahab’s family]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 9:8 (#3)

מַשְׁתִּתִּין בְּקִיר

“one pissing against a wall”

Yahweh is referring to the males in Ahab’s household. To emphasize how angry he is at the serious sins of Ahab and his family and what severe punishment they deserve, Yahweh is using a vivid expression that might be considered vulgar in some cultures. If it would not be appropriate for your readers if you reproduced this exact expression, you could use an equivalent one that would reflect Yahweh’s anger. You could also use plain language. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Kings 14:10. Alternate translation: [every single one of the men]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 9:8 (#4)

וְעָצוּר וְעָזוּב

“both one restrained and one set free”

Yahweh is referring to all of Ahab’s male descendants by naming the two main categories of them, **one restrained** (legal slaves) and **one set free** (legal free men). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all male descendants] or [every male descendant]

See: Merism

2 Kings 9:8 (#5)

וְעָצוּר וְעָזוּב

“both one restrained and one set free”

The expressions **one restrained** and **one set free** are passive verbal forms. If you decide to represent both expressions in your translation, and if your language would not use such forms, you could express the ideas in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [both slaves and free men]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 9:9 (#1)

וְנָתַתִּי אֶת־בֵּית אַחְאָב כְּבֵית יָרָבְעָם בֶּן־נְבָט וּכְבֵית בַּעְשָׁא בֶּן־אֲחִיָּה

“And I will make the house of Ahab like the house of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, and like the house of Baasha, the son of Ahijah”

If you decided in verse 6 to translate this quotation in such a way that there would not be a quotation within a quotation, you can continue doing that here. Alternate translation: [He says that he will make the house of Ahab like the house of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, and like the house of Baasha, the son of Ahijah]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 9:9 (#2)

וְנָתַתִּי֙ אֶת־בֵּ֣ית אַחְאָ֔ב כְּבֵ֖ית יָרָבְעָ֣ם בֶּן־נְבָ֑ט וּכְבֵ֖ית בַּעְשָׁ֥א בֶן־אֲחִיָּֽה

“And I will make the house of Ahab like the house of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, and like the house of Baasha, the son of Ahijah”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the house of Jeroboam** and **the house of Baasha** were completely destroyed, so the **house of Ahab** will be completely destroyed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [And I will cause the family of Ahab to be destroyed completely, just like the family of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, and the family of Baasha, the son of Ahijah]

See: Simile

2 Kings 9:10 (#1)

וְאֶת־אִיזֶ֗בֶל יֹאכְלוּ֙ הַכְּלָבִ֔ים בְּחֶ֖לֶק יִזְרְעֶ֑אל וְאֵ֥ין קֹבֵֽר

“And dogs will eat Jezebel in the portion of Jezreel, and {there will be} no burying”

If you decided in the previous verse to translate this quotation in such a way that there would not be a quotation within a quotation, you can continue doing that here. Alternate translation: [And he says that dogs will eat Jezebel in the portion of Jezreel, so that no one will bury her]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 9:10 (#2)

בְּחֶ֖לֶק יִזְרְעֶ֑אל

“in the portion of Jezreel”

Yahweh assumes that Jehu will know that by **the portion of Jezreel**, he means the plot of land in Jezreel that Naboth owned and used for a vineyard. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the plot of land that belonged to Naboth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 9:10 (#3)

וַיִּפְתַּ֥ח הַדֶּ֖לֶת וַיָּנֹֽס

“And he opened the door, and he fled”

The pronoun **he** refers in each instance to the young prophet, not to Jehu. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the young prophet opened the door, and he fled]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 9:11 (#1)

הֶשָּׁלֹ֑ום

“Peace”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:21. Alternate translation: [Is all well]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 9:11 (#2)

אַתֶּ֥ם יְדַעְתֶּ֖ם

“You, you know”

Jehu is stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the verb translated as **you know** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize the other commanders’ personal awareness of the character of this prophet and the way he talks. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [You yourselves know]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 9:12 (#1)

שֶׁ֥קֶר

“A lie”

The commanders are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [What you have said is a lie]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 9:12 (#2)

כָּזֹ֣את וְכָזֹ֔את אָמַ֥ר אֵלַ֖י לֵאמֹ֑ר

“Like this and like this he spoke to me, saying”

Jehu is using **Like this and like this** as a common expression of his culture to introduce a summary of what someone said If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Along these lines he spoke to me, saying] or [What he said to me was]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 9:12 (#3)

לֵאמֹ֗ר כֹּ֚ה אָמַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה מְשַׁחְתִּ֥יךָ לְמֶ֖לֶךְ אֶל־יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“saying, ‘Thus says Yahweh, “I have anointed you as king over Israel”

There are three levels of quotation here. The author is quoting what Jehu said (level 1). Jehu is quoting what the young prophet said to him (level 2). That included a quotation from Yahweh (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or third-level quotations.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 9:12 (#4)

לֵאמֹ֗ר כֹּ֚ה אָמַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה מְשַׁחְתִּ֥יךָ לְמֶ֖לֶךְ אֶל־יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“saying, ‘Thus says Yahweh, “I have anointed you as king over Israel”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there are not quotations within quotations. Alternate translation: [telling me that Yahweh said that he had anointed me as king over Israel]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 9:13 (#1)

וַיְמַהֲר֗וּ וַיִּקְח֤וּ אִישׁ֙ בִּגְדּ֔וֹ

“And they hurried and took, a man his garment”

The phrase **hurried and took** expresses a single idea. The word **hurried** tells how the other commanders **took** their garments. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [And they hurriedly took, a man his garment]

See: Hendiadys

2 Kings 9:13 (#2)

וַיְמַהֲר֗וּ וַיִּקְח֤וּ אִישׁ֙ בִּגְדּ֔וֹ

“And they hurried and took, a man his garment”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:23. Alternate translation: [And each man hurriedly took his own garment]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 9:13 (#3)

וַיָּשִׂ֥ימוּ תַֽחְתָּ֖יו

“and they put {them} under him”

Putting their garments **under** Jehu (that is, letting him stand on them) was a symbolic action by which the commanders showed him honor. They were treating him as a person who was so great that his feet should not touch the ground. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote.

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 9:13 (#4)

אֶל־גֶּ֣רֶם הַֽמַּעֲלוֹת֮

“at the top of the steps”

The word that the ULT translates as **top** is an architectural term whose precise meaning is no longer certain. The context suggests, however, that the other commanders wanted to put Jehu in a high location to honor him and make him visible, so most translations understand the term to refer to the top of a staircase. However, some versions translate the term in other ways. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Translate Unknowns

2 Kings 9:13 (#5)

וַיִּתְקְע֣וּ בַשּׁוֹפָ֔ר

“And they blew on a shofar”

The act of blowing on a **shofar** was a symbolic action by these commanders showed that they were supporting Jehu as king instead of Jehoram, the son of Ahab. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And they blew on a shofar to show that they were supporting him as king]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 9:14 (#1)

וְיוֹרָ֣ם בֶּן־אַחְאָ֗ב הָיָה֙ שֹׁמֵ֣ר בְּרָמֹ֔ת גִּלְעָ֖ד הֽוּא־וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל מִפְּנֵי֙ חֲזָאֵ֣ל מֶֽלֶךְ־אֲרָֽם

“Now Joram had been guarding in Ramoth Gilead, he and all of Israel, from the face of Hazael, the king of Aram”

In this sentence and the first sentence of the next verse, the author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information

in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

2 Kings 9:14 (#2)

יוֹרָם

“Joram”

See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of how the author calls this king both **Joram** and Jehoram. In this chapter, follow the same decision you made in chapter 8 about whether to call him Jehoram consistently or to use the same forms of his name that the author does in each place.

See: How to Translate Names

2 Kings 9:14 (#3)

הוּא וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“he and all of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:6. Alternate translation: [he and the whole Israelite army]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 9:14 (#4)

מִפְּנֵי חֲזָאֵל

“from the face of Hazael”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:16. Alternate translation: [against the attack by]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 9:15 (#1)

לְהִתְרַפֵּא

“to be healed”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:29. Alternate translation: [to recuperate]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 9:15 (#2)

אִם־יֵשׁ נַפְשְׁכֶם

“If it is your soul”

Jehu is using the **soul** of the other commanders, their inner being, to mean their desire. Alternate translation: [If it is your desire]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 9:15 (#3)

אִם־יֵשׁ נַפְשְׁכֶם

“If it is your soul”

The word **your** is plural here because Jehu is addressing the other commanders, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

2 Kings 9:15 (#4)

אִם־יֵשׁ נַפְשְׁכֶם

“If it is your soul”

Jehu is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [If it is your desire to make me the king]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 9:16 (#1)

וַיִּרְכַּב יֵהוּא וַיֵּלֶךְ יִזְרְעֶאלָה כִּי יוֹרָם שֹׁכֵב שָׁמָּה

“And Jehu rode and went to Jezreel, because Joram was lying down there”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And because Joram was lying down there, Jehu rode and went to Jezreel]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 9:16 (#2)

וַיִּרְכַּב יֵהוּא וַיֵּלֶךְ

“And Jehu rode and went”

The phrase **rode and went** expresses a single idea. The word **rode**, which indicates that Jehu rode in his chariot, tells in what way he **went** to Jezreel. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [And Jehu went in his chariot]

See: Hendiadys

2 Kings 9:16 (#3)

יוֹרָם שֹׁכֵב שָׁמָּה

“Joram was lying down there”

Here, **lying down** represents "recuperating." It conveys the further idea that Joram was not in fully fit condition to fight Jehu. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Joram was laid up there] or [Joram was recuperating there]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 9:16 (#4)

וַאֲחַזְיָהוּ מֶֽלֶךְ יְהוּדָ֔ה יָרַ֖ד לִרְאֹ֣ות אֶת־יוֹרָֽם

"Now Ahaziah, the king of Judah, had gone down to see Joram"

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

2 Kings 9:16 (#5)

וַאֲחַזְיָהוּ מֶֽלֶךְ יְהוּדָ֔ה יָרַ֖ד

"Now Ahaziah, the king of Judah, had gone down"

See how you translated the similar expression "go up" in 1:3. Alternate translation: [Now Ahaziah, the king of Judah, had gone]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 9:17 (#1)

וְיֹאמַ֥ר הֲשָׁלֹ֖ום

"and he shall say, 'Peace"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and have the horseman ask them whether they are coming in peace]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 9:17 (#2)

הֲשָׁלֹ֖ום

"Peace"

Jehoram is instructing this messenger to leave out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Are you coming in peace]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 9:17 (#3)

הֲשָׁלֹ֖ום

"Peace"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **word**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Are you coming peacefully]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Kings 9:18 (#1)

כֹּה־אָמַ֣ר הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ הֲשָׁלֹֽום

"Thus says the king, 'Peace"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [The king asks whether you are coming in peace]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 9:18 (#2)

מַה־לְּךָ֥ וּלְשָׁלֹ֖ום

"What to you and to peace"

Jehu is using **What to you and to peace** as a common expression of his culture to mean that whether he is coming in peace has nothing to do with this messenger. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, here and in the next verse, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [What business is it of yours whether I am coming in peace] or [Why should I tell you whether I am coming in peace]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 9:18 (#3)

מַה־לְּךָ֥ וּלְשָׁלֹ֖ום

"What to you and to peace"

Jehu is using the question form to indicate forcefully that he will not discuss with this messenger whether he is coming in peace. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [It is none of your business whether I am coming in peace!] or [I do not need to tell you whether I am coming in peace!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 9:19 (#1)

רֹכֵב סוּס שֵׁנִי

“a second rider of a horse”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **second**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [another rider on a horse]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 9:19 (#2)

כֹּה־אָמַר הַמֶּלֶךְ שָׁלוֹם

“Thus says the king: ‘Peace”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. In this case, the rider is making a statement on behalf of the king rather than asking a question. Alternate translation: [The king says he hopes that you are coming in peace]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 9:20 (#1)

וְהַמְּנַהֵג

“and the driving”

The watchman assumes that the king will understand that by **the driving**, he means the driving of the person to whom the two messengers spoke. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the driving of the person to whom the two messengers spoke]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 9:20 (#2)

כִּי

“for”

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [I say that because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 9:20 (#3)

בְּשִׁגָּעוֹן

“with madness”

The watchman is saying **with madness** as an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [furiously]

See: Hyperbole

2 Kings 9:21 (#1)

אֱסֹר

“Harness”

Joram is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Harness my chariot]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 9:21 (#2)

וַיִּמְצְאֻהוּ

“And they found him”

The author does not mean that Jehoram and Ahaziah had to look for Jehu and that they **found him** at the location he describes. He means that they met or encountered him there. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And they encountered him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 9:22 (#1)

הֲשָׁלוֹם

“Peace”

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:17. Alternate translation: [Are you coming in peace] or [Are you coming peacefully]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 9:22 (#2)

מָה הַשָּׁלוֹם עַד־זְנוּנֵי אִיזֶבֶל אִמֶּךָ וּכְשָׁפֶיהָ הָרַבִּים

“What peace, during the prostitutions of Jezebel your mother and her many sorceries”

Jehu is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [What peace can there be during the prostitutions of Jezebel your mother and her many sorceries?]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 9:22 (#3)

מָמָּה הַשָּׁלֹום עַד־זְנוּנֵי אִיזֶבֶל אִמְּךָ וּכְשָׁפֶיהָ הָרַבִּים

“What peace, during the prostitutions of Jezebel your mother and her many sorceries”

Jehu is using the question form to deny emphatically that there can be peace. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [There can be no peace as long as the prostitutions of Jezebel your mother and her many sorceries continue!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 9:22 (#4)

זְנוּנֵי אִיזֶבֶל אִמְּךָ

“the prostitutions of Jezebel your mother”

Jehu is speaking as if the worship of many idols that Jezebel has been promoting were actually prostitution. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the worship of many idols that Jezebel your mother has promoted]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 9:23 (#1)

וַיַּהֲפֹךְ יְהוֹרָם יָדָיו וַיָּנָס וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל־אֲחַזְיָהוּ מִרְמָה אֲחַזְיָהוּ

“And Jehoram turned his hands and fled, and he said to Ahaziah, “Treachery, Ahaziah”

The author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. If it would be helpful your language, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [And Jehoram said to Ahaziah, “Treachery, Ahaziah!” And he turned his hands and fled]

See: Order of Events

2 Kings 9:23 (#2)

וַיַּהֲפֹךְ יְהוֹרָם יָדָיו

“And Jehoram turned his hands”

The author is using Jehoram’s **hands** to represent his control of the chariot. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Jehoram turned his chariot around]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 9:23 (#3)

מִרְמָה

“Treachery”

Jehoram is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Jehu is committing treachery against me]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 9:24 (#1)

וְיֵהֽוּא מִלֵּא יָדוֹ בַּקֶּשֶׁת

“And Jehu filled his hand with the bow”

The author is using **filled his hand with** as a common expression of his culture to mean “picked up.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Jehu took his bow in hand] or [And Jehu picked up his bow]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 9:24 (#2)

וְיֵהֽוּא מִלֵּא יָדוֹ בַּקֶּשֶׁת

“And Jehu filled his hand with the bow”

The implication is that Jehu picked up his bow and used it to shoot an arrow at Jehoram. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And Jehu picked up his bow and shot an arrow at Jehoram]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 9:24 (#3)

וַיִּכְרַע

“And he sank down”

The implication is that Jehoram **sank down** dead. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And he sank down dead]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 9:25 (#1)

בְּחֶלְקַת שְׂדֵה נָבוֹת הַיִּזְרְעֵאלִֽי

“onto the portion of the field of Naboth the Jezreelite”

Jehu is using this possessive form to describe a **portion** of land that consisted of a **field**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the agricultural property that Naboth the Jezreelite owned]

See: Possession

2 Kings 9:25 (#2)

נָשָׂא & אֶת־הַמַּשָּׂא הַזֶּה

“lifted this burden”

Jehu is speaking of this divine message as if it had been a **burden**, that is, a heavy load to carry. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [made this pronouncement]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 9:26 (#1)

אִם־לֹ֨א אֶת־דְּמֵ֤י נָבוֹת֙ וְאֶת־דְּמֵ֣י בָנָ֔יו רָאִ֖יתִי אֶמֶשׁ֑ נְאֻם־יְהוָ֔ה
וְשִׁלַּמְתִּ֥ךָ לְךָ֖ בַּחֶ֣לְקָ֑ה הַזֹּ֣את נְאֻם־יְהוָ֔ה

“If I have not seen the blood of Naboth and the blood of his sons yesterday,” the declaration of Yahweh, “and I will repay you on this portion,” the declaration of Yahweh”

There are three levels of quotation here. The author is quoting what Jehu said to his captain (level 1), continuing from the previous verse. Jehu is quoting what Yahweh said about Ahab through Elijah. (level 2). Within that quotation, Yahweh says that he is declaring something, and he quotes what he is declaring (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or third-level quotations.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 9:26 (#2)

אִם־לֹ֨א אֶת־דְּמֵ֤י נָבוֹת֙ וְאֶת־דְּמֵ֣י בָנָ֔יו רָאִ֖יתִי אֶמֶשׁ֑ נְאֻם־יְהוָ֔ה
וְשִׁלַּמְתִּ֥ךָ לְךָ֖ בַּחֶ֣לְקָ֑ה הַזֹּ֣את נְאֻם־יְהוָ֔ה

“If I have not seen the blood of Naboth and the blood of his sons yesterday,” the declaration of Yahweh, “and I will repay you on this portion,” the declaration of Yahweh”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there are not quotations within quotations. Alternate translation: [He said that he was declaring that he had certainly seen the blood of Naboth and his sons the day before and that he would repay Ahab on this portion]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 9:26 (#3)

אִם־לֹ֨א אֶת־דְּמֵ֤י נָבוֹת֙ וְאֶת־דְּמֵ֣י בָנָ֔יו רָאִ֖יתִי אֶמֶשׁ֑

“If I have not seen the blood of Naboth and the blood of his sons yesterday”

Following the custom of this culture, Yahweh is swearing an oath by stating the first part of a condition (“if”) but not the second part (“then”). In a context such as this, it may be natural to express just the first part of the condition as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [I certainly saw the blood of Naboth and the blood of his sons yesterday]

See: Oath Formulas

2 Kings 9:26 (#4)

אִם־לֹ֨א אֶת־דְּמֵ֤י נָבוֹת֙ וְאֶת־דְּמֵ֣י בָנָ֔יו רָאִ֖יתִי

“If I have not seen the blood of Naboth and the blood of his sons”

Here the **blood** of **Naboth** and **his sons** represents their deaths If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [If I have not witnessed the deaths of Naboth and his sons] or [I have certainly witnessed the deaths of Naboth and his sons]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 9:26 (#5)

נְאֻם־יְהוָ֔ה & נְאֻם־יְהוָ֔ה

“the declaration of Yahweh & the declaration of Yahweh”

Yahweh is speaking of himself in the third person because he is making an authoritative proclamation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [I declare ... I declare]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 9:27 (#1)

הַכֻּ֖הוּ

“Strike”

The implied “you” in the imperative **Strike** is plural because Jehu is addressing the soldiers who are with him. So use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

2 Kings 9:27 (#2)

בְּמַעֲלֵה־גוּרׇ

"At the ascent of Gur"

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And Jehu's soldiers shot Ahaziah with arrows at the ascent of Gur]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 9:28 (#1)

עִם־אֲבֹתָיו

"with his fathers"

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [with his ancestors]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 9:28 (#2)

וַיִּקְבְּרוּ אֹתׇוֹ

"and they buried him"

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people buried him] or [and he was buried]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 9:29 (#1)

וּבִשְׁנַתׇ אַחׇאָב מָלַךְ אֲחַזְיָה עַל־יְהוּדָה

"Now in the year of 11, the year to Joram, the son of Ahab, Ahaziah had reigned over Judah"

The author is repeating details from his introduction of Ahaziah as a participant in the story in 8:25. (He says **the eleventh year of Joram** here, rather than "the twelfth year of Joram" as he does there, simply because at this time people sometimes included partial years in totals and sometimes they did not.) He is using this repetition to signal the end of his account of Ahaziah's life and reign. Use a natural form in your language for concluding an account with a repetition of some of its details.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 9:29 (#2)

וּבִשְׁנַתׇ אַחׇאָב עָשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה לִיוֹרָם

"Now in the year of 11, the year to Joram"

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:25. Alternate translation: [And in the eleventh year of Joram]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 9:30 (#1)

וַתָּתֶשׂ בַּפּוּךְ עֵינֶיהָ

"and she set her eyes in paint"

The author means that Jezebel painted her eyebrows and eyelashes with a pigment composed of antimony and zinc. This created a dark outline as a setting to her eyes, which made them look larger and brighter. If your readers would not be familiar with the use of this kind of pigment in this way, you could describe a similar cosmetic practice that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [and she painted her eyes] or [and she put on eye shadow]

See: Translate Unknowns

2 Kings 9:30 (#2)

וַתֵּיטֶב אֶת־רֹאשָׁהּ

"and she made good her head"

This could mean: (1) that Jezebel arranged her hair in a fashionable way. Alternate translation: [and she did up her hair] or (2) that Jezebel put on a royal crown or tiara. Alternate translation: [and she put on her royal tiara]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 9:31 (#1)

הֲשָׁלוֹם זִמְרִי הֹרֵג אֲדֹנָיו

"Peace, Zimri, murderer of his master"

Jezebel is using the question form to challenge Jehu's apparent expectation that he will rule Israel for the rest of his life after he has killed Ahab's family. She calls him **Zimri** to remind him that an earlier military commander had murdered the king but only reigned for seven days after that (see 1 Kings 16:8–20). If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for this purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Do not expect that you will reign peacefully after this

for any longer than Zimri did, who also murdered the king and took his place!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 9:32 (#1)

וַיַּשְׁקֵ֥ף פָּנָ֖יו שְׁלֹשָׁ֣ה סָרִיסִֽים

“And two, three eunuchs looked down”

For stylistic reasons, the author is not using a connecting word between **two** and **three**. He may be suggesting that at first two eunuchs looked out, and then a third one did. In other words, he would be portraying Jezebel’s palace staff as slowly but steadily turning against her. It may be more natural in your language to use a connecting word here. Alternate translation: [And two or three eunuchs]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 9:33 (#1)

וַיִּ֤ז מִדָּמָהּ֙ אֶל־הַקִּ֔יר וְאֶל־הַסּוּסִ֖ים וַיִּרְמְסֶֽנָּה

“and some of her blood sprinkled on the wall and on the horses, and he trampled her”

The author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it and caused it. If it would be helpful your language, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. When the author says **he trampled her**, he means that Jehu drove his chariot over Jezebel’s body. Alternate translation: [and he drove his chariot over her body, and some of her blood sprinkled on the wall and on the horses]

See: Order of Events

2 Kings 9:33 (#2)

וַיִּרְמְסֶֽנָּה

“and he trampled her”

The author may be using one person, Jehu (**he**), who was involved in an action to represent many people who were involved. He may mean that Jehu ordered all of his chariot drivers to run over Jezebel’s body If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and Jehu had his chariot drivers trample her]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 9:34 (#1)

וַיָּבֹא֙ וַיֹּ֣אכַל וַיֵּ֔שְׁתְּ

“And he entered, and he ate and drank”

Entering the royal palace in Jezreel and eating a meal there was a symbolic action by which Jehu claimed that he was now the king of Israel. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And he entered the royal palace and ate and drank there to assert his claim that he was now the king]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 9:34 (#2)

פִּקְדוּ־נָ֣א אֶת־הָאְרוּרָ֣ה הַזֹּאת֮ וְקִבְּרוּהָ֒ כִּֽי־בַ֥ת מֶ֖לֶךְ הִֽיא

“Look after this cursed woman, please, and bury her, for she {was} the daughter of a king”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since this cursed woman was the daughter of a king, please look after her and bury her]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 9:34 (#3)

אֶת־הָאְרוּרָ֣ה הַזֹּאת֮

“this cursed woman”

The expression **cursed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [this woman whom Yahweh has cursed]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 9:35 (#1)

וְלֹא־מָצְא֣וּ בָהּ֮ כִּ֣י אִם־הַגֻּלְגֹּ֣לֶת וְהָרַגְלַ֔יִם וְכַפּ֖וֹת הַיָּדָֽיִם

“but they did not find of her except the skull and the feet and the palms of the hands”

If it would appear in your language that the author was making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [but the only parts of her they found were her skull and feet and the palms of her hands]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

2 Kings 9:36 (#1)

לֵאמֹ֑ר בְּחֶ֣לֶק יִזְרְעֶ֗אל יֹאכְל֤וּ הַכְּלָבִים֙ אֶת־בְּשַׂ֣ר אִיזֶֽבֶל

“saying, ‘In the portion of Jezreel, dogs will eat the flesh of Jezebel”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [who said that dogs would eat the flesh of Jezebel in the portion of Jezreel]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 9:36 (#2)

דְּבַר־יְהוָה הוּא אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר

“It {is} the word of Yahweh that he spoke”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:7. Alternate translation: [It is the message that Yahweh spoke]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 9:36 (#3)

בְּיַד־עַבְדּוֹ אֵלִיָּהוּ

“by the hand of his servant Elijah”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author and characters may use the word “hand” to mean “agency.” Alternate translation: [through the agency of his servant Elijah]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 9:37 (#1)

והית נִבְלַת אִיזֶבֶל כְּדֹמֶן עַל־פְּנֵי הַשָּׂדֶה בְּחֶלְקַת יִזְרְעֶאל אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יֹאמְרוּ זֹאת אִיזֶבֶל

“and the corpse of Jezebel will be like dung on the face of a field in the portion of Jezreel, that they will not say, “This is Jezebel”

There are three levels of quotation here. The author is quoting what Jehu said (level 1), continuing from the previous verse. Jehu is quoting what Elijah said (level 2), also continuing from the previous verse. That included something that people would say (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or third-level quotations.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 9:37 (#2)

והית נִבְלַת אִיזֶבֶל כְּדֹמֶן עַל־פְּנֵי הַשָּׂדֶה בְּחֶלְקַת יִזְרְעֶאל אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יֹאמְרוּ זֹאת אִיזֶבֶל

“and the corpse of Jezebel will be like dung on the face of a field in the portion of Jezreel, that they will not say, “This is Jezebel”

If you decided in the previous verse to translate this quotation in such a way that there would not be a quotation within a quotation, you can also translate this verse so that there are not quotations within quotations. Alternate translation: [and that the corpse of Jezebel would be like dung on the face of the field in the portion of Jezreel, so that no one would be able to identify her remains]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 9:37 (#3)

והית נִבְלַת אִיזֶבֶל כְּדֹמֶן עַל־פְּנֵי הַשָּׂדֶה

“and the corpse of Jezebel will be like dung on the face of a field”

The point of this comparison is that just as **dung** that is scattered as manure on a **field** decomposes and blends into the ground so that it becomes unrecognizable, so Jezebel’s body would be unrecognizable. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and the corpse of Jezebel will be as unrecognizable as dung that has decomposed into the ground]

See: Simile

2 Kings 9:37 (#4)

פְּנֵי

“the face of”

Elijah was using the term **face** to mean the surface of this **field**. If this term does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the surface of]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 9:37 (#5)

לֹא־יֹאמְרוּ

“they will not say”

Elijah was using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [no one will be able to say] or [it will not be said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings - Chapter 10 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter completes the story of how Yahweh fulfilled the prophecy that he spoke through Elijah that Ahab's entire family would be destroyed because of his wickedness. It tells how Jehu ensured that all of Ahab's remaining relatives and friends were killed, and it tells how he killed all the prophets, priests, and worshipers of Baal and destroyed the temple of Baal.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The pit of Beth Eked

The author describes in 10:14 how Jehu, on his way from Jezreel to Samaria, encountered a group of relatives of King Ahaziah of Judah. They were related to the family of Ahab, since Ahaziah's mother was the sister of Ahab. Jehu had his men seize and kill them, and the author says this happened at the pit of Beth Eked. The word that the ULT translates as "pit" refers to a large hole carved into rock. Such holes were often used as cisterns to store rainwater. This might also have been a pool where shepherds washed their sheep before shearing them, since the name Beth Eked means "shearing house" and the author calls this place Beth Eked of the Shepherds. So this "pit" could have been a dry cistern or pool that Jehu and his men used as a mass grave for this group of men. However, because these carved holes were often used to store water, the word also came to be applied to wells. Some versions call this place the Well of Beth Eked. The meaning is not certain. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the term that it uses, either "pit" or "well." If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the term that the ULT uses, "pit."

2 Kings 10:1 (#1)

וּלְאַחְאָ֗ב שִׁבְעִ֤ים בָּנִים֙ בְּשֹׁמְרֹ֔ון

"Now to Ahab {were} 70 sons in Samaria"

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

2 Kings 10:1 (#2)

בָּנִים֙

"sons"

To translate the term **sons** here and through verse 8, see how you translated the similar expression in 8:12. Alternate translation: [descendants]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 10:1 (#3)

שָׂרֵ֣י יִזְרְעֶאל֮

"the commanders of Jezreel"

This phrase likely refers to military officers or royal officials who had been stationed in Jezreel but who had gone to Samaria for safety. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 10:1 (#4)

וְאֶל־הָאֹמְנִ֣ים אַחְאָ֒ב

"and to the guardians of Ahab"

The author is using the possessive form to describe **guardians** whom **Ahab** had appointed to care for his children. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and to the guardians of Ahab's children]

See: Possession

2 Kings 10:2 (#1)

וְעַתָּ֣ה

"And now"

See how you translated this expression in 5:6, where it similarly occurs at the beginning of a letter.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 10:2 (#2)

וְהַנָּ֖שֶׁק

"and weapon"

Jehu is not referring to a specific **weapon**. He means weapons in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and weapons] or [and weaponry]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

2 Kings 10:3 (#1)

הַטּ֥וֹב וְהַיָּשָׁר֮

“the good and right {one”

Jehu is using the adjectives **good** and **right** as nouns to mean a certain kind of person. The ULT indicates that by supplying the word **one**. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the most capable and suitable person]

See: Nominal Adjectives

2 Kings 10:3 (#2)

וְשַׂמְתֶּם֙ עַל־כִּסֵּ֣א אָבִ֔יו וְהִלָּחֲמְתֶּ֖ם

“and you shall set {him} on the throne of his father, and you shall fight”

Jehu is using this son sitting **on the throne of his father** to represent him succeeding his father as king. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and you shall make him king as the successor to his father]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 10:3 (#3)

בֵּ֣ית אֲדֹנֶ֑יכֶם

“the house of your master”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:18. Alternate translation: [the dynasty of your master]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 10:4 (#1)

וַיִּרְא֥וּ מְאֹ֖ד מְאֹ֑ד

“And they were very, very afraid”

The author is repeating the word **very** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [And they were extremely afraid] or [And they were terrified]

See: Reduplication

2 Kings 10:4 (#2)

הִנֵּה֙

“Behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:9.

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 10:4 (#3)

שְׁנֵ֣י הַמְּלָכִ֗ים לֹֽא־עָמְד֤וּ לְפָנָיו֙ וְאֵ֣יךְ נַעֲמֹ֔ד אֲנָֽחְנוּ

“two kings did not stand to his face, so we, how will we stand”

The officials are using the question form **how will we stand?** to emphasize that they cannot resist Jehu. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Since two kings were not able to stand to his face, we certainly will not be able to stand!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 10:4 (#4)

לֹֽא־עָמְד֤וּ

“did not stand”

In this context, **stand** is a military term that means an army or soldier did not give way before an enemy. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You can also use plain language. Alternate translation: [could not hold their ground] or [did not survive]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 10:4 (#5)

לְפָנָיו֙

“to his face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [when they opposed him]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 10:4 (#6)

וְאֵ֣יךְ נַעֲמֹ֔ד אֲנָֽחְנוּ

“so we, how will we stand”

The leaders in Samaria are stating the pronoun **we** separately, even though the verb translated as **will we stand** already includes this meaning. He is doing that in order to emphasize a contrast between these **kings**, who were experienced warriors commanding armies, and themselves as ordinary civilians. Alternate translation: [so how will we common people stand] or [so how will we common people be able to fight successfully against him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 10:5 (#1)

הַטּוֹב בְּעֵינֶיךָ עֲשֵׂה

“Do the good in your eyes”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:13. Alternate translation: [Do what you consider to be good]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 10:6 (#1)

סֵפֶר ׀ שֵׁנִית

“a second letter”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **second**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [another letter]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 10:6 (#2)

וּלְקֹלִי ׀ אַתֶּם שֹׁמְעִים

“and you are listening to my voice”

Here, Jehu’s **voice** represents what he is saying by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you are listening to what I say]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 10:6 (#3)

וּלְקֹלִי ׀ אַתֶּם שֹׁמְעִים

“and you are listening to my voice”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author and characters often use the term “listen” to mean “agree.” Alternate translation: [and you agree to do what I say]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 10:6 (#4)

וּבְנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ שִׁבְעִים אִישׁ אֶת־גְּדֹלֵי הָעִיר מְגַדְּלִים אוֹתָם

“Now the sons of the king {were} 70 men, with the great {ones} of the city raising them”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

2 Kings 10:6 (#5)

גְּדֹלֵי הָעִיר

“the great {ones} of the city”

The author is using the adjective **great** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. The ULT indicates this by supplying the word **ones**. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase, here and in verse 11. Alternate translation: [the leading citizens of the city]

See: Nominal Adjectives

2 Kings 10:7 (#1)

כְּבֹא הַסֵּפֶר׀ אֲלֵיהֶם

“when the letter came to them”

The author is speaking of this **letter** as if it had been a living thing that could have come to the leaders of Samaria on its own. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when they received the letter]

See: Personification

2 Kings 10:7 (#2)

אֵלָיו

“to him”

The pronoun **him** refers to Jehu. It may be helpful to use his name here in your translation. Alternate translation: [to Jehu]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 10:9 (#1)

וַיַּעֲמֹד

“and stood”

The implication is that Jehu **stood** at the entrance of the city gate. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and stood at the entrance of the city gate]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 10:9 (#2)

אֲנִי קָשַׁרְתִּי עַל־אֲדֹנִי׀ וָאֶהַרְגֵהוּ

“I, I conspired against my master and killed him”

Jehu is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I conspired** already includes this meaning. He is doing that in order to emphasize

a contrast between the people of Samaria, whom he calls **righteous**, and himself. Alternate translation: [I am guilty of conspiring against my master and killing him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 10:9 (#3)

וּמִמִּי הִכָּה אֶת־כָּל־אֵלֶּה

“But who struck all of these”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:23. Alternate translation: [But who killed all of these]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 10:9 (#4)

וּמִמִּי הִכָּה אֶת־כָּל־אֵלֶּה

“But who struck all of these”

Jehu is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [But I did not kill all of these men!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 10:10 (#1)

יִפֹּל & אַ֣רְצָה

“has fallen to the ground”

Jehu is speaking as if a **word** were a physical object that could fall **to the ground**. The image is that nothing Yahweh said **about the house of Ahab** has been lost or ruined, as happens to things that people drop or let fall. He means that everything Yahweh said has come true. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 3:19. Alternate translation: [has failed to come true]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 10:10 (#2)

כִּי֩ & מִדְּבַ֨ר יְהוָ֜ה & דִּבֶּ֣ר & וַיהוָ֗ה

“from the word of Yahweh that & spoke & For Yahweh”

It might seem that the expression **the word of Yahweh that Yahweh spoke** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [of what Yahweh said]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 10:10 (#3)

בֵּ֣ית אַחְאָ֑ב

“the house of Ahab”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:18. Alternate translation: [the dynasty of Ahab]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 10:10 (#4)

בְּיַ֣ד עַבְדּ֔וֹ אֵ֖לִיָּהוּ

“by the hand of his servant Elijah”

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:36. Alternate translation: [through the agency of his servant Elijah]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 10:11 (#1)

וַיַּ֤ךְ יֵהוּא֙

“And Jehu struck”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:23. Alternate translation: [And Jehu killed]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 10:11 (#2)

לְבֵית־אַחְאָ֔ב

“to the house of Ahab”

See how you translated the similar expression in 7:9. Alternate translation: [to the household of Ahab]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 10:12 (#1)

וַיָּ֥קָם וַיָּבֹ֖א

“And he arose and came”

The author is saying **he arose and came** to describe something that was ongoing. This provides the background for an event he will describe that began to happen during this time. Connect this clause to the story in a way that makes it clear in your language that this clause is describing something that was ongoing in the background. Alternate translation: [Then Jehu began a journey to Samaria]

See: Connect — Background Information

2 Kings 10:12 (#2)

וַיָּ֖קָם

“And he arose”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [And he took action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 10:13 (#1)

וְיֵהֽוּא מָצָ֞א

“and Jehu found”

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:21. Alternate translation: [and Jehu encountered]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 10:13 (#2)

אֶת־אֲחֵי֙ אֲחַזְיָ֣הוּ

“the brothers of Ahaziah”

As the parallel passage in 2 Chronicles 22:8 makes clear, these were not Ahaziah’s actual **brothers** but members of his extended family. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly, here and in the other instance of this phrase in this verse. Alternate translation: [family members of Ahaziah]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 10:13 (#3)

וַנֵּ֣רֶד

“and we have come down”

See how you translated the similar expression “go up” in 1:3. Alternate translation: [and we have come]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 10:13 (#4)

לִשְׁל֥וֹם בְּנֵי־הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ וּבְנֵ֣י הַגְּבִירָֽה

“for the welfare of the sons of the king and the sons of the queen mother”

These relatives of Ahaziah are using the expression **for the welfare of** as a common expression of their culture to describe coming to visit family or friends with a particular interest in their health and well-being. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to see how the sons of the king and the sons of the queen mother are doing]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 10:15 (#1)

וַיִּמְצָ֖א

“and he found”

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:21. Alternate translation: [and he encountered]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 10:15 (#2)

לִקְרָאתֹ֑ו

“to meet him”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [coming to meet him]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 10:15 (#3)

הֲיֵ֤שׁ אֶת־לְבָבְךָ֙ יָשָׁ֣ר כַּאֲשֶׁ֔ר לְבָבִ֖י עִם־לְבָבֶ֑ךָ

“Is your heart right, just as my heart {is} with your heart”

Here the **heart** represents a person’s feelings and commitments, in this case, loyalty. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Are you as prepared to be loyal to me as I am prepared to be loyal to you]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 10:15 (#4)

וְיֵ֤שׁ תְּנָה֙ אֶת־יָדֶ֔ךָ וַיִּתֵּ֥ן יָד֖וֹ

“If it is, give your hand.” And he gave his hand”

Giving his **hand** to Jehu (that is, shaking hands with him) was a symbolic action by which Jehonadab showed his agreement and alliance with Jehu. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [“If it is, shake hands with me to show we are allies.” And he shook hands with him]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 10:15 (#5)

וְיֵשׁ תִּנָּה אֶת־יָדֶךָ

“If it is, give your hand”

This is a direct quotation from Jehu. If it would be helpful to your readers, introduce it as a direct quotation in a way that would be natural in your language. [And Jehu responded, “If it is, give your hand]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

2 Kings 10:17 (#1)

וַיַּךְ

“and he struck”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:23. Alternate translation: [and he killed]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 10:17 (#2)

כִּדְבַר יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר אֶל־אֵלִיָּהוּ

“according to the word of Yahweh that he spoke to Elijah”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:7. Alternate translation: [according to the message that Yahweh gave to Elijah]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 10:18 (#1)

אַחְאָב עָבַד אֶת־הַבַּעַל מְעָעֶט יֵהוּא יַעַבְדֶנּוּ הַרְבֵּה

“Ahab served Baal a little. Jehu will serve him much”

When Jehu says that Ahab served Baal only a **little**, he is making an understatement in order to draw a comparison. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express this comparison. Alternate translation: [Compared to how much I am going to serve Baal, Ahab served him only a little]

See: Hyperbole

2 Kings 10:18 (#2)

יֵהוּא יַעַבְדֶנּוּ הַרְבֵּה

“Jehu will serve him much”

Jehu is speaking of himself in the third person because he is making an authoritative proclamation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [I will serve him much]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 10:18 (#3)

וַיְקַבֵּץ יֵהוּא אֶת־כָּל־הָעָם וַיֹּאמֶר אֲלֵהֶם

“And Jehu gathered all of the people, and he said to them”

The author is saying **all of the people** as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [And Jehu called for a citywide meeting, and he said to the people]

See: Hyperbole

2 Kings 10:19 (#1)

אִישׁ אַל־יִפָּקֵד & כֹּל אֲשֶׁר־יִפָּקֵד

“Let not a man be missing & Everyone who is missing”

The expressions **be missing** and **is missing** are passive verbal forms. If your language would not use these forms, you could express the idea they convey in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Let no man fail to attend ... Everyone who fails to attend]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 10:19 (#2)

אִישׁ אַל־יִפָּקֵד כִּי־זֶבַח גָּדוֹל לִי לַבַּעַל

“Let not a man be missing, for a great sacrifice {is} to me for Baal”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since a great sacrifice is to me for Baal, let not a man be missing]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 10:19 (#3)

אִישׁ

“a man”

Here the masculine term **man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. As the word **servants** indicates, Jehu is speaking specifically of men and women who worship Baal. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women and reflects his meaning. Alternate translation: [anyone who worships Baal]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

2 Kings 10:19 (#4)

אִ֣ישׁ

“a man”

Here the masculine term **a man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [a person] or [anyone]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

2 Kings 10:20 (#1)

וַיִּקְרְאוּ

“And they proclaimed”

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And his servants proclaimed that there would be an assembly] or [And an assembly was announced]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 10:21 (#1)

אִ֣ישׁ

“a man”

Here the masculine term **a man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [a person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

2 Kings 10:21 (#2)

בֵּ֣ית הַבַּ֔עַל

“the house of Baal”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:18. Alternate translation: [the temple of Baal]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 10:21 (#3)

וַיִּמָּלֵ֖א בֵּית־הַבַּֽעַל

“and the house of Baal was filled”

The expression **was filled** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and they filled the house of Baal]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 10:21 (#4)

פֶּ֥ה לָפֶֽה

“mouth to mouth”

The author is using the term **mouth** to mean “end” or “side.” If this term does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from end to end] or [to capacity]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 10:22 (#1)

הַמַּלְבּ֔וּשׁ

“the vestment”

In this context, the word **vestment** refers to a special ceremonial garment that priests and worshipers of Baal wore during religious rituals. These garments signified devotion to Baal and added solemnity to the rituals. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of **vestment**, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the ceremonial garment that signified devotion to Baal]

See: Translate Unknowns

2 Kings 10:24 (#1)

וַיָּבֹ֣אוּ

“And they came in”

The pronoun **they** refers to Jehu and Jehonadab. (The author is probably referring to how they **came in** to the part of the temple where the altar was.) It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Jehu and Jehonadab came in]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 10:24 (#2)

וְיֵה֗וּא שָׂם־לוֹ֙ בַּחוּץ֙ שְׁמֹנִ֣ים אִ֔ישׁ וַיֹּ֣אמֶר הָאִ֗ישׁ אֲשֶׁר־יְמַלֵּ֤ט
מִן־הָאֲנָשִׁים֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר אֲנִ֣י מֵבִ֔יא עַל־יְדֵיכֶ֖ם נַפְשׁ֣וֹ תַחַ֑ת נַפְשֽׁוֹ

“Now Jehu had stationed for himself 80 men outside, and he had said, “The man who escapes from the men whom I am bringing into your hands, his life in place of his life”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

2 Kings 10:24 (#3)

נַפְשֹׁו תַּתַּחַת נַפְשֹׁו

“his life in place of his life”

Jehu was using **his life in place of his life** as a common expression of his culture to mean that any of the men he was stationing outside would forfeit his own life if he allowed any of the **men** from inside the temple to escape. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Kings 20:39. Alternate translation: [the one of you who lets him escape will pay for that with his life] or [we will execute the one of you who lets him get away]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 10:25 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened”

The author is using the phrase **And it happened** to introduce a new development in this event. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 10:25 (#2)

לָרָצִים

“to the runners”

The term **runners** originally described men who were royal bodyguards and who ran in front of and alongside the king’s chariot to protect him. The term later also described palace guards, as 1 Kings 14:27–28 shows. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the term there. Alternate translation: [to the royal guards] or [to the palace guards]

See: Translate Unknowns

2 Kings 10:25 (#3)

הַכּוּם

“strike them”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:23. Alternate translation: [kill them]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 10:25 (#4)

וַיַּכּוּם לְפִי־חָרֶב

“And they struck them to the mouth of the sword”

The author is using as a common expression of his culture to mean that the runners and captains completely destroyed the worshipers of Baal, leaving no survivors. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 22:19. Alternate translation: [And they destroyed them completely]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 10:25 (#5)

וַיַּשְׁלִכוּ הָרָצִים וְהַשָּׁלִשִׁים

“and the runners and the captains threw {them”

This could mean: (1) that the runners and captains **threw** the dead bodies of the Baal worshipers out of the temple. Alternate translation: [and the runners and the captains threw their bodies out of the temple] or (2) that the runners and captains **threw** the bodies of the people they killed to one side so that they could continue going through the crowd and killing others. Alternate translation: [and the runners and captains threw to one side the body of each person they killed until they had killed everyone]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 10:25 (#6)

עִעִיר בֵּית־הַבָּעַל

“the city of the house of Baal”

In this context, the term **city** seems to describe an inner sanctuary of the temple of Baal where the sacred “pillars” described in the next verse were kept. Alternate translation: [the inner sanctuary of the temple of Baal]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 10:26 (#1)

וַיִּשְׂרְפוּהָ

“and they burned it”

Since the pronoun **it** refers back to the **pillars** (sacred images) that were kept in the temple of Baal, it may be more natural in your language to use a plural pronoun. Alternate translation: [and they burned them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 10:27 (#1)

עַד־הַיּוֹם

“to this day”

See how you translated the same expression in 2:22.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 10:29 (#1)

לֹא־סָר֙ יֵה֣וּא מֵאַחֲרֵיהֶ֔ם

“Jehu did not turn away from after them”

To translate the expression **did not turn away** here and in verse 31, see how you translated the similar expression in 3:3. Alternate translation: [Jehu did not stop committing them]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 10:29 (#2)

עֶגְלֵי֙ הַזָּהָ֔ב

“the calves of gold”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [the worship of the calves of gold]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 10:30 (#1)

יַ֚עַן אֲשֶׁר־הֵטִ֣יבֹתָ֔ לַעֲשׂ֖וֹת הַיָּשָׁ֣ר בְּעֵינַ֑י כְּכֹ֨ל אֲשֶׁ֤ר בִּלְבָבִי֙ עָשִׂ֔יתָ לְבֵ֖ית אַחְאָ֥ב בְּנֵ֛י רְבִעִ֖ים יֵֽשְׁבוּ־לְךָ֥ עַל־כִּסֵּ֖א יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“Because you did well by doing right in my eyes, according to all that {was} in my heart you did to the house of Ahab, sons of the fourth will sit for you on the throne of Israel”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the description of what Jehu did before the information about what Yahweh will do as a result. Alternate translation: [According to all that was in my heart, you did to the house of Ahab. Because you did well by doing right in my eyes, sons of the fourth will sit for you on the throne of Israel]

See: Information Structure

2 Kings 10:30 (#2)

כְּכֹל֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר בִּלְבָבִ֔י

“according to all that {was} in my heart”

Here the **heart** represents a person’s desires. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [according to everything that I wanted]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 10:30 (#3)

לְבֵ֖ית אַחְאָ֥ב

“to the house of Ahab”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:1. Alternate translation: [to the family of Ahab]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 10:30 (#4)

בְּנֵ֥י רְבִעִ֖ים

“sons of the fourth”

Yahweh is using **sons of the fourth** as a common expression of this culture to mean “four generations of your descendants.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [four generations of your descendants]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 10:30 (#5)

יֵֽשְׁבוּ־לְךָ֥ עַל־כִּסֵּ֖א יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“will sit for you on the throne of Israel”

Here, sitting on the **throne of Israel** represents ruling Israel as king. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [will succeed you as the king of Israel]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 10:31 (#1)

לָלֶכֶת בְּתוֹרַת־יְהוָה

“to walk in the law of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:18. Alternate translation: [to live according to the law of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 10:31 (#2)

בְּכָל־לְבָבוֹ

“with all of his heart”

Here the **heart** represents a person’s motives and desires. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in complete devotion]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 10:32 (#1)

לְקַצּוֹת בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל

“to cut off Israel”

The author is speaking as if Yahweh had actually **cut off** parts of Israel. He means that Yahweh allowed Hazael to conquer parts of Israel’s territory. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to reduce the territory of Israel]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 10:32 (#2)

וַיַּכֵּם חֲזָאֵל

“And Hazael struck them”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [And Hazael defeated them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 10:32 (#3)

בְּכָל־גְּבוּל יִשְׂרָאֵל

“in every border of Israel”

Here the **border** of Israel represents its territory. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [throughout the territory of Israel]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 10:33 (#1)

מִן־הַיַּרְדֵּן מִזְרָחָה הַשָּׁמֶשׁ

“from the Jordan from the rising of the sun”

The author is describing the location of a place in the way that is characteristic of his culture. He means here that if someone were traveling from the territories he is about to describe to the area where most of the Israelites lived, he would be coming **from the rising of the sun**, that is, from the east. In your translation, express this in the way your culture describes the location of places. If you have already translated the book of Joshua, see how you translated the similar expression in Joshua 12:1. Alternate translation: [to the east of the Jordan River]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 10:33 (#2)

הַגָּדִי וְהָרְאוּבֵנִי וְהַמְנַשִּׁי

“the Gadite and the Reubenite and the Manassite”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [the land of the Gadite and the Reubenite and the Manassite]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 10:33 (#3)

הַגָּדִי וְהָרְאוּבֵנִי וְהַמְנַשִּׁי

“the Gadite and the Reubenite and the Manassite”

The author is not referring to a specific **Gadite**, **Reubenite**, or **Manassite**. He means members of those tribes in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the Gadites and the Reubenites and the Manassites]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

2 Kings 10:33 (#4)

וְהַגִּלְעָד וְהַבָּשָׁן

“and Gilead and Bashan”

The author means that in addition to capturing **Aroer**, Hazael conquered territory throughout Gilead all the way to **Bashan**. If that is not clear, you may want to use different connecting words to show how the phrase **and Gilead and Bashan** relates to what

comes before it. Alternate translation: [and throughout Gilead all the way to Bashan]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 10:34 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי יֵהוּא וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה וְכָל־גְּבוּרָתוֹ הֲלוֹא־הֵם כְּתוּבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים לְמַלְכֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Now the rest of the matters of Jehu and all that he did and all of his might, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel”

In this verse and the next two verses, the author is concluding the story of Jehu. To translate this verse, see how you have translated the comparable phrases in 1:18 and similar contexts in the book.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 10:35 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּב יֵהוּא עִם־אֲבֹתָיו

“And Jehu lay down with his fathers”

See how you translated the same expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [And Jehu passed away] or [And Jehu died]

See: Euphemism

2 Kings 10:35 (#2)

וַיִּקְבְּרוּ אֹתוֹ

“and they buried him”

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people buried him] or [and he was buried]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 10:36 (#1)

וְהַיָּמִים & עֶשְׂרִים וּשְׁמֹנָה־שָׁנָה

“And the days & were} 28 years”

Here, **days** represent “time,” since time is made up of days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And the time … was 28 years]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 10:36 (#2)

מָלַךְ & עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל עֶשְׂרִים וּשְׁמֹנָה־שָׁנָה בְּשֹׁמְרוֹן

“had reigned over Israel {were} 28 years in Samaria”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information that Jehu ruled **in Samaria** with the information that he **was king over Israel**. Alternate translation: [had reigned over Israel in Samaria were 28 years]

See: Information Structure

2 Kings - Chapter 11 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

In this section of the book, the author continues to tell what the kings were like who ruled over the two kingdoms, Israel and Judah, into which David’s kingdom split. In this chapter, he tells how Yahweh protected Joash, the infant son of King Ahaziah, when Ahaziah’s mother Athaliah tried to kill all of the male heirs to the throne of Judah so that she could rule the kingdom herself. The priests sheltered Joash in the temple until he was seven years old, and then they proclaimed him as king. The people of Judah killed Athaliah and destroyed the worship of Baal that she had promoted.

2 Kings 11:1 (#1)

וְעֲתַלְיָהוּ אֵמֶּם אֲחַזְיָהוּ

“Now Athaliah {was} the mother of Ahaziah”

The author is reintroducing **Athaliah**, whom he mentioned briefly in 8:26, as a main participant in this part of the story. If your language has its own way of reintroducing participants, you could use it here in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 11:1 (#2)

וראתה

“and she saw”

The author is speaking of the death of Ahaziah, the **son** of Athaliah, as if it were something that Athaliah actually **saw**. He means that she learned of his death. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and she learned]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 11:1 (#3)

וַתָּקָם

“And she arose”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [And she took action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 11:1 (#4)

וַתְּאַבֵּד

“and she destroyed”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:24. Alternate translation: [and she commanded soldiers to destroy]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 11:1 (#5)

זֶרַע הַמַּמְלָכָה

“the seed of the kingdom”

The author is speaking as if the children of Ahaziah were actually **seed**, one of which could grow to succeed him as the ruler of the **kingdom**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression in 5:27. Alternate translation: [the children of Ahaziah] or [the royal family]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 11:2 (#1)

אֲחוֹת אֲחַזְיָהוּ

“the sister of Ahaziah”

By specifying that **Jehosheba** was **the daughter of King Joram** but not saying that she was also the daughter of Athaliah, as Ahaziah was, the author is indicating that Jehosheba and Ahaziah had the same father but not the same mother. Your language may have its own term or expression for this relationship. Alternate translation: [the half-sister of Ahaziah]

See: Kinship

2 Kings 11:2 (#2)

הממותתים

“being killed”

The expression **being killed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom Athaliah’s soldiers were killing]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 11:2 (#3)

בַּחֲדַר הַמִּטּוֹת

“in the room of the beds”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and hid them in the room of the beds]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 11:2 (#4)

בַּחֲדַר הַמִּטּוֹת

“in the room of the beds”

The **room of the beds** was not a bedroom in which someone would sleep. Athaliah would have had her soldiers search every bedroom thoroughly to look for members of the royal family. The phrase describes a storeroom in the palace for bed cushions and blankets, where the soldiers did not think to look. If your readers would not recognize the nature of this room from the phrase **the room of the beds**, you could use the name of a similar kind of room that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [in the palace storeroom for bedding]

See: Translate Unknowns

2 Kings 11:2 (#5)

וַיַּסְתִּירוּ אֹתוֹ

“And they hid him”

The author does not say specifically whom he means by **they**, but the later events in the story suggest that he means the priests in Yahweh’s temple. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And the priests hid him in the temple]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 11:2 (#6)

מִפְּנֵי עֲתַלְיָהוּ

“from the face of Athaliah”

The author is using one part of Athaliah, her **face**, to mean all of her in the act of trying to kill all of Ahaziah’s sons. See how you translated the similar expression in 1:15. Alternate translation: [from Athaliah]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 11:2 (#7)

וְלֹ֣א הוּמָֽת

“and he was not killed”

The expression **was not killed** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [so no one killed him]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 11:3 (#1)

וַיְהִ֣י אִתָּ֔הּ בְּבֵ֖ית יְהוָ֑ה מִתְחַבֵּ֕א שֵׁ֥שׁ שָׁנִ֖ים

“And he was with her {in} the house of Yahweh, being hidden six years”

The expression **being hidden** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the priests kept him hidden with her in the house of Yahweh six years]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 11:3 (#2)

אִתָּ֔הּ

“with her”

The pronoun **her** could refer to: (1) Joash’s aunt Jehosheba. Alternate translation: [with Jehosheba] or (2) Joash’s nurse. Alternate translation: [with his nurse]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 11:3 (#3)

בְּבֵ֖ית יְהוָ֑ה

“in} the house of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:18. Alternate translation: [in the temple of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 11:4 (#1)

וּבַשָּׁנָ֣ה הַֽשְּׁבִיעִ֗ית

“And in the seventh year”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **seventh**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [And in year seven] or [And in the next year]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 11:4 (#2)

יְהוֹיָדָ֡ע

“Jehoiada”

Jehoiada participates in the story for the first time here, but the author does not introduce him formally. This may be because the author assumed that his readers would know that Jehoiada was the high priest at this time. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could include this information. Alternate translation: [the high priest Jehoiada]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 11:4 (#3)

לַכָּרִי֩

“to the Carite”

The author is not referring to a specific **Carite**. He means the Carites in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [of the Carites]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

2 Kings 11:4 (#4)

לַכָּרִי֩

“to the Carite”

The word **Carite** could be: (1) a shorter form of the name “Cherethite,” describing a member of the royal bodyguard that is mentioned several times in 2 Samuel and 1 Kings. Alternate translation: [of the Cherethites] or (2) the name of a people group whose soldiers the kings of Judah hired as palace guards. Alternate translation: [of the Carite guards]

See: How to Translate Names

2 Kings 11:4 (#5)

וְלָֽרָצִ֑ים

“and to the runners”

See how you decided to translate this term in 10:25.

See: Translate Unknowns

2 Kings 11:4 (#6)

וַיִּכְרֹ֨ת & בְּרִ֜ית

“And he cut a covenant”

The author is using **cut a covenant** as a common expression of his culture to mean “made a covenant.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the same expression in 1 Kings 5:12. Alternate translation: [And he made a covenant]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 11:5 (#1)

הַשְּׁלִשִׁ֣ית מִכֶּ֔ם

“A third of you”

A **third** means one part out of three equal parts.

See: Fractions

2 Kings 11:5 (#2)

וְשֹׁמְרֵ֥י מִשְׁמֶ֖רֶת בֵּ֣בֵית הַמֶּ֑לֶךְ

“indeed {shall be} keepers of the keeping of the house of the king”

Jehoiada is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [will securely guard the royal palace]

See: Poetry

2 Kings 11:6 (#1)

בְּשַׁ֣עַר סּ֔וּר

“shall be} at the gate of Sur”

The **gate of Sur** is mentioned only here in the Bible, so interpreters are not certain what this name means. Some understand it to be one of the gates of the palace courtyard, perhaps a side exit. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could suggest this meaning. However, it might be simplest to use the name of the gate without describing it, as the UST does. Alternate translation: [shall be at the side gate of the palace courtyard]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 11:6 (#2)

בַּשַּׁ֣עַר אַחַ֔ר הָרָצִ֖ים

“shall be} at the gate behind the runners”

This expression seems to describe a gate that the palace guards stood in front of, so it was probably the main gate of the palace courtyard. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [shall be at the main gate of the palace courtyard]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 11:7 (#1)

וּשְׁתֵּ֤י הַיָּדוֹת֙ כָּכֶ֔ם כֹּ֖ל יֹצְאֵ֣י הַשַּׁבָּ֑ת

“And the two of the hands among you, everyone going out on the Sabbath”

In this context, the word **hands** refers to divisions of armed men. Alternate translation: [and the two contingents of all of you who are going off duty on the Sabbath]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 11:7 (#2)

וְשָׁמְר֥וּ אֶת־מִשְׁמֶ֛רֶת בֵּית־יְהוָ֖ה אֶל־הַמֶּֽלֶךְ

“even they shall keep the keeping of the house of Yahweh for the king”

To translate the expression **keep the keeping** here, see how you translated the similar expression in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [even they shall securely guard the temple of Yahweh to protect the king]

See: Poetry

2 Kings 11:8 (#1)

אֶ֚יש וְכֵלָ֔יו בְּיָדֹ֑ו

“a man with his weapons in his hand”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:23. Alternate translation: [each of you with his weapons in his hand]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 11:8 (#2)

וְהַבָּבָ֖א אֶל־הַשְּׂדֵרֹ֑ות יוּמָֽת

“and one coming to the ranks shall be killed”

The expression **shall be killed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and you shall kill anyone coming to the ranks]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 11:8 (#3)

בְּצֵאתְךָ֥ וּבְבֹאֽוֹ

“when he goes out and when he comes in”

Jehoiada is referring to all of the king’s potential movements by naming two basic directions, **when he goes out** and **when he comes in**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [everywhere he goes]

See: Merism

2 Kings 11:11 (#1)

לַמִּזְבֵּ֖חַ וְלַבָּֽיִת

“to the altar and to the house”

By **to the altar and to the house**, the author means that the **altar** in the temple courtyard was on one side of these guards and the **house** or temple was on the other side of them. In other words, they were standing between the temple and the altar in its courtyard. Alternate translation: [between the courtyard altar and the temple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 11:11 (#2)

עַל־הַמֶּ֥לֶךְ סָבִֽיב

“around the king all around”

Since the king was inside the temple while the guards were outside the temple, the guards were not actually standing **around** the king. The author means that they were protecting the entire approach to the temple where the king was. Alternate translation: [protecting the king]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 11:12 (#1)

וַיּוֹצֵ֣א

“And he brought out”

The pronoun **he** refers to Jehoiada. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Jehoiada brought out]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 11:12 (#2)

וְאֶת־הָעֵדוּת

“and the testimony”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he gave him the testimony]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 11:12 (#3)

וְאֶת־הָעֵדוּת

“and the testimony”

Giving the new king Joash **the testimony**, that is, a copy of the law of Moses (or at least some part of it, such as the laws for kings) was a symbolic action that indicated the obligation Joash had to govern according to Yahweh’s commands and covenant. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote.

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 11:12 (#4)

וַיַּמְלִיכוּ אֹתוֹ וַיִּמְשָׁחֻ֖הוּ

“and they made him king, and they anointed him”

The author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. If it would be helpful your language, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [and they anointed him and made him the king]

See: Order of Events

2 Kings 11:12 (#5)

וַיַּכּוּ־כָ֔ף

“And they struck palm”

This expression means that the people clapped their hands together or applauded. This was a symbolic action by which they showed their approval of Joash becoming king and their acceptance of him as their ruler. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And they clapped their hands to show that they approved of Joash becoming king]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 11:12 (#6)

יְחִ֥י הַמֶּֽלֶךְ

“May the king live”

The people were saluting Joash with the courteous expression that people in this culture used to wish a ruler a long and prosperous reign. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Kings 1:25. Alternate translation: [Long live the king]

See: Politeness

2 Kings 11:14 (#1)

וְהִנֵּה

“and behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:9.

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 11:14 (#2)

הַמֶּלֶךְ֙ עֹמֵ֣ד עַל־הָעַמּ֔וּד כַּמִּשְׁפָּ֖ט

“the king was standing by the pillar, according to the custom”

It appears from the text that **standing by the pillar** (meaning a certain one of the pillars on the temple porch) was a **custom** or symbolic action by which a new king showed that he would be loyal to Yahweh. (What the later king Josiah did in 23:2 supports this understanding.) If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [the king was standing by the pillar, according to the custom by which new kings expressed their loyalty to Yahweh]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 11:14 (#3)

וַתִּקְרַ֤ע עֲתַלְיָהוּ֙ אֶת־בְּגָדֶ֔יהָ

“And Athaliah tore her clothes”

See how you described the significance of this action in 2:12.

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 11:14 (#4)

קֶ֥שֶׁר קֶ֖שֶׁר

“Conspiracy! Conspiracy”

Athaliah is repeating the word **Conspiracy** in order to intensify her expression of the idea she wishes to convey. If your language can repeat phrases for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Reduplication

2 Kings 11:15 (#1)

אֶל־מִבֵּ֣בֵית & בֵּ֔בֵית יְהוָ֖ה

“from the house & in the house of Yahweh”

While the word **house** means “temple” in this verse, as it does throughout this account (except in the case of the phrase “the house of the king”), Athaliah would not have gone inside the temple building. So it means more generally the temple precincts, including its courtyard. Alternate translation: [from the temple area ... in the area of Yahweh’s temple]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 11:15 (#2)

כִּ֣י אָמַ֔ר הַכֹּהֵ֖ן

“For the priest said”

Here the word **For** may introduce an explanation of why Jehoiada gave this order. In that case, the word **said** may mean that Jehoiada said this to himself, in other words, that he thought it. Alternate translation: [Jehoiada gave this order because he was thinking]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 11:15 (#3)

אַל־תּוּמַ֖ת

“Let her not be killed”

The expression **Let her not be killed** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Do not kill her]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 11:16 (#1)

וַיָּשִׂ֥ימוּ לָ֛הּ יָדַ֖יִם

“And they put two hands to her”

The author is using **they put two hands to her** as a common expression of his culture. It could mean: (1) that the soldiers made a clearing in the crowd so that Athaliah would have room on both sides to walk from the temple area back to the palace. Alternate translation: [And the soldiers cleared the way on both sides] or (2) that the soldiers physically seized her to arrest

her. Alternate translation: [And the soldiers laid hands on her] or [And the soldiers arrested her]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 11:16 (#2)

וַתּוּמַת שָׁם

“and she was killed there”

The expression **was killed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the soldiers killed her there]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 11:17 (#1)

וַיִּכְרֹת יְהוֹיָדָע אֶת־הַבְּרִית

“And Jehoiada cut a covenant”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:4. Alternate translation: [And Jehoiada made a covenant]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 11:18 (#1)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:12. Alternate translation: [in front of]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 11:19 (#1)

וַיִּקַּח

“And he took”

The pronoun **he** refers to Jehoiada. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Jehoiada took] or [And Jehoiada led]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 11:19 (#2)

וְאֶת־הַכָּרִי

“and the Carite”

See how you translated this name in 11:4. Alternate translation: [and the Cherethites] or [and the Carite guards]

See: How to Translate Names

2 Kings 11:19 (#3)

וַיֹּרִידוּ אֶת־הַמֶּלֶךְ

“and they brought the king down”

See how you translated the similar expression “go up” in 1:3. Alternate translation: [and they brought the king]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 11:20 (#1)

וַיִּשְׂמַח כָּל־עַם־הָאָרֶץ וְהָעִיר שָׁקְטָה וְאֶת־עֲתַלְיָהוּ הֵמִתוּ בַחֶרֶב בְּבֵית מלך

“And all of the people of the land rejoiced, and the city was quiet, for they had killed Athaliah with the sword {at} the house of the king”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And because they had killed Athaliah with the sword at the house of the king, all of the people of the land rejoiced, and the city was quiet]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 11:20 (#2)

וַיִּשְׂמַח כָּל־עַם־הָאָרֶץ

“And all of the people of the land rejoiced”

The author is saying **all of the people** as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [And people throughout the land rejoiced]

See: Hyperbole

2 Kings 11:21 (#1)

בֶּן־שֶׁשׁ שָׁנִים יְהוֹאָשׁ

“Joash {was} a son of seven years”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:17. Alternate translation: [Joash was seven years old]

See: Idiom

2 Kings - Chapter 12 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the story of King Joash of Judah. It tells how he ensured that the temple of Yahweh was repaired and maintained.

2 Kings 12:1 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַת־שֶׁשֶׁבַע לְיֵהוּאָ֣ מָלַ֣ךְ יְהוֹאָ֔שׁ וְאַרְבָּעִ֥ים שָׁנָ֖ה מָלַ֣ךְ בִּירוּשָׁלָ֑͏ִם וְשֵׁ֣ם אִמּ֔וֹ צִבְיָ֖ה מִבְּאֵ֥ר שָֽׁבַע

“In the year of seven to Jehu, Joash reigned. And he reigned 40 years in Jerusalem. And the name of his mother {was} Zibiah, from Beersheba”

In this verse and the next two verses, the author is introducing **Joash** as a participant in the story as the new king of Judah. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:16.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 12:1 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַת־שֶׁשֶׁבַע לְיֵהוּאָ֣

“In the year of seven to Jehu”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **seven**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [In the seventh year of Jehu’s reign]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 12:1 (#3)

צִבְיָ֖ה מִבְּאֵ֥ר שָֽׁבַע

“was} Zibiah, from Beersheba”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [was Zibiah, and she was from Beersheba]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 12:2 (#1)

וַיַּ֤עַשׂ יְהוֹאָשׁ֙ הַיָּשָׁ֔ר בְּעֵינֵ֖י יְהוָ֑ה כָּל־יָמָ֕יו אֲשֶׁ֥ר הוֹרָ֖הוּ יְהוֹיָדָ֥ע הַכֹּהֵֽן

“And Joash did right in the eyes of Yahweh all of his days because Jehoiada the priest instructed him”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And because Jehoiada the priest instructed him, Joash did right in the eyes of Yahweh all of his days]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 12:2 (#2)

הַיָּשָׁ֔ר בְּעֵינֵ֖י יְהוָ֑ה

“right in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:13. Alternate translation: [what Yahweh considered to be right]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 12:3 (#1)

הַבָּמ֖וֹת לֹא־סָ֣רוּ

“they did not remove the high places”

The author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the high places were not removed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 12:4 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר־יוּבָ֖א

“that is brought”

The expression **is brought** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that people bring]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 12:4 (#2)

בֵּ֣ית־יְהוָ֔ה

“into} the house of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:18. Alternate translation: [into the temple of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 12:4 (#3)

כֶּ֖סֶף עוֹבֵ֣ר אִ֑ישׁ

“the silver passing over a man”

Joash is using **the silver passing over a man** as a common expression of his culture to mean the money that each Israelite male would pay during a census for the maintenance of the temple. (This was commanded in the law of Moses in Exodus 30:11–16 and originally supported the worship in the tabernacle.) If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language,

you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the silver collected during a census] or [census money]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 12:4 (#4)

כֶּ֣סֶף נַפְשׁ֔וֹת עֶרְכּ֖וֹ

“the silver of the lives of his valuation”

Joash is referring to **silver** that someone would pay to redeem a person or animal that he had dedicated to Yahweh, as described in Leviticus 27:1–13. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [silver paid to redeem people or animals dedicated to Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 12:4 (#5)

כָּל־כֶּ֣סֶף אֲשֶׁ֣ר יֵעָלֶ֣ה עַל־לֵ֣ב אִ֔ישׁ לְהָבִ֖יא בֵּ֣ית יְהוָ֑ה

“all of the silver that goes up onto the heart of a man to bring {into} the house of Yahweh”

Joash is speaking as if **silver** could actually go **up onto the heart of a man**. He is using the heart to represent a person’s desires. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all of the silver that a person desired to bring into the temple of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 12:5 (#1)

אִ֖ישׁ מֵאֵ֣ת מַכָּרֵ֑ו

“a man from his acquaintance”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:23. Alternate translation: [each of you from his acquaintances]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 12:5 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר־יִמָּצֵ֥א שָׁ֖ם בֶּ֑דֶק

“where damage is found there”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [where damage is found]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 12:5 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר־יִמָּצֵ֥א שָׁ֖ם בֶּ֑דֶק

“where damage is found there”

The expression **is found** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [where they find damage]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 12:6 (#1)

וַיְהִ֗י

“And it happened”

The author is using this phrase to introduce a new development within this event. See how you translated the same phrase in 2:9.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 12:6 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַ֥ת עֶשְׂרִ֛ים וְשָׁל֥וֹשׁ שָׁנָ֖ה לַמֶּ֣לֶךְ יְהוֹאָֽשׁ

“in the year of 23, the year to King Joash”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:25. Alternate translation: [And in the twenty-third year of King Joash]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 12:7 (#1)

מַדּ֗וּעַ אֵינְכֶם֙ מְחַזְּקִ֣ים אֶת־הַבֶּ֔דֶק הַבָּ֖יִת

“Why are you not strengthening the damage of the house”

King Joash is using the question form to express frustration and to rebuke the priests for their failure to repair the temple. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You have not been successful in strengthening the damage of the house.]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 12:7 (#2)

וְעַתָּ֔ה

“And now”

And now was an expression that speakers in this culture commonly used to introduce an important point such as the implications of what they were just saying. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. See how you translated this expression in 3:23.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 12:9 (#1)

אִישׁ

“a man”

Here the masculine term **man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [a person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

2 Kings 12:9 (#2)

הַמּוּבָא

“brought”

The expression **brought** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that he brought]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 12:10 (#1)

הִנְמְצָא

“found”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:5. Alternate translation: [that they found]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 12:11 (#1)

הֻמְתְּכָן

“that was weighed”

The expression **was weighed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that they had weighed]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 12:11 (#2)

עַל־יד

“into the hands of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:5. Alternate translation: [into the custody of]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 12:11 (#3)

הפקדים

“the ones appointed”

The expression **appointed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the ones whom the king and high priest had appointed]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 12:12 (#1)

וּלְכֹל אֲשֶׁר־יֵצֵא עַל־הַבַּיִת לְחָזְקָה

“and for everything that came out concerning the house to strengthen {it”

The author is using **everything that came out** as a common expression of his culture to describe further needs that were discovered in the process of making repairs to the temple. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and for anything else that came up as they were repairing the temple] or [and for further needs that were discovered in the process of making repairs to the temple]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 12:12 (#2)

וְאַבְנֵי מַחְצֵב

“and stones of hewing”

The author is using the possessive form to describe **stones** that were characterized by **hewing**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Kings 5:17. Alternate translation: [and stones that workers had cut into shape]

See: Possession

2 Kings 12:13 (#1)

אַדְּךָ֗ לֹ֣א יֵעָשֶׂ֞ה בֵּ֣ית יְהוָ֗ה סִפּ֤וֹת כֶּ֙סֶף֙ מְזַמְּרֹ֔ת מִזְרָקוֹת֙ חֲצֹצְרֹ֔ות כָּל־כְּלֵ֥י זָהָ֖ב וּכְלֵי־כָ֑סֶף מִן־הַכֶּ֙סֶף֙ הַמּוּבָ֔א בֵּית־יְהוָ֖ה

“However, {in} the house of Yahweh, bowls of silver, snuffers, basins, trumpets, {or} any {other} articles of gold or articles of silver were not made from the silver brought {to} the house of Yahweh”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could you could combine this verse and the first sentence of the next verse into a verse bridge in which that sentence comes first, since that sentence gives the reason for the result that this verse describes. Alternate translation: [However, since they gave the silver brought to the house of Yahweh to the people doing the work, that silver was not used to make bowls of silver, snuffers, basins, trumpets, or any or articles of gold or articles of silver for the house of Yahweh]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 12:13 (#2)

לֹ֣א יֵעָשֶׂ֞ה & סִפּ֤וֹת כֶּ֙סֶף֙ מְזַמְּרֹ֔ת מִזְרָקוֹת֙ חֲצֹצְרֹ֔ות כָּל־כְּלֵ֥י זָהָ֖ב וּכְלֵי־כָ֑סֶף

“bowls of silver, snuffers, basins, trumpets, {or} any {other} articles of gold or articles of silver were not made”

The expression **were not made** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the workers did not make bowls of silver, snuffers, basins, trumpets, or any other articles of gold or articles of silver]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 12:13 (#3)

הַמּוּבָ֔א

“brought”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:9. Alternate translation: [that people brought]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 12:15 (#1)

וְלֹ֣א יְחַשְּׁבוּ֩ אֶת־הָאֲנָשִׁ֨ים אֲשֶׁ֜ר יִתְּנ֧וּ אֶת־הַכֶּ֛סֶף עַל־יָדָ֖ם לְתִתֶּ֣ת לְעֹשֵׂ֑י הַמְלָאכָ֔ה כִּ֥י בֶאֱמֶנָ֖ה הֵ֥ם עֹשִֽׂים

“And they did not reckon with the men into whose hand they gave the silver to give to the doers of the work, for they were acting in faithfulness”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And because the men into whose hand they gave the silver to give to the doers of the work were acting in faithfulness, they did not reckon with them]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 12:15 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֨ר & עַל־יָדָ֜ם

“into whose hand”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:11. Alternate translation: [into whose custody]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 12:15 (#3)

אֲשֶׁ֨ר & עַל־יָדָ֜ם

“into whose hand”

In this verse, the word **hand** is singular in form, but it refers to the hands of all of the men who had been appointed to supervise the work. If you decide to keep the image of a **hand** that represents custody, if it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of the word. Alternate translation: [into whose hands]

See: Collective Nouns

2 Kings 12:15 (#4)

בֶּאֱמֶנָ֖ה

“in faithfulness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **faithfulness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [faithfully]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Kings 12:16 (#1)

כֶּ֚סֶף אָשָׁ֣ם וְכֶ֔סֶף חַטָּאֹ֖ות לֹ֣א יוּבָ֑א בֵּ֥בֵית יְהוָ֖ה

“The silver of the guilt offering and the silver of the sin offerings was not brought into the house of Yahweh”

The expression **was not brought** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [The priests did not bring the silver of the

guilt offering and the silver of the sin offerings into the house of Yahweh]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 12:16 (#2)

לַכֹּהֲנִים יִהְיוּ

“They were to the priests”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could use a singular form for this expression, since it refers to the **silver** described in the previous sentence. Alternate translation: [It was to the priests] or [It belonged to the priests]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

2 Kings 12:17 (#1)

אָז

“Then”

The author is using the term **Then** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 12:17 (#2)

יַעַל & לַעֲלוֹת

“went up & to go up”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [went ... to go]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 12:17 (#3)

וַיָּשֶׂם חֲזָאֵל פָּנָיו

“And Hazael set his face”

The author is using **set his face** as a common expression of his culture to mean “determined.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Hazael determined] or [And Hazael resolved]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 12:18 (#1)

אֲבֹתָיו

“his fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [his ancestors]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 12:18 (#2)

וְאֵת כָּל־הַזָּהָב הַנִּמְצָא

“and all of the gold found”

The author is using the term **found** in a way characteristic of his language and culture to mean that this **gold** could be found, that is, that it was present in the **treasuries** of the temple and palace. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and all of the gold that was]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 12:19 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי יוֹאָשׁ וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה הֲלוֹא־הֵם כְּתוּבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים לְמַלְכֵי יְהוּדָה

“Now the rest of the matters of Joash and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Judah”

In this verse and the next two verses, the author is concluding the story of Joash. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar phrases in 1:18.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 12:20 (#1)

וַיָּקֻמוּ עֲבָדָיו

“And his servants arose”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [And his servants took action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 12:20 (#2)

וַיִּקְשְׁרוּ־קֶשֶׁר

“and they conspired a conspiracy”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [and they formed a conspiracy]

See: Poetry

2 Kings 12:20 (#3)

וַיַּכּוּהוּ

“and they struck”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [and they attacked]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 12:21 (#1)

וִיהוֹזָבָד & וַיִּקְבְּרוּ אֹתוֹ

“and Jehozabad & And they buried him”

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people buried him] or [and he was buried]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 12:21 (#2)

עִם־אֲבֹתָיו

“with his fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [with his ancestors] or [in the same place where people had buried his ancestors]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings - Chapter 13 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

In this chapter, the author continues to tell what the kings were like who ruled over the kingdoms of Israel and Judah.

1. King Jehoahaz of Israel (1–9)
2. King Jehoash of Israel (10–25)

The author formally concludes a brief account of the reign of King Jehoash of Israel in 13:10–11. However, after telling the story of the end of Elisha’s life, he gives further details of the reign of Jehoash in 13:22–14:14, and he formally concludes his reign again in 14:15–16. So within the overall outline of the book, the story of the end of Elisha’s life takes place within a special kind of time, a sacred time outside the reigns of kings, just like the story of the end of Elijah’s life in 2:1–18.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Who was the “savior” whom Yahweh gave to Israel?
In 13:4–5, after the author has introduced Jehoahaz as the next king of Israel, he says that when Yahweh “saw the oppression of Israel,” he “gave to Israel a savior,” that is, someone to deliver them from their enemies. Since he then describes how badly the Arameans defeated Jehoahaz, he probably does not mean that Jehoahaz was this savior. Rather, he is most likely looking ahead to the story of Jehoash in 13:14–19, in which Elisha promises Jehoash victories over the Arameans and he wins a few such victories. The author is probably looking ahead even more so to the story of Jeroboam, the son of Jehoash, in 14:23–29. There the author describes how Jeroboam won back much territory that the Israelites had lost and says that Yahweh “saved” them through the actions of Jeroboam, using a verb from the same root as “savior.”

2 Kings 13:1 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַת֩ עֶשְׂרִ֨ים וְשָׁלֹ֜שׁ שָׁנָ֗ה לְיוֹאָ֤שׁ בֶּן־אֲחַזְיָ֙הוּ֙ מֶ֣לֶךְ יְהוּדָ֔ה מָלַ֕ךְ
יְהוֹאָחָ֥ז בֶּן־יֵה֖וּא עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל בְּשֹׁ֣מְר֔וֹן שְׁבַ֥ע עֶשְׂרֵ֖ה שָׁנָֽה

“In the year of 23, the year to Joash, the son of Ahaziah, the king of Judah, Jehoahaz, the son of Jehu, reigned over Israel in Samaria, 17 years”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is introducing **Jehoahaz** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Israel**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:16.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 13:1 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַת֩ עֶשְׂרִ֨ים וְשָׁלֹ֜שׁ שָׁנָ֗ה לְיוֹאָ֤שׁ

“In the year of 23, the year to Joash”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:25. Alternate translation: [In the twenty-third year of Joash]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 13:1 (#3)

שְׁבַ֥ע עֶשְׂרֵ֖ה שָׁנָֽה

“17 years”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he reigned for 17 years]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 13:2 (#1)

וַיַּעַשׂ הָרַע בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה וַיֵּלֶךְ אַחַר חַטֹּאת יָרָבְעָם בֶּן־נְבָט אֲשֶׁר־הֶחֱטִיא אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל לֹא־סָר מִמֶּנָּה

“And he did evil in the eyes of Yahweh. And he walked after the sins of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who caused Israel to sin. He did not turn away from it”

The author is continuing to introduce Jehoahaz. See how you translated the similar expressions in 3:3 and 8:18. Alternate translation: [And he did what Yahweh considered to be evil, and he committed the same sins as Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who caused Israel to sin. He did not stop committing those sins]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 13:3 (#1)

וַיִּחַר־אַף יְהוָה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל

“And the nose of Yahweh burned against Israel”

The author is saying that the **nose** of Yahweh **burned** as a common expression of his culture to mean that Yahweh became angry. This culture used the nose to represent anger because a person who is angry breathes heavily through his nose, and his nose may become red. Your culture may also associate anger with a particular part of the body. If so, you could use an expression involving that part of the body in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [Then Yahweh became very angry with Israel]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 13:3 (#2)

וַיִּתְּנֵם בְּיַד ׀ חֲזָאֵל מֶלֶךְ־אֲרָם וּבְיַד בֶּן־הֲדַד בֶּן־חֲזָאֵל

“and he gave them into the hand of Hazael, the king of Aram, and into the hand of Ben Hadad, the son of Hazael”

Here, **hand** represents the power and control of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he gave Hazael, the king of Aram, and Ben Hadad, the son of Hazael, power over them]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 13:3 (#3)

כָּל־הַיָּמִים

“all of the days”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:6. Alternate translation: [for a long time]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 13:4 (#1)

אֶת־פְּנֵי יְהוָה

“the face of Yahweh”

The author is using Yahweh’s **face** to represent all of him in the act of listening to the entreaty of Jehoahaz. See how you translated the similar expression in 1:15. Alternate translation: [Yahweh]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 13:4 (#2)

וַיִּשְׁמַע אֵלָיו יְהוָה כִּי־רָאָה אֶת־לַחַץ יִשְׂרָאֵל כִּי־לָחַץ אֹתָם מֶלֶךְ אֲרָם

“and Yahweh listened to him because he saw the oppression of Israel, for the king of Aram oppressed them”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [and since the king of Aram was oppressing them, Yahweh listened to him because he saw the oppression of Israel]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 13:4 (#3)

וַיִּשְׁמַע אֵלָיו יְהוָה

“and Yahweh listened to him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:6. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh gave him what he asked for]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 13:4 (#4)

אֶת־לַחַץ יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the oppression of Israel”

The author is using the possessive form to describe **oppression** that **Israel** suffered, not oppression that Israel committed. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [how Israel was being oppressed]

See: Possession

2 Kings 13:4 (#5)

יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:1. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 13:5 (#1)

וַיֵּצְאוּ מִתַּחַת יַד־אֲרָם

“and they came out from under the hand of Aram”

The author is speaking as if the Israelites had actually been **under** the **hand of Aram**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he freed them from the power of Aram]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 13:5 (#2)

בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:12. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 13:5 (#3)

בְּאָהֳלֵיהֶם

“in their tents”

The author may be using one kind of home, a **tent**, to mean all kinds of homes. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in their homes]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 13:5 (#4)

כִּתְמוֹל שִׁלְשׁוֹם

“as yesterday, the third day”

The author is using **as yesterday, the third day** as a common expression of their culture to mean “as in the past.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as in the past]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 13:6 (#1)

לֹא־סָרוּ מֵחַטֹּאוֹת

“they did not turn aside from the sins of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 13:2. Alternate translation: [they did not stop committing the sins]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 13:6 (#2)

בֵּית־יָרָבְעָם

“the house of Jeroboam”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:18. Alternate translation: [the dynasty of Jeroboam]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 13:6 (#3)

בָּהֶם הָלָךְ

“He walked in it”

The pronoun **He** refers to the Israelite people, whom the author calls “the sons of Israel” in the previous verse. The pronoun **it** refers to **the sins of the house of Jeroboam**. Since the author uses the plural pronoun “they” to represent the Israelites in the previous sentence, and since the word “sins” is plural, it may be natural in your language to use plural pronouns here. Alternate translation: [They walked in them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 13:6 (#4)

בָּהֶם הָלָךְ

“He walked in it”

See how you translated the similar expression in 13:2. Alternate translation: [They committed those sins]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 13:6 (#5)

וְגַם הָאֲשֵׁרָה עָמְדָה בְּשֹׁמְרוֹן

“and also the Asherah stood in Samaria”

The author says **the Asherah** to mean a specific one, the one that King Ahab set up, as 1 Kings 16:33 describes. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and also the Asherah that King Ahab had set up remained in Samaria]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 13:7 (#1)

כִּֽי

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces an explanation for what the author describes Yahweh doing in verses 4 and 5. Alternate translation: [Yahweh sent a savior to Israel because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 13:7 (#2)

לֹא־הִשְׁאִ֣יר לִֽיהוֹאָחָ֗ז עָ֚ם כִּ֣י אִם־חֲמִשִּׁ֣ים פָּרָשִׁ֔ים וַעֲשָׂרָ֥ה רֶ֖כֶב וַעֲשֶׂ֣רֶת אַלְפֵ֣י רַגְלִ֑י כִּ֣י אִבְּדָ֔ם וַיְּשִׂמֵ֖ם כֶּעָפָ֥ר לָדֽוּשׁ

“he did not leave people to Jehoahaz except 50 horsemen and 10 chariots and 10,000 foot soldiers, for the king of Aram destroyed them”

The pronoun **he** refers to **the king of Aram**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could name the king in the earlier part of the sentence and use the pronoun in the later part of the sentence. Alternate translation: [the king of Aram did not leave people to Jehoahaz except 50 horsemen and 10 chariots and 10,000 foot soldiers, for he destroyed them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 13:7 (#3)

לֹא־הִשְׁאִ֣יר לִֽיהוֹאָחָ֗ז עָ֚ם כִּ֣י אִם־חֲמִשִּׁ֣ים פָּרָשִׁ֔ים וַעֲשָׂרָ֥ה רֶ֖כֶב וַעֲשֶׂ֣רֶת אַלְפֵ֣י רַגְלִ֑י

“he did not leave people to Jehoahaz except 50 horsemen and 10 chariots and 10,000 foot soldiers”

If it would appear in your language that the author was making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [the only people he left to Jehoahaz were 50 horsemen and 10 chariots and 10,000 foot soldiers]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

2 Kings 13:7 (#4)

עָ֚ם

“people”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:21. Alternate translation: [soldiers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 13:7 (#5)

וַיְּשִׂמֵ֖ם כֶּעָפָ֥ר לָדֽוּשׁ

“and made them like dust to threshing”

The author is using the word **threshing** to represent “trampling,” since the way people threshed grain in this culture was to have oxen trample it. Alternate translation: [and he made them like dust that people trample on]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 13:7 (#6)

וַיְּשִׂמֵ֖ם כֶּעָפָ֥ר לָדֽוּשׁ

“and made them like dust to threshing”

The point of this comparison is that just as **dust** is harmless and people can step on it easily, so the king of Aram defeated Israel’s army so completely that it became harmless and easy for anyone to defeat. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and rendered them harmless] or [and rendered them completely vulnerable]

See: Simile

2 Kings 13:8 (#1)

וְיֶ֤תֶר דִּבְרֵי֙ יְהוֹאָחָ֔ז וְכָל־אֲשֶׁ֥ר עָשָׂ֖ה וּגְבוּרָתֽוֹ הֲלוֹא־הֵ֗ם כְּתוּבִ֛ים עַל־סֵ֥פֶר דִּבְרֵ֖י הַיָּמִ֑ים לְמַלְכֵ֖י יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“Now the rest of the matters of Jehoahaz and all that he did and his might, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is concluding the story of Jehoahaz. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar phrases in 1:18.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 13:9 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּ֥ב יְהוֹאָחָ֖ז עִם־אֲבֹתָ֑יו

“And Jehoahaz lay down with his fathers”

See how you translated the same expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [And Jehoahaz passed away] or [And Jehoahaz died]

See: Euphemism

2 Kings 13:9 (#2)

וַיִּקְבְּרֻ֣הוּ

“and they buried him”

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language.

Alternate translation: [and people buried him] or [and he was buried]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 13:10 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַת שְׁלֹשִׁים וְשֶׁשַׁבַּעַ שָׁנָה לְיוֹאָשׁ מֶמֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה מָלַךְ יְהוֹאָחָשׁ בֶּן־יְהוֹאָחָז עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּשֹׁמְרוֹן שֵׁשׁ עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה

“In the year of 37, the year to Joash, the king of Judah, Jehoash, the son of Jehoahaz, reigned over Israel in Samaria, 16 years”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is introducing **Jehoash** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Israel**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:25.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 13:10 (#2)

שֵׁשׁ עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה

“16 years”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he reigned for 16 years]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 13:11 (#1)

וַיַּעַשׂ הָרַע בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה לֹא סָר מִכָּל־חַטֹּאות יָרָבְעָם בֶּן־נְבָט אֲשֶׁר־הֶחֱטִיא אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל בָּבָּה הָלָךְ

“And he did evil in the eyes of Yahweh. He did not turn aside from all of the sins of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who caused Israel to sin. He walked in it”

The author is continuing to introduce Jehoash. See how you translated the similar expressions in 3:3 and 8:18. Alternate translation: [And he did what Yahweh considered to be evil. He committed the same sins as Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who caused Israel to sin. He did not stop committing those sins]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 13:12 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי יוֹאָשׁ וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה וּגְבוּרָתוֹ אֲשֶׁר נִלְחַם עִם אֲמַצְיָה מֶלֶךְ־יְהוּדָה הֲלוֹא־הֵם כְּתוּבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים לְמַלְכֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Now the rest of the matters of Jehoash and all that he did and his might {with} which he fought with Amaziah, the king of Judah, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel”

After giving a brief summary of the reign of Jehoash in 13:10–11, the author concludes this summary here and in the next verse. However, he immediately gives a more detailed description of the reign of Jehoash in 13:14–14:14, and he concludes that description in 14:15–16. It would still be appropriate to translate this verse in the same way that you translated the similar phrases in 1:18.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 13:13 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּב יוֹאָשׁ עִם־אֲבֹתָיו

“And Jehoash lay down with his fathers”

See how you translated the same expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [And Jehoash passed away] or [And Jehoash died]

See: Euphemism

2 Kings 13:13 (#2)

וְיָרָבְעָם יָשַׁב עַל־כִּסְאוֹ

“and Jeroboam sat on his throne”

The author is using the act of sitting on a **throne** to represent becoming king. See how you translated the similar expression in 10:3. Alternate translation: [and Jeroboam succeeded him as king]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 13:13 (#3)

וְיָרָבְעָם & וַיִּקָּבֵר יוֹאָשׁ

“and Jeroboam & And Jehoash was buried”

The expression **was buried** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people buried Jehoash]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 13:14 (#1)

וֶאֱלִישָׁע חָלָה אֶת־חָלְיוֹ אֲשֶׁר יָמוּת בּוֹ

“Now Elisha had become sick with his sickness with which he would die”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information

in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

2 Kings 13:14 (#2)

וַיֵּ֣רֶד & יוֹאָ֞שׁ מֶ֧לֶךְ־יִשְׂרָאֵ֛ל

“And Jehoash, the king of Israel, went down”

See how you translated the similar expression “go up” in 1:3. Alternate translation: [And Jehoash the king of Israel went]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 13:14 (#3)

וַיֵּ֥בְךְּ עַל־פָּנָ֖יו

“and he wept over his face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:15. Alternate translation: [and he wept over him]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 13:14 (#4)

אָבִ֤י ׀ אָבִי֙

“My father, my father”

Jehoash is referring to Elisha by a respectful title. Use a comparable title or expression for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [O prophet, O prophet]

See: Politeness

2 Kings 13:14 (#5)

אָבִ֤י ׀ אָבִי֙

“My father, my father”

Jehoash is repeating the phrase **My father** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat phrases for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [O great prophet]

See: Reduplication

2 Kings 13:14 (#6)

רֶ֥כֶב יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל וּפָרָשָׁ֑יו

“the chariotry of Israel and its horsemen”

Jehoash is speaking as if Elisha had actually been **chariotry** and **horsemen** defending **Israel**. He means that Elisha’s spiritual leadership, prayers, counsel, and presence provided strength and security for the kingdom. See how you translated the same expression in 2:12. Alternate translation: [Israel’s mighty defender]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 13:16 (#1)

הַרְכֵּ֥ב יָדְךָ֖ עַל־הַקָּ֑שֶׁת

“Make your hand ride on the bow”

Elisha is using **Make your hand ride on the bow** as a common expression of his culture to mean “Grasp the bow with your left hand.” (The context indicates that the king understood that he should also grasp the bowstring with his right hand.) If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Take the bow in your hands] or [Hold the bow in readiness to shoot an arrow]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 13:16 (#2)

וַיַּרְכֵּ֥ב יָדָ֖ו

“And he made his hand ride”

The author is using the same common expression as Jehoash. Alternate translation: [And he took the bow in his hands]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 13:17 (#1)

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר פְּתַ֔ח הַחַלּ֖וֹן קֵ֑דְמָה

“And he said, “Open the window to the east”

Since the king was holding the bow, the implication is that Elisha wanted the king to have a servant or attendant open the window. You could indicate this in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 13:17 (#2)

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר פְּתַ֔ח הַחַלּ֖וֹן קֵ֑דְמָה וַיִּפְתָּ֖ח וַיֹּ֣אמֶר אֱלִישָׁ֗ע יְרֵ֤ה ׀ וַיֹּ֙רׇ֙ וַיֹּ֣אמֶר חֵ֔ץ תְּשׁוּעָ֖ה לַיהוָ֑ה וְחֵ֥ץ תְּשׁוּעָ֖ה בָּאֲרָ֑ם וְהִכִּ֣יתָ֔ אֶת־אֲרָ֖ם בַּאֲפֵ֥ק עַד־כַּלֵּֽה

“And he said, “Open the window to the east.” And one opened {it}. And Elisha said, “Shoot.” And he shot. And he said, “The arrow of victory to Yahweh, and the arrow of victory against Aram. And you will strike Aram at Aphek to finishing”

Having the king shoot an arrow eastward, in the direction of Aram, was a symbolic action by which Elisha represented Yahweh’s promise of victory over Aram and encouraged the king to trust that promise. Elisha placing his hands on the king’s hands symbolized how Yahweh would enable Jehoash to win that victory. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote.

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 13:17 (#3)

וְהִכִּיתָ֖ אֶת־אֲרָ֑ם

“And you will strike Aram”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [And you will defeat Aram]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 13:19 (#1)

הִכִּ֥יתָ & תַּכֶּ֖ה

“you would have struck & you will strike”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [you would have defeated ... you will defeat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 13:20 (#1)

וַיְקַבְּרֻ֖הוּ

“and they buried him”

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people buried him] or [and he was buried]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 13:20 (#2)

וּגְדוּדֵ֣י מוֹאָ֔ב יָבְא֖וּ בָּאָ֑רֶץ בָּבָ֖א שָׁנָֽה

“Now raiding bands of Moab came into the land {at} the coming {of} the year”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

2 Kings 13:20 (#3)

בָּבָ֖א שָׁנָֽה

“at} the coming {of} the year”

The author is using **{at} the coming {of} the year** as a common expression of his culture to mean “in the springtime.” This culture followed an agricultural year, which began at the time when it became possible to plant crops. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the springtime]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 13:21 (#1)

וַיְהִ֗י

“And it happened”

The author is using the phrase **And it happened** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 13:21 (#2)

הֵ֣מָּה ׀ קֹבְרִ֣ים אִ֔ישׁ

“they were burying a man”

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [some people were burying a man] or [a man was being buried]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 13:21 (#3)

וְהִנֵּ֣ה

“and behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:9.

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 13:21 (#4)

וַיִּגַּ֤ע הָאִישׁ֙ בְּעַצְמ֣וֹת אֱלִישָׁ֔ע

“And the man went and touched the bones of Elisha”

Since **the man** was dead, it is not the case that he **went** anywhere on his own. In this case the author is using a verb of motion to indicate a change of location. What he means is that the man’s body came into contact with **the bones of Elisha**. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And the man’s body came into contact with the bones of Elisha]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 13:21 (#5)

בְּעַצְמוֹת אֱלִישָׁע

“the bones of Elisha”

Since Elisha had only recently died, the author seems to be using his **bones** to represent all of his remains. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Elisha’s remains]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 13:21 (#6)

וַיָּקָם עַל־רַגְלָיו

“that he arose onto his feet”

The pronoun **he** refers to the man, not to Elisha. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [that the man arose onto his feet]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 13:22 (#1)

וְחֲזָאֵל מֶלֶךְ אֲרָם לָחַץ אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל כֹּל יְמֵי יְהוֹאָחָז

“Now Hazael, the king of Aram, had oppressed Israel all of the days of Jehoahaz”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

2 Kings 13:22 (#2)

כֹּל יְמֵי יְהוֹאָחָז

“all of the days of Jehoahaz”

The author is using **days** to represent “time,” since time is made up of days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [during the whole time when Jehoahaz was king]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 13:23 (#1)

וַיֵּפֶן אֲלֵיהֶם

“and he turned to them”

The author is speaking as if Yahweh had actually **turned** to look at the Israelites. He means that Yahweh paid attention to them out of concern for them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he paid attention to them out of concern for them]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 13:23 (#2)

וְלֹא־הִשְׁלִיכָם

“and he has not cast them”

The author is speaking as if Yahweh might actually have **cast** or thrown the Israelites somewhere. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he has not allowed anyone to take them]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 13:23 (#3)

מֵעַל־פָּנָיו

“away from his face”

Here, the **face** of Yahweh represents his presence, and in this context it means specifically the land of Israel, where Yahweh was understood to be present in a special way. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [away from the land of Israel]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 13:23 (#4)

עַד־עָתָּה

“until now”

The author is using the term **now** to refer to the time at which he is writing. As in the case of the phrase “to this day,” translators should bear in mind that the phrase refers to a time that is now in the past. They should avoid giving the impression that it means

the present day of the translation's readers. Alternate translation: [up to the time of this writing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 13:25 (#1)

וַיָּ֣שָׁב & וַיִּקַּ֗ח

"And & returned and took"

The phrase **returned and took** expresses a single idea. The word **returned** tells in what way Jehoash **took** these cities. Specifically, he took them back after Hazael had taken them from his father. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [took back] or [retook]

See: Hendiadys

2 Kings 13:25 (#2)

מִיַּד֙ בֶּן־הֲדַ֣ד יְהוֹאָחָ֔ז & מִיַּ֖ד

"from the hand of Ben Hadad & from the hand of Jehoahaz"

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:5. Alternate translation: [from the possession of Ben-Hadad & from the possession of Jehoahaz]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 13:25 (#3)

הִכָּ֥הוּ יוֹאָ֛שׁ

"Joash struck him"

Here the author calls Jehoash by a shortened form of his name, **Joash**. If you have decided to use the same names in your translation that the biblical author does in each place, you may wish to use the name Joash here. If you have decided to use the same name consistently for a given person, you may wish to use the name Jehoash here.

See: How to Translate Names

2 Kings 13:25 (#4)

הִכָּ֥הוּ

"struck him"

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [defeated him]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 13:25 (#5)

וַיָּ֣שָׁב אֶת־עָרֵ֔י יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

"and he made the cities of Israel return"

The author is speaking as if Jehoash had actually **made** these cities **return** to Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he established Israelite control over the cities once again]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings - Chapter 14 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

In this chapter, the author continues to tell what the kings were like who ruled over the kingdoms of Israel and Judah.

1. King Amaziah of Judah (1–22)
2. King Jeroboam of Israel (23–29)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did Amaziah want to fight a battle with Jehoash?

It seems that Amaziah wanted to fight a battle with Jehoash primarily because of the pride and self-confidence he felt as a result of his recent victory over the Edomites. But the challenge to Jehoash may also have been motivated in part by a desire for revenge against the Israelites. As 2 Chronicles 25:5–13 describes, Amaziah hired soldiers from Israel to help him fight the Edomites. But a prophet warned Amaziah not to bring those soldiers with his army, so he sent them back to Israel. On their way home, they plundered Judean towns and killed 3,000 people. Amaziah may also have held a grudge against the family of Jehoash because his grandfather Jehu had massacred Amaziah's ancestors. For some or all of these reasons, Amaziah challenged Jehoash to a battle to test their strength against each other. He wanted to expand the power and influence of his kingdom, and he may also have wanted to get some kind of revenge.

What does it mean that Jeroboam "brought Damascus and Hamath of Judah back into Israel" (14:28)?

Damascus and Hamath were cities in Aram. David and Solomon had conquered them and made them subject to their rule. The Arameans had later recaptured them. So when the author speaks of "Damascus and Hamath of Judah," he probably means that those cities had formerly been subjugated by kings from the tribe of Judah. When he says that Jeroboam "brought" them "back into Israel," he means that they were once again ruled by Israelites, although this time by the northern kingdom. He does not mean that Jeroboam took these

cities away from the possession of Judah and made them subject to his own rule.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

The names Jehoash and Joash
In this chapter, the author calls the son of Jehoahaz who succeeded him as king of Israel by two different names. He calls him by his full name, Jehoash, in verses 15, 16, 21, and 29. He calls him by a shortened form of his name, Joash, in verses 1, 23, and 27, as he also did in 13:25. If you have decided to use the same names in your translation that the biblical author does in each place, you may wish to use the name Joash in those verses. If you have decided to use the same name consistently for a given person, you may wish to use the name Jehoash instead.

2 Kings 14:1 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַ֣ת שְׁתַּ֔יִם לְיוֹאָ֖שׁ בֶּן־יוֹאָחָ֑ז מֶ֣לֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל מָלַ֖ךְ אֲמַצְיָ֥הוּ בֶן־יוֹאָ֛שׁ מֶ֥לֶךְ יְהוּדָֽה

“In the year of two to Joash, the son of Jehoahaz, the king of Israel, Amaziah, the son of Joash, the king of Judah, reigned”

In this verse and the next two verses, the author is introducing **Amaziah** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Judah**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:16.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 14:1 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַ֣ת שְׁתַּ֔יִם לְיוֹאָ֖שׁ

“In the year of two to Joash”

If your language would not describe a year of a king’s reign in a form such as **the year of two**, you could represent this year in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [in the second year of Jehoash]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 14:1 (#3)

לְיוֹאָ֖שׁ

“to Joash”

Here and in verses 23 and 27, the author calls Jehoash by a shortened form of his name, **Joash**, as he also does in 13:25. See what form of the name you decided to use there, and use the same form here and in those verses.

See: How to Translate Names

2 Kings 14:2 (#1)

בֶּן־עֶשְׂרִ֥ים וְחָמֵ֖שׁ שָׁנָ֣ה הָיָ֑ה

“He was a son of 25 years”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:17. Alternate translation: [He was 25 years old]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 14:2 (#2)

יְהוֹעַדִּ֥ין מִן־יְרוּשָׁלָֽם

“was} Jehoaddan, from Jerusalem”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [was Jehoaddan, and she was from Jerusalem]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 14:3 (#1)

וַיַּ֣עַשׂ הַיָּשָׁ֔ר בְּעֵינֵ֖י יְהוָ֑ה

“And he did right in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:13. Alternate translation: [And he did what Yahweh considered to be right]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 14:3 (#2)

אָבִ֖יו

“his father”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [his ancestor]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 14:4 (#1)

הַבָּמ֖וֹת לֹא־סָ֣רוּ

“the high places were not removed”

The expression **were not removed** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he did not remove the high places]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 14:5 (#1)

כַּאֲשֶׁר חָזְקָה הַמַּמְלָכָה בְּיָדוֹ

“as soon as the kingdom was strong in his hand”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [as soon as he had firm control of the kingdom]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 14:5 (#2)

וַיַּדְּךָ & הַמַּכִּים

“that he struck & the ones having struck”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:23. Alternate translation: [that he killed … the ones having killed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 14:6 (#1)

כַּכָּתוּב בְּסֵפֶר תּוֹרַת־מֹשֶׁה

“as written in the book of the law of Moses”

The expression **written** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [as Moses wrote in the book of the law]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 14:6 (#2)

לֹא־יוּמְתוּ אָבוֹת עַל־בָּנִים וּבָנִים לֹא־יוּמְתוּ עַל־אָבוֹת כִּי אִם־אִישׁ בְּחֶטְאוֹ יָמוּת

“Fathers shall not be killed for sons, and sons shall not be killed for fathers. Rather, a man shall be killed for his sin”

The expression **shall not be killed** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [You shall not kill fathers for sons, and you shall not kill sons for fathers. Rather, you shall kill a man for his sin]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 14:6 (#3)

אָבוֹת & בָּנִים & אִישׁ

“Fathers & sons & a man”

Here the masculine terms **Fathers**, **sons**, and **man** have a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. The UST models one way to do that.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

2 Kings 14:7 (#1)

הוּא־הִכָּה

“He, he struck”

The author is stating the pronoun **he** separately, even though the verb translated as **he struck** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to put focus on Amaziah as the king who led the Judean army to do this. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [He was the king who struck]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 14:7 (#2)

הִכָּה

“he struck”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [he defeated]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 14:7 (#3)

אֶת־אֱדוֹם

“Edom”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:1. Alternate translation: [the Edomites]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 14:7 (#4)

עֲשֶׂרֶת אֲלָפִים

“10,000”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [where the Israelite killed 10,000 of their soldiers]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 14:7 (#5)

וַיִּקְרָ֣א אֶת־שְׁמָ֔הּ

“And he called its name”

It might seem that the expression **called its name** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [And he called it] or [And he named it]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 14:7 (#6)

עַ֖ד הַיּ֣וֹם הַזֶּ֑ה

“to this day”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:22. Alternate translation: [and that is still its name at the time of this writing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 14:8 (#1)

לְכָ֥ה

“Come”

Amaziah is not telling Jehoash to **Come** somewhere. He is saying **Come** to encourage him to take the action that he describes. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [Come on]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 14:8 (#2)

נִתְרָאֶ֖ה פָּנִֽים

“let us see one another’s faces”

Amaziah is using **let us see one another’s faces** as a common expression of his culture to mean “let us fight a battle against each other.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly, as the UST does. Alternate translation: [let us meet face to face] or [let us fight a battle against each other]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 14:9 (#1)

לֵאמֹ֔ר הַחֹ֖וחַ אֲשֶׁ֣ר בַּלְּבָנ֑וֹן

“saying, “A thornbush that {was} in Lebanon”

To try to make Amaziah realize that he will lose the battle if they fight, Jehoash has his messengers tells him a story. It is a parable, a brief story that teaches something that is true and delivers its lesson in a way that is easy to understand and hard to forget. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state explicitly that the messengers are telling a story. You could also begin this story in the way that made-up stories usually begin in your language. Alternate translation: [and he had them tell Amaziah a story to make him realize he would lose the battle if they fought. They said, “Once upon a time, a thornbush that {was} in Lebanon]

See: Parables

2 Kings 14:9 (#2)

לֵאמֹ֗ר תְּנָה־אֶת־בִּתְּךָ֙ לִבְנִ֣י לְאִשָּׁ֔ה

“saying, ‘Give your daughter to my son as a wife”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [telling it to give its daughter to its son as a wife]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 14:9 (#3)

תְּנָה־אֶת־בִּתְּךָ֙ לִבְנִ֣י לְאִשָּׁ֔ה

“Give your daughter to my son as a wife”

By making this request or demand, the thornbush was symbolically claiming to be equal to the cedar, since in the ancient world fathers would only let their daughters marry the sons of men who were their equals. if it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote.

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 14:10 (#1)

הַכֵּ֥ה הִכִּ֖יתָ

“Striking, you have struck”

Jehoash is repeating forms of the verb “strike” in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of

expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [Certainly you have struck]

See: Reduplication

2 Kings 14:10 (#2)

הַכֵּה הִכִּיתָ

“Striking, you have struck”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [Certainly you have defeated]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 14:10 (#3)

וְנִשְׂאַךְ לִבֶּךָ

“and your heart has lifted you up”

Jehoash is speaking as if Amaziah’s **heart** had actually **lifted** him up. He is using the heart to represent a person’s feelings, and he is using being lifted to a high position to mean becoming proud. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you are so elated that you have become proud]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 14:10 (#4)

הִכָּבֵד

“Be honored”

The expression **Be honored** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Be content with the honors that come with your victory]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 14:10 (#5)

וְשֵׁשֵׁב בְּבֵיתֶךָ

“but stay in your house”

Jehoash assumes that Amaziah will know that by **stay in your house**, he does not mean that Amaziah should not leave his palace. He means that he should not lead his army out to war against him. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [but do not lead your army out to war against me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 14:10 (#6)

וְלָמָּה תִתְגָּרֶהּ בְּרָעָה וְנָפַלְתָּ אַתָּה וִיהוּדָה עִמָּךְ

“For why should you contend with calamity, so that you will fall, you and Judah with you”

Jehoash is using the question form to warn Amaziah and discourage him from fighting. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [There is no reason for you to contend with calamity, so that you will fall, you and Judah with you!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 14:10 (#7)

תִתְגָּרֶהּ בְּרָעָה

“should you contend with calamity”

Jehoash is speaking of **calamity** as if it were a living thing that Amaziah could actually **contend with**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [why should you stir up trouble] or [why should you risk causing calamity for your kingdom]

See: Personification

2 Kings 14:10 (#8)

וְנָפַלְתָּ אַתָּה וִיהוּדָה עִמָּךְ

“so that you will fall, you and Judah with you”

Jehoash is speaking as if Amaziah and Judah would actually **fall** from a height. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [so that you will be destroyed, you and Judah with you] or [so that both you and Judah will be destroyed]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 14:11 (#1)

וְלֹא־שָׁמַע אֲמַצְיָהוּ

“But Amaziah did not listen”

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:6. Alternate translation: [But Amaziah did not do what Jehoash said]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 14:11 (#2)

וַיִּתְרָאוּ פָּנִים

“and they saw one another’s faces”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:8. Alternate translation: [and they met face to face] or [and they fought a battle against each other]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 14:12 (#1)

וַיִּנָּגֶף יְהוּדָה לִפְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“And Judah was struck to the face of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [And Judah was struck as it opposed Israel]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 14:12 (#2)

וַיִּנָּגֶף יְהוּדָה לִפְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“And Judah was struck to the face of Israel”

The expression **was struck** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And Israel struck Judah in this conflict]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 14:12 (#3)

וַיִּנָּגֶף יְהוּדָה לִפְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“And Judah was struck to the face of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [And Israel defeated Judah in this conflict]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 14:12 (#4)

וַיָּנֻסוּ אִישׁ לְאָהֳלוֹ

“And they fled, a man to his tent”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:21. Alternate translation: [And their soldiers abandoned the army and returned home]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 14:13 (#1)

אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת אַמָּה

“400 cubits”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [a distance of 400 cubits]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 14:13 (#2)

אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת אַמָּה

“400 cubits”

These **cubits** were a unit of measurement corresponding to the distance between an average person’s elbow and middle fingertip, or about 46 centimeters or about 18 inches. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this length in modern measurements, either in the text of your translation or in a footnote. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Biblical Distance

2 Kings 14:14 (#1)

הַנִּמְצְאִים

“found”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:18. Alternate translation: [that were]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 14:14 (#2)

בֵּית־יְהוָה

“in} the house of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:18. Alternate translation: [in the temple of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 14:14 (#3)

וְאֵת בְּנֵי הַתַּעֲרֻבוֹת

“and sons of pledges”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he took sons of pledges]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 14:14 (#4)

וְאֵאת בְּנֵנֵי הַתַּעֲרֻבֹות

“and sons of pledges”

The author is using the phrase **sons of** to indicate that these people had the characteristic of something. In this case, he means that these people had the characteristic of serving as a guarantee of **pledges** that Amaziah made not to attack Israel. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:16. Alternate translation: [hostages]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 14:15 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי יְהוֹאָשׁ אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה וּגְבוּרָתוֹ וַאֲשֶׁר נִלְחַם עִם אֲמַצְיָהוּ מֶלֶךְ־יְהוּדָה הֲלֹא־הֵם כְּתוּבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים לְמַלְכֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Now the rest of the matters of Jehoash, what he did, and his might, and how he fought with Amaziah, the king of Judah, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is concluding the story of Jehoash. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar phrases in 1:18.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 14:16 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּב יְהוֹאָשׁ עִם־אֲבֹתָיו

“And Jehoash lay down with his fathers”

See how you translated the same expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [And Jehoash passed away] or [And Jehoash died]

See: Euphemism

2 Kings 14:16 (#2)

וַיִּקָּבֵר

“and he was buried”

The expression **was buried** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people buried him]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 14:18 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי אֲמַצְיָהוּ הֲלֹא־הֵם כְּתוּבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים לְמַלְכֵי יְהוּדָה

“Now the rest of the matters of Amaziah, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Judah”

In this verse and the next two verses, the author is concluding the story of Amaziah. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar phrases in 1:18.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 14:19 (#1)

וַיִּקְשְׁרוּ & קֶשֶׁר

“And they conspired a conspiracy”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [And they formed a conspiracy] or [And a conspiracy formed]

See: Poetry

2 Kings 14:19 (#2)

וַיִּקְשְׁרוּ & קֶשֶׁר

“And they conspired a conspiracy”

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. The context suggests that Amaziah’s own officials conspired against him. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And his officials formed a conspiracy]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 14:20 (#1)

וַיִּשְׂאוּ אֹתוֹ עַל־הַסּוּסִים

“And they carried him on the horses”

Because the author says **the** horses, he probably means Amaziah’s own horses. In that case, he would be using the **horses** to represent Amaziah’s royal chariot, which the horses pulled. Alternate translation: [And they brought him back in his royal chariot]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 14:20 (#2)

וַיִּשְׂאוּ אֹתוֹ עַל־הַסּוּסִים

“And they carried him on the horses”

Bringing Amaziah’s body back to Jerusalem in his royal chariot was a symbolic action by which the conspirators who killed him nevertheless showed respect for his role as king. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And they brought him back to Jerusalem respectfully in his royal chariot]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 14:21 (#1)

וַיִּקְח֣וּ כָל־עַ֔ם יְהוּדָ֖הּ

“And all of the people of Judah took”

The author is saying **all** as a generalization. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the meaning. Alternate translation: [And by general agreement the people of Judah took]

See: Hyperbole

2 Kings 14:21 (#2)

וְה֣וּא בֶן־שֵׁ֣שׁ עֶשְׂרֵ֔ה שָׁנָ֖ה

“now he {was} a son of 16 years”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:17. Alternate translation: [now he was 16 years old]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 14:22 (#1)

הֽוּא־בָנָ֞ה אֶת־אֵיל֗וֹת וַיְשִׁבֶ֥הָ לִֽיהוּדָ֖ה

“He, he built up Elath, and he returned it to Judah”

The author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. If it would be helpful your language, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [He, he returned Elath to Judah and built it up]

See: Order of Events

2 Kings 14:22 (#2)

הֽוּא־בָנָ֞ה & וַיְשִׁבֶ֥הָ

“He, he built up & and he returned it”

The author is stating the pronoun **He** separately, even though the verb translated as **he built up** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to specify that while it was Amaziah who defeated the Edomites generally (as he describes in 14:7), it was Azariah who reconquered and fortified Elath. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [He was the one who built up]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 14:22 (#3)

אַחֲרֵ֕י שְׁכַ֥ב־הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ עִם־אֲבֹתָֽיו

“after the king lay down with his fathers”

See how you translated the same expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [after the king passed away] or [after the king died]

See: Euphemism

2 Kings 14:23 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַ֣ת חֲמֵשׁ־עֶשְׂרֵ֗ה שָׁנָה֙ לַאֲמַצְיָ֣הוּ בֶן־יוֹאָ֔שׁ מֶ֖לֶךְ יְהוּדָ֑ה מָלַ֞ךְ
יָרָבְעָ֤ם בֶּן־יוֹאָשׁ֙ מֶ֣לֶךְ־יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל בְּשֹׁמְר֖וֹן אַרְבָּעִ֥ים וְאַחַ֖ת שָׁנָֽה

“In the year of 15, the year to Amaziah, the son of Joash, the king of Judah, Jeroboam, the son of Joash, the king of Israel, reigned in Samaria, 41 years”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is introducing **Jeroboam** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Israel**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:25 and 13:10.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 14:24 (#1)

וַיַּ֣עַשׂ הָרַ֔ע בְּעֵינֵ֖י יְהוָ֑ה לֹ֣א סָ֗ר מִכָּל־חַטֹּאות֙ יָרָבְעָ֣ם בֶּן־נְבָ֔ט
אֲשֶׁ֥ר הֶחֱטִ֖יא אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“And he did evil in the eyes of Yahweh. He did not turn away from all of the sins of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who caused Israel to sin”

The author is continuing to introduce Jeroboam, the son of Jehoash. See how you translated the similar expressions in 3:3 and 8:18. Alternate translation: [And he did what Yahweh considered to be evil. He did not stop committing the same sins as Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who caused Israel to sin]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 14:25 (#1)

הֽוּא־הֵשִׁיב

“He, he restored”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:22. Alternate translation: [He was the one who restored]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 14:25 (#2)

אֶת־גְּבֻל יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the border of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:32. Alternate translation: [the territory of Israel]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 14:25 (#3)

כִּדְבַר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר בְּיַד

“according to the word of Yahweh, the God of Israel, that he spoke by the hand of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:7. Alternate translation: [according to the message that Yahweh the God of Israel spoke]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 14:25 (#4)

אֱלֹהֵי & בְּיַד

“the God of & by the hand of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:36. Alternate translation: [through the agency of]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 14:26 (#1)

כִּי־רָאָה יְהוָה

“For Yahweh saw”

Here the word **For** introduces an explanation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh enabled Jeroboam to do that because he saw]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 14:26 (#2)

וְאֶפֶס עָצוּר וְאֶפֶס עָזוּב וְאֵין עֹזֵר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל

“and none restrained and none set free and no helper for Israel”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he saw that there was and none restrained and none set free and no helper for Israel]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 14:26 (#3)

וְאֶפֶס עָצוּר וְאֶפֶס עָזוּב וְאֵין עֹזֵר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל

“and none restrained and none set free and no helper for Israel”

If it would be more natural in your language, in order to put a general statement before more specific details about it, you may want to put the information that there was **no helper for Israel** before the information that no one **restrained** and no one **set free** was able to help Israel. Alternate translation: [and there was no helper for Israel, none restrained and none set free]

See: Information Structure

2 Kings 14:26 (#4)

וְאֶפֶס עָצוּר וְאֶפֶס עָזוּב

“and none restrained and none set free”

The author is referring to all Israelites by naming the two main categories of them, those **restrained** (legal slaves) and those **set free** (legal free men). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the same expression in 1 Kings 14:10. Alternate translation: [no one at all]

See: Merism

2 Kings 14:26 (#5)

וְאֶפֶס עָצוּר וְאֶפֶס עָזוּב

“and none restrained and none set free”

The expressions **restrained** and **set free** are passive verbal forms. If your language would not use those forms, you could express these ideas in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whether slave or free]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 14:27 (#1)

לִמְחוֹת אֶת־שֵׁשֵׁם יִשְׂרָאֵל מִתַּחַת הַשָּׁמָיִם

“that he would wipe out the name of Israel from under the heavens”

The author is speaking as if the **name of Israel** were actually written in ink on a scroll somewhere and that Yahweh would actually **wipe** the ink off the scroll. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that he would make Israel cease to exist as a nation anywhere on earth]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 14:27 (#2)

וַיּוֹשִׁיעֵם

“so he saved them”

The word that the ULT translates as **saved** here comes from the same root as the word that it translates as “savior” in 13:5. There, after saying that Yahweh “saw the oppression of Israel,” the author says that “Yahweh gave to Israel a savior.” The similarity of language between that passage and this one suggests that the author meant that Jeroboam was that “savior.” To help your readers make this connection, see how you translated the term in 13:5 that the ULT translates as “savior” and translate the term **saved** similarly here. Alternate translation: [so he delivered them] or [so he rescued them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 14:27 (#3)

בְּיַד

“by the hand of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:36. Alternate translation: [through the agency of]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 14:28 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר֙ דִּבְרֵ֣י יָרָבְעָ֔ם וְכָל־אֲשֶׁ֥ר עָשָׂ֖ה וּגְבוּרָתֹ֑ו אֲשֶׁר־נִלְחָ֗ם וַאֲשֶׁ֤ר הֵשִׁיב֙ אֶת־דַּמֶּ֣שֶׂק וְאֶת־חֲמָ֔ת לִֽיהוּדָ֖ה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל הֲלֹא־הֵ֛ם כְּתוּבִ֥ים עַל־סֵ֖פֶר דִּבְרֵ֣י הַיָּמִ֑ים לְמַלְכֵ֖י יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“Now the rest of the matters of Jeroboam and all that he did and his might, how he fought and how he brought Damascus and Hamath of Judah back into Israel, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is concluding the story of Jeroboam. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar phrases in 1:18.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 14:29 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּ֥ב יָרָבְעָ֖ם & אֶת־אֲבֹתָ֑יו עִ֖ם

“And Jeroboam lay down with his fathers”

See how you translated the same expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [And Jeroboam passed away] or [And Jeroboam died]

See: Euphemism

2 Kings 14:29 (#2)

עִם & מַלְכֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“with the kings of Israel”

Based on how the author usually concludes his stories of Israelite kings, here he has probably left out some of the words that he ordinarily uses. He probably means “and he was buried in Samaria with the kings of Israel.” See how you translated that statement in 13:13 and 14:16.

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings - Chapter 15 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

In this chapter, the author continues to tell what the kings were like who ruled over the kingdoms of Israel and Judah.

1. King Azariah of Judah (1–7)
2. King Zechariah of Israel (8–12)
3. King Shallum of Israel (13–15)
4. King Menahem of Israel (6–22)
5. King Shallum of Israel (23–26)
6. King Pekah of Israel (27–31)
7. King Jotham of Judah (32–38)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did Yahweh cause Azariah to become a leper?

Yahweh caused Azariah to become a leper because he unlawfully entered the temple to burn incense. That was something that only priests were allowed to do. This incident is explained in detail in 2 Chronicles 26:16–21, where Azariah is called by his other name Uzziah and where the text says specifically that pride led him to want to have more power and privileges than the law of Moses allowed kings to have. The priests confronted him in the temple, and leprosy broke out on his forehead. They immediately forced him out of the temple, and he had to live in isolation until he died.

Why did Yahweh "send" enemy armies to invade Judah?
The author says in 15:37 that during the reign of Jotham, "Yahweh began to send Rezin, the king of Aram, and Pekah, the son of Remaliah, against Judah." He means that Yahweh allowed those kings, whose kingdoms had previously been enemies, to form an alliance and make plans to invade Judah together. Yahweh did this because he knew that the next king, Jotham's son Ahaz, would be unfaithful to him. Ahaz would make an alliance with the king of Assyria and worship the false gods of other nations. Yahweh wanted to make Ahaz realize that he must trust in him alone for help and protection, not in idols or in foreign rulers. The prophet Isaiah told Ahaz this specifically, as Isaiah 7:1–17 describes.

2 Kings 15:1 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַ֣ת עֶשְׂרִ֗ים וְשֶׁשְׁבַּ֙עַ֙ שָׁנָ֔ה לְיָרָבְעָ֖ם מֶ֣לֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל מָלַ֕ךְ עֲזַרְיָ֖ה בֶּן־אֲמַצְיָ֥ה מֶֽלֶךְ יְהוּדָֽה

"In the year of 27, the year to Jeroboam, the king of Israel, Azariah, the son of Amaziah, the king of Judah, reigned"

In this verse and the next two verses, the author is introducing **Azariah** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Judah**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:25.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 15:2 (#1)

בֶּן־שֵׁ֣שׁ עֶשְׂרֵ֔ה שָׁנָ֖ה יְהֹוָ֑ה הָיָ֖ה

"He was a son of 16 years"

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:17. Alternate translation: [He was 16 years old]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 15:2 (#2)

יְכָלְיָ֥הוּ מִירוּשָׁלִָֽם

"was} Jekoliah, from Jerusalem"

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:2. Alternate translation: [was Jekoliah, and she was from Jerusalem]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 15:3 (#1)

וַיַּ֣עַשׂ הַיָּשָׁ֔ר בְּעֵינֵ֖י יְהֹוָ֑ה

"And he did right in the eyes of Yahweh"

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:13. Alternate translation: [And he did what Yahweh considered to be right]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 15:4 (#1)

הַבָּמ֖וֹת לֹא־סָ֑רוּ

"the high places were not removed"

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:4. Alternate translation: [he did not remove the high places]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 15:5 (#1)

וַיְנַגַּ֥ע יְהוָ֖ה אֶת־הַמֶּ֑לֶךְ

"And Yahweh touched the king"

In this context, the word **touched** means that Yahweh "afflicted" Azariah with a disease. (See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of why Yahweh did that.) You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh afflicted the king with a disease]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 15:6 (#1)

וְיֶ֣תֶר דִּבְרֵ֣י עֲזַרְיָ֔הוּ וְכָל־אֲשֶׁ֥ר עָשָׂ֖ה הֲלֹא־הֵ֣ם כְּתוּבִ֑ים עַל־סֵ֗פֶר דִּבְרֵ֛י הַיָּמִ֖ים לְמַלְכֵ֥י יְהוּדָֽה

"Now the rest of the matters of Azariah and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Judah"

In this verse and the next verse, the author is concluding the story of Azariah. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar phrases in 1:18.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 15:7 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּ֥ב עֲזַרְיָ֖הוּ עִם־אֲבֹתָ֑יו

"And Azariah lay down with his fathers"

See how you translated the same expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [And Azariah passed away] or [And Azariah died]

See: Euphemism

2 Kings 15:7 (#2)

וַיִּקְבְּר֣וּ אֹתָ֔וֹ

“and they buried him”

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people buried him] or [and he was buried]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 15:7 (#3)

אֹתוֹ עִם־אֲבֹתָיו

“him with his fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [in the same place where people had buried his ancestors]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 15:8 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַת שְׁלֹשִׁים וּשְׁמֹנָה לְעֲזַרְיָהוּ מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה מָלַךְ זְכַרְיָהוּ בֶּן־יָרָבְעָם עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּשֹׁמְרוֹן שִׁשָּׁה חֳדָשִׁים

“In the year of 38, the year to Azariah, the king of Judah, Zechariah, the son of Jeroboam, reigned over Israel in Samaria, six months”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is introducing **Zechariah** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Israel**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:25 and 13:1.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 15:9 (#1)

וַיַּעַשׂ הָרַע בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה כַּאֲשֶׁר עָשׂוּ אֲבֹתָיו לֹא סָר מֵחַטֹּאות יָרָבְעָם בֶּן־נְבָט אֲשֶׁר הֶחֱטִיא אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“And he did evil in the eyes of Yahweh, just as his fathers had done. He did not turn away from the sins of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who caused Israel to sin”

The author is continuing to introduce Zechariah. See how you translated the similar expressions in 3:3 and 8:18. Alternate translation: [And he did what Yahweh considered to be evil. He did not stop committing the same sins as Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who had caused Israel to sin]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 15:10 (#1)

וַיַּכֵּהוּ

“and he struck him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [and he attacked him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 15:11 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי זְכַרְיָהוּ הִנָּם כְּתוּבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים לְמַלְכֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Now the rest of the matters of Zechariah, behold them, written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is concluding the story of Zechariah. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar phrases in 1:18.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 15:12 (#1)

הַהוּא דְּבַר־יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר אֶל־יֵהוּא

“It {was} the word of Yahweh that he had spoken to Jehu”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:7. Alternate translation: [It was the message that Yahweh had spoken to Jehu]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 15:12 (#2)

בָּנַי רְבִיעִים יֵשְׁבוּ לְךָ עַל־כִּסֵּא יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Sons of the fourth will sit for you on the throne of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:30. Alternate translation: [Four generations of your descendants will succeed you as the king of Israel]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 15:13 (#1)

שַׁלֻּם בֶּן־יָבִישׁ מָלַךְ בִּשְׁנַת שְׁלֹשִׁים וְתִשַּׁע שָׁנָה לְעֻזִּיָּהוּ מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה וַיִּמְלֹךְ יָרֵחַ־יָמִים בְּשֹׁמְרוֹן

“Shallum, the son of Jabesh, reigned in the year of 39, the year to Azariah, the king of Judah, and he reigned a month of days in Samaria”

In this verse, the author is introducing **Shallum** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Israel**. See how you translated the similar expressions in 8:25.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 15:14 (#1)

וַיַּעַל מְנַחֵם בֶּן־גָּדִי

“Then Menahem, the son of Gadi, came up”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [And Menahem, the son of Gadi, came]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 15:14 (#2)

וַיַּךְ אֶת־שַׁלֻּם

“And he struck Shallum”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [And he attacked Shallum]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 15:15 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי שַׁלֻּם וְקִשְׁרֹו אֲשֶׁר קָשָׁר הִנָּם כְּתֻבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים לְמַלְכֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Now the rest of the matters of Shallum and his conspiracy that he conspired, behold them, written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel”

In this verse, the author is concluding the story of Shallum. To translate it, see how you translated the similar phrases in 1:18.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 15:15 (#2)

וְקִשְׁרֹו אֲשֶׁר קָשָׁר

“and his conspiracy that he conspired”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:20. Alternate translation: [and the conspiracy that he carried out]

See: Poetry

2 Kings 15:16 (#1)

אָז יַכֶּה־מְנַחֵם אֶת־תִּפְסַח וְאֶת־כָּל־אֲשֶׁר־בָּהּ וְאֶת־גְּבוּלֶיהָ מִתִּרְצָה כִּי לֹא פָתְחָה

“Then Menahem struck Tiphsah and all who {were} in it and its borders, from Tirzah, because one did not open”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Then, because one did not open, Menahem struck Tiphsah and all who were in it and its borders, from Tirzah]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 15:16 (#2)

אָז יַכֶּה־מְנַחֵם אֶת־תִּפְסַח וְאֶת־כָּל־אֲשֶׁר־בָּהּ וְאֶת־גְּבוּלֶיהָ מִתִּרְצָה

“Then Menahem struck Tiphsah and all who {were} in it and its borders, from Tirzah”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information that Menahem began this military campaign **from Tirzah** at the beginning of the sentence. Alternate translation: [Then from Tirzah Menahem struck Tiphsah and all who were in it and its borders]

See: Information Structure

2 Kings 15:16 (#3)

אָז יַכֶּה־מְנַחֵם אֶת־תִּפְסַח

“Then Menahem struck Tiphsah”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:19. Alternate translation: [Then Menahem destroyed Tiphsah]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 15:16 (#4)

וְאֶת־גְּבוּלֶיהָ

“and its borders”

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:32. Alternate translation: [and the surrounding territory]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 15:16 (#5)

לֹא פָתְחָה

“one did not open”

Here the author is using the pronoun **one** in a general sense, not to refer to a specific person. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the people of the city refused to open its gates and admit him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 15:16 (#6)

לֹא פָתְחָה

“one did not open”

The author is using the action of not opening the city gates for Menahem to represent refusing to accept

him as king. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people of the city refused to accept him as their king]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 15:16 (#7)

וַיַּךְ

“And he struck {them”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:23. Alternate translation: [And he killed all the people of the city]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 15:17 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַת שְׁלֹשִׁים וְתִשַּׁשְׁעִ֣ שָׁנָ֔ה לַעֲזַרְיָ֖ה מֶ֣לֶךְ יְהוּדָ֑ה מָלַ֞ךְ מְנַחֵ֤ם בֶּן־גָּדִי֙ עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל עֶ֥שֶׂר שָׁנִ֖ים בְּשֹׁמְרֽוֹן

“In the year of 39, the year to Azariah, the king of Judah, Menahem, the son of Gadi, reigned over Israel, ten years in Samaria”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is introducing **Menahem** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Israel**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:25 and 13:1.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 15:18 (#1)

וַיַּ֣עַשׂ הָרַ֔ע בְּעֵינֵ֖י יְהוָ֑ה לֹ֣א סָ֗ר מֵעַל֙ חַטֹּ֣אות יָרָבְעָ֔ם בֶּן־נְבָ֖ט אֲשֶׁר־הֶחֱטִ֥יא אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל כָּל־יָמָֽיו

“And he did evil in the eyes of Yahweh. He did not turn away from the sins of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who caused Israel to sin, all of his days”

The author is continuing to introduce Menahem. See how you translated the similar expressions in 3:3 and 8:18. Alternate translation: [And he did what Yahweh considered to be evil. He did not stop committing the same sins as Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who had caused Israel to sin, all of his days]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 15:18 (#2)

לֹ֣א סָ֗ר מֵעַל֙ חַטֹּ֣אות יָרָבְעָ֔ם בֶּן־נְבָ֖ט אֲשֶׁר־הֶחֱטִ֥יא אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל כָּל־יָמָֽיו

“He did not turn away from the sins of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who caused Israel to sin, all of his days”

If it would be more natural in your language, before the information that Menahem **did not turn away from the sins of Jeroboam**, you may want to put the information that Menahem did that **all of his days**. Alternate translation: [All of his days, he did not turn away from the sins of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who caused Israel to sin]

See: Information Structure

2 Kings 15:19 (#1)

פֻּ֣ל

“Pul”

Many interpreters consider **Pul** to be the same king who is known elsewhere as Tiglath Pileser. See what you decided to do in the cases of the Israelite and Judean kings whom the author sometimes calls Jehoram and sometimes calls Joram. If you have decided to use the same names in your translation that the biblical author does in each place, you may wish to use the name Pul here. If you decided to use the same name consistently for a given person, you may wish to use the name Tiglath Pileser here, since that king appears later in this chapter and in chapter 16.

See: How to Translate Names

2 Kings 15:19 (#2)

אֶ֖לֶף כִּכַּר־כָּ֑סֶף

“1,000 kikkars of silver”

See how you decided to represent the weight of a kikkar of silver in 5:5.

See: Biblical Weight

2 Kings 15:19 (#3)

לִֽהְיֹ֥ות יָדֹ֖ו אִתֹּֽו

“so that his hands would be with him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [so that Pul would use his power to help him]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 15:19 (#4)

לְהַחֲזִ֥יק הַמַּמְלָכָ֖ה בְּיָדֹֽו

“to strengthen the kingdom in his hand”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:5. Alternate translation: [so that he would have firmer control of the kingdom]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 15:20 (#1)

וַיֹּצֵא מְנַחֵם אֶת־הַכֶּסֶף עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל עַל כָּל־גִּבּוֹרֵי הַחַיִל

“And Menahem brought forth the silver over Israel, over all of the mighty of valor”

The author is using the preposition **over** in these two instances in order to depict the imposition of a financial burden on or **over** wealthy Israelites. If your language would not use a term comparable to “over” in this way, you could use a preposition that indicated the source of the funds, as many versions do. Alternate translation: [And Menahem exacted the silver from Israel, from all of the mighty of valor]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 15:20 (#2)

גִּבּוֹרֵי הַחַיִל

“the mighty of valor”

While in many biblical contexts this expression describes a soldier who can fight powerfully and effectively, the term can also describe a person of great wealth and standing, and that seems to be the meaning in this context. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 9:1. Alternate translation: [the wealthy citizens]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 15:20 (#3)

חֲמִשִּׁים שְׁקָלִים כֶּסֶף

“50 silver shekels”

See how you decided to represent the weight of a shekel at 5:5.

See: Biblical Weight

2 Kings 15:20 (#4)

וַיָּשָׁב מֶלֶךְ אַשּׁוּר וְלֹא־עָמַד שָׁם בָּאָרֶץ

“And the king of Assyria returned, and he did not stay there in the land”

The author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. If it would be helpful your language, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [And the king of Assyria did not stay there in the land. Instead, he returned home]

See: Order of Events

2 Kings 15:21 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי מְנַחֵם וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה הֲלוֹא־הֵם כְּתוּבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים לְמַלְכֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Now the rest of the matters of Menahem and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is concluding the story of Menahem. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar phrases in 1:18.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 15:22 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּב מְנַחֵם עִם־אֲבֹתָיו

“And Menahem lay down with his fathers”

See how you translated the same expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [And Menahem passed away] or [And Menahem died]

See: Euphemism

2 Kings 15:23 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַת חֲמִשִּׁים שָׁנָה לַעֲזַרְיָה מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה מָלַךְ פְּקַחְיָה בֶּן־מְנַחֵם עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּשֹׁמְרוֹן שְׁנָתָיִם

“In the year of 50, the year to Azariah, the king of Judah, Pekahiah, the son of Menahem, reigned over Israel in Samaria, two years”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is introducing **Pekahiah** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Israel**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:25 and 13:1.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 15:24 (#1)

וַיַּעַשׂ הָרַע בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה לֹא סָר מֵחַטֹּאות יָרָבְעָם בֶּן־נְבָט אֲשֶׁר הֶחֱטִיא אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“And he did evil in the eyes of Yahweh. He did not turn away from the sins of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who caused Israel to sin”

The author is continuing to introduce Pekahiah. See how you translated the similar expressions in 3:3 and 8:18. Alternate translation: [And he did what Yahweh considered to be evil. He did not stop committing the same sins as Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who had caused Israel to sin]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 15:25 (#1)

וַיִּקְשֹׁר עָלָיו֙ פֶּ֣קַח בֶּן־רְמַלְיָ֔הוּ שָׁלִישָׁ֖ו וַיַּכֵּ֣הוּ בְשֹׁמְר֑וֹן בְּאַרְמְמ֗וֹן בֵּית־מלך אֶת־אַרְגֹּ֙ב וְאֶת־הָאַרְיֵ֔ה וְעִמּ֖וֹ חֲמִשִּׁ֣ים אִ֑ישׁ מִבְּנֵ֥י גִלְעָדִ֖ים

“And Pekah, the son of Remaliah, his captain, conspired against him, and he struck him in Samaria, in the citadel of the house of the king, Argob and Arieh, and with him 50 men of the sons of the Gileadites”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information that Pekah also “struck” Argob and Arieh with the information that he **struck** the king and the information that **50 men of the sons of the Gileadites** were **with him** with the information that Pekah **conspired against** Pekahiah. Alternate translation: [And Pekah, the son of Remaliah, his captain, and with him 50 men of the sons of the Gileadites, conspired against him, and in Samaria, in the citadel of the house of the king, he struck him, Argob, and Arieh]

See: Information Structure

2 Kings 15:25 (#2)

וַיַּכֵּ֣הוּ

“and he struck him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [and he attacked him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 15:25 (#3)

אִ֑ישׁ מִבְּנֵ֥י גִלְעָדִ֖ים

“men of the sons of the Gileadites”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:12. Alternate translation: [men who were Gileadites]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 15:26 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר֙ דִּבְרֵ֣י פְקַחְיָ֔ה וְכָל־אֲשֶׁ֥ר עָשָׂ֖ה הִנָּ֑ם כְּתוּבִ֗ים עַל־סֵ֚פֶר דִּבְרֵ֣י הַיָּמִ֔ים לְמַלְכֵ֖י יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“Now the rest of the matters of Pekahiah and all that he did, behold them, written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel”

The author is concluding the story of Pekahiah. See how you translated the similar phrases in 1:18.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 15:27 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַ֨ת חֲמִשִּׁ֜ים וּשְׁתַּ֣יִם שָׁנָ֗ה לַעֲזַרְיָ֛ה מֶ֥לֶךְ יְהוּדָ֖ה מָלַ֣ךְ פֶּ֑קַח בֶּן־רְמַלְיָ֥הוּ עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֛ל בְּשֹׁמְר֖וֹן עֶשְׂרִ֥ים שָׁנָֽה

“In the year of 52, the year to Azariah, the king of Judah, Pekah, the son of Remaliah, reigned over Israel in Samaria, 20 years”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is introducing **Pekah** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Israel**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:25 and 13:1.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 15:28 (#1)

וַיַּ֣עַשׂ הָרַ֔ע בְּעֵינֵ֖י יְהוָ֑ה לֹ֣א סָ֗ר מִן־חַטֹּאות֙ יָרָבְעָ֣ם בֶּן־נְבָ֔ט אֲשֶׁ֥ר הֶחֱטִ֖יא אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“And he did evil in the eyes of Yahweh. He did not turn away from the sins of Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who caused Israel to sin”

The author is continuing to introduce Pekah. See how you translated the similar expressions in 3:2 and 8:18. Alternate translation: [And he did what Yahweh considered to be evil. He did not stop committing the same sins as Jeroboam, the son of Nebat, who caused Israel to sin]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 15:29 (#1)

בִּימֵ֣י פֶּ֔קַח

“In the days of Pekah”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:20. Alternate translation: [During the reign of Pekah]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 15:29 (#2)

וַיַּגְלֵ֖ם

“and he exiled them to”

The pronoun **them** refers to the people of the cities and regions the author has just listed. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and he exiled the people who lived in those areas]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 15:30 (#1)

וַיִּקְשֹׁר־קֶ֣שֶׁר הוֹשֵׁ֣עַ בֶּן־אֵלָ֔ה

“And Hoshea, the son of Elah, conspired a conspiracy”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:20. Alternate translation: [And Hoshea, the son of Elah, formed a conspiracy]

See: Poetry

2 Kings 15:30 (#2)

וַיַּכֵּהוּ

“and he struck him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [and he attacked him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 15:30 (#3)

בִּשְׁנַת עֶשְׂרִים לְיוֹתָם

“in the year of 20 to Jotham”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **20**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [in the twentieth year of Jotham]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 15:30 (#4)

עֻזִּיָּה

“Uzziah”

Uzziah is another name for Azariah, whose reign the author describes in 15:1–7. The author calls this same king Azariah in verses 32 and 34. If you have decided to use the same names in your translation that the biblical author does in each place, you may wish to use the name Uzziah here. If you have decided to use the same name consistently for a given person, you may wish to use the name Azariah here.

See: How to Translate Names

2 Kings 15:31 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי־פֶקַח וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה הִנָּם כְּתוּבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים לְמַלְכֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Now the rest of the matters of Pekah and all that he did, behold them, written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Israel”

The author is concluding the story of Pekah. See how you translated the similar phrases in 1:18.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 15:32 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַת שְׁתַּיִם לְפֶקַח בֶּן־רְמַלְיָהוּ מֶלֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל מָלַךְ יוֹתָם בֶּן־עֻזִּיָּהוּ מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה

“In the year of two to Pekah, the son of Remaliah, the king of Israel, Jotham, the son of Azariah, the king of Judah, reigned”

In this verse and the next two verses, the author is introducing **Jotham** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Judah**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:16.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 15:32 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַת שְׁתַּיִם לְפֶקַח

“In the year of two to Pekah”

If your language would not describe a year of a king’s reign in a form such as **the year of two**, you could represent this year in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [In the second year of Pekah]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 15:33 (#1)

בֶּן־עֶשְׂרִים וְחָמֵשׁ שָׁנָה הָיָה

“He was a son of 25 years”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:17. Alternate translation: [He was 25 years old]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 15:35 (#1)

הַבָּמוֹת לֹא סָרוּ

“the high places were not removed”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:4. Alternate translation: [he did not remove the high places]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 15:35 (#2)

הוּא בָּנָה

“He, he built”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:22. Alternate translation: [He was the one who built]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 15:35 (#3)

בֵּית־יְהוָה

“the house of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:18. Alternate translation: [the temple of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 15:35 (#4)

בֵּית־יְהוָה

“the house of Yahweh”

The author assumes that readers will understand that by **the house of Yahweh**, he means the courtyard around the temple, into which this **gate** led. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the courtyard of Yahweh’s temple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 15:36 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי יוֹתָם אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה הֲלֹא־הֵם כְּתוּבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים לְמַלְכֵי יְהוּדָה

“Now the rest of the matters of Jotham that he did, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Judah”

In this verse and the next two verses, the author is concluding the story of Jotham. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar phrases in 1:18.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 15:37 (#1)

בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם

“In those days”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:6. Alternate translation: [At that time]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 15:38 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּב יוֹתָם עִם־אֲבֹתָיו

“And Jotham lay down with his fathers”

See how you translated the same expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [And Jotham passed away] or [And Jotham died]

See: Euphemism

2 Kings 15:38 (#2)

וַיִּקָּבֵר

“and he was buried”

The expression **was buried** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people buried him]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 15:38 (#3)

עִם־אֲבֹתָיו & אָבִיו

“with his fathers & his father”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [with his ancestors ... his ancestor] or [in the same place where people had buried his ancestors ... his ancestor]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings - Chapter 16 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

In this chapter, the author continues to tell what the kings were like who ruled over the kingdoms of Israel and Judah.

1. King Ahaz of Judah (16:1–20)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did King Ahaz remove many of the fixtures of the temple courtyard?

The author describes in 16:17–18 how King Ahaz cut off the panels and removed the basins from the bronze stands (carts) in the temple courtyard, removed the sea (the giant water basin) from the oxen that supported it, took down a canopy that people walked under to reach the temple courtyard on the Sabbath, and closed up a special entrance to the courtyard for the royal family. Ahaz did this after witnessing Assyrian worship practices in the city of Damascus, which the Assyrians had just conquered and occupied. Ahaz had made an alliance with the powerful king of Assyria, and he wanted to appease him. So he removed many features of the temple courtyard that were crafted specifically for the worship of Yahweh or that showed how devoted the king and people (supposedly) were to Yahweh. The panels and basins on the carts and the large bronze sea were beautifully decorated with symbols such as lions, oxen, and cherubim that showed they were crafted for the worship of

Yahweh. They thereby marked the Judeans as God's people. Similarly, the Sabbath canopy showed that the Judeans worshiped Yahweh each week on a special day that he had chosen, and the special royal entrance showed that the king and his family were personally devoted to Yahweh. Even though Ahaz had a godly father in Jotham and a godly grandfather in Azariah (Uzziah), he chose not to follow their example and instead relied on foreign gods and an alliance with a pagan king. Such actions by Israelite and Judean kings ultimately led to the conquest and exile of both kingdoms.

2 Kings 16:1 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַתּ֨ שְׁבַע־עֶשְׂרֵ֜ה שָׁנָ֗ה לְפֶ֙קַח֙ בֶּן־רְמַלְיָ֔הוּ מָלַ֖ךְ אָחָ֣ז בֶּן־יוֹתָ֑ם מֶ֚לֶךְ יְהוּדָ֔ה

“In the year of 17, the year to Pekah the son of Remaliah, Ahaz, the son of Jotham, the king of Judah, reigned”

In this verse and the next two verses, the author is introducing **Ahaz** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Judah**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:16.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 16:2 (#1)

בֶּן־עֶשְׂרִ֥ים שָׁנָ֖ה אָחָ֑ז

“Ahaz {was} a son of 20 years”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:17. Alternate translation: [Ahaz was 20 years old]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 16:2 (#2)

וְלֹא־עָשָׂ֞ה הַיָּשָׁ֣ר בְּעֵינֵ֗י יְהוָה֙ אֱלֹהָ֔יו

“But he did not do right in the eyes of Yahweh his God”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:2. Alternate translation: [But he did not do what Yahweh his God considered to be right]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 16:2 (#3)

אָבִ֑יו

“his father”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [his ancestor]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 16:3 (#1)

וַיֵּ֖לֶךְ בְּדֶ֣רֶךְ מַלְכֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“And he walked in the way of the kings of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:18. Alternate translation: [And he lived as the kings of Israel had lived]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 16:3 (#2)

וְגַ֣ם אֶת־בְּנ֗וֹ הֶֽעֱבִ֙יר בָּאֵ֔שׁ

“And he even made his son pass through the fire”

The author is using **made … pass through the fire** as a common expression of his culture to mean “burned completely as an offering to an idol.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Idiom

2 Kings 16:3 (#3)

אֲשֶׁ֣ר הוֹרִ֣ישׁ יְהוָ֔ה אוֹתָ֖ם

“that Yahweh had driven them out”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [that Yahweh had driven out]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 16:3 (#4)

מִפְּנֵ֖י בְּנֵ֥י יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“from the face of the sons of Israel”

Here the phrase **from the face of** could: (1) be a common expression of the culture that means “on account of” or “on behalf of” a group. Alternate translation: [on behalf of the sons of Israel] or (2) represent [from the presence] of a group. Alternate translation: [from before the sons of Israel]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 16:3 (#5)

בְּנֵ֥י יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:12. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 16:4 (#1)

וְתַחַת כָּל־עֵ֥ץ רַעֲנָֽן

“and under every green tree”

The author is saying **every** green tree as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [and under green trees throughout his kingdom]

See: Hyperbole

2 Kings 16:5 (#1)

אָ֣ז יַעֲלֶ֗ה רְצִ֤ין מֶֽלֶךְ־אֲרָם֙

“Then Rezin, the king of Aram, came up”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [Then Rezin, the king of Aram, came]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 16:5 (#2)

וְלֹ֥א יָכְל֖וּ לְהִלָּחֵֽם

“but they were not able to fight”

The author assumes that readers will understand that by **fight**, in this context he means that the two kings were not immediately able to “overcome” or “defeat” Ahaz. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [but they were not able to defeat him right away]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 16:6 (#1)

בָּעֵ֣ת הַהִ֔יא הֵשִׁ֥יב רְצִ֖ין מֶֽלֶךְ־אֲרָ֑ם אֶת־אֵילַ֙ת֙ לַאֲרָ֔ם וַיְנַשֵּׁ֥ל אֶת־הַיְהוּדִ֖ים מֵאֵילֹ֑ות וארמים בָּ֣אוּ אֵילַ֔ת וַיֵּ֥שְׁבוּ שָׁ֖ם עַ֥ד הַיֹּ֥ום הַזֶּֽה

“At that time, Rezin, the king of Aram, restored Elath to Aram, and he drove the Judeans from Elath. And Arameans came to Elath, and they have lived there to this day”

The author is providing background information about something that Rezin did on this same military campaign. The author related in 14:22 how Azariah, the grandfather of Ahaz, recaptured Elath and brought it back under the control of the kingdom of Judah. The renewed loss of this city shows how the kingdom declined because of the idolatry of Ahaz. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

2 Kings 16:6 (#2)

הֵשִׁ֥יב & אֶת־אֵילַ֙ת֙ לַאֲרָ֔ם וַיְנַשֵּׁ֥ל אֶת־הַיְהוּדִ֖ים מֵאֵילֹ֑ות

“restored Elath to Aram, and he drove the Judeans from Elath”

The author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. If it would be helpful your language, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [drove the Judeans from Elath and restored Elath to Aram]

See: Order of Events

2 Kings 16:6 (#3)

וַיֵּ֥שְׁבוּ שָׁ֖ם עַ֥ד הַיֹּ֥ום הַזֶּֽה

“and they have lived there to this day”

See how you translated the same expression in 2:22. Alternate translation: [and they are still living there at the time of this writing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 16:7 (#1)

עַבְדְּךָ֥ וּבִנְךָ֖ אָ֑נִי

“I {am} your servant and your son”

Ahaz is using each of the terms **servant** and **son** to offer to become a vassal of Tiglath-Pileser if he will help him. The term **servant** indicates more literally that Ahaz will obey Tiglath-Pileser, while the term **son** is a respectful form of address that makes Tiglath-Pileser, by implication, a “father” to Ahaz. See how you translated the term “son” in 8:9 and use a comparable expression for addressing someone respectfully in your language. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [I will obey you and I will be personally loyal to you]

See: Politeness

2 Kings 16:7 (#2)

מִכַּ֣ף מֶֽלֶךְ־אֲרָ֗ם וּמִכַּף֙ מֶ֣לֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“from the palm of the king of Aram and from the palm of the king of Israel”

In this context, the word **palm** represents power, as the word “hand” often does elsewhere in the book. Alternate translation: [from the power of the king of Aram and from the power of the king of Israel]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 16:7 (#3)

הַקּוֹמְמִים עָלָי

“the ones having arisen against me”

Ahaz is speaking as if Rezin and Pekah had actually **arisen** or stood up. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the ones who are attacking me]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 16:8 (#1)

אֶת־הַכֶּסֶף וְאֶת־הַזָּהָב הַנִּמְצָאִ

“the silver and the gold found”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:18. Alternate translation: [the silver and the gold that was]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 16:8 (#2)

בֵּית יְהוָֹה

“in} the house of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:18. Alternate translation: [in the temple of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 16:9 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁמַע אֵלָיו מֶלֶךְ אַשּׁוּר

“And the king of Assyria listened to him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:6. Alternate translation: [And the king of Assyria did what he asked]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 16:9 (#2)

וַיַּעַל מֶלֶךְ אַשּׁוּר

“and the king of Assyria came up”

Since the author has already used the title **the king of Assyria** earlier in this sentence, it may be more natural in your language to use a pronoun here. Alternate translation: [and he came up]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 16:9 (#3)

וַיִּגְלֶהָ

“And he exiled it”

See how you translated the similar expression in 15:29. Alternate translation: [And he exiled the people of the city]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 16:10 (#1)

וְאֶת־תַּבְנִיתָהּ לְכָל־מַעֲשֵׂהוּ

“and its pattern for all of its work”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can say this in a way that would be more natural. Alternate translation: [and the pattern for all of its work]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 16:12 (#1)

וַיַּרְא הַמֶּלֶךְ

“and the king saw”

Since the author has already used the title **the king** earlier in this sentence, it may be more natural in your language to use a pronoun here. Alternate translation: [and he saw]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 16:13 (#1)

וַיַּקְטֵר אֶת־עֹלָתוֹ וְאֶת־מִנְחָתוֹ וַיַּסֵּךְ אֶת־נִסְכּוֹ וַיִּזְרֹק אֶת־דַּם־הַשְּׁלָמִים אֲשֶׁר־לוֹ עַל־הַמִּזְבֵּחַ

“And he burned his burnt offering and his grain offering and poured out his drink offering and sprinkled the blood of the peace offerings that {were} to him on the altar”

To show that Ahaz not only **sprinkled ... blood** on the **altar** but also did the other actions there, you may want to put the information that he did these things **on the altar** at the start of the verse. Alternate translation: [And on the altar he burned his burnt offering

and his grain offering and poured out his drink offering and sprinkled the blood of the peace offerings that were to him]

See: Information Structure

2 Kings 16:14 (#1)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“was} to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:14. Alternate translation: [was in the presence of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 16:14 (#2)

מֵאֵת פְּנֵי הַבַּיִת

“from the face of the house”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:12. Alternate translation: [from in front of the temple]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 16:14 (#3)

צָפוֹנָה

“to the north”

The author assumes that readers will understand that when he says the bronze altar was **to the north** of the new altar, he means that it was on the right side of that altar. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [on the right]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 16:15 (#1)

הַמִּזְבֵּחַ הַגָּדוֹל

“the large altar”

The implication is that the new altar was larger than the old bronze altar. You could indicate in your translation that Ahaz is referring to the new altar here if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the new altar]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 16:15 (#2)

וְכָל־דַּם עֹלָה וְכָל־דַּם־זָבַח

“And & all of the blood of the burnt offering and all of the blood of the sacrifice”

In this verse, the terms **burnt offering** and **sacrifice** are singular in form, but Ahaz is using them to describe every burnt offering and fellowship offering that would be offered on this altar. You could indicate this in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the blood of every burnt offering and the blood of every fellowship offering]

See: Collective Nouns

2 Kings 16:15 (#3)

לְבַקֵּר

“to seek”

Ahaz is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [to seek guidance from Yahweh]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 16:17 (#1)

ואת־הַמִּסְגְּרוֹת הַמְּכֹנֹנוֹת & ואת־הַכִּיֹּר & הַיָּם

“QUOTE_NOT_FOUND: ואת־הַמִּסְגְּרוֹת הַמְּכֹנֹנוֹת & ואת־הַכִּיֹּר & הַיָּם”

These are all technical terms relating to the furnishings of the temple courtyard. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated these terms in 1 Kings 7:23–39.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 16:17 (#2)

מֵעֲלֵיהֶם ואת־הַכִּיֹּר

“the panels of & the basin from upon them”

In this verse, the word **basin** is singular in form, but it refers to the basins on all ten of the **stands** in the temple courtyard. You could indicate this in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the basins from upon them] or [the basin that was on each one]

See: Collective Nouns

2 Kings 16:17–18 (#1)

וַיְקַצֵּץ֩ הַמֶּ֨לֶךְ אָחָ֜ז אֶת־הַמִּסְגְּרוֹת֮ הַמְּכֹנֹנוֹת֒ וַיָּ֤סַר מֵעֲלֵיהֶם֙ אֶת־הַכִּיֹּ֔ר וְאֶת־הַיָּ֖ם הוֹרִ֑ד מֵעַ֗ל הַבָּקָ֙ר הַנְּחֹ֣שֶׁת אֲשֶׁ֔ר תַּחְתָּ֖יו וַיִּתֵּ֥ן אֹתוֹ֙ עַ֣ל מַרְצֶ֔פֶת אֲבָנִֽים׃ וְאֶת־מוּסַ֣ךְ הַשַּׁבָּ֗ת אֲשֶׁר־בָּנ֙וּ בַּבַּ֔יִת וְאֶת־מְבוֹא֙ הַמֶּ֣לֶךְ הַחִיצֹנָ֔ה הֵסֵ֥ב בֵּֽית־יְהוָ֖ה מִפְּנֵ֥י מֶֽלֶךְ אַשּֽׁוּר

"QUOTE_NOT_FOUND: וַיְקַצֵּץ֮ הַמֶּ֣לֶךְ אָחָז֒ אֶת־הַמִּסְגְּרוֹת֙ הַמְּכֹנוֹת֔ וַיָּ֥סַר מֵעֲלֵיהֶ֖ם אֶת־הַכִּיֹּ֑ר וְאֶת־הַיָּ֜ם הוֹרִ֣יד מֵעַ֗ל הַבָּקָ֤ר הַנְּחֹשֶׁת֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר תַּחְתָּ֔יו וַיִּתֵּ֖ן אֹת֑וֹ עַ֖ל מַרְצֶ֥פֶת אֲבָנִֽים׃ וְאֶת־מוֹסַ֣ךְ הַשַּׁבָּ֗ת אֲשֶׁר־בָּנ֤וּ בַבַּ֙יִת֙ וְאֶת־מְבֹ֣א הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ הֵסִ֥ב בֵּית־יְהוָ֖ה מִפְּנֵ֥י מֶֽלֶךְ־אַשּׁ֖וּר **"הַסֵּֽסֶב בֵּ֣בֵית יְהוָ֔ה מִפְּנֵי֙ מֶ֣לֶךְ אַשּׁ֔וּר**

Ahaz took all of the actions that the author describes in 16:17 and 16:18 **from the face of the king of Assyria**, that is, out of deference to him or to please him. If it would be helpful to your readers, in order to indicate this, you could combine these two verses into a verse bridge. You could put the phrase **from the face of the king of Assyria**, which gives the reason for Ahaz's actions, at the beginning. Alternate translation: [And from the face of the king of Assyria, King Ahaz cut off the panels of the stands, and he removed the basin from upon them, and he took down the sea from upon the oxen of bronze that were beneath it and put it on a pavement of stones, and the canopy of the Sabbath that they had built at the house and the outer entrance of the king, he removed from the house of Yahweh]

See: Verse Bridges

2 Kings 16:18 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר־בָּנוּ

"that they had built"

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that had been built]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 16:18 (#2)

מִפְּנֵי

"from the face of"

See how you translated the similar expression in 16:3. Alternate translation: [on account of]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 16:19 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי֙ אָחָ֔ז אֲשֶׁ֥ר עָשָׂ֖ה הֲלֹא־הֵ֑ם כְּתוּבִ֗ים עַל־סֵ֛פֶר דִּבְרֵ֥י הַיָּמִ֖ים לְמַלְכֵ֥י יְהוּדָֽה

"Now the rest of the matters of Ahaz that he did, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Judah"

In this verse and the next verse, the author is concluding the story of Ahaz. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar phrases in 1:18.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 16:20 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּ֥ב אָחָ֖ז עִם־אֲבֹתָ֑יו

"And Ahaz lay down with his fathers"

See how you translated the same expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [And Ahaz passed away] or [And Ahaz died]

See: Euphemism

2 Kings 16:20 (#2)

וַיִּקָּבֵ֥ר עִם־אֲבֹתָ֖יו

"and he was buried with his fathers"

The expression **was buried** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people buried him in the same place where people had buried his ancestors]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings - Chapter 17 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

At the start of this chapter (verses 1–6), the author tells the story of Hoshea, who was the last king of the northern kingdom of Israel. During his reign, the Assyrians conquered that kingdom and exiled its people. So in the following chapters, the author tells what the kings were like who ruled the kingdom of Judah in the years afterward.

Much of this chapter (verses 7–23) is devoted to an explanation that Yahweh allowed the exile of the people of the northern kingdom because they persistently disobeyed him and engaged in idolatry and wickedness despite repeated warnings from his prophets. This can be understood as the closing argument, applied initially to the northern kingdom, of the case that the author or authors of these historical books have been building that Yahweh was not at fault when the Israelites were conquered and exiled from their land. Instead, this happened because the people disobeyed Yahweh and broke their covenant with him.

The remainder of the chapter (verses 24–31) describes how the Assyrians resettled other peoples in the land of Israel and how those peoples worshiped other gods in addition to Yahweh.

2 Kings 17:1 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַתתֵּ שְׁתֵּים עֶשְׂרֵה לְאָחָז מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה מָלַךְ הוֹשֵׁעַ בֶּן־אֵלָה בְּשֹׁמְרוֹן עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל תֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים

“In the year of 12 to Ahaz, the king of Judah, Hoshea, the son of Elah, reigned in Samaria over Israel, 9 years”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is introducing **Hoshea** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Israel**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:25 and 13:1.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 17:2 (#1)

וַיַּעַשׂ הָרַע בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה

“And he did evil in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:2. Alternate translation: [And he did what Yahweh considered to be evil]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 17:2 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר הָיוּ לְפָנָיו

“who were to his face”

See the discussion in the introduction to 2 Kings of how the author and characters may use the term “face” to mean “before in time.” Alternate translation: [who had preceded him] or [who had ruled before he did]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 17:3 (#1)

עָלְתָה שַׁלְמַנְאֶסֶר מֶלֶךְ אַשּׁוּר

“Shalmaneser, the king of Assyria, came up”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [Shalmaneser, the king of Assyria, came]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 17:5 (#1)

וַיַּעַל מֶלֶךְ־אַשּׁוּר בְּכָל־הָאָרֶץ

“Now the king of Assyria came up against all of the land”

The author described the ultimate result of Hoshea’s rebellion in the previous verse. In this verse and the next verse, he is describing the ongoing events that led to this result. Connect these verses to the previous verse in a way that makes it clear in your language that they are describing something that led to the result already stated.

See: Connect — Background Information

2 Kings 17:5 (#2)

וַיַּעַל & בְּכָל־הָאָרֶץ

“Now & came up against all of the land”

The author is saying **all of the land** as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [subjugated the kingdom as a whole]

See: Hyperbole

2 Kings 17:6 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַת הַתְּשִׁיעִית לְהוֹשֵׁעַ

“In the year of nine to Hoshea”

If your language would not describe a year of a king’s reign in a form such as **the year of nine**, you could represent this year in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [In the ninth year of Hoshea]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 17:7 (#1)

בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵלֹ

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:12. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 17:7 (#2)

הַמַּעֲלֶה אֹתָם מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם

“the one having brought them up from the land of Egypt”

The author is using the current generation of Israelites, referring to them with the pronoun **them**, to represent the Israelite people and specifically the earlier generation of them whom Yahweh rescued from slavery in Egypt. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the one having brought the Israelite people up from the land of Egypt]

or [the one having brought their ancestors up from the land of Egypt]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 17:7 (#3)

יַד

“the hand of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [the control of]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 17:8 (#1)

וַיֵּלְכוּ֙ בְּחֻקֹּ֣ות הַגֹּויִ֔ם

“and they walked in the statutes of the nations”

The author is speaking as if the customs of these **nations** had actually been **statutes** or laws that they had obeyed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they walked in the customs of the nations]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 17:8 (#2)

וַיֵּלְכוּ֙ בְּחֻקֹּ֣ות הַגֹּויִ֔ם

“and they walked in the statutes of the nations”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:18. Alternate translation: [and they followed the same customs as the nations]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 17:8 (#3)

מִפְּנֵ֖י

“from the face of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 16:3. Alternate translation: [on account of]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 17:8 (#4)

וּמַלְכֵּ֥י יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל אֲשֶׁ֥ר עָשֽׂוּ

“and the kings of Israel that they did”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and they walked in the statutes of the kings of Israel that they did] or [and they followed the same customs that the kings of Israel followed]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 17:9 (#1)

וַיְחַפְּאוּ֩ בְנֵֽי־יִשְׂרָאֵ֨ל דְּבָרִ֜ים אֲשֶׁ֣ר לֹא־כֵ֗ן עַל־יְהוָה֙ אֱלֹהֵיהֶ֔ם

“And the sons of Israel covered things against Yahweh their God that were not thus”

The meaning of the word **covered** here seems to be that the Israelites pretended they were worshiping Yahweh even as they did **things** that they knew **were not thus**, that is, that Yahweh had not commanded and in fact had forbidden. (While many versions translate the word as “did secretly,” all of the practices that the author describes in 17:9–12 were done openly.) Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also use plain language, as the UST does. Alternate translation: [And the sons of Israel put a veneer of religiosity over the things they did against Yahweh their God, things that he had not commanded them to do]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 17:9 (#2)

בְּכָל־עָֽרֵיהֶ֗ם

“in all of their cities”

The author is saying **all** as an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [in cities throughout their land]

See: Hyperbole

2 Kings 17:9 (#3)

מִמִּגְדַּ֥ל נוֹצְרִ֖ים עַד־עִ֥יר מִבְצָֽר

“from a tower of watchmen to a city of fortification”

The author is referring to every kind of inhabited place by naming two extremes. A **tower of watchmen**, from which a few people would guard crops, was an isolated post in a rural area. A **city of fortification** was a major urban center. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [wherever people lived]

See: Merism

2 Kings 17:10 (#1)

עַ֚ל כָּל־גִּבְעָ֣ה גְבֹהָ֔ה וְתַ֖חַת כָּל־עֵ֥ץ רַעֲנָֽן

“on every high hill and under every green tree”

See how you translated the similar expression in 16:4. Alternate translation: [and on high hills and under green trees throughout their kingdom]

See: Hyperbole

2 Kings 17:11 (#1)

וַיְקַטְּרוּ־שָׁם֙ בְּכָל־בָּמ֔וֹת

“And they burned incense there in all of the high places”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [And they burned incense in all of those high places]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 17:11 (#2)

מִפְּנֵיהֶ֑ם

“from their faces”

See how you translated the similar expression in 16:3. Alternate translation: [on their account]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 17:13 (#1)

בְּיִשְׂרָאֵ֥ל וּבִיהוּדָ֖ה

“Israel and Judah”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:1. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel and Judah]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 17:13 (#2)

בְּיַד֙ כָּל־נביאו & בְּיַ֣ד עֲבָדַ֔י הַנְּבִיאִ֖ים

“by the hand of all of his prophets & by the hand of my servants the prophets”

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:36. Alternate translation: [through the agency of all of his prophets ... through the agency of my servants the prophets]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 17:13 (#3)

כָּל־נביאו כָּל־חֹזֶ֑ה

“all of his prophets, every seer”

The author is saying **all** and **every** as generalizations for emphasis. He means specifically the prophets and seers to whom Yahweh gave messages for this purpose. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [every prophet and seer whom he sent to them]

See: Hyperbole

2 Kings 17:13 (#4)

שֻׁ֚בוּ מִדַּרְכֵיכֶ֣ם הָרָעִ֔ים

“Turn from your evil ways”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:3. Alternate translation: [Stop committing your evil deeds]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 17:13 (#5)

מִצְוֹתַ֥י חֻקּוֹתַ֖י

“my commandments, my statutes”

The terms **commandments** and **statutes** mean similar things. Yahweh is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [all of my commandments]

See: Doublet

2 Kings 17:13 (#6)

אֶת־אֲבֹתֵיכֶ֑ם

“your fathers”

To translate the term “fathers” here and in the next two verses, see how you translated it in 8:24. Alternate translation: [your ancestors]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 17:14 (#1)

וְלֹ֣א שָׁמֵ֔עוּ

“But they did not listen”

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:6. Alternate translation: [But they did not obey]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 17:14 (#2)

וַיַּקְשׁ֣וּ אֶת־עָרְפָּ֔ם כְּעֹ֥רֶף אֲבוֹתָ֖ם

“and they stiffened their neck, like the neck of their fathers”

The author is speaking as if the Israelites he is describing and their ancestors had actually **stiffened their neck**, as an ox would do that did not want to turn in the direction that a farmer was indicating. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they resisted stubbornly, as their fathers did]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 17:14 (#3)

וַיַּקְשׁוּ אֶת־עָרְפָּם֙ כְּעֹ֣רֶף אֲבוֹתָ֔ם

“and they stiffened their neck, like the neck of their fathers”

In this verse, the word **neck** is singular in form, but it refers to all of the necks of the Israelites and their ancestors. If it would be helpful in your language, if you decide to retain the image in your translation, you could use the plural form of “neck.” Alternate translation: [and they stiffened their necks, like the necks of their fathers]

See: Collective Nouns

2 Kings 17:15 (#1)

וְאֶת־בְּרִיתוֹ֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר כָּרַ֔ת אֶת־אֲבוֹתָ֖ם

“and his covenant that he had cut with their fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:4. Alternate translation: [and the covenant that he had made with their fathers]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 17:15 (#2)

וְאֵת֙ עֵדְוֹתָ֣יו אֲשֶׁ֣ר הֵעִ֔יד בָּהֶ֖ם

“and his testimonies that he testified against them”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. In this context, the idea is that Yahweh **testified** against the Israelites the way someone would testify against another person in court. Yahweh sent the prophets to give evidence that the Israelites had broken his covenant and needed to change the way they were acting. Alternate translation: [and the evidence that his prophets brought against them]

See: Poetry

2 Kings 17:15 (#3)

וְאַחֲרֵי֙ הַגּוֹיִ֔ם אֲשֶׁ֥ר סְבִיבֹתָ֖ם

“and after the nations that {were} around them”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and they went after the nations that were around them] or [and they followed the nations that were around them]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 17:15 (#4)

וְאַחֲרֵי֙ הַגּוֹיִ֔ם אֲשֶׁ֥ר סְבִיבֹתָ֖ם

“and after the nations that {were} around them”

The author is speaking as if the Israelites had actually gone **after** or physically followed the surrounding nations. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they did the same things as the nations that were around them]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 17:16 (#1)

מַסֵּכָ֔ה

“a molded image”

While the word **image** is singular in form, it refers to both of the **calves**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “image.” Alternate translation: [molded images]

See: Collective Nouns

2 Kings 17:16 (#2)

אֲשֵׁירָ֑ה

“an Asherah”

The author is not referring to a specific **Asherah**. He means all of the Asherahs that the Israelites made. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Asherahs] or [Asherah poles]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

2 Kings 17:16 (#3)

לְכָל־צְבָא הַשָּׁמַיִם

“to the whole army of the heavens”

The author is speaking of the sun, moon, and stars as if they were an **army** in the sky. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly, as the UST does. Alternate translation: [to all the lights in the sky] or [to the heavenly bodies]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 17:17 (#1)

וַיַּעֲבִירוּ אֶת־בְּנֵיהֶם וְאֶת־בְּנוֹתֵיהֶם בָּאֵשׁ

“And they made their sons and their daughters pass through the fire”

See how you translated the similar expression in 16:3. Alternate translation: [And they burned up their sons and daughters completely as offerings to idols]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 17:17 (#2)

וַיְקַסְּמוּ קְסָמִים

“And they divined divinations”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [And they practiced divination]

See: Poetry

2 Kings 17:17 (#3)

וַיִּתְמַכְּרוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת הָרַע

“And they sold themselves to do evil”

The author is using **they sold themselves** as a common expression of his culture to mean that the Israelites allowed doing evil to take complete control of their lives. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Kings 21:20. Alternate translation: [And they surrendered themselves completely to doing evil] or [And they gave in completely to doing evil]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 17:18 (#1)

וַיִּתְאַנַּף יְהוָה מְאֹד

“And Yahweh was exceedingly enraged”

The expression **was exceedingly enraged** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And this enraged Yahweh exceedingly]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 17:18 (#2)

מֵעַל פָּנָיו

“away from his face”

To translate the term **face** here and in verses 20 and 23, see how you translated the similar expression in 13:23. Alternate translation: [away from his presence] or [away from the land of Israel]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 17:18 (#3)

לִבְדּוֹ לֹא נִשְׁאַר רַק שֵׁבֶט יְהוּדָה לְבַדּוֹ

“None was left, only the tribe of Judah alone”

If it would appear in your language that the author was making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [The only tribe that was left was Judah alone]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

2 Kings 17:19 (#1)

וַיֵּלְכוּ בְּחֻקּוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל אֲשֶׁר עָשׂוּ

“And they walked in the statutes of Israel that they did”

See how you translated the similar expression in 17:8. Alternate translation: [And they followed the same customs that the people followed in the kingdom of Israel]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 17:20 (#1)

זֶרַע יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the seed of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:27. Alternate translation: [the descendants of Israel] or [the people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 17:20 (#2)

וַיִּתְּנֵם בְּיַד־שֹׁסִים

“and he gave them into the hand of plunderers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [and he gave them into the power of plunderers] or [and he allowed people to plunder them]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 17:20 (#3)

הִשְׁלִיכָם

“he cast them”

The author is speaking as if Yahweh had actually **cast** or thrown the Israelites somewhere. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he allowed enemies to take them]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 17:21 (#1)

קָרַע יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵעַל

“he tore Israel away from”

The author is speaking as if Yahweh actually **tore** Israel away from the kings descended from David, the way someone might tear a piece of cloth away from the rest of a garment. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Kings 11:11. Alternate translation: [he took Israel away]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 17:21 (#2)

בֵּית דָּוִד

“the house of David”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:18. Alternate translation: [the dynasty of David]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 17:21 (#3)

וידא יָרָבְעָם אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵאַחֲרֵי יְהוָה

“And Jeroboam drove Israel away from after Yahweh”

Speaker is speaking as if Jeroboam actually **drove** the Israelites away from worshiping and obeying Yahweh, the way the author says in 16:16 that Rezin “drove the Judeans out of Elath.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Jeroboam influenced the Israelites to stop worshiping and obeying Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 17:21 (#4)

וְהֶחֱטִיאָם חֲטָאָה גְדוֹלָה

“and he made them sin a great sin”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [and he caused them to sin greatly]

See: Poetry

2 Kings 17:22 (#1)

וַיֵּלְכוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּכָל־חַטֹּאות יָרָבְעָם אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לֹא־סָרוּ מִמֶּנָּה

“And the sons of Israel walked in all of the sins of Jeroboam that he did. They did not turn away from it”

See how you translated the similar expressions in 3:3 and 8:18. Alternate translation: [And the sons of Israel committed the same sins that Jeroboam committed. They did not stop committing those sins]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 17:22 (#2)

לֹא־סָרוּ מִמֶּנָּה

“They did not turn away from it”

Since the pronoun **it** refers back to the **sins** of Jeroboam, it may be more natural in your language to use a plural pronoun. Alternate translation: [They did not turn away from them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 17:23 (#1)

בְּיַד כָּל־עֲבָדָיו הַנְּבִיאִים

“by the hand of all of his servants the prophets”

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:36. Alternate translation: [through the agency of his servants the prophets]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 17:23 (#2)

עַ֣ד הַיּ֣וֹם הַזֶּ֑ה

“to this day”

See how you translated the same expression in 2:22. Alternate translation: [and that is still the case as of the time of this writing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 17:24 (#1)

בְּעָרֵ֣י שֹׁמְר֔וֹן & וַיִּרְשׁוּ֙ אֶת־שֹׁמְר֔וֹן

“in the cities of Samaria & And they possessed Samaria”

The author is using the name **Samaria** for the kingdom of Israel. Since the Assyrians now controlled the area, he is using the same name that the Assyrians used, as 17:26 shows. If you have decided to use the same names in your translation that the biblical author does in each place, you may wish to use the name Samaria here and in verse 28. If you decided to use the same name consistently for a given place, you may wish to use the name Israel.

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 17:25 (#1)

וַיְהִ֗י

“And it happened”

The author is using this phrase to introduce a new event. See how you translated the phrase in 2:1.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 17:26 (#1)

וַיֹּאמְר֗וּ לְמֶ֙לֶךְ֙ אַשּׁ֣וּר

“And they spoke to the king of Assyria”

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the king of Assyria was told]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 17:26 (#2)

שֹׁמְר֔וֹן

“Samaria”

Even if you used the name “Israel” in your translation in 17:24 to reflect the author’s meaning, it would be appropriate to use the name **Samaria** here, since that is apparently how the people in the Assyrian royal court referred to the land that had been the northern kingdom of Israel.

See: How to Translate Names

2 Kings 17:26 (#3)

וְהִנָּ֣ם מְמִיתִ֔ים אוֹתָ֖ם

“and behold them, killing them”

The people who are informing the Assyrian king are using **behold them** as a common expression of their culture to describe an activity that is ongoing at the time when they are speaking. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Kings 1:25. Alternate translation: [and they are killing them as we speak] or [and they are killing them right now]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 17:27 (#1)

וְיֵלְכ֣וּ וְיֵשְׁב֣וּ שָׁ֔ם וְיֹרֵ֖ם

“And let them go and settle there, and let him teach them”

The pronoun **them** likely refers in this instance to the household and assistants of the priest. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. (In the second instance, in the phrase **let him teach them**, the pronoun **them** refers to the people whom the Assyrians resettled in Israel.) Alternate translation: [And let him go and settle there with his household and assistants]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 17:29 (#1)

וַיִּהְי֣וּ עֹשִׂ֗ים גּ֚וֹי גּ֣וֹי אֱלֹהָ֔יו & גּוֹיִ֖ם בְּעָרֵיהֶ֑ם אֲשֶׁ֥ר הֵ֙מָּה֙ יוֹשְׁבִ֣ים שָׁ֔ם

“And they were making, a nation, a nation, its gods & a nation, a nation, in their cities where they were settling there”

The author is using **a nation, a nation** as a common expression of his culture to mean "each nation" or "every nation." If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And all the nations were making their own gods ... all the nations in their cities where they were settling there] or [And each nation was making its own gods ... each nation in their cities where it was settling there]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 17:29 (#2)

בְּבֵית

"in the house of"

In this verse, the word **house** is singular in form, but it refers to all of the temples on the high places as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of "house." Alternate translation: [in the temples of]

See: Collective Nouns

2 Kings 17:29 (#3)

בְּבֵית הַבָּמֹות

"in the house of the high places"

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:18. Alternate translation: [in the temples of the high places] or [in the shrines at the high places]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 17:29 (#4)

אֲשֶׁר הֵמָּה יֹשְׁבִים שָׁם

"where they were settling there"

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [where they were settling]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 17:32 (#1)

מִקְצוֹתָם

"from their extremities"

The author is using the term **extremities** to mean the outer limits of the population of these groups, and he is using those outer limits to represent them and everything in between. In other words, he means that these people groups made priests from throughout their entire population, not from a specific priestly tribe such as the Levites. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Kings 12:31. Alternate translation: [from throughout their populations]

See: Merism

2 Kings 17:32 (#2)

וַיִּהְיוּ עֹשִׂים לָהֶם

"and they were making {sacrifices} to them"

The pronoun **they** refers to these **priests**, while the pronoun **them** refers to the gods whom these people groups made idols to represent. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and those priests were making sacrifices to the gods that their nations had made]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 17:33 (#1)

הִגְלֹוּ אֹתָם

"they had exiled them"

The pronoun **they** refers to the Assyrians. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the Assyrians had exiled them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 17:33 (#2)

מִשָּׁם

"from there"

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you do not need to represent it explicitly in your translation.

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 17:34 (#1)

עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה

"To this day"

See how you translated the same expression in 2:22. Alternate translation: [At the time of this writing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 17:34 (#2)

הֵ֣ם עֹשִׂ֔ים

“they are acting”

The pronoun **they** refers to the people groups whom the Assyrians settled in the land of Israel and specifically to their descendants who were alive at the time the author wrote this verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [their descendants are acting]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 17:34 (#3)

אֵינָ֣ם יְרֵאִ֔ים אֶת־יְהוָ֖ה

“They are not fearing Yahweh”

The implication, based on what the author says in the following verses, is that here he means that these people were not genuinely fearing Yahweh. He said in the previous two verses that they “were fearing Yahweh,” but by that he meant that they observed certain religious practices. They were not truly devoted to Yahweh, as their worship of other gods showed. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [They are not genuinely fearing Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 17:34 (#4)

כְּחֻקָּתָ֣ם וּכְמִשְׁפָּטָ֗ם וְכַתּוֹרָה֙ וְכַמִּצְוָ֔ה אֲשֶׁ֥ר צִוָּ֖ה יְהוָ֑ה אֶת־בְּנֵ֣י יַעֲקֹ֔ב

“according to their statutes or according to their judgment or according to the law or according to the commandment that Yahweh commanded the sons of Jacob”

It may be more natural in your language to use a noun phrase in the first part of this sentence and a pronoun in the second part of the sentence. Alternate translation: [according to the statutes of the sons of Jacob, whose name he made Israel, or according to their judgment or according to the law or according to the commandment that Yahweh commanded them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 17:34 (#5)

כְּחֻקָּתָ֣ם וּכְמִשְׁפָּטָ֗ם וְכַתּוֹרָה֙ וְכַמִּצְוָ֔ה אֲשֶׁ֥ר צִוָּ֖ה יְהוָ֑ה אֶת־בְּנֵ֣י יַעֲקֹ֔ב

“according to their statutes or according to their judgment or according to the law or according to the commandment that Yahweh commanded the sons of Jacob”

The terms **statutes**, **judgment**, **law**, and **commandment** mean similar things. The author is using these terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [according to the entire law that Yahweh gave to the sons of Jacob]

See: Doublet

2 Kings 17:34 (#6)

וּכְמִשְׁפָּטָ֔ם & וְכַמִּצְוָ֔ה

“or according to their judgment & or according to the commandment”

In this verse, the words **judgment** and **commandment** are singular in form, but they refer to all of the judgments and commandments that Yahweh gave to **the sons of Jacob**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural forms of these words. Alternate translation: [or according to their judgments ... or according to the commandments]

See: Collective Nouns

2 Kings 17:34 (#7)

וְכַמִּצְוָ֔ה אֲשֶׁ֥ר צִוָּ֖ה יְהוָ֑ה

“or according to the commandment that Yahweh commanded”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [or according to the commandments that Yahweh gave to]

See: Poetry

2 Kings 17:34 (#8)

אֶת־בְּנֵ֣י יַעֲקֹ֔ב

“the sons of Jacob”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:12. Alternate translation: [the descendants of Jacob]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 17:35 (#1)

וַיִּכְרֹ֤ת יְהוָה֙ & בְּרִ֔ית

“For Yahweh had cut a covenant”

To translate the expression **cut a covenant** here and in verse 38, see how you translated the similar expression in 11:4. Alternate translation: [For Yahweh had made a covenant here]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 17:36 (#1)

כִּֽי־אִם־אֶת־יְהוָ֣ה

“except Yahweh”

If it would appear in your language that Yahweh was making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. In some languages this may be particularly helpful to avoid the idea that Yahweh is one of the “other gods” described in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [The only God you shall worship is Yahweh]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

2 Kings 17:36 (#2)

אֶת־יְהוָ֣ה & אֹת֗וֹ & וְלֹ֤ו & וְלֹ֥ו

“Yahweh & him, and & to him, and & to him”

Yahweh is speaking of himself in the third person because he is making an authoritative proclamation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [me, Yahweh ... me ... to me ... to me]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 17:36 (#3)

בְּכֹ֣חַ גָּדֹ֔ול וּבִזְרֹועַ֖ נְטוּיָ֑ה

“with great power and an outstretched arm”

Yahweh stretching out his **arm** represents Yahweh doing supernatural acts. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. If you have already translated the book of Deuteronomy, see how you translated the same expression in Deuteronomy 4:34. Alternate translation: [with great power and supernatural deeds]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 17:36 (#4)

בְּכֹ֣חַ גָּדֹ֔ול וּבִזְרֹועַ֖ נְטוּיָ֑ה

“with great power and an outstretched arm”

Together the phrases **great power** and **an outstretched arm** express a single idea. The phrase **great power** tells in what way Yahweh accomplished the deeds that his **outstretched arm** represents. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [powerfully with supernatural deeds]

See: Hendiadys

2 Kings 17:37 (#1)

וְאֶת־הַחֻקִּ֣ים וְאֶת־הַמִּשְׁפָּטִ֗ים וְהַתֹּורָה֙ וְהַמִּצְוָ֔ה

“And the statutes and the judgments and the law and the commandment”

See how you translated the similar expression in 17:34. Alternate translation: [And the entire law]

See: Doublet

2 Kings 17:37 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר כָּתַ֖ב לָכֶ֑ם

“that he wrote for you”

The pronoun **he** refers to Moses. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [that Moses wrote down for you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 17:37 (#3)

כָּל־הַיָּמִ֔ים

“all of the days”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:19. Alternate translation: [always] or [continually]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 17:38 (#1)

וְהַבְּרִ֣ית & לֹ֥א תִשְׁכְּח֖וּ

“And you shall not forget the covenant”

This is a double negative, consisting of the negative particle **not** and the negative word **forget**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this. Alternate translation: [And you must always remember]

See: Double Negatives

2 Kings 17:39 (#1)

כִּֽי־אִם־אֶת־יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֵיכֶ֔ם תִּירָ֖אוּ

“except you shall fear Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the similar expression in 17:36. Alternate translation: [You shall fear only Yahweh your God]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

2 Kings 17:39 (#2)

אֶת־יְהוָה & וְהוּאִ֥ יַצִּ֖יל

“Yahweh & and he, he will deliver”

Yahweh is continuing to speak of himself in the third person because he is making an authoritative proclamation. See what you did in 17:36. Alternate translation: [me, Yahweh ... and I, I will deliver]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 17:39 (#3)

וְהוּאִ֥ יַצִּ֖יל

“and he, he will deliver”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:7. Alternate translation: [and he is the one who will deliver] or [and I am the one who will deliver]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 17:39 (#4)

מִיַּ֖ד

“from the hand of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [from the power of]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 17:41 (#1)

גַּם־בְּנֵיהֶ֥ם ׀ וּבְנֵ֣י בְנֵיהֶ֑ם

“Both their sons and the sons of their sons”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:4. Alternate translation: [Both their children and the children of their children]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

2 Kings 17:41 (#2)

גַּם־בְּנֵיהֶ֥ם ׀ וּבְנֵ֣י בְנֵיהֶ֑ם

“Both their sons and the sons of their sons”

Your language may have its own term or expression for the relationship that the author describes with the phrase **the sons of their sons**. Alternate translation: [Both their children and grandchildren]

See: Kinship

2 Kings 17:41 (#3)

גַּם־בְּנֵיהֶ֥ם ׀ וּבְנֵ֣י בְנֵיהֶ֑ם

“Both their sons and the sons of their sons”

The author may be using the first two generations of descendants to represent many generations. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Subsequent generations of their descendants]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 17:41 (#4)

אֲבֹתָ֖מ

“their fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [their ancestors]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 17:41 (#5)

עַ֥ד הַיּ֖וֹם הַזֶּֽה

“to this day”

See how you translated the same expression in 2:22.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings - Chapter 18 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter begins the story of Hezekiah, one of the great kings of Judah. Because he is so important, the author describes the history of his reign at length, in chapters 18, 19, and 20.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

What was “the serpent of bronze that Moses had made”?

The author refers in 18:4 to “the serpent of bronze that Moses had made.” This was an artifact originally constructed during the Israelites’ wilderness journey, as described in Numbers 21:4–9. Yahweh instructed Moses to make this bronze serpent and place it on a pole so that anyone bitten by poisonous snakes could look at it and be healed. Over time, however, the Israelites began to worship the bronze serpent itself (they even gave it a name, Nehushtan) and burn incense to it as an idol. King Hezekiah destroyed this object during his reforms, recognizing that what was once a symbol associated with Yahweh’s healing had become an object of improper worship.

2 Kings - Chapter 18 Introduction

Why did Sennacherib not end his invasion of Judah even after Hezekiah paid him what he demanded?
The author describes in 18:13–16 how Sennacherib, the king of Assyria, invaded Judah. Hezekiah had rebelled against him (as verse 7 describes), but he agreed to become his vassal again and pay any tribute he demanded. Sennacherib specified an amount, and Hezekiah paid it. But Sennacherib did not end his invasion of Judah after that. Instead, he continued to besiege the cities he had not yet conquered, and he sent officials at the head of a large army to demand the surrender of Jerusalem. It seems that Sennacherib was not content with tribute. He wanted complete control over the Judean kingdom. He did not want to risk another Judean king rebelling against him. So he had to conquer or achieve the surrender of the capital, Jerusalem. It is possible that Sennacherib used the tribute as a means of weakening Judah before insisting on full surrender. If so, that shows his determination to assert his dominance and destroy any resistance.

Why did the Assyrians stop where they did?
The author says in 18:17 that the large Assyrian army that advanced against Jerusalem "stopped by the conduit of the upper pool that was on the highway of the Field of the Fuller." One reason for stopping and apparently setting up camp there was probably the need for water for a large army. According to the parallel account in 2 Chronicles, Hezekiah had blocked up all the water sources around the city in order to keep the Assyrians from having a water supply. But the location where their army stopped was right next to an aqueduct that brought water down to Jerusalem from springs above the city. That provided a ready source of water. This was also a prominent location right outside the city walls. This allowed the Assyrian officials to demand a conference with King Hezekiah's representatives that would take place within the hearing of Judeans who gathered on the city walls. The Assyrians exploited this and said things publicly to try to terrify and demoralize the Judeans.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Levels of quotation

There are multiple levels of quotation in the long quotations in verses 19–25 and 28–35. In the first case, it is complicated to follow who is speaking and on whose behalf. But here is one probable explanation. This is the interpretation that the ULT follows.

- Verse 19 introduces three levels of quotation. The author begins quoting what the Rabshakeh said (level 1). The Rabshakeh begins to tell Hezekiah's officials what he wants them to say to Hezekiah (level 2). This includes the beginning of a quotation from Sennacherib, the king of Assyria (level 3).
- The third-level quotation continues through verses 20 and 21. A fourth-level quotation begins in verse 20, as Sennacherib quotes something that Hezekiah is supposedly saying. The pronouns "you" and "yourself" are singular because Sennacherib is addressing Hezekiah. The second-level and third-level quotations that began in verse 19 conclude at the end of verse 21.
- In verse 22, there are two levels of quotation. The "you" in "if you say" is plural, so the Rabshakeh is now addressing Hezekiah's officials directly. He speaks of Hezekiah in the third person. But he quotes what the officials might say and what Hezekiah has said.
- The first-level quotation from the Rabshakeh continues in v. 23, but now the Rabshakeh is addressing Hezekiah directly. (He is implicitly expecting the Judean officials to pass along his words). The implied "you" in the imperative "wager" and the pronoun "yourself" are singular, but the king of Assyria is spoken of in the third person ("my master"), so the Rabshakeh is not quoting the king as he did in vv. 19–21.
- This seems to be the case in v. 24, as well, where the Rabshakeh continues to speak of Sennacherib as "my master."
- But the speaker in v. 25 seems to be Sennacherib again, speaking of himself in the first person. (The Rabshakeh would not say of himself, "Now have I come up against this place.") This is an implicit return to the third-level quotation, although the author does not signal it directly in the text.

Notes describe different possible ways of indicating the speakers throughout this long quotation.

The long quotation in verses 28–35 contains three levels of quotation, but it the identity of the speakers seems clearer throughout. Notes also describe ways of indicating the speakers throughout this quotation.

The Rabshakeh's strong language

In 18:27, to try to terrify the Judeans into surrendering, the Rabshakeh speaks graphically of the effects of a prolonged siege. He tells them that they will "eat their dung and drink their urine." His language might be considered offensive in some cultures. If it would not be appropriate for your readers if you reproduced his exact words, you could use an equivalent expression that would still reflect his ominous threat. You

might have him say, for example, that the Judeans will "consume their own waste."

2 Kings 18:1 (#1)

וַיְהִי֙ בִּשְׁנַ֣ת שָׁל֔וֹשׁ לְהוֹשֵׁ֥עַ בֶּן־אֵלָ֖ה מֶ֣לֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל מָלַ֕ךְ חִזְקִיָּ֖ה בֶּן־אָחָ֥ז מֶֽלֶךְ יְהוּדָֽה

"And it happened in the year of three to Hoshea, the son of Elah, the king of Israel, Hezekiah, the son of Ahaz, the king of Judah, reigned"

In this verse and the next two verses, the author is introducing **Hezekiah** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Judah**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:16. (In this instance, the author uses the phrase **And it happened** to introduce a participant. He may do this to highlight the exceptional godly character of Hezekiah. Consider how you have been translating that phrase and how you might express its meaning here.)

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 18:1 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַ֣ת שָׁל֔וֹשׁ לְהוֹשֵׁ֥עַ

"in the year of three to Hoshea"

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:25. Alternate translation: [in the third year of Hoshea]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 18:2 (#1)

בֶּן־עֶשְׂרִ֥ים וְחָמֵ֖שׁ שָׁנָ֑ה הָיָֽיְה

"He was a son of 25 years"

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:17. Alternate translation: [He was 25 years old]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 18:3 (#1)

הַיָּשָׁ֖ר בְּעֵינֵ֥י יְהוָ֑ה

"right in the eyes of Yahweh"

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:13. Alternate translation: [what Yahweh considered to be right]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 18:3 (#2)

אָבִֽיו

"his father"

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [his ancestor]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 18:4 (#1)

הֽוּא ׀ הֵסִ֣יר

"He, he removed"

The author is stating the pronoun **he** separately, even though the verb translated as **he removed** already includes this meaning. He may be doing that in order to emphasize a contrast between what Hezekiah did and what previous kings had done, even godly ones such as Joash, Azariah, and Jotham. The author notes that those kings "did right in the eyes of Yahweh," but even so, "the high places were not removed." Alternate translation: [Unlike previous kings, he removed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 18:4 (#2)

אֶת־הָאֲשֵׁרָ֖ה

"the Asherah"

This could be a reference to: (1) many different Asherah poles that the Judeans had set up throughout their kingdom. The word **Asherah** is singular in form, but it would be referring to all of these poles as a group. Alternate translation: [all of the Asherah poles that people had set up] or (2) a specific prominent Asherah pole, such as the one the author describes in 13:6. If so, it would have been in Jerusalem. Alternate translation: [the prominent Asherah pole in Jerusalem]

See: Collective Nouns

2 Kings 18:4 (#3)

וְכִתַּ֣ת נְחַ֔שׁ הַנָּחָ֖שׁ אֲשֶׁר־עָשָׂ֣ה מֹשֶׁ֑ה כִּֽי־עַד־הַיָּמִ֣ים הָהֵ֗מָּה הָי֤וּ בְנֵֽי־יִשְׂרָאֵל֙ מְקַטְּרִ֣ים לֹ֔ו וַיִּקְרָא־לֹ֖ו נְחֻשְׁתָּֽן

"And he broke up the serpent of bronze that Moses had made, because until those days the sons of Israel were offering incense to it (and one called it Nehushtan"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And because until those days the sons of Israel were offering incense to the serpent of bronze that Moses had made (and one called it Nehushtan), he broke it up]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 18:4 (#4)

הַיָּמִים הָהֵמָּה

“those days”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:6. Alternate translation: [that time]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 18:4 (#5)

בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:12. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 18:4 (#6)

וַיִּקְרָא־לוֹ נְחֻשְׁתָּן

“and one called it Nehushtan”

Here the author is using the pronoun **one** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and it was called Nehushtan] or [and it had come to be called Nehushtan]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 18:5 (#1)

וַאֲשֶׁר הָיוּ לְפָנָיו

“or those who were to his face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 17:2. Alternate translation: [nor those who were before him]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 18:5 (#2)

וַאֲשֶׁר הָיוּ לְפָנָיו

“or those who were to his face”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [, nor had any of those who were before him been like him]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 18:6 (#1)

וַיִּדְבַּק בַּיהוָה

“And he clung to Yahweh”

The author is speaking of Hezekiah continually being loyal to Yahweh as if he had **clung** to him physically. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he was loyal to Yahweh continually]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 18:6 (#2)

לֹא־סָר מֵאַחֲרָיו

“he did not turn away from after him”

The author is speaking as if Hezekiah had been following Yahweh down a path and as if he could have **turned away** from him physically. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he did not stop obeying him]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 18:6 (#3)

וַיִּשְׁמֹר מִצְוֹתָיו אֲשֶׁר־צִוָּה יְהוָה אֶת־מֹשֶׁה

“and he kept his commandments, which Yahweh had commanded Moses”

In some languages it may be more natural to use the name **Yahweh** earlier and a pronoun later. Alternate translation: [and he kept Yahweh’s commandments, which he had commanded Moses]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 18:7 (#1)

וְהָיָה יְהוָה עִמּוֹ

“And Yahweh was with him”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean that Yahweh helped Samuel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the same expression in 1 Samuel 3:19. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [And Yahweh helped him]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 18:7 (#2)

יֵצֵא

“he went out”

The author is using **he went out** as a common expression of his culture to mean “he led his army into

battle." If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he went to war] or [he led his army into battle]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 18:8 (#1)

הִוא־הִכָּה אֶת־פְּלִשְׁתִּים

"He, he struck the Philistines"

The author is stating the pronoun **He** separately, even though the verb translated as **he struck** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to put focus on Hezekiah as the king who led the Judean army to do this. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. See how you translated the same expression in 14:7. Alternate translation: [He was the king who struck]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 18:8 (#2)

הִכָּה אֶת־פְּלִשְׁתִּים

"he struck the Philistines"

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [he defeated the Philistines]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 18:8 (#3)

וְאֶת־גְּבוּלֶיהָ

"and its borders"

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:32. Alternate translation: [and its territory]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 18:8 (#4)

מִמִּגְדַּל נוֹצְרִים עַד־עִיר מִבְצָר

"from a tower of watchmen to a fortified city"

See how you translated the similar expression in 17:9. Alternate translation: [conquering settlements of all sizes]

See: Merism

2 Kings 18:9 (#1)

וַיְהִי

"And it happened"

The author is using this phrase to introduce a new event. See how you translated the same phrase in 2:1.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 18:9 (#2)

בַּשָּׁנָה הָרְבִיעִית לַמֶּלֶךְ חִזְקִיָּהוּ הִיא הַשָּׁנָה הַשְּׁבִיעִית לְהוֹשֵׁעַ

"in the fourth year of King Hezekiah (it {was} the seventh year of Hoshea"

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **fourth** or **seventh**, you could represent these number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [in year four of Hezekiah (it was year seven of Hoshea]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 18:9 (#3)

עָלָה

"came up"

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [came]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 18:10 (#1)

וַיִּלְכְּדֻהָ

"And they captured it"

The pronoun **they** refers to the Assyrians. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the Assyrians captured it]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 18:10 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַת־שֵׁשׁ לְחִזְקִיָּהוּ הִיא שְׁנַת־תֵּשַׁע לְהוֹשֵׁעַ

"In the year of six to Hezekiah, it {was} the year of nine to Hoshea"

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:25. Alternate translation: [In the sixth year of Hezekiah, which was the ninth year of Hoshea]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 18:10 (#3)

נִלְכְּדָה שֹׁמְרוֹן

“Samaria was captured”

The expression **was captured** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the Assyrians captured Samaria]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 18:11 (#1)

אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Israel”

Here, **Israel** represents the Israelites. Since the author uses the plural pronoun **them** for the Israelites in the next sentence, it may be helpful to use a plural term here. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 18:12 (#1)

עַל ׀ אֲשֶׁר

“because”

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but an explanation. The author does not mean that the king of Assyria did the things he described in the previous verse because of the things he describes in this verse. He is explaining that the things in the previous verse happened because of the things in this verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 18:12 (#2)

לֹא־שָׁמְעוּ בְּקוֹל יְהוָה

“they did not listen to the voice of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:6. Alternate translation: [they did not listen to what Yahweh their God had told them to do]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 18:12 (#3)

לֹא־שָׁמְעוּ בְּקוֹל יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיהֶם

“they did not listen to the voice of Yahweh their God”

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:6. Alternate translation: [they did not obey what Yahweh their God had told them to do]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 18:12 (#4)

וְלֹא שָׁמְעוּ וְלֹא עָשׂוּ

“and they did not listen, and they did not do”

Since, in this context, the term **listen** means “obey,” these two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [and they did not obey him at all]

See: Parallelism

2 Kings 18:13 (#1)

וּבְאַרְבַּע עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה לַמֶּלֶךְ חִזְקִיָּהוּ

“And in 14, the year to King Hezekiah”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:25. Alternate translation: [And in the fourteenth year of Hezekiah]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 18:13 (#2)

וַיִּתְפְּשֵׂם

“and he captured them”

The author is saying **all** as an overstatement for emphasis. It becomes clear in the next verse, understood in light of 19:8, that there were some significant cities that Sennacherib had not yet captured. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [and he captured one after another] or [and he captured many of them]

See: Hyperbole

2 Kings 18:14 (#1)

חָטָאתִי

“I have sinned”

Hezekiah is speaking as if he had actually **sinned** or done something that was against Yahweh’s commandments. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I have done the wrong thing by not serving you]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 18:14 (#2)

אֵת אֲשֶׁר־תִּתֵּן עָלַי אֶשָּׂא

“Whatever you put on me, I will bear”

Hezekiah is speaking as if he were actually a beast of burden and would **bear** a load that Sennacherib would put on him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Whatever you impose on me, I will pay]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 18:14 (#3)

שְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת כִּכַּר־כֶּסֶף וּשְׁלֹשִׁים כִּכַּר זָהָב

“300 kikkars of silver and 30 kikkars of gold”

See how you decided to represent the weight of a kikkar in 5:5.

See: Biblical Weight

2 Kings 18:15 (#1)

הִנְמְצָא

“found”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:18. Alternate translation: [that was]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 18:15 (#2)

בֵּית־יְהוָה

“in} the house of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:18. Alternate translation: [in the temple of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 18:16 (#1)

קִצַּץ & אֶת־דַּלְתוֹת הֵיכַל יְהוָה וְאֶת־הָאֲמְנוֹת

“cut off the doors of the temple of Yahweh and the doorposts”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [cut off the gold from the doors of the temple of Yahweh and the doorposts]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 18:16 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר צִפָּה חִזְקִיָּהוּ מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה

“that Hezekiah, the king of Judah, had overlaid”

Since the author has already used Hezekiah’s name earlier in this sentence, it may be more natural in your language to use a pronoun here. Alternate translation: [that he had overlaid]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 18:16 (#3)

וַיִּתְּנֵם

“and he gave them”

The pronoun **them** refers to the gold that Hezekiah **cut off** from the doors and doorposts of the temple. In some languages it may be more natural to use a singular pronoun to represent this gold, particularly if it might otherwise seem that Hezekiah sent the doors and doorposts to the king of Assyria. Alternate translation: [and he gave it]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 18:17 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁלַח & אֶת־תַּרְתָּן וְאֶת־רַב־סָרִיס ו וְאֶת־רַב־שָׁקֵה מִן־לָכִישׁ אֶל־הַמֶּלֶךְ חִזְקִיָּהוּ בְּחַיִל כָּבֵד יְרוּשָׁלִָם

“And & sent the Tartan and the Rabsaris and the Rabshakeh from Lachish to King Hezekiah with a heavy army {to} Jerusalem”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about the **heavy army** with the information about the officials whom the Assyrian king sent, and the information that he sent them **{to} Jerusalem** with the information that he sent them **from Lachish**. Alternate translation: [sent the Tartan and the Rabsaris and the Rabshakeh with a heavy army from Lachish {to} Jerusalem, to King Hezekiah]

See: Information Structure

2 Kings 18:17 (#2)

אֶת־תַּרְתָּן וְאֶת־רַב־סָרִיס ו וְאֶת־רַב־שָׁקֵה

“the Tartan and the Rabsaris and the Rabshakeh”

The terms **Tartan**, **Rabsaris**, and **Rabshakeh** are Assyrian words, titles of important officials, that the biblical author is using in his account and spelling the way they sound in his language. You could do the same thing, or you could translate the meaning of each term into your language. If you use the Assyrian words, you

could explain what they mean in a footnote. Alternate translation: [his supreme commander, his chief officer, and his field commander]

See: Copy or Borrow Words

2 Kings 18:17 (#3)

וַיַּעֲלוּ֙ וַיָּבֹ֔אוּ יְרוּשָׁלִַ֖ם וַיַּעֲל֑וּ וַיָּבֹ֣אוּ וַיַּעֲמֹ֗דוּ

“And they went up, and they came {to} Jerusalem. And they went up, and they came, and they stopped”

The author is repeating the statement **And they went up, and they came** for stylistic purposes. The repetition illustrates and dramatizes the steady advance of the Assyrian army up the mountain slopes to the city of Jerusalem. It allows readers to share in the suspense and dread that the people of Jerusalem felt as this army approached. If a storyteller in your language would not repeat a statement in this way, you may be able to achieve the same effects in your translation in some other way. Alternate translation: [And the Assyrians advanced inexorably up the mountain slopes to the city of Jerusalem, finally stopping]

See: Reduplication

2 Kings 18:19 (#1)

וַיֹּ֤אמֶר אֲלֵהֶם֙ רַב־שָׁקֵ֔ה אִמְרוּ־נָ֥א אֶל־חִזְקִיָּ֖הוּ כֹּֽה־אָמַ֣ר הַמֶּ֣לֶךְ הַגָּד֑וֹל מֶ֣לֶךְ אַשּׁ֔וּר מָ֥ה הַבִּטָּחוֹן֙ הַזֶּ֣ה אֲשֶׁ֔ר בָּטָֽחְתָּ

“And the Rabshakeh said to them, “Now say to Hezekiah, ‘Thus says the great king, the king of Assyria, “What {is} this trust that you trust”

See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of the multiple levels of quotation in verses 19–25. There are three levels of quotation in this verse. The author is quoting what **the Rabshakeh** said (level 1). The Rabshakeh tells Hezekiah’s officials what he wants them to say **to Hezekiah** (level 2). This includes a quotation from **the king of Assyria** (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or third-level quotations.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 18:19 (#2)

וַיֹּ֤אמֶר אֲלֵהֶם֙ רַב־שָׁקֵ֔ה אִמְרוּ־נָ֥א אֶל־חִזְקִיָּ֖הוּ כֹּֽה־אָמַ֣ר הַמֶּ֣לֶךְ הַגָּד֑וֹל מֶ֣לֶךְ אַשּׁ֔וּר מָ֥ה הַבִּטָּחוֹן֙ הַזֶּ֣ה אֲשֶׁ֔ר בָּטָֽחְתָּ

“And the Rabshakeh said to them, “Now say to Hezekiah, ‘Thus says the great king, the king of Assyria, “What {is} this trust that you trust”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, starting in this verse. Alternate translation: [And the Rabshakeh told them, “Tell Hezekiah that the great king, the king of Assyria, wants to know what this trust is that he is trusting]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 18:19 (#3)

אִמְרוּ

“say”

The implied “you” in the imperative **say** is plural here because the Rabshakeh is addressing all three of Hezekiah’s officials. So use the plural form here in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

2 Kings 18:19 (#4)

בָּטָֽחְתָּ

“you trust”

The word **you** is singular here because the king of Assyria (speaking through the Rabshakeh) is addressing Hezekiah directly. The words “you” and “yourself” are singular in verses 20 and 21 for the same reason. So use singular forms in these verses in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

2 Kings 18:19 (#5)

מָ֥ה הַבִּטָּחוֹן֙ הַזֶּ֣ה אֲשֶׁ֔ר בָּטָֽחְתָּ

“What {is} this trust that you trust”

The king of Assyria is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [What is this trust that you have] or [In whom are you trusting]

See: Poetry

2 Kings 18:19 (#6)

מָ֥ה הַבִּטָּחוֹן֙ הַזֶּ֣ה אֲשֶׁ֔ר בָּטָֽחְתָּ

“What {is} this trust that you trust”

The king of Assyria is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could

translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [There is no one in whom you can trust to protect you from us!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 18:20 (#1)

אָמַרְתָּ֗ אַךְ־דְּבַר־שְׂפָתַ֤יִם עֵצָה֙ וּגְבוּרָ֣ה לַמִּלְחָמָ֔ה עַתָּ֖ה עַל־מִ֣י בָטַ֑חְתָּ כִּ֥י מָרַ֖דְתָּ בִּֽי

“You speak only a word of lips, ‘Counsel and might for war.’ Now in whom do you trust, that you rebel against me”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [The great king says that he is only speaking a word of lips when he says that he has counsel and might for war. The king asks in whom he is trusting, that he rebels against him.]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 18:20 (#2)

אָמַרְתָּ֗ אַךְ־דְּבַר־שְׂפָתַ֤יִם עֵצָה֙ וּגְבוּרָ֣ה לַמִּלְחָמָ֔ה

“You speak only a word of lips, ‘Counsel and might for war”

This could mean: (1) that the Assyrian king is saying Hezekiah claims to have sufficient military strength and strategy to resist, but that is mere talk. The ULT follows this interpretation. Alternate translation: [When you say, ‘I have counsel and might for war,’ that is just a word of lips] or (2) that the king is contrasting brave talk with what is actually needed for war. In that case, he would not be quoting Hezekiah. Alternate translation: [All you have is mere talk. Counsel and might are actually needed for war]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 18:20 (#3)

אָמַרְתָּ֗ אַךְ־דְּבַר־שְׂפָתַ֤יִם עֵצָה֙ וּגְבוּרָ֣ה לַמִּלְחָמָ֔ה

“You speak only a word of lips, ‘Counsel and might for war”

There is a fourth level of quotation here, in addition to the three that a note describes in the previous verse. According to the interpretation that the ULT follows, the king of Assyria (level 3), whom Hezekiah’s officials are to quote (level 2), as the Rabshakeh tells them to do (level 1), is quoting what he believes Hezekiah is saying (level 4). If you have decided to mark levels of quotation with punctuation, use the appropriate punctuation in your language for this level as well.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 18:20 (#4)

אָמַרְתָּ֗ אַךְ־דְּבַר־שְׂפָתַ֤יִם

“You speak only a word of lips”

The king of Assyria is using **a word of lips** as a common expression of his culture to mean “mere talk.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You speak only empty words] or [It is mere talk when you say]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 18:20 (#5)

עַתָּ֑ה עַל־מִ֣י בָטַ֑חְתָּ כִּ֥י מָרַ֖דְתָּ בִּֽי

“Now in whom do you trust, that you rebel against me”

The king of Assyria is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [There is no one you can trust to help you, that you should rebel against me]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 18:21 (#1)

עַתָּ֡ה הִנֵּ֣ה בָטַחְתָּ֣ לְךָ֗ עַל־מִשְׁעֶנֶת֙ הַקָּנֶ֣ה הָרָצ֔וּץ הַזֶּ֖ה עַל־מִצְרַ֑יִם אֲשֶׁ֤ר יִסָּמֵךְ֙ אִישׁ֙ עָלָ֔יו וּבָ֥בָא בְכַפּ֖וֹ וּנְקָבָ֑ה כֵּ֚ן פַּרְעֹ֣ה מֶלֶךְ־מִצְרַ֔יִם לְכֹל־הַבֹּטְחִ֖ים עָלָֽיו

“Now behold, you trust for yourself in the staff of this broken reed, in Egypt, on which a man supports himself and it goes into his palm and pierces it. Thus {is} Pharaoh, the king of Egypt, to all of the ones trusting in him”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [The great king says that behold, Hezekiah is trusting in Egypt to help him, but that is like using a broken reed as a staff. If a man leans on it, it goes into his palm and pierces it. That is what Pharaoh, the king of Egypt, is like for anyone who trusts in him]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 18:21 (#2)

הִנֵּה

“behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:9.

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 18:21 (#3)

בָּטַחְתָּ֣ לְךָ֗ עַל־מִשְׁעֶ֤נֶת֙ הַקָּנֶ֣ה הָרָצ֔וּץ הַזֶּ֖ה עַל־מִצְרַ֑יִם

“you trust for yourself in the staff of this broken reed, in Egypt”

The king of Assyria is speaking as if **Egypt** were actually a **broken reed**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you believe that you can rely on Egypt, but that is like using a broken reed as a staff]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 18:21 (#4)

עַל־מִשְׁעֶ֤נֶת֙ הַקָּנֶ֣ה הָרָצ֔וּץ הַזֶּ֖ה עַל־מִצְרַ֑יִם

“in the staff of this broken reed, in Egypt”

The king of Assyria is using the possessive form to describe a **staff** that consists of a **broken reed**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [in this broken reed, Egypt, as a staff]

See: Possession

2 Kings 18:22 (#1)

וְכִֽי־תֹאמְר֣וּן אֵלַ֔י אֶל־יְהוָ֖ה אֱלֹהֵ֑ינוּ בָּטָ֣חְנוּ הֲלֹא־ה֣וּא אֲשֶׁ֣ר הֵסִ֣יר חִזְקִיָּ֣הוּ אֶת־בָּמֹתָ֣יו וְאֶת־מִזְבְּחֹתָ֗יו וַיֹּ֤אמֶר לִֽיהוּדָה֙ וְלִירֻשָׁלַ֔͏ִם לִפְנֵי֙ הַמִּזְבֵּ֣חַ הַזֶּ֔ה תִּשְׁתַּחֲוֻ֖ו בִּירוּשָׁלָֽ͏ִם

“But if you say to me, ‘We trust in Yahweh our God,’ {is it} not he whose high places and altars Hezekiah has removed and said to Judah and to Jerusalem, ‘To the face of this altar in Jerusalem you shall prostrate yourselves”

The Rabshakeh is using the question form to challenge the claim that Hezekiah’s officials might make that they are trusting in Yahweh. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [And you should not say to me, ‘We trust in Yahweh our God,’ since he is the one whose high places and altars Hezekiah has removed and said to Judah and to Jerusalem, ‘To the face of this altar in Jerusalem you shall prostrate yourselves’!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 18:22 (#2)

וְכִֽי־תֹאמְר֣וּן אֵלַ֔י אֶל־יְהוָ֖ה אֱלֹהֵ֑ינוּ בָּטָ֣חְנוּ הֲלֹא־ה֣וּא אֲשֶׁ֣ר הֵסִ֣יר חִזְקִיָּ֣הוּ אֶת־בָּמֹתָ֣יו וְאֶת־מִזְבְּחֹתָ֗יו וַיֹּ֤אמֶר לִֽיהוּדָה֙ וְלִירֻשָׁלַ֔͏ִם לִפְנֵי֙ הַמִּזְבֵּ֣חַ הַזֶּ֔ה תִּשְׁתַּחֲוֻ֖ו בִּירוּשָׁלָֽ͏ִם

“But if you say to me, ‘We trust in Yahweh our God,’ {is it} not he whose high places and altars Hezekiah has removed and said to Judah and to Jerusalem, ‘To the face of this altar in Jerusalem you shall prostrate yourselves”

The second-level and third-level quotations that began in verse 19 conclude at the end of verse 21. There are two levels of quotation in this verse. The Rabshakeh is addressing Hezekiah’s officials directly (level 1), and he quotes what the officials might say and what Hezekiah has said (level 2). If you have been marking levels of quotation with punctuation, use the appropriate punctuation in your language for the levels in this verse.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 18:22 (#3)

וְכִֽי־תֹאמְר֣וּן אֵלַ֔י אֶל־יְהוָ֖ה אֱלֹהֵ֑ינוּ בָּטָ֣חְנוּ הֲלֹא־ה֣וּא אֲשֶׁ֣ר הֵסִ֣יר חִזְקִיָּ֣הוּ אֶת־בָּמֹתָ֣יו וְאֶת־מִזְבְּחֹתָ֗יו וַיֹּ֤אמֶר לִֽיהוּדָה֙ וְלִירֻשָׁלַ֔͏ִם לִפְנֵי֙ הַמִּזְבֵּ֣חַ הַזֶּ֔ה תִּשְׁתַּחֲוֻ֖ו בִּירוּשָׁלָֽ͏ִם

“But if you say to me, ‘We trust in Yahweh our God,’ {is it} not he whose high places and altars Hezekiah has removed and said to Judah and to Jerusalem, ‘To the face of this altar in Jerusalem you shall prostrate yourselves”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [The great king says that Hezekiah should not tell him that you Judeans are trusting in Yahweh your God. After all, he is the one whose high places and whose altars Hezekiah has removed and told the people of Judah and Jerusalem that they must prostrate themselves to the face of the altar in Jerusalem.]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 18:22 (#4)

תֹאמְר֣וּן & תִּשְׁתַּחֲוֻ֖ו

“you say & you shall prostrate yourselves”

The word **you** is plural in the first instance because the Rabshakeh is addressing Hezekiah's three officials. The word **you** in the second instance and the word **yourself** are plural because Hezekiah was addressing all of the Judeans. So use plural forms in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

2 Kings 18:22 (#5)

אֶל־יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֵ֔ינוּ בָּטָ֖חְנוּ

"We trust in Yahweh our God"

By **We**, Hezekiah's officials would mean themselves and their fellow Judeans but not the Rabshakeh, to whom they would be speaking. So use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

2 Kings 18:22 (#6)

לִֽיהוּדָ֥ה וְלִירוּשָׁלִָֽם

"to Judah and to Jerusalem"

Here, **Judah** and **Jerusalem** represent the people who live in those places. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to the people of Judah and Jerusalem]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 18:22 (#7)

לִפְנֵ֥י

"To the face of"

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:12. Alternate translation: [In front of]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 18:23 (#1)

וְעַתָּ֣ה הִתְעָ֣רַב נָ֠א אֶת־אֲדֹנִ֨י אֶת־מֶ֜לֶךְ אַשּׁ֗וּר וְאֶתְּנָ֤ה לְךָ֙ אַלְפַּ֣יִם סוּסִ֔ים אִם־תּוּכַ֥ל לָ֛ךְ לָתֵ֥ת לְךָ֖ רֹכְבִ֥ים עֲלֵיהֶֽם

"And now, wager, please, with my master, with the king of Assyria. And I will give to you 2,000 horses if you are able to put riders on them for yourself"

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [And now, please invite Hezekiah to make a wager with my master, the king of Assyria. Tell him that I will give him 2,000 horses if he is able to put riders on them for himself]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 18:23 (#2)

וְעַתָּ֣ה

"And now"

This is the beginning of something that the Rabshakeh is saying directly to Hezekiah. He implicitly wants the Judean officials to quote to Hezekiah what he says. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate this in your translation. Alternate translation: [Tell Hezekiah from me, 'And now]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

2 Kings 18:23 (#3)

וְעַתָּ֣ה

"And now"

And now was an expression that speakers in this culture commonly used to introduce an important point such as the implications of what they were just saying. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. See how you translated this expression in 3:23.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 18:23 (#4)

הִתְעָ֣רַב & לְךָ֔ & תּוּכַ֥ל & לְךָ֖

"wager & to you & you are able & for yourself"

The implied "you" in the imperative **wager** and the pronouns **you** and **yourself** are singular in each instance because the Rabshakeh is addressing Hezekiah directly. The words "you" and "yourself" are singular in verse 24 for the same reason. So use singular forms in these verses in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

2 Kings 18:24 (#1)

וְאֵ֣יךְ תָּשִׁ֗יב אֵ֚את פְּנֵ֣י פַחַ֣ת אַחַ֔ד עַבְדֵ֖י אֲדֹנִ֣י הַקְּטַנִּ֑ים וַתִּבְטַ֤ח לְךָ֙ עַל־מִצְרַ֔יִם לְרֶ֖כֶב וּלְפָרָשִֽׁים

"But how would you turn back the face of a captain of one of the least servants of my master? So you trust for yourself in Egypt for chariots and for horsemen"

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [But ask him how he would turn back the face of a captain of one of the least servants of my master. Tell him I know that is why he is trusting for himself in Egypt for chariots and for horsemen]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 18:24 (#2)

וְאֵאֵיךְ תָּשִׁיב אֵאֶת פְּנֵי פַּחַת אַחַד עַבְדֵי אֲדֹנִי הַקְּטַנִּים

“But how would you turn back the face of a captain of one of the least servants of my master”

The Rabshakeh is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [But even then, you would not be able to turn back the face of a captain of one of the least servants of my master!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 18:24 (#3)

וְאֵאֵיךְ תָּשִׁיב אֵאֶת פְּנֵי פַּחַת אַחַד עַבְדֵי אֲדֹנִי הַקְּטַנִּים

“But how would you turn back the face of a captain of one of the least servants of my master”

The Rabshakeh is using one part of a person, his **face**, to mean all of him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But how would you turn back a captain of one of the least servants of my master] or [But how would you force a captain to retreat even if he was one of the least servants of my master]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 18:24 (#4)

פַּחַת אַחַד עַבְדֵי אֲדֹנִי הַקְּטַנִּים

“a captain of one of the least servants of my master”

The Rabshakeh is using the possessive form to describe a **captain** who would be **one of the least servants** of the king of Assyria, that is, one of his weakest soldiers. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [a captain who was among the least servants of my master]

See: Possession

2 Kings 18:24 (#5)

וּלְפָרָשִׁים

“and for horsemen”

This is the end of what the Rabshakeh is saying directly to Hezekiah. In the next verse, the Rabshakeh quotes the end of the message from Sennacherib that he wants the officials to give to Hezekiah. If you have been marking levels of quotation with punctuation, use the appropriate closing punctuation at the end of this verse.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 18:25 (#1)

עַתָּה֙ הֲמִבַּלְעֲדֵ֣י יְהוָ֔ה עָלִ֖יתִי עַל־הַמָּקוֹם֙ הַזֶּ֔ה לְהַשְׁחִיתָ֑ו יְהוָה֙ אָמַ֣ר אֵלַ֔י עֲלֵ֥ה עַל־הָאָ֖רֶץ הַזֹּ֥את וְהַשְׁחִיתָֽהּ

“Now have I come up against this place to destroy it without Yahweh? Yahweh said to me, ‘Go up against this land and destroy it”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [Tell Hezekiah that the king of Assyria says that he has not come up against this place to destroy it without Yahweh. Yahweh told him to go up against this land and destroy it]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 18:25 (#2)

עַתָּה֙ הֲמִבַּלְעֲדֵ֣י יְהוָ֔ה עָלִ֖יתִי עַל־הַמָּקוֹם֙ הַזֶּ֔ה לְהַשְׁחִיתָ֑ו יְהוָה֙ אָמַ֣ר אֵלַ֔י עֲלֵ֥ה עַל־הָאָ֖רֶץ הַזֹּ֥את וְהַשְׁחִיתָֽהּ

“Now have I come up against this place to destroy it without Yahweh? Yahweh said to me, ‘Go up against this land and destroy it”

There are four levels of quotation in this verse. If you have decided to mark levels of quotation with punctuation, see what you did in the similar case of the four levels in verses 19 and 20.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 18:25 (#3)

עַתָּה֙ הֲמִבַּלְעֲדֵ֣י יְהוָ֔ה עָלִ֖יתִי עַל־הַמָּקוֹם֙ הַזֶּ֔ה לְהַשְׁחִיתָ֑ו

“Now have I come up against this place to destroy it without Yahweh”

This is the beginning of something that Sennacherib is saying directly to Hezekiah. It is the rest of the message that the Rabshakeh began to quote in verses 19–21. The Rabshakeh implicitly wants the Judean of-

ficials to quote this to Hezekiah as something that Sennacherib has said. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate this in your translation. Alternate translation: [Say to Hezekiah, 'Thus says the great king, "Now have I come up]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

2 Kings 18:25 (#4)

עַתָּה֙ הֲמִבַּלְעֲדֵ֣י יְהוָ֔ה עָלִ֖יתִי עַל־הַמָּקֹ֣ום הַזֶּ֑ה לְהַשְׁחִיתֹ֔ו

"Now have I come up against this place to destroy it without Yahweh"

The king of Assyria is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Do not think that I have come up against this place to destroy it without Yahweh!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 18:25 (#5)

הֲמִבַּלְעֲדֵ֣י יְהוָ֔ה

"without Yahweh"

Sennacherib is not using the phrase **without Yahweh** to mean that Hezekiah should not think that he has come without Yahweh accompanying him. Rather, he means that he has come after receiving a command from Yahweh. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [without receiving a command to do so from Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 18:26 (#1)

אֶל־עֲבָדֶ֜יךָ

"to your servants"

Eliakim, Shebna, and Joah are speaking of themselves in the third person as **your servants** to show respect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a respectful form in the first person. Alternate translation: [to us, your servants,]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 18:26 (#2)

דַּבֶּר־נָ֣א אֶל־עֲבָדֶ֗יךָ אֲרָמִ֤ית כִּֽי־שֹׁמְעִים֙ אֲנָ֔חְנוּ

"Please speak to your servants in Aramaic, for we are understanding"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since we, your servants, understand Aramaic, please speak to us in that language]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 18:26 (#3)

יְהוּדִ֔ית

"in Judean"

Eliakim is using the name of the dialect of Hebrew that people spoke in the kingdom of Judah. Some versions use the name of the language rather than the name of this dialect and say "in Hebrew." If you have decided to use the same names in your translation that the biblical author does, you may wish to use the name Judean here. If not, you may wish to use the name Hebrew here.

See: How to Translate Names

2 Kings 18:26 (#4)

בְּאָזְנֵ֣י הָעָ֔ם אֲשֶׁ֖ר עַל־הַחֹומָֽה

"in the ears of the people who {are} on the wall"

Here, **ears** represent "hearing." If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the hearing of the people who are on the wall] or [, since the people who are on the wall can hear us]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 18:27 (#1)

הַעַ֗ל אֲדֹנֶ֙יךָ֙ וְאֵלֶ֔יךָ שְׁלָחַ֖נִי אֲדֹנִ֑י לְדַבֵּ֞ר אֶת־הַדְּבָרִ֣ים הָאֵ֗לֶּה הֲלֹ֣א עַל־הָאֲנָשִׁ֡ים הַיֹּשְׁבִים֩ עַל־הַחֹומָ֨ה לֶאֱכֹ֜ל אֶת חריהם וְלִשְׁתֹּ֤ות אֶת־שיניהם עִמָּכֶם

"Did my master send me to speak these words to your master and to you? {Was it} not to the men sitting on the wall, who will eat their dung and drink their urine with you"

The Rabshakeh is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [My master did not send me to speak these words only to your master and to you! He also sent me to speak them to the men sitting on the wall, who will eat their dung and drink their urine with you!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 18:27 (#2)

אֶת־הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה

“these words”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:7. Alternate translation: [this message]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 18:27 (#3)

הַעַל אֲדֹנֶיךָ וְאֵלֶיךָ & עִמָּכֶם

“to your master and to you & with you”

Even though the author says that the Rabshakeh spoke to **them**, the word **your** and the word **you** in its first instance are singular because the Rabshakeh is replying directly to Eliakim, who spoke on behalf of all three Judean officials. The word **you** in its second instance is plural because the Rabshakeh is including Shebnah and Joah in what he says will happen. Use the appropriate singular and plural forms in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

2 Kings 18:28 (#1)

וַיַּעֲמֹד רַב־שָׁקֵה

“And the Rabshakeh stood”

The author probably does not mean that the Rabshakeh had been sitting down and having a private conversation with the Judean officials and that he then **stood** up. If the conversation had been private, there would have been no need for Eliakim to ask him to speak in Aramaic so that the people on the wall would not understand. So the author probably means that the Rabshakeh stood in such a way that his speech to the people on the wall would seem even more forceful and intimidating. Alternate translation: [And the Rabshakeh assumed a dominating stance]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 18:28 (#2)

וַיִּקְרָא

“and said”

See how you decided at 1:10 to represent the phrase **and said** when it introduces a direct quotation.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

2 Kings 18:29 (#1)

כֹּה אָמַר הַמֶּלֶךְ אַל־יַשִּׁאֲכֶם לָכֶם חִזְקִיָּהוּ כִּי־לֹא יוּכַל לְהַצִּיל אֶתְכֶם מִיָּדוֹ

“Thus says the king, ‘Do not let Hezekiah deceive you, for he is not able to deliver you from his hand”

See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of the multiple levels of quotation in verses 19–25. If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate all of this long quotation so that there are not quotations within quotations. Alternate translation: [The king says that you should not let Hezekiah deceive you, since he is not able to deliver you from his hand]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 18:29 (#2)

אַל־יַשִּׁאֲכֶם לָכֶם חִזְקִיָּהוּ כִּי־לֹא יוּכַל לְהַצִּיל אֶתְכֶם מִיָּדוֹ

“Do not let Hezekiah deceive you, for he is not able to deliver you from his hand”

Some ancient manuscripts read “his hand.” The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “my hand.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

2 Kings 18:29 (#3)

אַל־יַשִּׁאֲכֶם לָכֶם חִזְקִיָּהוּ כִּי־לֹא יוּכַל לְהַצִּיל אֶתְכֶם מִיָּדוֹ

“Do not let Hezekiah deceive you, for he is not able to deliver you from his hand”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since Hezekiah is not able to deliver you from my hand, do not let him deceive you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 18:29 (#4)

לָכֶם & אֶתְכֶם

“you & you”

The word **you** is plural in both of these instances because king of Assyria, speaking through the Rabshakeh, is addressing the Judeans who have gathered on the city wall. For the same reason, the words “you” and “your” and the implied “you” in imperatives are also plural throughout verses 30–32. So use plural

forms in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

2 Kings 18:30 (#1)

וְאַל־יַבְטַח אֶתְכֶם חִזְקִיָּהוּ אֶל־יְהוָה לֵאמֹר הַצֵּל יַצִּילֵנוּ יְהוָה וְלֹא תִנָּתֵן אֶת־הָעִיר הַזֹּאת בְּיַד מֶלֶךְ אַשּׁוּר

"And do not let Hezekiah make you trust in Yahweh, saying, "Delivering, Yahweh will deliver us, and this city will not be given into the hand of the king of Assyria"

There are three levels of quotation here. The author is quoting what the Rabshakeh said (level 1), continuing from the previous verse. The Rabshakeh is quoting the king of Assyria (level 2), also continuing from the previous verse. The king is quoting Hezekiah (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or third-level quotations.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 18:30 (#2)

וְאַל־יַבְטַח אֶתְכֶם חִזְקִיָּהוּ אֶל־יְהוָה לֵאמֹר הַצֵּל יַצִּילֵנוּ יְהוָה וְלֹא תִנָּתֵן אֶת־הָעִיר הַזֹּאת בְּיַד מֶלֶךְ אַשּׁוּר

"And do not let Hezekiah make you trust in Yahweh, saying, "Delivering, Yahweh will deliver us, and this city will not be given into the hand of the king of Assyria"

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [The king says that you should not let Hezekiah make you trust in Yahweh by telling you that delivering, Yahweh will deliver all of you, and this city will not be given into the hand of the king of Assyria]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 18:30 (#3)

הַצֵּל יַצִּילֵנוּ יְהוָה

"Delivering, Yahweh will deliver us"

According to the king of Assyria, Hezekiah has been repeating forms of the verb **deliver** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will certainly deliver us]

See: Reduplication

2 Kings 18:30 (#4)

הַצֵּל יַצִּילֵנוּ יְהוָה

"Delivering, Yahweh will deliver us"

By **us**, Hezekiah means to include both himself and those to whom he is speaking, so use the inclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction, here and in verse 32.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

2 Kings 18:30 (#5)

וְלֹא תִנָּתֵן אֶת־הָעִיר הַזֹּאת

"and this city will not be given"

The expression **will not be given** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and he will not give this city]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 18:30 (#6)

בְּיַד

"into the hand of"

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [into the control of]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 18:31 (#1)

אַל־תִּשְׁמְעוּ אֶל־חִזְקִיָּהוּ

"Do not listen to Hezekiah"

To translate the term "listen" here and in the next verse, see how you translated the similar expression in 10:6. Alternate translation: [Do not do what Hezekiah wants you to do here]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 18:31 (#2)

כִּי כֹה אָמַר מֶלֶךְ אַשּׁוּר עֲשׂוּ־אִתִּי בְרָכָה וּצְאוּ אֵלַי וְאִכְלוּ אִישׁ־גַּפְנוֹ וְאִישׁ תְּאֵנָתוֹ וּשְׁתוּ אִישׁ מֵי־בוֹרוֹ

"for thus says the king of Assyria: 'Make a blessing with me, and come out to me, and eat, a man of

his vine and a man of his fig tree, and drink, a man {from} the waters of his well"

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [the king of Assyria is telling you to make a blessing with him and come out to him. Then you will be able to eat, a man of his vine and a man of his fig tree, and drink, a man from the waters of his well]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 18:31 (#3)

עֲשׂוּ־אִתִּי בְרָכָה

"Make a blessing with me"

Here, **a blessing**, meaning a gift, represents "a peace agreement," since in this culture people exchanged gifts when they made peace agreements. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Make a peace agreement with me]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 18:31 (#4)

וְאִכְלוּ אִישׁ־גַּפְנוֹ וְאִישׁ תְּאֵנָתוֹ וּשְׁתוּ אִישׁ מֵי־בוֹרוֹ

"and eat, a man of his vine and a man of his fig tree, and drink, a man {from} the waters of his well"

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:23. Alternate translation: [and let each of you eat from his vine and fig tree, and let each of you drink from the waters of his well]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 18:32 (#1)

עַד־בֹּאִי וְלָקַחְתִּי אֶתְכֶם אֶל־אֶרֶץ כְּאַרְצְכֶם אֶרֶץ דָּגָן וְתִירֹושׁ אֶרֶץ לֶחֶם וּכְרָמִים אֶרֶץ זֵית יִצְהָר וּדְבַשׁ וִחְיוּ וְלֹא תָמֻתוּ וְאַל־תִּשְׁמְעוּ אֶל־חִזְקִיָּהוּ כִּי־יַסִּית אֶתְכֶם לֵאמֹר יְהוָה יַצִּילֵנוּ

"until I come and take you to a land like your land, a land of grain and new wine, a land of bread and vineyards, a land of olive of oil and honey. So live, and do not die. And do not listen to Hezekiah when he misleads you, saying, "Yahweh will deliver us"

There are three levels of quotation here. The author is quoting what the Rabshakeh said (level 1), continuing from the previous verse. The Rabshakeh is quoting the king of Assyria (level 2), also continuing from the previous verse. The king is quoting Hezekiah (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or third-level quotations.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 18:32 (#2)

עַד־בֹּאִי וְלָקַחְתִּי אֶתְכֶם אֶל־אֶרֶץ כְּאַרְצְכֶם אֶרֶץ דָּגָן וְתִירֹושׁ אֶרֶץ לֶחֶם וּכְרָמִים אֶרֶץ זֵית יִצְהָר וּדְבַשׁ וִחְיוּ וְלֹא תָמֻתוּ וְאַל־תִּשְׁמְעוּ אֶל־חִזְקִיָּהוּ כִּי־יַסִּית אֶתְכֶם לֵאמֹר יְהוָה יַצִּילֵנוּ

"until I come and take you to a land like your land, a land of grain and new wine, a land of bread and vineyards, a land of olive of oil and honey. So live, and do not die. And do not listen to Hezekiah when he misleads you, saying, "Yahweh will deliver us"

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [until he comes and takes you to a land like your land, a land of grain and new wine, a land of bread and vineyards, a land of olive of oil and honey. He tells you to live and not die. He says that you should not listen to Hezekiah when he misleads you by telling you that Yahweh will deliver all of you]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 18:32 (#3)

וּכְרָמִים

"and vineyards"

Since the rest of the items on this list are agricultural products, these **vineyards** may represent the products of vineyards. Alternate translation: [and grapes]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 18:32 (#4)

זֵית יִצְהָר

"olive of oil"

The phrase **olive of oil** describes cultivated olives, that is, olives from trees in orchards as opposed to wild olives, which yielded less and worse oil. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [cultivated olives]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 18:33 (#1)

הַהַצֵּל הִצִּילוּ אֱלֹהֵי הַגּוֹיִם אִישׁ אֶת־אַרְצוֹ מִיַּד מֶלֶךְ אַשּׁוּר

“Delivering, did the gods of the nations deliver, a man his land from the hand of the king of Assyria”

The king of Assyria is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [None of the gods of the nations actually delivered the land where people worshiped it from the hand of the king of Assyria!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 18:33 (#2)

הַהַצֵּל הִצִּילוּ אֱלֹהֵי הַגּוֹיִם אִישׁ אֶת־אַרְצוֹ מִיַּד מֶלֶךְ אַשּׁוּר

“Delivering, did the gods of the nations deliver, a man his land from the hand of the king of Assyria”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [The king tells you to consider that none of the gods of the nations has delivered its land from the hand of the king of Assyria]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 18:33 (#3)

הַהַצֵּל הִצִּילוּ אֱלֹהֵי הַגּוֹיִם

“Delivering, did the gods of the nations deliver”

The king is repeating forms of the verb **deliver** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [Did the gods of the nations actually deliver]

See: Reduplication

2 Kings 18:33 (#4)

הִצִּילוּ אֱלֹהֵי הַגּוֹיִם אִישׁ אֶת־אַרְצוֹ

“did the gods of the nations deliver, a man his land”

The king is not suggesting that each of these **gods** is a **man** at best. He is using a common expression of this culture. See how you translated the similar expressions in 3:23 and, in this context, 18:31. Alternate translation: [did the gods of the nations deliver, any of them, its land] or [did any of the gods of the nations deliver its land]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 18:33 (#5)

מִיַּד מֶלֶךְ אַשּׁוּר

“from the hand of the king of Assyria”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [from the power of the king of Assyria and similarly in the next two verses]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 18:33 (#6)

מִיַּד מֶלֶךְ אַשּׁוּר

“from the hand of the king of Assyria”

The king of Assyria is speaking of himself in the third person because he is making a triumphant declaration. (The expression “my hand” in verses 34 and 35 is equivalent in this context.) If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [from my hand]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 18:34 (#1)

אַיֵּה אֱלֹהֵי חֲמָת וְאַרְפָּד אַיֵּה אֱלֹהֵי סְפַרְוַיִם הֵנַע וְעִוָּה כִּי־הִצִּילוּ אֶת־שֹׁמְרוֹן מִיָּדִי

“Where {were} the gods of Hamath and Arpad? Where {were} the gods of Sepharvaim, Hena, and Ivvah? Indeed, did they deliver Samaria from my hand”

The king of Assyria is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate these questions as statements or as exclamations. Alternate translation: [The gods of Hamath and Arpad did nothing to help those people! The gods of Sepharvaim, Hena, and Ivvah did nothing to help those people! Indeed, the gods of Samaria did not deliver it from my hand!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 18:34 (#2)

אַיֵּה אֱלֹהֵי חֲמָת וְאַרְפָּד אַיֵּה אֱלֹהֵי סְפַרְוַיִם הֵנַע וְעִוָּה כִּי־הִצִּילוּ אֶת־שֹׁמְרוֹן מִיָּדִי

“Where {were} the gods of Hamath and Arpad? Where {were} the gods of Sepharvaim, Hena, and Ivvah? Indeed, did they deliver Samaria from my hand”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this

verse. Alternate translation: [The king points out that the gods of Hamath and Arpad did nothing to help those people, and the gods of Sepharvaim, Hena, and Ivvah did nothing to help those people, and in fact the gods of Samaria did not deliver it from his hand]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 18:34 (#3)

הִצִּ֥ילוּ אֶת־שֹׁמְרוֹן

“did they deliver Samaria”

The pronoun **they** does not refer to the gods that the king has just listed. It refers generally back to “the gods of the nations” in the previous verse and specifically to the gods that the people of the kingdom of Israel, called **Samaria** here, were worshiping. Alternate translation: [did the gods of Samaria deliver it]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 18:35 (#1)

מִמֵּ֣י בְכָל־אֱלֹהֵ֣י הָאֲרָצוֹת֮ אֲשֶׁר־הִצִּ֣ילוּ אֶת־אַרְצָם֒ מִיָּדִ֔י כִּֽי־יַצִּ֥יל יְהוָ֖ה אֶת־יְרוּשָׁלַ֑͏ִם מִיָּדִֽי

“Who {are they} among all of the gods of the lands that have delivered their land from my hand, that Yahweh should deliver Jerusalem from my hand”

The king of Assyria is using the question form to emphasize that none of the gods of other nations have been able to rescue their lands from the Assyrian king. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You cannot name any of the gods of the lands that have delivered their land from my hand, so do not believe that Yahweh will deliver Jerusalem from my hand!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 18:35 (#2)

מִמֵּ֣י בְכָל־אֱלֹהֵ֣י הָאֲרָצוֹת֮ אֲשֶׁר־הִצִּ֣ילוּ אֶת־אַרְצָם֒ מִיָּדִ֔י כִּֽי־יַצִּ֥יל יְהוָ֖ה אֶת־יְרוּשָׁלַ֑͏ִם מִיָּדִֽי

“Who {are they} among all of the gods of the lands that have delivered their land from my hand, that Yahweh should deliver Jerusalem from my hand”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there would not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [The king emphasizes that none of the gods of the lands have delivered their lands from his hand, so you should not believe that Yahweh will deliver Jerusalem from his hand]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 18:35 (#3)

אֶת־אַרְצָֽם

“their land”

In this instance, the word **land** is singular in form, but it refers to all of the lands where these **gods** were worshiped. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “land.” Alternate translation: [their lands]

See: Collective Nouns

2 Kings 18:36 (#1)

וְהֶֽחֱרִ֣ישׁוּ הָעָ֗ם וְלֹא־עָנ֥וּ אֹת֛וֹ דָּבָ֖ר כִּי־מִצְוַ֣ת הַמֶּ֑לֶךְ הֵהָ֣יא לֵאמֹ֔ר לֹ֥א תַעֲנֻֽהוּ

“But the people were silent and did not answer him a word, for it {was} a commandment of the king, saying, “You shall not answer him”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [But since it was a commandment of the king, saying, “You shall not answer him,” the people were silent and did not answer him a word]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 18:36 (#2)

וְהֶֽחֱרִ֣ישׁוּ הָעָ֗ם וְלֹא־עָנ֥וּ אֹת֛וֹ דָּבָֽר

“But the people were silent and did not answer him a word”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [But the people said nothing in response to him]

See: Parallelism

2 Kings 18:37 (#1)

וַיָּבֹ֨א & אֶל־חִזְקִיָּ֜הוּ קְרוּעֵ֣י בְגָדִ֗ים

“Then & came to Hezekiah, torn of clothes”

The expression **torn** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [tore their clothes and came to Hezekiah]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 18:37 (#2)

קְרוּעֵי בְגָדִים

"torn of clothes"

See how you indicated the symbolic significance of this action in 2:12.

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings - Chapter 19 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

The story of Hezekiah continues in this chapter. He is one of the great kings of Judah, so the author is describing his reign in detail.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did Sennacherib's sons kill him?

The author reports in 19:37 that after Sennacherib returned to Nineveh, while he was worshiping in the temple of the Assyrian god Nisrok, Adrammelek and Sharezer, two of his sons, assassinated him. They did that because of a bitter conflict over who would succeed him as king, as ancient Assyrian sources report. The crown prince Assur-nadin-shumi died, and Sennacherib at first named Adrammelech his heir. But later he replaced him with Esarhaddon, a younger son, for reasons that the sources do not specify. This made Adrammelek very angry, but Sennacherib refused to reinstate him. So he conspired with his brother Sharezer to assassinate their father. They had hoped to seize power for themselves, but they had to flee, and Esarhaddon became the next king.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

As in chapter 18, there are two long quotations in this chapter that contain multiple levels of quotation. They are in verses 10–13 and 20–34. Notes describe ways of indicating the speakers throughout these quotations. See what you did in the case of the quotations in the previous chapter, and present these quotations in the same way.

Images in the king of Assyria's boast

In 19:23, Yahweh uses vivid imagery to depict how the Assyrian king has been boasting of his military conquests. Here is an explanation of the various images that he uses.

- As Yahweh quotes him, Assyrian king is speaking as if he had actually gone up the highest and most remote mountains of **Lebanon** and cut down its tallest and most valuable trees.
- He is using **Lebanon** to represent the entire geographical area of which Israel is a part.
- He is using the giant **trees** that grow in Lebanon to represent huge, strong entities, so that his boast to have cut them down means that he has defeated powerful foes.
- By **the lodging place of its end**, he means the place where his army would stop at the end of a successful campaign to conquer the whole country, that is, Jerusalem. (The author says in 18:13 that Sennacherib sought first to conquer all of the other fortified cities in Judah, and then he attacked Jerusalem.)
- By **the forest of its garden** (that is, its forest that is like a garden), he means the place where the forest has been most transformed by cultivation into a park for human recreation and enjoyment. This seems to represent the grounds of the royal palace and temple, particularly in light of how extensively cedar and cypress wood was used in the construction of those buildings.

Consider how best to represent these images in your translation. A note to this verse suggests one possible way to do that.

2 Kings 19:1 (#1)

וַיְקָרַע אֶת־בְּגָדָיו וַיִּתְכַּס בַּשָּׂק

"that he tore his clothes, and he covered himself with sackcloth"

See how you indicated in 6:30 the symbolic significance of the actions of tearing one's **clothes** and wearing **sackcloth**.

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 19:1 (#2)

בֵּית יְהוָה

"into} the house of Yahweh"

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:18. Alternate translation: [into the temple of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 19:3 (#1)

כֹּה אָמַר חִזְקִיָּהוּ יוֹם־צָרָה וְתוֹכֵחָה וּנְאָצָה הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה כִּי בָאוּ בָנִים עַד־מַשְׁבֵּר וְכֹחַ אַיִן לְיֹלֵדָה

“Thus says Hezekiah, ‘This day {is} a day of trouble and chastisement and reproach, for sons have come to the birth canal, but {there is} no strength to give birth”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Hezekiah says that this day is a day of trouble and chastisement and reproach, for sons have come to the birth canal, but there is no strength to give birth]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 19:3 (#2)

בָּאוּ בָנִים עַד־מַשְׁבֵּר וְכֹחַ אַיִן לְיֹלֵדָה

“sons have come to the birth canal, but {there is} no strength to give birth”

Hezekiah is using or inventing a proverb in order to illustrate that the Judeans are in a life-and-death situation, but they do not have the resources to rescue themselves from it. Translate this proverb in a way that will be recognized as a proverb and be meaningful in your language and culture.

See: Proverbs

2 Kings 19:4 (#1)

אוּלַי יִשְׁמַע יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“Perhaps Yahweh your God will have heard”

If you decided in the previous verse to translate this quotation in such a way that there would not be a quotation within a quotation, you can continue doing that here. In many languages it will not be necessary to make significant alterations. Alternate translation: [Hezekiah says that perhaps Yahweh your God will have heard]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 19:4 (#2)

אֵת ׀ כָּל־דִּבְרֵי רַב־שָׁקֵה

“all of the words of the Rabshakeh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:7. Alternate translation: [everything that the Rabshakeh said]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 19:4 (#3)

וְהוֹכִיחַ בַּדְּבָרִים אֲשֶׁר שָׁמַע יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“and he will chastise the words that Yahweh your God has heard”

Since the author has already used the name Yahweh earlier in this sentence, it may be more natural in your language to use a pronoun here. Alternate translation: [and he will chastise the words that he has heard]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 19:4 (#4)

וְהוֹכִיחַ בַּדְּבָרִים אֲשֶׁר שָׁמַע יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“and he will chastise the words that Yahweh your God has heard”

The messengers are using the **words** that the Rabshakeh spoke to represent the Rabshakeh himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and he will chastise him for what he heard him say]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 19:4 (#5)

הַשְּׁאֵרִית הַנִּמְצָאָה

“the remnant {that is} found”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:18. Alternate translation: [the remnant of Judeans who still survive]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 19:4 (#6)

וְנָשָׂאתָ תְפִלָּה

“And may you lift up a prayer”

The messengers are speaking as if a **prayer** were something that Isaiah could physically **lift up**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And may you say a prayer]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 19:5 (#1)

וַיָּבֹאוּ עַבְדֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ חִזְקִיָּהוּ אֶל־יְשַׁעְיָהוּ

“And the servants of King Hezekiah came to Isaiah”

In this verse, the author is describing an event after describing in the previous two verses an event that

followed it. If it would be helpful your language, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. You could do that by putting this sentence at the start of verse 3. You could also translate this verse in such a way as to show that this event preceded the events of the previous two verses and begin verse 6 with "then." Alternate translation: [And when the servants of King Hezekiah had come to Isaiah]

See: Order of Events

2 Kings 19:6 (#1)

וַיֹּ֤אמֶר לָהֶם֙ יְשַׁעְיָ֔הוּ כֹּ֥ה תֹאמְר֖וּן אֶל־אֲדֹנֵיכֶ֑ם כֹּ֣ה ׀ אָמַ֣ר יְהוָ֗ה אַל־תִּירָא֙ מִפְּנֵי֙ הַדְּבָרִ֔ים אֲשֶׁ֥ר שָׁמַ֖עְתָּ אֲשֶׁ֣ר גִּדְּפ֗וּ נַעֲרֵ֛י מֶֽלֶךְ־אַשּׁ֥וּר אֹתִֽי

"and Isaiah said to them, "Thus you shall say to your master, 'Thus says Yahweh, "Do not be afraid from the face of the words that you have heard, {by} which the servants of the king of Assyria have blasphemed me"

There are three levels of quotation in this verse. The author is quoting what **Isaiah** said (level 1). Isaiah tells Hezekiah's officials what he wants them to say to their **master** Hezekiah (level 2). This includes a quotation from **Yahweh** (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation, here and at the end of the next verse. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or third-level quotations.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 19:6 (#2)

וַיֹּ֤אמֶר לָהֶם֙ יְשַׁעְיָ֔הוּ כֹּ֥ה תֹאמְר֖וּן אֶל־אֲדֹנֵיכֶ֑ם כֹּ֣ה ׀ אָמַ֣ר יְהוָ֗ה אַל־תִּירָא֙ מִפְּנֵי֙ הַדְּבָרִ֔ים אֲשֶׁ֥ר שָׁמַ֖עְתָּ אֲשֶׁ֣ר גִּדְּפ֗וּ נַעֲרֵ֛י מֶֽלֶךְ־אַשּׁ֥וּר אֹתִֽי

"and Isaiah said to them, "Thus you shall say to your master, 'Thus says Yahweh, "Do not be afraid from the face of the words that you have heard, {by} which the servants of the king of Assyria have blasphemed me"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and Isaiah told them to tell Hezekiah that Yahweh said he should not be afraid from the face of the words that he had heard, by which the servants of the king of Assyria had blasphemed him]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 19:6 (#3)

מִפְּנֵי

"from the face of"

See how you translated the similar expression in 16:3. Alternate translation: [on account of]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 19:6 (#4)

נַעֲרֵ֛י מֶֽלֶךְ־אַשּׁ֥וּר

"the servants of the king of Assyria"

Isaiah uses a specific word for **servants** that in other contexts can mean a "young man" or "boy." While Hezekiah told his officials to refer to the Rabshakeh by his official title, Isaiah is belittling the Assyrian officials. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [the lackeys of the king of Assyria]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 19:7 (#1)

הִנְנִ֥י נֹתֵ֛ן בּ֖וֹ ר֑וּחַ וְשָׁמַ֤ע שְׁמוּעָה֙ וְשָׁ֣ב לְאַרְצ֔וֹ וְהִפַּלְתִּ֥יו בַּחֶ֖רֶב בְּאַרְצֽוֹ

"Behold me, putting a spirit in him, and he will hear a report, and he will return to his land, and I will make him fall by the sword in his land"

If you decided in the previous verse to translate this quotation in such a way that there would not be quotations within a quotations, you can continue doing that here. Alternate translation: [Tell Hezekiah that Yahweh says that he is about to put a spirit on the king of Assyria, and he will hear a report, and he will return to his land, and Yahweh will make him fall by the sword in his land]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 19:7 (#2)

הִנְנִ֥י נֹתֵ֛ן

"Behold me, putting"

Yahweh is using a common expression of this culture, **behold me**, to indicate that he is about to do something. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 2 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 2 Samuel 12:11. Alternate translation: [I am about to put]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 19:8 (#1)

וַיִּמְצָא֙ אֶת־מֶ֣לֶךְ אַשּׁ֔וּר נִלְחָ֖ם עַל־לִבְנָ֑ה כִּ֚י שָׁמַ֣ע כִּֽי־נָסַ֔ע מִלָּכִֽישׁ

“and he found the king of Assyria fighting against Libnah, for he had heard that he had departed from Lachish”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [and since he had heard that the king of Assyria had departed from Lachish, he found him fighting against Libnah]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 19:8 (#2)

וַיִּמְצָא֙

“and he found”

The author does not mean that the Rabshakeh had to look for the **king of Assyria** and that he **found him** at **Libnah**. He means that he met him there. See how you translated the similar expression in 9:21. Alternate translation: [and he met]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 19:8 (#3)

שָׁמַ֣ע כִּֽי־נָסַ֔ע מִלָּכִֽישׁ

“he had heard that he had departed from Lachish”

The pronoun **he** refers in the first instance to **the Rabshakeh**, and it refers in the second instance to **the king of Assyria**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the Rabshakeh had heard that the king had departed from Lachish]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 19:9 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁמַ֖ע

“Then he heard”

The pronoun **he** refers to the king of Assyria. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Then the king of Assyria heard]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 19:9 (#2)

הִנֵּ֥ה

“Behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:9.

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 19:9 (#3)

וַיָּ֤שָׁב וַיִּשְׁלַ֨ח

“And he returned and sent”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:11. Alternate translation: [And once again he sent]

See: Hendiadys

2 Kings 19:10 (#1)

כֹּ֣ה תֹאמְר֗וּן אֶל־חִזְקִיָּ֤הוּ מֶֽלֶךְ־יְהוּדָה֙ לֵאמֹ֔ר אַל־יַשִּׂאֲךָ֥ אֱלֹהֶ֖יךָ אֲשֶׁ֣ר אַתָּ֣ה בֹטֵ֣חַ בּ֑וֹ לֵאמֹ֗ר לֹ֤א תִנָּתֵן֙ יְרוּשָׁלַ֔͏ִם בְּיַ֖ד מֶ֥לֶךְ אַשּֽׁוּר

“Thus you shall say to Hezekiah, the king of Judah, saying, ‘Do not let your God, in whom you are trusting, deceive you, saying, “Jerusalem will not be given into the hand of the king of Assyria”

See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of the long quotation in verses 10–13. There are three levels of quotation in this verse. The author is quoting what the king of Assyria said to his messengers (level 1). The king is telling his messengers what he wants them to say to Hezekiah (level 2). This includes a quotation of something that the Assyrian king believes Yahweh is telling Hezekiah (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or third-level quotations.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 19:10 (#2)

כֹּ֣ה תֹאמְר֗וּן אֶל־חִזְקִיָּ֤הוּ מֶֽלֶךְ־יְהוּדָה֙ לֵאמֹ֔ר אַל־יַשִּׂאֲךָ֥ אֱלֹהֶ֖יךָ אֲשֶׁ֣ר אַתָּ֣ה בֹטֵ֣חַ בּ֑וֹ לֵאמֹ֗ר לֹ֤א תִנָּתֵן֙ יְרוּשָׁלַ֔͏ִם בְּיַ֖ד מֶ֥לֶךְ אַשּֽׁוּר

“Thus you shall say to Hezekiah, the king of Judah, saying, ‘Do not let your God, in whom you are trusting, deceive you, saying, “Jerusalem will not be given into the hand of the king of Assyria”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there are not quotations within a quotations. Alternate translation: [Tell Hezekiah, the king of Judah, that he should not let his God, in whom he is trusting, deceive him by telling him that Jerusalem will not be given into my hand]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 19:10 (#3)

לֹ֣א תִנָּתֵ֗ן יְרֽוּשָׁלַ֙͏ִם֙ בְּיַ֣ד מֶֽלֶךְ־אַשּׁ֔וּר

“Jerusalem will not be given into the hand of the king of Assyria”

See how you translated the similar expression in 18:30. Alternate translation: [I will not give Jerusalem into the control of the king of Assyria] or [I will not allow the king of Assyria to conquer Jerusalem]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 19:11 (#1)

הִנֵּ֣ה ׀ אַתָּ֣ה שָׁמַ֗עְתָּ אֵ֚ת אֲשֶׁ֣ר עָשׂ֔וּ מַלְכֵ֥י אַשּׁ֖וּר לְכָל־הָאֲרָצ֣וֹת לְהַחֲרִ֣ימָ֔ם וְאַתָּ֖ה תִּנָּצֵֽל

“Behold, you, you have heard what the kings of Assyria have done to all of the lands by destroying them. So you, will you be delivered”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [Remind him that he has personally heard what the kings of Assyria have done to all of the lands by destroying them. Tell him there is no reason why he should expect that, by contrast, his God will deliver him]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 19:11 (#2)

אַתָּ֣ה שָׁמַ֗עְתָּ

“you, you have heard”

See how you translated the similar expression “you, you know” in 4:1. Alternate translation: [you have heard personally]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 19:11 (#3)

לְכָל־הָאֲרָצ֣וֹת

“to all of the lands”

The king is saying **all** as an overstatement for emphasis. He is referring specifically to **to all of the lands** that the Assyrians have so far invaded. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [to every single one of the lands they have attacked]

See: Hyperbole

2 Kings 19:11 (#4)

וְאַתָּ֣ה תִנָּצֵֽל

“So you, will you be delivered”

See how you translated the expression “he, he came” in 5:25, which emphasizes a contrast as the expression here does. Alternate translation: [So will you, by contrast, be delivered] or [So for your part, will you be delivered]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 19:11 (#5)

וְאַתָּ֣ה תִנָּצֵֽל

“So you, will you be delivered”

The expression **will you be delivered** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [So, by contrast, will Yahweh deliver you]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 19:11 (#6)

וְאַתָּ֣ה תִנָּצֵֽל

“So you, will you be delivered”

The king of Assyria is using the question form to emphasize that de does not believe that Yahweh will deliver Hezekiah. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [So do not think that you will be delivered] or [So do not think that Yahweh will deliver you]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 19:12 (#1)

הַהִצִּ֣ילוּ אֹתָ֗ם אֱלֹהֵי֙ הַגּוֹיִ֔ם אֲשֶׁ֥ר שִׁחֲתוּ֙ אֲבוֹתָ֔י אֶת־גּוֹזָ֖ן וְאֶת־חָרָ֑ן וְרֶ֙צֶף֙ וּבְנֵי־עֶ֔דֶן אֲשֶׁ֖ר בִּתְלַאשָּֽׂר

“Did the gods of the nations that my fathers destroyed deliver them, Gozan or Haran or Rezeph or the sons of Eden who {were} in Tel Assar”

The Assyrian king is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [The gods of the nations that my fathers destroyed, Gozan and Haran and Rezeph and the sons of Eden who were in Tel Assar, did not deliver any of them!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 19:12 (#2)

הַהִצִּילוּ אֹתָם אֱלֹהֵי הַגּוֹיִם אֲשֶׁר שִׁחֲתוּ אֲבוֹתָי אֶת־גּוֹזָן וְאֶת־חָרָן וְרֶצֶף וּבְנֵי־עֵדֶן אֲשֶׁר בִּתְלַאשָּׁר

“Did the gods of the nations that my fathers destroyed deliver them, Gozan or Haran or Rezeph or the sons of Eden who {were} in Tel Assar”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [Remind Hezekiah that the gods of the nations that my fathers destroyed did not deliver them, Gozan and Haran and Rezeph and the sons of Eden who were in Tel Assar.]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 19:12 (#3)

אֲבוֹתָי

“my fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [my ancestors]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 19:12 (#4)

וּבְנֵי־עֵדֶן

“or the sons of Eden”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:12. Alternate translation: [the Edenites]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 19:13 (#1)

אַיֵּיוֹ מֶלֶךְ־חֲמָתוֹ וּמֶלֶךְ אַרְפָּד וּמֶלֶךְ לְעִיר סְפַרְוַיִם הֵנַע וְעִוָּה

“Where {is} the king of Hamath or the king of Arpad or the king of the city of Sepharvaim, Hena, or Ivvah”

The king of Assyria is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [The kings of Hamath and Arpad and of the cities of Sepharvaim, Hena, and Ivvah are all gone!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 19:13 (#2)

אַיֵּיוֹ מֶלֶךְ־חֲמָתוֹ וּמֶלֶךְ אַרְפָּד וּמֶלֶךְ לְעִיר סְפַרְוַיִם הֵנַע וְעִוָּה

“Where {is} the king of Hamath or the king of Arpad or the king of the city of Sepharvaim, Hena, or Ivvah”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [Remind Hezekiah that Assyrians defeated the kings of Hamath and Arpad and of the cities of Sepharvaim, Hena, and Ivvah, so all those kings no longer rule.]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 19:13 (#3)

וּמֶלֶךְ לְעִיר סְפַרְוַיִם הֵנַע וְעִוָּה

“or the king of the city of Sepharvaim, Hena, or Ivvah”

In this expression, the words **king** and **city** are singular in form, but they refer to the kings of all three of the cities listed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. Alternate translation: [or the kings of the cities of Sepharvaim, Hena, or Ivvah]

See: Collective Nouns

2 Kings 19:14 (#1)

וַיְקַבֵּל חִזְקִיָּהוּ אֶת־הַסְּפָרִים מִיַּד הַמַּלְאָכִים וַיִּקְרָאֵם

“And Hezekiah took the writings from the hand of the messengers, and he read them”

While the term **writings** and the pronoun **them** are plural, the author’s use of the singular pronoun **it** in the next sentence shows that Hezekiah received one letter from the king of Assyria. (His messengers apparently read the contents of this letter out loud to Hezekiah and then gave him the written copy of the message for confirmation.) So in this context, the term **writings** has the sense of “the things that the king had written.” You could indicate that explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. You could also use singular forms instead of plural ones. Alternate translation: [Then the messengers handed Hezekiah a copy of what they had said, and he read the things that the king had written] or [Then Hezekiah took the letter from the hand of the messengers, and he read it]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

2 Kings 19:14 (#2)

וַיַּ֥עַל

“And he went up”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [And he went]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 19:14 (#3)

וַיִּפְרְשֵׂ֥הוּ חִזְקִיָּ֖הוּ לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָֽה

“and Hezekiah spread it out to the face of Yahweh”

When Hezekiah **spread** the letter **out** (unrolled the scroll on which it was written) so that the contents were visible to Yahweh, this was a symbolic action by which he was asking for help by calling Yahweh’s attention to what Sennacherib had written, specifically the claim that Yahweh was no different from the gods of other nations. (Hezekiah did not believe that Yahweh would not know what was in the letter if he did not unroll the scroll. Sennacherib’s messengers had stated the contents out loud before giving him this written version.) If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and Hezekiah spread it out before Yahweh as an appeal for help]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 19:14 (#4)

לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָֽה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:12. Alternate translation: [in front of Yahweh] or [where Yahweh could see it]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 19:15 (#1)

לִפְנֵ֣י יְהוָ֑ה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:14. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 19:15 (#2)

וַיֹּאמַ֖ר

“and said”

See how you decided at 1:10 to represent the phrase **and said** when it introduces a direct quotation.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

2 Kings 19:15 (#3)

אַתָּ֥ה עָשִׂ֛יתָ

“You, you made”

See how you translated the similar expression “He, he built up” in 14:22. Alternate translation: [You are the one who made]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 19:16 (#1)

הַטֵּ֥ה & אָזְנְךָ֖

“Incline your ear”

Hezekiah is speaking as if he wants Yahweh physically to **Incline** his **ear**, that is, to lean over the way someone would do to listen to someone who was located below him, such as a supplicant who was kneeling in front of him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Listen carefully]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 19:16 (#2)

שָׁלְחוֹ

“he has sent it”

The pronoun **it** refers to the message from the king of Assyria. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [he has sent this message]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 19:17 (#1)

וְאֶת־אַרְצָֽם

“and their land”

In this verse, the word **land** is singular in form, but it refers to all of the lands of these **nations** as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “land.” Alternate translation: [and their lands]

See: Collective Nouns

2 Kings 19:18 (#1)

וְנָתְנ֣וּ אֶת־אֱלֹהֵיהֶ֣ם בָּאֵ֣שׁ כִּ֣י ׀ לֹ֣א אֱלֹהִ֣ים הֵ֣מָּה כִּ֚י אִם־מַעֲשֵׂ֣ה יְדֵי־אָדָ֔ם עֵ֥ץ וָאֶ֖בֶן וַיְאַבְּדֽוּם

“And they have put their gods in the fire, for they {are} not gods, but rather the work of the hands of man, wood and stone, and they have destroyed them”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And since their gods are not gods, but rather the work of the hands of man, wood and stone, they have put them in the fire and destroyed them]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 19:18 (#2)

מַעֲשֵׂי יְדֵי־אָדָם

“the work of the hands of man”

Hezekiah is using one part of people, their **hands**, to mean all of them in the act of making **gods** out of **wood** and **stone**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the work of craftsmen]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 19:19 (#1)

וְעַתָּה

“And now”

See how you translated the same expression in 3:23.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 19:19 (#2)

מִיָּדוֹ

“from his hand”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [from his power]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 19:20 (#1)

לֵאמֹר כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֲשֶׁר הִתְפַּלַּלְתָּ אֵלַי אֶל־סַנְחֵרִב מֶלֶךְ־אַשּׁוּר שָׁמָעְתִּי

“saying, “Thus says Yahweh, the God of Israel, ‘What you have prayed to me about Sennacherib, the king of Assyria, I have heard”

See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of the long quotation in verses 20–34, in which there are multiple levels of quotation. If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this verse so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [telling him that Yahweh, the God of Israel, said that he had heard what he had prayed to him about Sennacherib, the king of Assyria]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 19:20 (#2)

שָׁמָעְתִּי

“I have heard”

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:6. Alternate translation: [I will do]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 19:21 (#1)

זֶה הַדָּבָר אֲשֶׁר־דִּבֶּר יְהוָה עָלָיו בָּזְתָה לְךָ לָעֲגָה לְךָ בְּתוּלַת בַּת־צִיּוֹן אַחֲרֶיךָ רֹאשׁ הֵנִיעָה בַּת יְרוּשָׁלָם

“This {is} the word that Yahweh has spoken about him. ‘The virgin, the daughter of Zion, despises you, she derides you. The daughter of Jerusalem shakes a head after you”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [This {is} the word that Yahweh has spoken about him. He says that the virgin, the daughter of Zion, despises him, she derides him. The daughter of Jerusalem shakes a head after him]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 19:21 (#2)

בָּזְתָה לְךָ לָעֲגָה לְךָ בְּתוּלַת בַּת־צִיּוֹן אַחֲרֶיךָ רֹאשׁ הֵנִיעָה בַּת יְרוּשָׁלָם

“The virgin, the daughter of Zion, despises you, she derides you. The daughter of Jerusalem shakes a head after you”

Isaiah is speaking as if the city of **Jerusalem** were actually a mother and its inhabitants were her **daughter**. (In the first instance of this image, he uses the term **Zion**, the mountain on which the city was located, to represent the city itself.) If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The people of Jerusalem despise you, they deride you. The people of Jerusalem shake their heads after you]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 19:21 (#3)

בָּזְתָה לְּךָ לָעֲגָה בְּתוּלַת בַּת־צִיּוֹן אַחֲרֶיךָ רֹאשׁ הֵנִיעָה בַּת יְרוּשָׁלָ͏ִם

“The virgin, the daughter of Zion, despises you, she derides you. The daughter of Jerusalem shakes a head after you”

Isaiah is using the present tense to describe something that is going to happen in the future in order to show that it will certainly happen and that it will happen soon. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [The people of Jerusalem will despise you, they will deride you. The people of Jerusalem will shake their heads after you]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

2 Kings 19:21 (#4)

בָּזְתָה לְּךָ לָעֲגָה בְּתוּלַת בַּת־צִיּוֹן אַחֲרֶיךָ רֹאשׁ הֵנִיעָה בַּת יְרוּשָׁלָ͏ִם

“The virgin, the daughter of Zion, despises you, she derides you. The daughter of Jerusalem shakes a head after you”

Yahweh, speaking through Isaiah, is speaking to someone whom he knows cannot hear him, the king of Assyria. He is doing this to communicate to Hezekiah that he feels very strongly about that king’s arrogance and mockery. If it would be helpful in your language, here and through verse 28, you could translate these words as if Yahweh were speaking directly to Hezekiah about the king of Assyria. Alternate translation: [The virgin, the daughter of Zion, despises him, she derides him. The daughter of Jerusalem shakes her head after him] or [The people of Jerusalem will despise him, they will deride him. The people of Jerusalem will shake their heads after him]

See: Apostrophe

2 Kings 19:21 (#5)

אַחֲרֶיךָ רֹאשׁ הֵנִיעָה בַּת יְרוּשָׁלָ͏ִם

“The daughter of Jerusalem shakes a head after you”

In this culture, shaking or wagging one’s head at a person was a symbolic action by which people showed contempt and expressed mockery toward that person. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [The daughter will shake her head disdainfully and mockingly after you]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 19:21 (#6)

אַחֲרֶיךָ

“after you”

Isaiah assumes that his listeners will know that by **after you**, he means that the Assyrians will flee from Jerusalem and that the people of the city will make this gesture at them as they run away. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [at you as you flee] or [at him as he flees]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 19:22 (#1)

אֶת־מִמִּי חֵרַפְתָּ וְגִדַּפְתָּ וְעַל־מִמִּי הֵרַמְתָּ קוֹל וַתִּשָּׂא מָרוֹם עֵינֶיךָ עַל־קְדוֹשׁ יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Whom have you mocked and taunted? And against whom have you raised a voice and lifted your eyes upward? Against the Holy {One} of Israel”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [Yahweh asks him whom he has mocked and taunted. Yahweh asks him against whom he has raised a voice and lifted his eyes upward. The answer is that he has done that against him, the Holy One of Israel!]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 19:22 (#2)

אֶת־מִמִּי חֵרַפְתָּ וְגִדַּפְתָּ וְעַל־מִמִּי הֵרַמְתָּ קוֹל וַתִּשָּׂא מָרוֹם עֵינֶיךָ

“Whom have you mocked and taunted? And against whom have you raised a voice and lifted your eyes upward”

Yahweh is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate these questions as statements or as exclamations. Alternate translation: [You must realize whom have you mocked and taunted! You must realize against whom have you raised a voice and lifted your eyes upward!]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 19:22 (#3)

וַתִּשָּׂא מָרוֹם עֵינֶיךָ

“and lifted your eyes upward”

The action of **lifting** his **eyes upward** was a symbolic action by which the king of Assyria showed arrogance and defiance toward Yahweh. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and arrogantly lifted your eyes upward] or [and defiantly lifted your eyes upward]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 19:22 (#4)

קְדֹושׁ יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the Holy {One} of Israel”

Yahweh is using this possessive form to describe the holy God with whom the Israelites are in a covenant relationship. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the holy God with whom you Israelites are in a covenant relationship]

See: Possession

2 Kings 19:23 (#1)

בְּיַד מַלְאָכֶיךָ חֵרַפְתָּ ׀ אֲדֹנָי וַתֹּאמֶר ברכב רִכְבִּבְיַ אֲנִי עָלִיתִי מְרֹום הָרִים יַרְכְּתֵי לְבָנֹון וְאֶכְרֹת קוֹמַת אֲרָזָיו מִבְחַר בְּרֹשָׁיו וְאָבֹואָה מְלֹון קִצֹּה יַעַר כַּרְמְלֹו

“By the hand of your messengers you mocked the Lord and said, “With the multitude of my chariotry, I, I went up {to} the height of the mountains, the recesses of Lebanon. And I cut down the heights of its cedars, the choicest of its cypress trees, that I might enter the lodging place of its end, the forest of its garden”

There are three levels of quotation here. The author is quoting what Isaiah told Hezekiah in his message (level 1), continuing from the previous verses. This includes what, according to Isaiah, Yahweh was saying to Hezekiah, also continuing from the previous verse (level 2). This includes a quotation from the king of Assyria (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or third-level quotations.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 19:23 (#2)

בְּיַד מַלְאָכֶיךָ חֵרַפְתָּ ׀ אֲדֹנָי וַתֹּאמֶר ברכב רִכְבִּבְיַ אֲנִי עָלִיתִי מְרֹום הָרִים יַרְכְּתֵי לְבָנֹון וְאֶכְרֹת קוֹמַת אֲרָזָיו מִבְחַר בְּרֹשָׁיו וְאָבֹואָה מְלֹון קִצֹּה יַעַר כַּרְמְלֹו

“By the hand of your messengers you mocked the Lord and said, “With the multitude of my chariotry, I, I went up {to} the height of the mountains, the recesses of Lebanon. And I cut down the heights of its cedars, the choicest of its cypress trees, that I might enter the lodging place of its end, the forest of its garden”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that by the hand of his messengers he mocked him and said boastfully that with the multitude of his chariotry, he went up to the height of the mountains, the recesses of Lebanon. He boasted that he cut down the heights of its cedars, the choicest of its cypress trees, that he might enter the lodging place of its end, the forest of its orchard]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 19:23 (#3)

ברכב רִכְבִּבְיַ אֲנִי עָלִיתִי מְרֹום הָרִים יַרְכְּתֵי לְבָנֹון וְאֶכְרֹת קוֹמַת אֲרָזָיו מִבְחַר בְּרֹשָׁיו וְאָבֹואָה מְלֹון קִצֹּה יַעַר כַּרְמְלֹו

“With the multitude of my chariotry, I, I went up {to} the height of the mountains, the recesses of Lebanon. And I cut down the heights of its cedars, the choicest of its cypress trees, that I might enter the lodging place of its end, the forest of its garden”

See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of the elaborate comparison that the Assyrian king is drawing in this verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I commanded my chariot forces and invaded this land, even though it was remote from me and secure. I defeated the most powerful and skillful opponents. Now I am going to enter Jerusalem and capture the royal palace and temple]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 19:23 (#4)

בְּיַד מַלְאָכֶיךָ

“By the hand of your messengers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:36. Alternate translation: [Through the agency of your messengers]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 19:23 (#5)

וַתֹּ֣אמֶר ברכב רִכְבִּ֔י אֲנִ֖י עָלִ֣יתִי

“and said, “With the multitude of my chariotry, I, I went up”

The Assyrian king is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I went up** already includes this meaning. He is doing that because he is boasting. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [and said boastfully, “With the multitude of my chariotry, I went up]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 19:24 (#1)

אֲנִ֣י קַרְתִּ֔י וְשָׁתִ֖יתִי מַ֣יִם זָרִ֑ים וְאַחֲרֵ֤ב בְּכַף־פְּעָמַי֙ כֹּ֚ל יְאֹרֵ֣י מָצֽוֹר

“I, I dug, and I drank foreign waters. And with the sole of my feet I will dry up all of the streams of Matsor”

This verse is the conclusion of the third-level quotation that begins in the previous verse. If you have decided to use punctuation to mark levels of quotation, end this verse with the appropriate punctuation for closing a third-level quotation.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 19:24 (#2)

אֲנִ֣י קַרְתִּ֔י וְשָׁתִ֖יתִי מַ֣יִם זָרִ֑ים וְאַחֲרֵ֤ב בְּכַף־פְּעָמַי֙ כֹּ֚ל יְאֹרֵ֣י מָצֽוֹר

“I, I dug, and I drank foreign waters. And with the sole of my feet I will dry up all of the streams of Matsor”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that the Assyrian king has boasted that he has dug wells and drunk foreign waters. He has also boasted that he will dry up all of the streams of Matsor with the sole of his feet]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 19:24 (#3)

אֲנִ֣י קַרְתִּ֔י וְשָׁתִ֖יתִי מַ֣יִם זָרִ֑ים

“I, I dug, and I drank foreign waters”

The Assyrian king is stating the pronoun **I** explicitly, even though the verb translated as **I dug** already includes this meaning, because he is boasting. See how you translated the similar expression in the previous verse.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 19:24 (#4)

אֲנִ֣י קַרְתִּ֔י וְשָׁתִ֖יתִי מַ֣יִם זָרִ֑ים

“I, I dug, and I drank foreign waters”

The Assyrian king could be saying: (1) that he was able to dig wells and drink water from them in **foreign** countries. This would be a boast that his armies could successfully traverse arid, desolate areas. (Compare how the Israelite army and its allies nearly perished of thirst in 3:9–10.) Alternate translation: [I have wells in foreign countries and drank water from them] or (2) that he was able to dig wells and find water in places where no one suspected it would be. This might be a taunt at Hezekiah, who, according to 2 Chronicles 32:3–4, tried to eliminate the supply of water around the city of Jerusalem to thwart the Assyrians. Alternate translation: [I have been able to dig wells and find water in places my enemies did not expect]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 19:24 (#5)

וְאַחֲרֵ֤ב בְּכַף־פְּעָמַי֙ כֹּ֚ל יְאֹרֵ֣י מָצֽוֹר

“And with the sole of my feet I will dry up all of the streams of Matsor”

The word **Matsor** is another name for Egypt. (The word is related to the word for “border.” Egypt was considered the border of Israel.) Alternate translation: [And with the sole of my feet I will dry up all of the streams of Egypt]

See: How to Translate Names

2 Kings 19:24 (#6)

וְאַחֲרֵ֤ב בְּכַף־פְּעָמַי֙ כֹּ֚ל יְאֹרֵ֣י מָצֽוֹר

“And with the sole of my feet I will dry up all of the streams of Matsor”

In this verse, the word **sole** is singular in form, but the king is using it to refer to both of his feet. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural or dual form of “sole.” Alternate translation: [And with the soles of my feet I will dry up all of the streams of Egypt]

See: Collective Nouns

2 Kings 19:24 (#7)

וְאַחֲרֵבֹ֥ת בְּכַף־פְּעָמַ֖י כֹּ֣ל יְאֹרֵ֥י מָצֽוֹר

“And with the sole of my feet I will dry up all of the streams of Matsor”

The king is speaking as if he could actually **dry up all the streams of** Egypt with the soles of his **feet**, the way a person could stamp out a small puddle. The **streams** of Egypt, meaning the Nile and its tributary, represent something formidable, like the giant trees of Lebanon in the previous verse. The king is boasting that after conquering Jerusalem, he will conquer the Egyptian empire without great effort. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And next I will conquer Egypt without great effort]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 19:25 (#1)

הֲלֹ֣א־שָׁמַ֔עְתָּ לְמֶרָח֖וֹק אֹתָ֣הּ עָשִׂ֑יתִי לְמִֽימֵי־קֶ֙דֶם֙ וְיֹצַרְתִּ֣יהָ עַתָּ֔ה הֱיֹתָ֗ה לְהַשִּׁ֛ות גַּלִּ֥ים נְצֻר֖וֹת עָרֵ֥י בְצֻרֽוֹת

“Have you not heard? From long ago, I did it; from days of antiquity, I formed it. Now I have brought it, that you should be for devastating fortified cities {into} ruined heaps”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that the Assyrian king must surely have heard that from long ago, he did it, that from days of antiquity, he formed it. Now Yahweh has brought it, that the king should be for devastating fortified cities into ruined heaps]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 19:25 (#2)

הֲלֹ֣א־שָׁמַ֔עְתָּ לְמֶרָח֖וֹק אֹתָ֣הּ עָשִׂ֑יתִי לְמִֽימֵי־קֶ֙דֶם֙ וְיֹצַרְתִּ֣יהָ

“Have you not heard? From long ago, I did it; from days of antiquity, I formed it”

Yahweh is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Surely you must have heard that from long ago, I did it, that from days of antiquity, I formed it]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 19:25 (#3)

לְמֶרָח֖וֹק אֹתָ֣הּ עָשִׂ֑יתִי לְמִֽימֵי־קֶ֙דֶם֙ וְיֹצַרְתִּ֣יהָ

“From long ago, I did it; from days of antiquity, I formed it”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [I decided a long time ago that this would happen]

See: Parallelism

2 Kings 19:25 (#4)

לְמִֽימֵי־קֶ֙דֶם֙

“from days of antiquity”

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:36. Alternate translation: [from ancient times]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 19:25 (#5)

גַּלִּ֥ים נְצֻר֖וֹת

“into} ruined heaps”

The expression **ruined** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [into heaps of ruins]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 19:26 (#1)

וְיֹשְׁבֵיהֶ֣ן קִצְרֵי־יָ֔ד חַתּ֥וּ וַיֵּבֹ֖שׁוּ הָיוּ֙ עֵ֣שֶׂב שָׂדֶ֔ה וְיֶ֥רֶק דֶּ֖שֶׁא חֲצִ֣יר גַּגּ֑וֹת וּשְׁדֵמָ֖ה לִפְנֵ֥י קָמָֽה

“And their dwellers {are} short of hand; they feel dismay and feel shame. They are vegetation of the field or green of herb; grass of roofs, blasting to the face of growing up”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that their dwellers are short of hand, they feel dismay and feel shame. They are vegetation of the field or green of herb; grass of roofs, blasting to the face of growing up]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 19:26 (#2)

קִצְרֵי־יָ֔ד

“are} short of hand”

Yahweh is using **short of hand** as a common expression of this culture to mean “powerless.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are powerless]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 19:26 (#3)

הָיוּ֙ עֵ֣שֶׂב שָׂדֶ֔ה וְיֶ֥רֶק דֶּ֖שֶׁא חֲצִ֣יר גַּגּ֑וֹת וּשְׁדֵמָ֖ה לִפְנֵ֥י קָמָֽה

“They are vegetation of the field or green of herb; grass of roofs, blasting to the face of growing up”

Yahweh is speaking as if the people whom the Assyrians are conquering are actually tender plants that are defenseless against certain threats. Plants growing in the **field** can be easily trampled, for example, while **grass** growing on the flat **roofs** of this culture could easily wither in the heat of the sun. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [They are as defenseless before the Assyrians as vegetation or green herbs out in the field or as grass on a flat roof, which withers in the heat of the sun]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 19:26 (#4)

וְיֶ֥רֶק דֶּ֖שֶׁא

“or green of herb”

Yahweh is using the possessive form to describe an **herb** that is characterized by being **green**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [or green herbs]

See: Possession

2 Kings 19:26 (#5)

חֲצִ֣יר גַּגּ֑וֹת וּשְׁדֵמָ֖ה לִפְנֵ֥י קָמָֽה

“grass of roofs, blasting to the face of growing up”

See how you translated the similar expression in 17:2. Alternate translation: [grass on roofs, which the sun blasts before it can grow up]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 19:27 (#1)

וְשִׁבְתְּךָ֥ וְצֵאתְךָ֖ וּבֹאֲךָ֣ יָדָ֑עְתִּי וְאֵ֥את הִתְרַגִּזְךָ֖ אֵלָֽי

“But I know your dwelling and your going out and your coming in and your raging against me”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [But Yahweh says he knows the dwelling of the king of Assyria and his going out and his coming in and his raging against him]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 19:27 (#2)

וְשִׁבְתְּךָ֥ וְצֵאתְךָ֖ וּבֹאֲךָ֣ יָדָ֑עְתִּי וְאֵ֥את הִתְרַגִּזְךָ֖ אֵלָֽי

“But I know your dwelling and your going out and your coming in and your raging against me”

Yahweh is using two different conditions, either being at home or leaving or returning, to represent all conditions that the king of Assyria might be in. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [But I know everything about you, including how you rage against me]

See: Merism

2 Kings 19:28 (#1)

יַ֚עַן הִתְרַגִּזְךָ֣ אֵלַ֔י וְשַׁאֲנַנְךָ֖ עָלָ֑ה בָּאָ֙זְנָ֙י וְשַׂמְתִּ֤י חַחִי֙ בְּאַפֶּ֔ךָ וּמְתָגִ֖י
בִּשְׂפָתֶ֑יךָ וְהֵשִׁבֹתִ֙יךָ֙ בַּדֶּ֣רֶךְ אֲשֶׁר־בָּ֔אתָ בָּ֖הּ

“Because of your raging against me, and your arrogance has come up into my ears, I will put my hook in your nose and my bit in your lips, and I will make you return on the way by which you came”

The second-level quotation that begins in verse 21, in which Yahweh addresses the king of Assyria even though he cannot hear him, ends with this verse. If you have decided to use punctuation to mark levels of quotation, end this verse with the appropriate punctuation for closing a second-level quotation.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 19:28 (#2)

יַ֚עַן הִתְרַגִּזְךָ֣ אֵלַ֔י וְשַׁאֲנַנְךָ֖ עָלָ֑ה בָּאָ֙זְנָ֙י וְשַׂמְתִּ֤י חַחִי֙ בְּאַפֶּ֔ךָ וּמְתָגִ֖י
בִּשְׂפָתֶ֑יךָ וְהֵשִׁבֹתִ֙יךָ֙ בַּדֶּ֣רֶךְ אֲשֶׁר־בָּ֔אתָ בָּ֖הּ

“Because of your raging against me, and your arrogance has come up into my ears, I will put my hook in your nose and my bit in your lips, and I will make you return on the way by which you came”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in

this verse. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that because of his raging against him, and his arrogance has come up into his ears, he will put his hook in his nose and his bit in his lips. And he will make him return on the way by which he came]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 19:28 (#3)

וְשַׁאֲנַנְךָ עָלְתָה בְאָזְנָי

“and your arrogance has come up into my ears”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and because your arrogance has come up into my ears]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 19:28 (#4)

וְשַׁאֲנַנְךָ עָלְתָה בְאָזְנָי

“and your arrogance has come up into my ears”

Here, **ears** represent hearing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and your arrogance has come up into my hearing] or [and I have heard from heaven the arrogant things you have been saying]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 19:28 (#5)

וְשַׂמְתִּי חַחִי בְאַפֶּךָ וּמִתְגִּי בְשִׂפָתֶיךָ וַהֲשִׁבֹתִיךָ בַּדֶּרֶךְ אֲשֶׁר־בָּאתָ בָּהּ

“I will put my hook in your nose and my bit in your lips, and I will make you return on the way by which you came”

Yahweh is speaking as if he were actually going to put a **hook** in the **nose** of the king of Assyria and a **bit** in his **lips**, as if the king were an animal such as people would control by these means. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will control you by powerful means, and I will make you return on the way by which you came]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 19:28 (#6)

בִּשְׂפָתֶיךָ

“in your lips”

Here, the king’s **lips** represent his mouth. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [your mouth]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 19:29 (#1)

וְזֶה־לְּךָ הָאוֹת

“And this {will be} the sign for you”

Isaiah is now addressing Hezekiah directly. He is no longer speaking in the first person on behalf of Yahweh (although he will do that again in verses 32–34). It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And this {will be} the sign for you, Hezekiah]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 19:29 (#2)

וּבַשָּׁנָה הַשֵּׁנִית & וּבַשָּׁנָה הַשְּׁלִישִׁית

“and in the second year & But in the third year”

If your language would not represent number in forms such as **second** or **third**, you could represent these numbers in forms that your language would use. Alternate translation: [and in year two … But in year three] or [and next year … But in the year after that]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 19:29 (#3)

סָחִישׁ

“its} offspring”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [you will eat its offspring] or [you will eat what grows from that]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 19:30 (#1)

וְיָסְפָה פְּלֵיטַת בֵּית־יְהוּדָה הַנִּשְׁאָרָה שֹׁרֶשׁ לְמָטָּה וְעָשָׂה פְּרִי לְמָעְלָה

“And the remaining survival of the house of Judah will again {take} root downward, and it will make fruit upward”

Isaiah is speaking as if the Judeans were actually a plant that would **{take} root** and **make fruit**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the Judeans who have survived and remain will establish themselves in their land again and have many children]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 19:30 (#2)

וְיָסְפָה פְלֵיטַת בֵּית־יְהוּדָה הַנִּשְׁאָרָה

“And the remaining survival of the house of Judah will again”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **survival**, you could express the same idea in another way, here and in the next verse. Alternate translation: [And the remaining survivors of the house of Judah]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Kings 19:30 (#3)

בֵּית־יְהוּדָה

“the house of Judah”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:12. Alternate translation: [the descendants of Judah]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 19:31 (#1)

וּפְלֵיטָה מֵהַר צִיּוֹן

“and a survival from Mount Zion”

Isaiah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and survivors will come out from Mount Zion]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 19:31 (#2)

קִנְאַת יְהוָה תַּעֲשֶׂה־זֹּאת

“The zeal of Yahweh will do this”

Some ancient manuscripts read “The zeal of Yahweh will do this.” The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “The zeal of Yahweh of armies will do this.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

2 Kings 19:31 (#3)

קִנְאַת יְהוָה תַּעֲשֶׂה־זֹּאת

“The zeal of Yahweh will do this”

Isaiah is speaking of the **zeal** of Yahweh as if it were a living thing that could do the things he describes. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will do this in his zeal] or [Yahweh will zealously do this]

See: Personification

2 Kings 19:32 (#1)

לָכֵן כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה אֶל־מֶלֶךְ אַשּׁוּר לֹא יָבֹא אֶל־הָעִיר הַזֹּאת וְלֹא־יוֹרֶנָּה שָׁשָׁם חֵצֶן וְלֹא־יְקַדְּמֶנָּה מָגֵן וְלֹא־יִשְׁפֹּךְ עָלֶיהָ סֹלְלָה

“Therefore, thus says Yahweh about the king of Assyria: ‘He will not come to this city, and he will not shoot an arrow there, and he will not come before it {with} a shield, and he will not pour out a mound against it”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Therefore Yahweh says about the king of Assyria that he will not come to this city, and he will not shoot an arrow there, and he will not come before it with a shield, and he will not pour out a mound against it]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 19:33 (#1)

בַּדֶּרֶךְ אֲשֶׁר־יָבֹא בָּהּ יָשׁוּב וְאֶל־הָעִיר הַזֹּאת לֹא יָבֹא נְאֻם־יְהוָה

“He will return by the way on which he came, and he will not come to this city.’ The declaration of Yahweh”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh declares that he will return by the way on which he came, and he will not come to this city]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 19:33 (#2)

בַּדֶּרֶךְ אֲשֶׁר־יָבֹא בָּהּ יָשׁוּב וְאֶל־הָעִיר הַזֹּאת לֹא יָבֹא

“He will return by the way on which he came, and he will not come to this city”

Yahweh is describing one event before describing another event that would precede it. If it would be helpful your language, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [He will not come to this city, but he will return by the way on which he came]

See: Order of Events

2 Kings 19:34 (#1)

וְגַנּוֹתִ֤י אֶל־הָעִיר֙ הַזֹּ֣את לְהוֹשִׁיעָ֔הּ לְמַעֲנִ֖י וּלְמַ֣עַן דָּוִ֑ד עַבְדִּֽי

“For I will cover over this city to save it, for my sake and for the sake of David my servant”

This is a direct quotation from Yahweh that Isaiah is relaying to Hezekiah. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate that Yahweh is the speaker. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says, ‘For I will cover over this city to save it, for my sake and for the sake of David my servant.’]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

2 Kings 19:34 (#2)

וְגַנּוֹתִ֤י אֶל־הָעִיר֙ הַזֹּ֣את לְהוֹשִׁיעָ֔הּ לְמַעֲנִ֖י וּלְמַ֣עַן דָּוִ֑ד עַבְדִּֽי

“For I will cover over this city to save it, for my sake and for the sake of David my servant”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that he will cover over this city to save it, for his own sake and for the sake of David his servant]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 19:34 (#3)

וְגַנּוֹתִ֤י אֶל־הָעִיר֙ הַזֹּ֣את

“For I will cover over this city”

Yahweh is speaking as if he were actually going to **cover over** the city of Jerusalem to protect it, as with a shield. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [For I will protect this city]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 19:34 (#4)

וְגַנּוֹתִ֤י

“For I will cover”

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [This will happen because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 19:34 (#5)

וּלְמַ֣עַן דָּוִ֑ד עַבְדִּֽי

“and for the sake of David my servant”

This verse ends the long first-level quotation that begins at verse 20. It also contains a second-level quotation from Yahweh that concludes at the end of the verse. If you have decided to use punctuation to mark levels of quotation, end this verse with the appropriate punctuation for closing both a second-level and first-level quotation.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 19:35 (#1)

וַיְהִי֙

“And it happened”

The author is using the phrase **And it happened** to introduce a new development within the event of the Assyrians invading Judah. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 19:35 (#2)

יְהוָ֔ה וַיַּ֖ךְ

“Yahweh & and struck”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:23. Alternate translation: [and killed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 19:35 (#3)

מֵאָ֥ה שְׁמוֹנִ֛ים וַחֲמִשָּׁ֥ה אֲלָפִ֖ים

“185,000”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [185,000 soldiers]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 19:35 (#4)

וַיַּשְׁכִּ֣ימוּ

“And they arose early”

The pronoun **they** refers to the soldiers in the Assyrian camp whom the angel of Yahweh did not kill. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the surviving soldiers arose early]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 19:36 (#1)

וַיִּסַּע וַיֵּלֶךְ וַיָּשָׁב סַנְחֵרִיב מֶלֶךְ־אַשּׁוּר וַיֵּשֶׁב בְּנִינְוֵה

“And he departed and went, and Sennacherib, the king of Assyria, returned and stayed in Nineveh”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could name the king in the earlier part of the sentence and use the pronoun in the later part of the sentence. Alternate translation: [And Sennacherib, the king of Assyria, departed and went, and he returned and stayed in Nineveh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 19:37 (#1)

וַיְהִי׀

“And it happened”

The author is using the phrase **And it happened** to introduce a new development within the event of the Assyrians invading Judah. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 19:37 (#2)

וְאַדְרַמֶּלֶךְ וְשַׂרְאֶצֶר הִכֻּהוּ בַחֶרֶב

“and Adrammelech and Sharezer struck him with the sword”

Some ancient manuscripts read “and Adrammelech and Sharezer struck him with the sword.” The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “and Adrammelech and Sharezer, his sons, struck him with the sword.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

2 Kings 19:37 (#3)

הִכֻּהוּ

“struck him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:23. Alternate translation: [killed him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 19:37 (#4)

וְהֵמָּה נִמְלְטוּ

“and they, they escaped”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:25. Alternate translation: [and for their part, they escaped]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings - Chapter 20 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

In this chapter, the author concludes his detailed account of the reign of Hezekiah, one of the great kings of Judah.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did Isaiah say to put figs on Hezekiah’s sore?
In the ancient world, figs were a known remedy for sores and boils. Figs contain natural compounds and enzymes that have anti-inflammatory, soothing, and drawing effects. These can help bring a festering boil to a head and reduce swelling and infection. However, Hezekiah was so ill that he was near death, so it was improbable that the effects of the figs alone would have cured him. So agreeing to have his servants put the figs on his sore anyway was therefore an act of faith, trust, and obedience by Hezekiah. It showed that he was prepared to follow the instructions of Yahweh’s prophet, even if it did not seem that the measures he specified would be sufficient. Isaiah had the king’s servants use the best means available, so that they and he and the king were doing their part. But Hezekiah ultimately had to trust Yahweh for his healing.

2 Kings 20:1 (#1)

בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם

“In those days”

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:36. Alternate translation: [Around that time]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 20:1 (#2)

כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה צַו לְבֵיתֶךָ כִּי מֵת אַתָּה וְלֹא תִחְיֶה

“Thus says Yahweh, ‘Command regarding your house, for you are dying, and you will not live”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that you should command regarding your house, for you are dying, and you will not live]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 20:1 (#3)

צַו לְבֵיתֶךָ כִּי מֵת אַתָּה וְלֹא תִחְיֶה

“Command regarding your house, for you are dying, and you will not live”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since you are dying, and you will not live, command regarding your house]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 20:1 (#4)

צַו לְבֵיתֶךָ

“Command regarding your house”

Here Hezekiah’s **house** could represent: (1) his household affairs. Alternate translation: [Put your affairs in order] or (2) his royal dynasty. Hezekiah lived 15 years after this illness, but his son and successor Manasseh was 12 years old when he became king, indicating that Hezekiah did not have an heir at this time. He would therefore have had to identify someone as his successor. Alternate translation: [Name your successor]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 20:1 (#5)

מֵת אַתָּה וְלֹא תִחְיֶה

“you are dying, and you will not live”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [you will surely die from this illness]

See: Parallelism

2 Kings 20:3 (#1)

זְכָר

“remember”

Hezekiah is not suggesting that Yahweh does not **remember** these things and needs to be reminded of them. He is asking Yahweh to take them into consideration. Alternate translation: [consider] or [take into consideration]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 20:3 (#2)

הִתְהַלַּכְתִּי

“I have walked about”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:18. Alternate translation: [I have lived]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 20:3 (#3)

לְפָנֶיךָ

“to your face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:14. Alternate translation: [in your presence]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 20:3 (#4)

בֶּאֱמֶת

“in faithfulness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **faithfulness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [faithfully]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Kings 20:3 (#5)

וּבְלֵבָב שָׁלֵם

“and with a whole heart”

Here the **heart** represents a person’s intentions and commitments. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and in complete devotion]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 20:3 (#6)

וְהַטּוֹב בְּעֵינֶיךָ עָשִׂיתִי

“and I have done good in your eyes”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:13. Alternate translation: [and I have done what you consider to be good]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 20:3 (#7)

וַיִּבְךְּ חִזְקִיָּהוּ בְּכִי גָדוֹל

“And Hezekiah wept a great weeping”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [And Hezekiah wept bitterly]

See: Poetry

2 Kings 20:4 (#1)

וּדְבַר־יְהוָה הָיָה אֵלָיו

“and the word of Yahweh was to him”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean that Yahweh spoke a message to Isaiah. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 15:10. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh spoke a message to him]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 20:5 (#1)

שׁוּב וְאָמַרְתָּ֞ אֶל־חִזְקִיָּ֣הוּ נְגִיד־עַמִּ֗י כֹּה־אָמַ֤ר יְהוָה֙ אֱלֹהֵ֣י דָוִ֔ד אָבִ֖יךָ שָׁמַ֣עְתִּי׀ אֶת־תְּפִלָּתֶ֗ךָ רָאִ֤יתִי אֶת־דִּמְעָתֶךָ֙ הִנְנִי֙ רֹפֵ֣א לָ֔ךְ בַּיּ֥וֹם הַשְּׁלִישִׁ֖י תַּעֲלֶ֣ה בֵּ֑ית יְהוָה

“Return, and you shall say to Hezekiah, the leader of my people, ‘Thus says Yahweh, the God of David your father, “I have heard your prayer. I have seen your weeping. Behold me, healing you. On the third day, you will go up {to} the house of Yahweh”

There are three levels of quotation here. The author is quoting what Yahweh said (level 1). Yahweh is quoting what he wants Isaiah to say to Hezekiah. (level 2). This includes a quotation from Yahweh himself. (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation, in this verse and at the end of the next verse. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or third-level quotations.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 20:5 (#2)

שׁוּב וְאָמַרְתָּ֞ אֶל־חִזְקִיָּ֣הוּ נְגִיד־עַמִּ֗י כֹּה־אָמַ֤ר יְהוָה֙ אֱלֹהֵ֣י דָוִ֔ד אָבִ֖יךָ שָׁמַ֣עְתִּי׀ אֶת־תְּפִלָּתֶ֗ךָ רָאִ֤יתִי אֶת־דִּמְעָתֶךָ֙ הִנְנִי֙ רֹפֵ֣א לָ֔ךְ בַּיּ֥וֹם הַשְּׁלִישִׁ֖י תַּעֲלֶ֣ה בֵּ֑ית יְהוָה

“Return, and you shall say to Hezekiah, the leader of my people, ‘Thus says Yahweh, the God of David your father, “I have heard your prayer. I have seen your weeping. Behold me, healing you. On the third day, you will go up {to} the house of Yahweh”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Return and tell Hezekiah, the leader of my people, that I, Yahweh, the God of David his father, have heard his prayer and have seen his weeping. I am going to heal him. On the third day, he will go up {to} my temple]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 20:5 (#3)

אָבִ֖יךָ

“your father”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [your ancestor]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 20:5 (#4)

הִנְנִי֙ רֹפֵ֣א לָ֔ךְ

“Behold me, healing you”

See how you translated the similar expression in 19:7. Alternate translation: [I am going to heal you]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 20:5 (#5)

תַּעֲלֶ֣ה

“you will go up”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [you will go]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 20:5 (#6)

בַּיּ֥וֹם הַשְּׁלִישִׁ֖י

“On the third day”

In this culture, the current day was considered the first day, the next day was considered the second day, and the day after that was considered **the third day**. In your translation, describe these days as your language and culture naturally would. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 30:1. Alternate translation: [On the day after tomorrow]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 20:5 (#7)

בֵּ֖ית יְהוָֽה

“to} the house of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:18. Alternate translation: [to the temple of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 20:5 (#8)

בֵּ֖ית יְהוָֽה

“to} the house of Yahweh”

Yahweh is speaking of himself in the third person because he is making a solemn declaration. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [to my temple]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 20:6 (#1)

וְהֹסַפְתִּ֣י עַל־יָמֶ֔יךָ חֲמֵ֥שׁ עֶשְׂרֵ֖הוּ שָׁנָ֑ה וּמִכַּ֤ף מֶֽלֶךְ־אַשּׁוּר֙ אַצִּ֣ילְךָ֔ וְאֶת־הָעִ֥יר הַזֹּ֖את וְגַנּוֹתִ֣י עַל־הָעִ֑יר הַזֹּ֖את לְמַעֲנִ֥י וּלְמַ֖עַן דָּוִ֥ד עַבְדִּֽי

“And I will add 15 years to your days, and I will deliver you and this city from the palm of the king of Assyria. And I will cover over this city for my sake and for the sake of David my servant”

If you decided in the previous verse to translate this quotation in such a way that there would not be quotations within a quotations, you can continue doing that here. Alternate translation: [Tell Hezekiah that I say that I will add 15 years to his days and that I will deliver him and this city from the palm of the king of Assyria. And I will cover over this city for my sake and for the sake of David my servant]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 20:6 (#2)

עַל־יָמֶ֔יךָ

“to your days”

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:36. Alternate translation: [to your lifetime]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 20:6 (#3)

וּמִכַּ֤ף מֶֽלֶךְ־אַשּׁוּר֙

“and & from the palm of the king of Assyria”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [from the power of the king of Assyria]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 20:6 (#4)

וְגַנּוֹתִ֣י עַל־הָעִ֑יר הַזֹּ֖את

“And I will cover over this city”

See how you translated the similar expression in 19:34. Alternate translation: [And I will protect this city]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 20:8 (#1)

בַּיּ֣וֹם הַשְּׁלִישִׁ֔י בֵּ֖ית יְהוָֽה

“on the third day to the house of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 20:5. Alternate translation: [on the day after tomorrow to the temple of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 20:9 (#1)

הָלַ֣ךְ הַצֵּ֗לֶל עֶ֚שֶׂר מַעֲלֹ֔ות

“The shadow has gone forward ten steps”

Since the author explains in verse 11 that these **steps** were the “steps of Ahaz,” that is, a sundial that Hezekiah’s father King Ahaz had built, you do not need to explain here what these steps were.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

2 Kings 20:11 (#1)

וַיָּ֣שָׁב

“and he made & go back”

The pronoun **he** refers to Yahweh. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh made]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 20:11 (#2)

בְּמַעֲלוֹת אָחָז

“on the steps of Ahaz”

The phrase **the steps of Ahaz** describes a structure that King Ahaz, the father of Hezekiah, built to track the passage of time. It showed the time of day by the position of the shadow that a pole cast on a series of **steps** below the pole. Such a structure is sometimes called a “shadow clock.” It is similar to what many cultures know as a sundial. If your readers would not be familiar with such a structure, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [on the steps of the shadow clock that King Ahaz had built] or [on the sundial of King Ahaz]

See: Translate Unknowns

2 Kings 20:11 (#3)

אֲחֹרַנִּית עֶשֶׂר מַעֲלוֹת

“backward ten steps”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [The shadow went backward ten steps]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 20:12 (#1)

בָּעֵת הַהִוא

“At that time”

The author is using the time reference **At that time** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 20:12 (#2)

שָׁלַח בְּרֹאדַךְ בַּלְאֲדָן בֶּן־בַּלְאֲדָן מֶלֶךְ־בָּבֶל סְפָרִים וּמִנְחָה אֶל־חִזְקִיָּהוּ כִּי שָׁמַע כִּי חָלָה חִזְקִיָּהוּ

“Berodach Baladan, the son of Baladan, the king of Babylon, sent writings and a gift to Hezekiah, for he had heard that Hezekiah was sick”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [since Berodach-Baladan, the son of Baladan, the king of Babylon, had heard that Hezekiah was sick, he sent letters and a gift to Hezekiah]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 20:12 (#3)

בְּרֹאדַךְ בַּלְאֲדָן

“Berodach Baladan”

Some ancient manuscripts read “Berodach Baladan.” The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts and the parallel passage in Isaiah 39:1 read “Merodach Baladan.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

2 Kings 20:12 (#4)

סְפָרִים

“writings”

See how you translated the similar expression in 19:14. Alternate translation: [a letter]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

2 Kings 20:12 (#5)

כִּי חָלָה חִזְקִיָּהוּ

“that Hezekiah was sick”

Since the author has already used the name Hezekiah earlier in this sentence, it may be more natural in your language to use a pronoun here. Alternate translation: [that he was sick]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 20:13 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁמַע עֲלֵיהֶם חִזְקִיָּהוּ

“And Hezekiah listened to them”

Some ancient manuscripts read “And Hezekiah listened to them.” The ULT follows that reading. Other

ancient manuscripts and the parallel passage in Isaiah 39:2 read “And Hezekiah rejoiced over them.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

2 Kings 20:13 (#2)

וְאֵת֙ כָּל־אֲשֶׁ֣ר נִמְצָ֔א בְּאוֹצְרֹתָ֖יו

“and everything that was found in his treasuries”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:18. Alternate translation: [and everything that was in his treasuries]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 20:13 (#3)

לֹא־הָיָ֣ה דָבָ֔ר אֲשֶׁ֣ר לֹא־הֶרְאָ֔ם חִזְקִיָּ֖הוּ בְּבֵיתֹ֑ו וּבְכָל־מֶמְשַׁלְתֹּ֖ו

“There was not a thing that Hezekiah did not show them in his house or in all of his realm”

This is a double negative, consisting of two instances of the negative particle **not**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this. Alternate translation: [Hezekiah showed them everything in his palace and in his realm]

See: Double Negatives

2 Kings 20:15 (#1)

לֹא־הָיָ֣ה דָבָ֔ר אֲשֶׁ֣ר לֹא־הֶרְאִיתִ֔ם בְּאֹצְרֹתָ֖י

“There was not a thing in my treasuries that I did not show them”

See how you translated the similar expression in 20:13. Alternate translation: [I showed them everything in my treasuries]

See: Double Negatives

2 Kings 20:16 (#1)

שְׁמַ֖ע דְּבַר־יְהוָֽה

“Hear the word of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:7. Alternate translation: [Hear a message from Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 20:17 (#1)

הִנֵּ֤ה ׀ יָמִים֙ בָּאִ֔ים וְנִשָּׂ֕א ׀ כָּל־אֲשֶׁ֥ר בְּבֵיתֶ֖ךָ וַאֲשֶׁ֣ר אָצְרָ֑רוּ אֲבֹתֶ֙יךָ֙ עַד־הַיֹּ֣ום הַזֶּ֔ה בָּבֶ֖לָה לֹא־יִוָּתֵ֥ר דָּבָ֖ר אָמַ֥ר יְהוָֽה

“Behold, days are coming when everything that {is} in your house and that your fathers have stored up to this day will be carried away to Babylon. A thing will not be left,’ says Yahweh”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that behold, days are coming when all that is in your house and that your fathers have stored up to this day will be carried away to Babylon. A thing will not be left]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 20:17 (#2)

הִנֵּ֤ה

“Behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:9.

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 20:17 (#3)

יָמִים֙ בָּאִ֔ים

“days are coming”

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:36. Alternate translation: [a time is coming]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 20:17 (#4)

וְנִשָּׂ֕א ׀ כָּל־אֲשֶׁ֥ר בְּבֵיתֶ֖ךָ וַאֲשֶׁ֣ר אָצְרָ֑רוּ אֲבֹתֶ֙יךָ֙ עַד־הַיֹּ֣ום הַזֶּ֔ה בָּבֶ֖לָה

“when everything that {is} in your house and that your fathers have stored up to this day will be carried away to Babylon”

The expression **will be carried away** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [when soldiers will carry away to Babylon everything that {is} in your house and that your fathers have stored up to this day]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 20:17 (#5)

אֲבֹתֶ֙יךָ֙

“your fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [your ancestors]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 20:18 (#1)

וּמִבָּנֶ֙יךָ֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר יֵצְא֔וּ מִמְּךָ֖ אֲשֶׁ֣ר תּוֹלִ֑יד יקח וְהָי֣וּ סָרִיסִ֔ים בְּהֵיכַ֖ל מֶ֥לֶךְ בָּבֶֽל

“And they will take some of your sons who will come forth from you, whom you will beget, and they will be eunuchs in the palace of the king of Babylon”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh also says that soldiers will take away some of your sons who will come forth from you, whom you will beget, and those sons will be eunuchs in the palace of the king of Babylon]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 20:18 (#2)

וּמִבָּנֶ֙יךָ֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר יֵצְא֔וּ מִמְּךָ֖ אֲשֶׁ֣ר תּוֹלִ֑יד

“And & some of your sons who will come forth from you, whom you will beget”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:12. Alternate translation: [some of the men of later generations who will descend from you, whose ancestor you will be]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 20:18 (#3)

וּמִבָּנֶ֙יךָ֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר יֵצְא֔וּ מִמְּךָ֖ אֲשֶׁ֣ר תּוֹלִ֑יד

“And & some of your sons who will come forth from you, whom you will beget”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [some of your actual biological descendants]

See: Parallelism

2 Kings 20:19 (#1)

טוֹב֙ דְּבַר־יְהוָ֔ה אֲשֶׁ֖ר דִּבַּֽרְתָּ

“The word of Yahweh that you have spoken {is} good”

Hezekiah does not mean that the content of this message from Yahweh is objectively **good**. He means that he accepts and submits to what Yahweh has decided. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 20:19 (#2)

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר

“For he said”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:15. Alternate translation: [For he thought]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 20:19 (#3)

הֲלֹ֗וא אִם־שָׁלֹ֛ום וֶאֱמֶ֥ת יִהְיֶ֖ה בְּיָמָֽי

“Is it not, if peace and stability will be in my days”

Hezekiah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Is it not good, if peace and stability will be in my days?]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 20:19 (#4)

הֲלֹ֗וא אִם־שָׁלֹ֛ום וֶאֱמֶ֥ת יִהְיֶ֖ה בְּיָמָֽי

“Is it not, if peace and stability will be in my days”

Hezekiah is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [It is good, since peace and stability will be in my days.]

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Kings 20:19 (#5)

אִם־שָׁלֹ֛ום וֶאֱמֶ֥ת יִהְיֶ֖ה בְּיָמָֽי

“if peace and stability will be in my days”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **peace** and **stability**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [if my kingdom will be peaceful and stabile in my days]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Kings 20:19 (#6)

בְּיָמָי

“in my days”

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:36. Alternate translation: [during my lifetime]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 20:20 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר דִּבְרֵי חִזְקִיָּהוּ וְכָל־גְּבוּרָתוֹ וַאֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה אֶת־הַבְּרֵכָה וְאֶת־הַתְּעָלָה וַיָּבֵא אֶת־הַמַּיִם הָעִירָה הֲלֹא־הֵם כְּתוּבִים עַל־סֵפֶר דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים לְמַלְכֵי יְהוּדָה

“Now the rest of the matters of Hezekiah and all of his might, and how he made the pool and the conduit and brought water into the city, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Judah”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is concluding the story of Hezekiah. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar phrases in 1:18.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 20:21 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּב חִזְקִיָּהוּ עִם־אֲבֹתָיו

“And Hezekiah lay down with his fathers”

See how you translated the same expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [And Hezekiah passed away] or [And Hezekiah died]

See: Euphemism

2 Kings - Chapter 21 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

In this chapter, the author continues to tell what the kings were like who ruled over the kingdom of Judah.

1. King Manasseh of Judah (1–18)
2. King Amon of Judah (19–26)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

How could such a good king as Hezekiah have had such a bad son as Manasseh?

The author says in 18:5 that Hezekiah “trusted in Yahweh the God of Israel” more than any of the kings of Judah who lived before him or after him. By contrast, he says that Hezekiah’s son Manasseh was even more evil than the pagan nations that had lived in Canaan before the Israelites. How could such a good king have had such a bad son? Manasseh was only 12 years old when his father died and he became king. He was still young and impressionable, and he seems to have come under the influence of a group of Judean leaders who had consistently opposed Hezekiah’s reforms. The book of Isaiah describes how these leaders continued to worship foreign gods and cultivate foreign alliances (Isaiah 2:6–9, 20:5, 30:1–7). They seem to have done all they could to influence Manasseh to become like them and, unfortunately, they seem to have succeeded.

2 Kings 21:1 (#1)

בֶּן־שְׁתֵּים עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה מְנַשֶּׁה בְמָלְכוֹ וַחֲמִשִּׁים וְשֵׁשׁ שָׁנָה מָלַךְ בִּירוּשָׁלִָם וְשֵׁם אִמּוֹ חֶפְצִי־בָהּ

“Manasseh {was} a son of 12 years when he reigned, and he reigned 55 years in Jerusalem. And the name of his mother {was} Hephzibah”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is introducing **Manasseh** as a participant in the story as the new king of Judah. Since there were no more kings of Israel, from this point on the author no longer refers to a year in the reign of the king of Israel to identify when a king began to reign Judah. So to translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:26 and similar verses.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 21:2 (#1)

וַיַּעַשׂ הָרַע בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה

“And he did evil in the eyes of Yahweh”

To translate the expression **in the eyes of Yahweh** here and in verse 6, see how you translated the similar expression in 3:2. Alternate translation: [And he did what Yahweh considered to be evil]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 21:2 (#2)

מִפְּנֵי

“from the face of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 16:3. Alternate translation: [on account of]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 21:2 (#3)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:12. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 21:3 (#1)

וַיָּ֣שָׁב וַיִּבֶן

“And he returned and built”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:11. Alternate translation: [And he once more built] or [And he rebuilt]

See: Hendiadys

2 Kings 21:3 (#2)

לְכָל־צְבָ֣א הַשָּׁמַ֔יִם

“to the whole army of the heavens”

To translate the expression **the whole army of the heavens** here and in verse 5, see how you translated the similar expression in 17:16. Alternate translation: [to all the lights in the sky] or [to the heavenly bodies here]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 21:4 (#1)

בְּבֵ֖ית יְהוָ֑ה

“in the house of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:18. Alternate translation: [in the temple of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 21:4 (#2)

בִּירוּשָׁלַ֖͏ִם אָשִׂ֥ים אֶת־שְׁמִֽי

“In Jerusalem I will put my name”

Here, the **name** of Yahweh represents people calling on him by name as their God and thus worshiping him. If it would be helpful in your language, here and in verse 7, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Kings 8:16. Alternate translation: [I will make Jerusalem a special place for people to worship me]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 21:5 (#1)

בִּשְׁתֵּ֖י חַצְרוֹת֙ בֵּ֣ית־יְהוָ֔ה

“in the two courts of the house of Yahweh”

By **the two courts**, the author is referring to the inner court, where the priests offered sacrifices, and the outer court, where other Judeans could go. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [in the inner and outer courtyards of the temple of Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 21:6 (#1)

וְהֶֽעֱבִ֥יר אֶת־בְּנ֖וֹ בָּאֵ֑שׁ

“And he made his son pass through the fire”

See how you translated the similar expression in 16:3. Alternate translation: [And he burned his son completely as an offering to an idol]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 21:6 (#2)

אֹ֥וב

“a ritual pit”

A **ritual pit** was a hole in the ground that was used in ceremonies to try to contact the spirits of dead people. If your readers would not be familiar with what a ritual pit was, in your translation you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a general expression. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the same expression in 1 Samuel 28:3. Alternate translation: [a place to use to try to contact dead people]

See: Translate Unknowns

2 Kings 21:6 (#3)

וְיִדְּעֹנִ֑ים

“and familiar spirits”

The expression **familiar spirits** describes supernatural beings that people in this culture believed existed and could help them gain secret knowledge. If your readers would not be familiar with this, in your translation you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a general expression. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the same expression in 1 Samuel 28:3. Alternate translation: [for spirits that people believed could give them secret knowledge]

See: Translate Unknowns

2 Kings 21:6 (#4)

הִרְבָּה לַעֲשׂוֹת הָרַע

“He multiplied doing evil”

The author is using **multiplied doing evil** as a common expression of his culture to mean “did very many evil things.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [He did evil after evil] or [He did very many evil things]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 21:7 (#1)

בַּבַּיִת הַזֶּה וּבִירוּשָׁלַ͏ִם אֲשֶׁר בָּחַרְתִּי מִכֹּל שִׁבְטֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אָשִׂים אֶת־שְׁמִי לְעוֹלָם

“In this house and in Jerusalem, which I have chosen from all of the tribes of Israel, I will put my name forever”

If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the similar expression “for my name to be there” in 1 Kings 8:16. In the context of the expression here **I will put my name**, the term **name** could refer to: (1) Yahweh providing a place for people to call on him by name as their God and thus worship him. Alternate translation: [I will make this temple in Jerusalem, which I have chosen from all of the tribes of Israel, a special place for people to worship me] or (2) Yahweh providing a place that would promote his reputation. Alternate translation: [I will make this temple in Jerusalem, which I have chosen from all of the tribes of Israel, a place that will promote my reputation]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 21:7 (#2)

מִכֹּל שִׁבְטֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“from all of the tribes of Israel”

Here the **tribes of Israel** represent their territories. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from the whole territory of Israel]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 21:8 (#1)

וְלֹא אֹסִיף לְהָנִיד רֶגֶל יִשְׂרָאֵל

“And I will not add to make the foot of Israel wander”

Yahweh, envisioning all the Israelites as if they were a single person, their ancestor **Israel**, is using one part of that person, his **foot**, to mean all of him in the act of wandering. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I will not add to make the Israelites wander]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 21:8 (#2)

וְלֹא אֹסִיף לְהָנִיד רֶגֶל יִשְׂרָאֵל

“And I will not add to make the foot of Israel wander”

Yahweh is using **I will not add to make** as a common expression of this culture to mean “I will not again make.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I will not make the Israelites wander again]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 21:8 (#3)

לַאֲבוֹתָם

“to their fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [to their ancestors]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 21:9 (#1)

מִפְּנֵי בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“from the face of the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 21:2. Alternate translation: [on account of the Israelites]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 21:10 (#1)

בְּיַד־עֲבָדָיו הַנְּבִיאִים

“by the hand of his servants the prophets”

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:36. Alternate translation: [through the agency of his servants the prophets]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 21:11 (#1)

עָשָׂה הָאֱמֹרִי אֲשֶׁר לְפָנָיו

“the Amorite did who {was} to his face”

The author is not referring to a specific **Amorite**. He means the Amorites in general. (The verb translated as **did** is plural.) If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the Amorites did who were to his face]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

2 Kings 21:11 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר לְפָנָיו

“who {was} to his face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 17:2. Alternate translation: [who was before him]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 21:12 (#1)

לָכֵן כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הִנְנִי מֵבִיא רָעָה עַל־יְרוּשָׁלַם
וִיהוּדָה אֲשֶׁר כָּל־שֹׁמְעָיו תְּצַלֶּלְנָה שְׁתֵּי אָזְנָיו

“therefore, thus says Yahweh, the God of Israel, ‘Behold me, bringing disaster on Jerusalem and Judah that everyone hearing it, the two of his ears will tingle”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [therefore Yahweh, the God of Israel, says to behold him, bringing disaster on Jerusalem and Judah that everyone hearing it, the two of his ears will tingle]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 21:12 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר כָּל־שֹׁמְעָיו תְּצַלֶּלְנָה שְׁתֵּי אָזְנָיו

“that everyone hearing it, the two of his ears will tingle”

Yahweh is using a physical sensation that people will have (their **ears** will **tingle**) to represent the emotion that people will feel when they hear about this disaster. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 3:11. Alternate translation: [that will horrify everyone who hears about it]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 21:12 (#3)

הִנְנִי מֵבִיא

“Behold me, bringing”

See how you translated the similar expression in 19:7. Alternate translation: [I am about to bring]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 21:13 (#1)

וְנָטִיתִי עַל־יְרוּשָׁלַ͏ִם אֵת קָו שֹׁמְרוֹן וְאֶת־מִשְׁקֹלֶת בֵּית אַחְאָב

“And I will stretch over Jerusalem the measuring line of Samaria and the plumb line of the house of Ahab”

A **measuring line** is a cord with markings on it that is used to determine length. A **plumb line** is a weight on the end of a cord that is used to determine whether a wall is straight upright. Alternate translation: [And I will measure Jerusalem with the same marked cord that I used to measure Samaria, and I will determine whether Jerusalem is upright by using the same weight on the end of a cord that I used to determine whether the house of Ahab was upright]

See: Translate Unknowns

2 Kings 21:13 (#2)

וְנָטִיתִי עַל־יְרוּשָׁלַ͏ִם אֵת קָו שֹׁמְרוֹן וְאֶת־מִשְׁקֹלֶת בֵּית אַחְאָב

“And I will stretch over Jerusalem the measuring line of Samaria and the plumb line of the house of Ahab”

If builders using a **measuring line** or **plumb line** discovered that a structure was not the right size or that a wall was leaning, they would tear down the structure or wall. Yahweh is using these instruments to represent the standards by which he judged and punished the people of **Samaria** (the northern kingdom of Israel) and the descendants of **Ahab**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 21:13 (#3)

וּמָחִיתִי אֶת־יְרוּשָׁלַ͏ִם כַּאֲשֶׁר־יִמְחֶה אֶת־הַצַּלַּחַת מָחָה וְהָפַךְ
עַל־פָּנֶיהָ

“And I will wipe Jerusalem away, just as one wipes a dish, he wipes {it} and turns {it} on its face”

The point of this comparison is that just as a person who ensures that he has wiped a **dish** thoroughly by turning it over and wiping both sides, so Yahweh will **wipe Jerusalem away** thoroughly and completely. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [And I will wipe Jerusalem away just as thoroughly as a person wipes a dish who turns it over to make sure that he has wiped both sides]

See: Simile

2 Kings 21:13 (#4)

וְהָפַךְ עַל־פָּנֶיהָ

“and turns {it} on its face”

Yahweh is using the term **face** to mean the “front” of this **dish**. If this term does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and turns it over and also wipes the back]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 21:14 (#1)

וְנָטַשְׁתִּי אֶת שְׁאֵרִית נַחֲלָתִי וּנְתַתִּים בְּיַד אֹיְבֵיהֶם וְהָיוּ לְבַז וְלִמְשִׁסָּה לְכָל־אֹיְבֵיהֶם

“And I will abandon the remnant of my inheritance, and I will give them into the hand of their enemies. And they will become spoil and plunder for all of their enemies”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that he will abandon the remnant of his inheritance, and he will give them into the hand of their enemies. And they will become spoil and plunder for all of their enemies]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 21:14 (#2)

נַחֲלָתִי

“my inheritance”

Yahweh is speaking of the people of Israel as if they were something that he had inherited as a lasting possession. He is referring to the Israelites as the people who were supposed to belong to him perpetually. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 10:1. Alternate translation: [my people, who were supposed to belong to me perpetually]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 21:14 (#3)

וּנְתַתִּים בְּיַד אֹיְבֵיהֶם

“and I will give them into the hand of their enemies”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:10. Alternate translation: [and I will allow their enemies to have power over them]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 21:14 (#4)

וְהָיוּ לְבַז וְלִמְשִׁסָּה לְכָל־אֹיְבֵיהֶם

“And they will become spoil and plunder for all of their enemies”

The terms **spoil** and **plunder** mean similar things. Yahweh is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [And all of their enemies will plunder them completely]

See: Doublet

2 Kings 21:14–15 (#1)

וְנָטַשְׁתִּי אֶת שְׁאֵרִית נַחֲלָתִי וּנְתַתִּים בְּיַד אֹיְבֵיהֶם וְהָיוּ לְבַז וְלִמְשִׁסָּה לְכָל־אֹיְבֵיהֶם׃ יַ֚עַן אֲשֶׁ֣ר עָשׂ֔וּ אֶת־הָרַ֖ע בְּעֵינַ֑י וַיִּהְי֣וּ מַכְעִסִ֔ים אֹתִ֕י מִן־הַיּ֗וֹם אֲשֶׁ֤ר יָצְא֙וּ אֲבוֹתָ֔ם מִמִּצְרַ֖יִם וְעַ֥ד הַיּ֖וֹם הַזֶּֽה

“And I will abandon the remnant of my inheritance, and I will give them into the hand of their enemies. And they will become spoil and plunder for all of their enemies, because they have done evil in my eyes and they have been making me angry from the day that their fathers came out from Egypt and to this day”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could create a verse bridge and put verse 15 before verse 14, since verse 15 gives the reason for the result that verse 14 describes. Alternate translation: [And because they have done evil in my eyes and they have been making me angry from the day that their fathers came out from Egypt and to this day, I will abandon the remnant of my inheritance, and I will give them into the hand of their enemies. And they will become spoil and plunder for all of their enemies]

See: Verse Bridges

2 Kings 21:15 (#1)

יַ֗עַן אֲשֶׁ֤ר עָשׂוּ֙ אֶת־הָרַ֣ע בְּעֵינַ֔י וַיִּהְי֥וּ מַכְעִסִ֖ים אֹתִ֑י מִן־הַיּ֣וֹם אֲשֶׁ֤ר יָצְאוּ֙ אֲבוֹתָ֣ם מִמִּצְרַ֔יִם וְעַ֖ד הַיּ֥וֹם הַזֶּֽה

“because they have done evil in my eyes and they have been making me angry from the day that their fathers came out from Egypt and to this day”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh says that he will do this because they have done evil in his eyes and they have been making him angry from the day that their fathers came out from Egypt and to this day]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 21:16 (#1)

וְגַם֩ דָּ֨ם נָקִ֜י שָׁפַ֣ךְ מְנַשֶּׁ֗ה הַרְבֵּ֛ה מְאֹ֖ד

“And Manasseh also poured out very much innocent blood”

The author is using the expression **poured out ... blood** to represent killing, since blood pours out of people when they are killed violently. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And Manasseh also killed very many innocent people] or [And Manasseh also had very many innocent people killed]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 21:16 (#2)

עַ֚ד אֲשֶׁר־מִלֵּ֣א אֶת־יְרוּשָׁלַ֔͏ִם פֶּ֖ה לָפֶֽה

“until he filled Jerusalem mouth to mouth”

The author is using the term **mouth** to mean “end” or “side.” If this term does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression in 10:21. Alternate translation: [until he filled Jerusalem from one end to the other] or [until he filled Jerusalem completely]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 21:16 (#3)

עַ֚ד אֲשֶׁר־מִלֵּ֣א אֶת־יְרוּשָׁלַ֔͏ִם פֶּ֖ה לָפֶֽה

“until he filled Jerusalem mouth to mouth”

The author is speaking as if Jerusalem had been a container and Manasseh had actually **filled** it with blood. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [until people had been killed violently in every part of Jerusalem]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 21:17 (#1)

וְיֶ֣תֶר דִּבְרֵ֣י מְנַשֶּׁ֗ה וְכָל־אֲשֶׁ֤ר עָשָׂה֙ וְחַטָּאת֔וֹ אֲשֶׁ֥ר חָטָ֖א הֲלֹא־הֵ֑ם כְּתוּבִ֗ים עַל־סֵ֚פֶר דִּבְרֵ֣י הַיָּמִ֔ים לְמַלְכֵ֖י יְהוּדָֽה

“Now the rest of the matters of Manasseh and all that he did and his sin that he sinned, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Judah”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is concluding the story of Manasseh. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar phrases in 1:18.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 21:17 (#2)

וְחַטָּאת֔וֹ אֲשֶׁ֥ר חָטָ֖א

“and his sin that he sinned”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [and the sins that he committed]

See: Poetry

2 Kings 21:18 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּ֥ב מְנַשֶּׁ֖ה עִם־אֲבֹתָ֑יו

“And Manasseh lay down with his fathers”

See how you translated the same expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [And Manasseh passed away] or [And Manasseh died]

See: Euphemism

2 Kings 21:18 (#2)

וַיִּקָּבֵ֖ר

“and he was buried”

The expression **was buried** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people buried him]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 21:19 (#1)

בֶּן־עֶשְׂרִ֥ים וּשְׁתַּ֛יִם שָׁנָ֥ה אָמ֖וֹן בְּמָלְכ֑וֹ וּשְׁתַּ֤יִם שָׁנִים֙ מָלַ֣ךְ בִּירוּשָׁלָ֔͏ִם וְשֵׁ֥שֶׁם אִמּ֖וֹ מְשֻׁלֶּ֣מֶת בַּת־חָרֻ֑ץ מִן־יָטְבָֽה

“Amon {was} a son of 22 years when he reigned, and he reigned two years in Jerusalem. And the name of his mother {was} Meshullemeth, the daughter of Haruz, from Jotbah”

In this verse and the next three verses, the author is introducing **Amon** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Judah**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:26.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 21:21 (#1)

וַיֵּ֖לֶךְ בְּכָל־הַדֶּ֣רֶךְ אֲשֶׁר־הָלַ֣ךְ אָבִ֑יו

“And he walked in every way that his father had walked”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:18. Alternate translation: [And he lived just as his father had lived]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 21:22 (#1)

וְלֹ֥א הָלַ֖ךְ בְּדֶ֣רֶךְ יְהוָֽה

“and he did not walk in the way of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:18. Alternate translation: [and he did not live as Yahweh wants people to live]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 21:24 (#1)

וַיַּ֣דְּךָ֔ עַם־הָאָ֖רֶץ אֵ֣ת

“But the people of the land struck”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:23. Alternate translation: [But the people of the land killed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 21:24 (#2)

וַיַּמְלִ֣יכוּ עַם־הָאָ֗רֶץ אֶת־יֹאשִׁיָּ֛הוּ בְּנ֖וֹ

“and the people of the land made Josiah his son reign”

Since the author has already used the expression **the people of the land** earlier in this sentence, it may be more natural in your language to use a pronoun here. Alternate translation: [and they made Josiah his son reign]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 21:25 (#1)

וְיֶ֣תֶר דִּבְרֵ֣י אָמ֔וֹן אֲשֶׁ֥ר עָשָׂ֖ה הֲלֹ֣א־הֵ֑ם כְּתוּבִ֗ים עַל־סֵ֛פֶר דִּבְרֵ֥י הַיָּמִ֖ים לְמַלְכֵ֥י יְהוּדָֽה

“Now the rest of the matters of Amon that he did, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Judah”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is concluding the story of Amon. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar phrases in 1:18.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 21:26 (#1)

וַיִּקְבְּר֥וּ אֹת֛וֹ

“And one buried him”

Here the author is using the pronoun **one** in a general sense, not to refer to a specific person. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And he was buried]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings - Chapter 22 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter begins the story of Josiah, another of the great kings of Judah. Because he is so important, the author describes the history of his reign at length, in chapters 22 and 23.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Long quotation in verses 15–20

There is a long quotation in verses 15–20 that contains multiple levels of quotation. Notes describe ways of indicating the speakers throughout this quotation. See what you did in the case of the similar long quotations in chapters 18 and 19, and present this quotation in the same way.

2 Kings 22:1 (#1)

בֶּן־שְׁמֹנֶ֣ה שָׁנָ֔ה יֹאשִׁיָּ֖הוּ בְּמָלְכ֑וֹ וּשְׁלֹשִׁ֣ים וְאַחַ֔ת שָׁנָ֥ה מָלַ֖ךְ בִּירוּשָׁלָ֑͏ִם וְשֵׁ֥שֶׁם אִמּ֖וֹ יְדִידָ֣ה בַת־עֲדָיָ֔ה מִבָּצְקַֽת

“Josiah {was} a son of 8 years when he reigned, and he reigned 31 years in Jerusalem. And the name of his mother {was} Yedidah, the daughter of Adaiah, from Bozkath”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is introducing **Josiah** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Judah**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:26.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 22:2 (#1)

וַיַּעַשׂ הַיָּשָׁר בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה וַיֵּלֶךְ בְּכָל־דֶּרֶךְ דָּוִד אָבִיו וְלֹא־סָר יָמִין וּשְׂמֹאול

“And he did right in the eyes of Yahweh, and he walked in every way of David his father, and he did not turn away, right or left”

The author is continuing to introduce Josiah. See how you translated the similar expressions in 3:2 and 8:18. Alternate translation: [And he did what Yahweh considered to be right, and he lived just as David his ancestor had lived, and he did not stop living that way in any regard]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 22:2 (#2)

וְלֹא־סָר יָמִין וּשְׂמֹאול

“and he did not turn away, right or left”

Within this image, the author is using two basic directions in which Josiah could have turned, **right** and **left**, to mean every direction. If you decide to retain the image in your translation, if it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and he did not turn away in any direction]

See: Merism

2 Kings 22:3 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened”

The author is using this phrase to introduce a new event. See how you translated it in 2:1.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 22:3 (#2)

בְּבֵית יְהוָה

“to the house of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:18. Alternate translation: [to the temple of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 22:4 (#1)

עֲלֵה

“Go up”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [Go]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 22:4 (#2)

וְיַתֵּם אֶת־הַכֶּסֶף

“and he shall complete the silver”

Josiah is using **complete the silver** as a common expression of his culture to mean that Hilkiah should “prepare” the silver that has been collected to be paid out to workers. In other words, he should determine the weight of the silver and put it in bags of a given weight and value. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he shall prepare the silver to use as payment]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 22:4 (#3)

אֶת־הַכֶּסֶף הַמּוּבָא בֵּית יְהוָה

“the silver having been brought {into} the house of Yahweh”

The expression **having been brought** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that the priests have brought into the house of Yahweh]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 22:5 (#1)

עַל־יַד

“into the hand of”

To translate the term “hand” here and in verse 7, see how you translated the similar expression in 12:11. Alternate translation: [into the custody of]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 22:5 (#2)

עַל־יַד

“into the hand of”

In this verse, the word **hand** is singular in form, but it refers to the hands of all of the men who had been appointed to supervise the work. If you decide to keep the image of a **hand** that represents custody, if it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of the word. Alternate translation: [into the hands]

See: Collective Nouns

2 Kings 22:5 (#3)

הַמַּפְקְדִ֔ים בבית יְהוָ֖ה

“the ones appointed over the house of Yahweh”

The expression **appointed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the ones responsible for the house of Yahweh]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 22:6 (#1)

וְאַבְנֵ֥י מַחְצֵ֖ב

“and stones of hewing”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:12. Alternate translation: [and stones that workers had cut into shape]

See: Possession

2 Kings 22:7 (#1)

לֹא־יֵחָשֵׁ֤שֶׁב אִתָּם֙ הַכֶּ֔סֶף הַנִּתָּ֖ן עַל־יָדָ֑ם כִּ֥י בֶאֱמוּנָ֖ה הֵ֥ם עֹשִֽׂים

“the silver given to their hand shall not be reckoned with them, because they are acting in faithfulness”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [since they are acting in faithfulness, the silver given to their hand shall not be reckoned with them]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 22:7 (#2)

לֹא־יֵחָשֵׁ֤שֶׁב אִתָּם֙ הַכֶּ֔סֶף הַנִּתָּ֖ן עַל־יָדָ֑ם

“the silver given to their hand shall not be reckoned with them”

The expressions **give** and **shall be not reckoned** contain passive verbal forms. If your language would not use those forms, you could express the ideas in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you shall not reckon with them the silver you give into their hand]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 22:7 (#3)

בֶּאֱמוּנָֽה

“in faithfulness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **faithfulness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [faithfully]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Kings 22:9 (#1)

דָּבָ֑ר

“a word”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:7. Alternate translation: [a report]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 22:9 (#2)

עֲבָדֶ֖יךָ

“Your servants”

Shaphan is speaking of himself and his fellow officials in the third person as **Your servants** to show humility. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a humble form in the first person. Alternate translation: [We, your servants,]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 22:9 (#3)

אֶת־הַכֶּ֙סֶף֙ הִנְמְצָ֔א בַּבַּ֖יִת

“the silver found in the house”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:18. Alternate translation: [the silver that was in the house]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 22:9 (#4)

עַל־יַד֙ עֹשֵׂ֣י הַמְּלָאכָ֔ה הַמַּפְקְדִ֖ים בְּבֵ֣ית יְהוָ֑ה

“into the hand of the doers of the work, the ones appointed {over} the house of Yahweh”

See how you translated these same expressions in 22:5. Alternate translation: [into the custody of the doers of the work, the ones responsible for the house of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 22:10 (#1)

לִפְנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ

“to the face of the king”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:14. Alternate translation: [in the presence of the king]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 22:11 (#1)

וַיִּקְרַע אֶת־בְּגָדָיו

“that he tore his clothes”

See how you indicated the significance of this action in 2:12. Alternate translation: [that he tore his clothes to show his great distress]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 22:13 (#1)

וּבְעַד־הָעָם

“and for the people”

Josiah assumes that these officials will know that by **the people**, he means the people of the city of Jerusalem. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and for the people of Jerusalem]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 22:13 (#2)

הַסֵּפֶר הַנִּמְצָא הַזֶּה

“this scroll having been found”

The expression **having been found** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [this scroll that Hilkiah found]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 22:13 (#3)

גְּדוֹלָה חֲמַת יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר־הִיא֙ נִצְּתָה֙ בָּ֔נוּ

“great {is} the heat of Yahweh, that which is kindled against us”

See how you translated the similar expression “the nose of Yahweh burned against Israel” in 13:3. Alternate translation: [great is the anger of Yahweh, that which is has been provoked against us]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 22:13 (#4)

גְּדוֹלָה חֲמַת יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר־הִיא֙ נִצְּתָה֙ בָּ֔נוּ

“great {is} the heat of Yahweh, that which is kindled against us”

The expression **is kindled** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [great {is} the heat of Yahweh, that which is burning against us] or [great is the anger of Yahweh that we have provoked]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 22:13 (#5)

לֹא־שָׁמְעוּ֙ & עַל־דִּבְרֵי֙ הַסֵּפֶ֔ר הַזֶּ֑ה

“did not listen to the words of this scroll”

By **did not listen to the words of this scroll**, King Josiah means that the ancestors of the Judeans did not obey what was written in the scroll. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [did not do what this scroll said to do]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 22:13 (#6)

כְּכָל־הַכָּתֻ֖ב

“according to everything written”

The expression **written** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [everything that it records]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 22:14 (#1)

שַׁלֻּ֣ם הַבֶּגְדִ֑ים

“the keeper of the clothes”

This could mean: (1) that Shallum was responsible to care for the vestments of the priests, like the official described in 10:22. Alternate translation: [the official who cared for the priests’ vestments] or (2) that Shal-

lum was responsible to care for the king's royal robes. Alternate translation: [the official who cared for the king's royal robes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 22:14 (#2)

בַּמִּשְׁנֶה

"in the Second Quarter"

The word that the ULT translates as **the Second Quarter** means "second" or "second part." Many scholars believe that it described a newer, expanded district of Jerusalem that was built to the north of the original city as the city grew, possibly during the reign of King Hezekiah or his successors. Some translations call this the "New Quarter" or the "Second District." If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the name that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the name that the ULT uses.

See: How to Translate Names

2 Kings 22:15 (#1)

וַתֹּאמֶר אֲלֵיהֶם כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אִמְרוּ לָאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר־שָׁלַח אֶתְכֶם אֵלָי

"And she said to them, "Thus says Yahweh, the God of Israel, 'Say to the man who sent you to me"

See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter of the long quotation in verses 15–20, in which there are multiple levels of quotation. If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this verse so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And she told them, "Yahweh, the God of Israel, wants you to tell the man who sent you to me]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 22:16 (#1)

כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה הִנְנִי מֵבִיא רָעָה אֶל־הַמָּקוֹם הַזֶּה וְעַל־יֹשְׁבָיו אֵת כָּל־דִּבְרֵי הַסֵּפֶר אֲשֶׁר קָרָא מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה

"Thus says Yahweh, 'Behold me, bringing disaster to this place and upon its inhabitants, all of the words of the scroll that the king of Judah has read"

There are four levels of quotation here. The author is quoting what Huldah said, continuing from the previous verse (level 1). This includes instructions from Yahweh, also continuing from the previous verse (level 2). These instructions include something that Yahweh wants the officials to say (level 3). And that includes a further quotation from Yahweh (level 4). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or third-level quotations.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 22:16 (#2)

כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה הִנְנִי מֵבִיא רָעָה אֶל־הַמָּקוֹם הַזֶּה וְעַל־יֹשְׁבָיו אֵת כָּל־דִּבְרֵי הַסֵּפֶר אֲשֶׁר קָרָא מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה

"Thus says Yahweh, 'Behold me, bringing disaster to this place and upon its inhabitants, all of the words of the scroll that the king of Judah has read"

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [that he says that he is about to bring disaster to this place and upon its inhabitants, all of the words of the scroll that the king of Judah has read]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 22:16 (#3)

כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה

"Thus says Yahweh"

Yahweh is speaking of himself in the third person because he is making a solemn declaration. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [This is what I have to say to you]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 22:16 (#4)

הִנְנִי מֵבִיא רָעָה

"Behold me, bringing disaster"

See how you translated the similar expression in 21:12. Alternate translation: [I am about to bring disaster]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 22:16 (#5)

אֵת כָּל־דִּבְרֵי הַסֵּפֶר אֲשֶׁר קָרָא מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה

"all of the words of the scroll that the king of Judah has read"

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:7. Alternate translation: [all of the punishments described in the scroll that the king of Judah has read]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 22:17 (#1)

תַּתָּחַת ׀ אֲשֶׁשֶׁר עֲזָבֻנִי וַיְקַטְּרוּ֙ לֵאלֹהִ֣ים אֲחֵרִ֔ים לְמַ֨עַן֙ הַכְעִיסֵ֔נִי בְּכֹ֖ל מַעֲשֵׂ֣ה יְדֵיהֶ֑ם וְנִצְּתָ֤ה חֲמָתִי֙ בַּמָּק֣וֹם הַזֶּ֔ה וְלֹ֥א תִכְבֶּֽה

“because they abandoned me and burned incense to other gods, so that they made me angry by all of the works of their hands. So my heat is kindled against this place, and it will not extinguish”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [because they abandoned him and burned incense to other gods, so that they have made him angry by all of the works of their hands. So his heat is kindled against this place, and it will not extinguish]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 22:17 (#2)

וַיְקַטְּרוּ֙ לֵאלֹהִ֣ים אֲחֵרִ֔ים

“and burned incense to other gods”

Yahweh is using one act of worship, burning **incense**, to mean worship in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and worshiped other gods]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 22:17 (#3)

בְּכֹ֖ל מַעֲשֵׂ֣ה יְדֵיהֶ֑ם

“by all of the works of their hands”

Yahweh is using the phrase **the works of their hands** to mean the idols that the Judeans made with their **hands**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [by all the idols that they made] or [by making all those idols]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 22:17 (#4)

וְנִצְּתָ֤ה חֲמָתִי֙ בַּמָּק֣וֹם הַזֶּ֔ה וְלֹ֥א תִכְבֶּֽה

“So my heat is kindled against this place, and it will not extinguish”

Here, **this place** represents the people who live in that place. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [So my heat is kindled against the people who live in this place, and it will not extinguish]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 22:17 (#5)

וְנִצְּתָ֤ה חֲמָתִי֙ בַּמָּק֣וֹם הַזֶּ֔ה וְלֹ֥א תִכְבֶּֽה

“So my heat is kindled against this place, and it will not extinguish”

See how you translated the similar expression in 22:13. Alternate translation: [So I have become very angry with the people who live in this place, and I will not stop being angry]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 22:17 (#6)

וְלֹ֥א תִכְבֶּֽה

“and it will not extinguish”

This verse is the conclusion of the second-level, third-level, and fourth-level quotations that began in the previous two verses. If you have decided to use punctuation to mark levels of quotation, end this verse with the appropriate punctuation for closing those levels of quotation.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 22:18 (#1)

וְאֶל־מֶ֣לֶךְ יְהוּדָ֗ה הַשֹּׁלֵ֤חַ אֶתְכֶם֙ לִדְרֹ֣שׁ אֶת־יְהוָ֔ה כֹּ֥ה תֹאמְר֖וּ אֵלָ֑יו כֹּה־אָמַ֞ר יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֗ל הַדְּבָרִ֔ים אֲשֶׁ֥ר שָׁמָֽעְתָּ

“But to the king of Judah, the one having sent you to seek Yahweh, thus you shall say to him, ‘Thus says Yahweh, the God of Israel, {about} the words that you heard”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [But tell the king of Judah, the one having sent you to seek Yahweh, that Yahweh, the God of Israel, says to him regarding the words that he heard]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 22:18 (#2)

הַדְּבָרִ֔ים אֲשֶׁ֥ר שָׁמָֽעְתָּ

“about} the words that you heard”

Huldah is referring to the **words** that Josiah **heard** when Shaphan read to him from the scroll. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [regarding what the scroll said would happen if the Israelites forsook him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 22:19 (#1)

יַ֗עַן רַךְ־לְבָבְךָ֙ וַתִּכָּנַ֣ע ׀ מִפְּנַ֣י יְהוָ֔ה בְּשָׁמְעֲךָ֖ אֲשֶׁ֣ר דִּבַּ֑רְתִּי עַל־הַמָּקוֹם֙ הַזֶּ֔ה וְעַל־יֹשְׁבָ֖יו לִֽהְיוֹת֙ לְשַׁמָּ֣ה וְלִקְלָלָ֔ה וַתִּקְרַ֖ע אֶת־בְּגָדֶ֑יךָ וַתִּבְכֶּ֥ה לְפָנַ֖י וְגַ֣ם אָנֹכִ֔י שָׁמַ֥עְתִּי נְאֻם־יְהוָֽה

“Because your heart is tender and you humbled yourself from the face of Yahweh when you heard what I spoke against this place and against its dwellers, that they would become a horror and a curse, and you tore your clothes and wept to my face, now I, I have also heard.” The declaration of Yahweh”

There are three levels of quotation here. The author is quoting what Huldah said to the officials (level 1), continuing from verse 15. This includes what the officials are supposed to say to King Josiah, continuing from the previous verse (level 2). This includes a quotation from Yahweh, which begins in this verse (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not second-level or third-level quotations.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings 22:19 (#2)

יַ֗עַן רַךְ־לְבָבְךָ֙ וַתִּכָּנַ֣ע ׀ מִפְּנַ֣י יְהוָ֔ה בְּשָׁמְעֲךָ֖ אֲשֶׁ֣ר דִּבַּ֑רְתִּי עַל־הַמָּקוֹם֙ הַזֶּ֔ה וְעַל־יֹשְׁבָ֖יו לִֽהְיוֹת֙ לְשַׁמָּ֣ה וְלִקְלָלָ֔ה וַתִּקְרַ֖ע אֶת־בְּגָדֶ֑יךָ וַתִּבְכֶּ֥ה לְפָנַ֖י וְגַ֣ם אָנֹכִ֔י שָׁמַ֥עְתִּי נְאֻם־יְהוָֽה

“Because your heart is tender and you humbled yourself from the face of Yahweh when you heard what I spoke against this place and against its dwellers, that they would become a horror and a curse, and you tore your clothes and wept to my face, now I, I have also heard.” The declaration of Yahweh”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [that because his heart is tender and he humbled himself in his presence when he heard what he spoke against this place and against its dwellers, that they would become a horror and a curse, and he tore his clothes and wept to his face, he declares that now he, he has also heard]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 22:19 (#3)

רַךְ־לְבָבְךָ֙

“your heart is tender”

Here the **heart** represents a person’s feelings and disposition. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [your conscience is sensitive] or [you grieved for the sins of the Judeans]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 22:19 (#4)

מִפְּנַ֣י יְהוָ֔ה & לְפָנַ֖י

“from the face of Yahweh & to my face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:14. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Yahweh … in my presence]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 22:19 (#5)

מִפְּנַ֣י יְהוָ֔ה

“from the face of Yahweh”

Yahweh is speaking of himself in the third person because he is making a solemn declaration. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [from my face] or [in my presence]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 22:19 (#6)

לְשַׁמָּ֣ה

“a horror”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **word**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [something that would horrify people]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Kings 22:19 (#7)

וְלִקְלָלָ֔ה

“and a curse”

Yahweh means that people would **curse** others by saying that they wanted the same thing to happen to them that had happened to the Judeans. Alternate translation: [and an example that people will use to curse others]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 22:19 (#8)

וְגַ֣ם אָנֹכִ֔י שָׁמַ֖עְתִּי

“now I, I have also heard”

Yahweh is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I have ... heard** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize his personal awareness of what Josiah has done and said. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. See how you translated the similar expression “I, I also know” in 2:3. Alternate translation: [for my part, I have heard]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 22:19 (#9)

שָׁמַ֖עְתִּי

“I have & heard”

Yahweh means implicitly that he has **heard** the humble, repentant things that Josiah has said (and also seen his acts of humility and repentance). You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I have heard the humble, repentant things you have said and seen your humble, repentant actions]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 22:19 (#10)

נְאֻם־יְהוָֽה

“The declaration of Yahweh”

Yahweh is speaking of himself in the third person because he is making an authoritative proclamation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. See how you translated the same expression in 9:26. Alternate translation: [This is what I, Yahweh, declare]

See: First, Second or Third Person

2 Kings 22:20 (#1)

לָכֵ֗ן הִנְנִי֙ אֹסִפְךָ֣ עַל־אֲבֹתֶ֔יךָ וְנֶאֱסַפְתָּ֖ אֶל־קִבְרֹתֶ֑יךָ בְּשָׁלוֹם֙ וְלֹא־תִרְאֶ֣ינָה עֵינֶ֔יךָ בְּכֹ֖ל הָרָעָ֣ה אֲשֶׁר־אֲנִ֥י מֵבִ֛יא עַל־הַמָּקוֹם֥ הַזֶּ֖ה

“Therefore, behold me, gathering you to your fathers, and you will be gathered to your graves in peace, and your eyes will not see all of the disaster that I am bringing upon this place”

If you have decided to translate all of this long quotation in such a way that there will not be quotations within quotations, you can continue doing that in this verse. Alternate translation: [Tell him that Yahweh says that he is going to gather him to his fathers, and he will be gathered to his graves in peace, and his eyes will not see all of the disaster that he will bring upon this place]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 22:20 (#2)

הִנְנִי֙ אֹסִפְךָ֣ עַל־אֲבֹתֶ֔יךָ

“behold me, gathering you to your fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 20:5. Alternate translation: [I am going to gather you to your fathers]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 22:20 (#3)

הִנְנִי֙ אֹסִפְךָ֣ עַל־אֲבֹתֶ֔יךָ

“behold me, gathering you to your fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [I am going to allow you to die]

See: Euphemism

2 Kings 22:20 (#4)

וְנֶאֱסַפְתָּ֖ אֶל־קִבְרֹתֶ֑יךָ

“and you will be gathered to your graves”

Yahweh is likely using the plural form **graves** because he means that Josiah will be buried in the royal family plot, where there are many graves of earlier kings. It may be more natural in your language to use a singular form. Alternate translation: [and you will be buried in your grave] or [and you will be buried in the royal family plot]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

2 Kings 22:20 (#5)

וְנֶאֱסַפְתָּ֖ אֶל־קִבְרֹתֶ֑יךָ

“and you will be gathered to your graves”

The expression **will be gathered** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the Judeans will bury you in your grave]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 22:20 (#6)

בְּשָׁלוֹם

“in peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [peacefully]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Kings 22:20 (#7)

וְלֹא־תִרְאֶינָה עֵינֶיךָ

“and your eyes will not see”

Yahweh using one part of Josiah, his **eyes**, to mean all of him in the act of potentially seeing the **disaster** that he will bring upon Jerusalem. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you will not see] or [and you will not personally witness]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 22:20 (#8)

אֲשֶׁר־אֲנִי מֵבִיא עַל־הַמָּקוֹם הַזֶּה

“that I am bringing upon this place”

This is the conclusion of the second-level and third-level quotations that began in the previous two verses. It is also the end of the first-level quotation that began in verse 15. If you have decided to use punctuation to mark levels of quotation, end this verse with the appropriate punctuation for closing those levels of quotation.

See: Quote Markings

2 Kings - Chapter 23 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

In this chapter, the author concludes the story of Josiah, and he then continues to tell what the kings were like who ruled the kingdom of Judah.

1. King Josiah of Judah (22:1–23:30)
2. King Jehoahaz of Judah (23:31–35)
3. King Jehoiakim of Judah (23:36–24:7)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did Neco not want Jehoahaz to be king?

Pharaoh Neco removed Jehoahaz from being the king of Judah because, for one thing, he wanted to show that he was the one who was in control of that kingdom. By picking the next king himself and changing his name, Neco was telling the Judeans, “You must not make your own king without my permission.” Neco also may have believed that Jehoahaz would have been a stronger and more independent ruler, so he made his brother Eliakim the king instead. This was Neco’s way of making sure Judah stayed weak and under his rule.

How did Jehoahaz get to Riblah?

The Bible does not say exactly how Jehoahaz got to Riblah, where Pharaoh Neco put him in prison. Some interpreters suggest that Neco summoned Jehoahaz and so Jehoahaz went to Riblah by himself, hoping to show respect or obedience to Pharaoh. Others suggest that Pharaoh Neco’s soldiers captured Jehoahaz and brought him to Riblah as a prisoner because Neco had ordered them to do that. Either way, Jehoahaz appeared before Neco at Riblah, in the region of Hamath, where Neco deposed him as king and made him his prisoner.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

The Mount of Destruction

In 23:13, when the author refers to the “Mount of Destruction,” he is making a word play on the name of that mountain. Because olive trees grew there, and because olive oil was used for anointing, it was known as the Mount of Anointing. The author changes one vowel and an “h” to a “th” in the word for “anointing” to get a word that means “destruction.” He is calling the mountain by that name in order to emphasize that the corrupt worship represented by the pagan shrines that Solomon built there led to the destruction of the kingdom. If you have decided to use the same names that the author does in each place in the book, you may want to say “the Mount of Destruction” in your translation. However, since it is difficult to translate a play on words in one language into another language, you may want to call this mountain by its familiar name, the Mount of Olives, so that your readers will know that the author is referring to that mountain near Jerusalem. You could explain in a footnote what name the biblical author uses in Hebrew.

2 Kings 23:1 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁלַ֤ח הַמֶּ֙לֶךְ֙ וַיַּאַסְפ֣וּ אֵלָ֔יו

“And the king sent, and they gathered to him”

The pronoun **they** refers to messengers whom King Josiah **sent** out. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the king sent out messengers who gathered to him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 23:2 (#1)

וַיַּ֥עַל הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ

“And the king went up”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [And the king went]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 23:2 (#2)

בֵּ֣ית־יְהוָ֑ה

“to} the house of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:18. Alternate translation: [to the temple of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 23:2 (#3)

וְכָל־אִ֣ישׁ יְהוּדָ֗ה וְכֹל֙ יֹשְׁבֵ֣י יְרוּשָׁלַ֔͏ִם

“and every man of Judah and all of the dwellers of Jerusalem”

The author is saying **every** and **all** as an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [and people from throughout Judah and the various parts of Jerusalem]

See: Hyperbole

2 Kings 23:2 (#4)

וְכָל־אִ֣ישׁ יְהוּדָ֗ה

“and every man of Judah”

Here the masculine term **man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [and every man and woman of Judah]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

2 Kings 23:2 (#5)

וְכָל־הָעָ֖ם לְמִקְטַ֣ן וְעַד־גָּדֹ֑ול

“and all of the people from small and to great”

The author is providing a further description of the crowd of people from **Judah** and **Jerusalem** who gathered at the temple. By naming two extremes, **small** and **great** (poor and rich, or ordinary and powerful, or young and old), he means those extremes and everything in between. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [including people from a wide range of ages and classes]

See: Merism

2 Kings 23:2 (#6)

בְּאָזְנֵיהֶ֔ם

“in their ears”

See how you translated the similar expression in 18:26. Alternate translation: [in their hearing]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 23:2 (#7)

הַנִּמְצָ֖א

“having been found”

The expression **having been found** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that Hilkiah had found]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 23:3 (#1)

וַיַּעֲמֹ֤ד הַמֶּ֙לֶךְ֙ עַל־הָעַמּ֔וּד

“And the king stood by the pillar”

The author says in 11:14 that it was a “custom” for a new king to stand “by the pillar,” apparently a certain one of the pillars on the temple porch, as a visible sign of his loyalty to Yahweh. Josiah had already been the king for 18 years, but he was now symbolizing that he and his people were making a new start by together pledging their loyalty to Yahweh. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And the king stood by the pillar to show that he and his people were making a new start]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 23:3 (#2)

וַיִּכְרֹ֨ת אֶת־הַבְּרִ֜ית

“and he cut a covenant”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:4. Alternate translation: [and he made a covenant]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 23:3 (#3)

לִפְנֵ֣י יְהוָ֗ה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:14. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 23:3 (#4)

לָלֶ֤כֶת אַחֲרַי֙ יְהוָ֔ה

“to walk after Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:18. Alternate translation: [to live as Yahweh wished]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 23:3 (#5)

מִצְוֹתָ֣יו וְאֶת־עֵדוֹתָ֔יו וְאֶת־חֻקֹּתָ֖יו

“his commandments and his testimonies and his statutes”

The terms **commandments**, **testimonies**, and **statutes** mean similar things. The author is using the three terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [all of his commandments]

See: Doublet

2 Kings 23:3 (#6)

בְּכָל־לֵבָ֥ב וּבְכָל־נַפְשׁ֖

“with all of the heart and with all of the soul”

The author is referring to all of a person by naming two major components of a person, his **heart** and his **soul**. These represent overlapping aspects of the inner life of a person, representing a person’s thoughts, feelings, desires, and intentions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Kings 2:4. Alternate translation: [wholeheartedly] or [with his entire being]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 23:3 (#7)

לְהָקִ֣ים אֶת־דִּבְרֵ֔י הַבְּרִ֖ית הַזֹּ֑את

“to raise up the words of this covenant”

The author is speaking as if the **words of this covenant** were objects that Josiah could **raise up**. He means that Josiah pledged to make happen what the covenant said should happen. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Kings 2:4. Alternate translation: [to make happen what the covenant said] or [to bring the covenant back into effect]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 23:3 (#8)

הַכְּתֻבִ֖ים עַל־הַסֵּ֣פֶר הַזֶּ֑ה

“written on that scroll”

The expression **written** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that that scroll recorded]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 23:3 (#9)

וַיַּעֲמֹ֖ד כָּל־הָעָ֑ם בַּבְּרִֽית

“And all of the people stood in the covenant”

The author is using **stood in the covenant** as a common expression of his culture to mean “agreed to the covenant” or “became parties to the covenant.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And all of the people joined in the covenant] or [And all of the people agreed to the terms of the covenant]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 23:4 (#1)

הָעֲשׂוּיִ֣ם

“having been made”

The expression **having been made** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that previous kings had made] or [that previous kings had commanded their workers to make]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 23:4 (#2)

וּלְכֹל֙ צְבָ֣א הַשָּׁמָ֔יִם

“and for the whole army of the heavens”

See how you translated the similar expression in 17:16. Alternate translation: [and for all the lights in the sky] or [and for the heavenly bodies]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 23:4 (#3)

וְנָשָׂ֥א אֶת־עֲפָרָ֖ם בֵּֽית־אֵֽל

“and he brought their ashes {to} Bethel”

Bringing the **ashes** of the burned idolatrous objects to the city of **Bethel**, which was outside the borders of Judah but under Judean control, was a symbolic action by which Josiah showed that he wanted no trace of these objects to remain in his kingdom. Furthermore, since idolatry in Israel had begun when Jeroboam placed a calf image in Bethel, this was a symbolic way of sending idolatry back to where it began in order to end it definitively. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and he sent their ashes out of Judah to Bethel, where Israel’s idolatry had begun]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 23:5 (#1)

לַשֶּׁ֣מֶשׁ וְלַיָּרֵ֗חַ וְלַמַּזָּל֙וֹת וּלְכֹל֙ צְבָ֣א הַשָּׁמָ֔יִם

“to the sun and to the moon and to the constellations and to the whole army of the heavens”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [to the sun and to the moon and to the constellations, yes, to the whole army of the heavens]

See: Parallelism

2 Kings 23:6 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁלֵ֖ךְ אֶת־עֲפָרָ֑הּ עַל־קִבְרֵ֖י בְּנֵ֥י הָעָֽם

“and he threw its dust over the grave of the sons of the people”

Since any contact with a dead body, including walking over a grave, made a person ceremonially unclean (Numbers 19:16), throwing the **dust** of the **Asherah** pole that had been in the temple onto a **grave** was a symbolic action by which Josiah rendered the remains of this object unclean and completely unsuitable for use in worship. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and he threw its dust over the grave of the sons of the people to make it defiled]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 23:6 (#2)

קִבְרֵ֖י

“the grave of”

In this verse, the word **grave** is singular in form, but it refers to all of the graves in this area outside Jerusalem. It appears that people who could not afford a tomb cut into rock were buried in a common plot there. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “grave.” Alternate translation: [the graves of]

See: Collective Nouns

2 Kings 23:6 (#3)

בְּנֵ֥י הָעָֽם

“the sons of the people”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:16. Alternate translation: [the common people]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 23:7 (#1)

אֲשֶׁ֤ר הַנָּשִׁים֙ אֹרְגוֹת֙ שָׁ֔ם בָּתִּ֖ים לָאֲשֵׁרָֽה

“where women were weaving houses there for Asherah”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. You can do the same with the similar expression in the next verse. Alternate translation: [where women were weaving houses for Asherah]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 23:7 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר הַנָּשִׁ֛ים אֹרְגוֹת שָׁ֖ם בָּתִּ֑ים לָֽאֲשֵׁרָֽה

“where women were weaving houses there for Asherah”

Since actual **houses** are not something that people make by **weaving**, the author seems to be using the term to represent something else. Interpreters are not entirely sure what this was, but many suggest that these were either fabric coverings for images of Asherah or small, decorated tents representing dwellings for Asherah. If it would be helpful in your language, you could suggest one of these meanings in your translation. You could also use a general expression. Alternate translation: [where women wove coverings for Asherah images] or [where women did weaving for Asherah]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 23:8 (#1)

מִגֶּ֣בַע עַד־בְּאֵ֣ר שָׁ֔בַע

“from Geba to Beersheba”

The author is referring to all of the territory of Judah by naming two extremes, the city of Geba at its northern edge and the city of Beersheba in the far south. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [throughout the territory of Judah]

See: Merism

2 Kings 23:8 (#2)

אֶת־בָּמ֣וֹת הַשְּׁעָרִ֗ים

“the high places of the gates”

The author is using the expression **high places** to represent the kind of shrines that people built on high places, that is, on hilltops. Since these were in cities, at their **gates**, they would not necessarily have been in the highest location in a given area. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the gate shrines]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 23:8 (#3)

אִ֖ישׁ

“a man”

Here the masculine term **man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [a person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

2 Kings 23:8 (#4)

בְּשַׁ֣עַר הָעִ֔יר

“at the gate of the city”

The author assumes that readers will understand that by **the gate**, he means the main gate of Jerusalem. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [at the main gate of the city]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 23:9 (#1)

אַ֣ךְ ׀ לֹ֣א יַעֲל֗וּ כֹּהֲנֵי֙ הַבָּמ֣וֹת אֶל־מִזְבַּ֣ח יְהוָ֔ה בִּירוּשָׁלִָ֑ם כִּֽי־אִ֣ם אָכְל֗וּ מַצּוֹת֙ בְּת֣וֹךְ אֲחֵיהֶֽם

“However, the priests of the high places did not go up to the altar of Yahweh in Jerusalem. Rather, they ate unleavened bread in the midst of their brothers”

The author is providing background information about the priests he described in the previous verse. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

2 Kings 23:9 (#2)

לֹ֣א יַעֲל֗וּ כֹּהֲנֵי֙ הַבָּמ֣וֹת אֶל־מִזְבַּ֣ח יְהוָ֔ה בִּירוּשָׁלִָ֑ם

“the priests of the high places did not go up to the altar of Yahweh in Jerusalem”

Not allowing the **priests** who had previously served at the **high places** was a symbolic action by which Josiah kept any trace of false worship away from the Jerusalem temple. These priests were descendants of Aaron who had been burning incense to Yahweh, but they had been doing so at unauthorized locations. This worship was therefore impure, and those who had led the people in it had to be kept away from Yahweh’s altar. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote.

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 23:9 (#3)

לֹ֣א יַעֲל֗וּ & אֶל־מִזְבַּ֤ח יְהוָה֙

“did not go up to the altar of Yahweh”

The author is using **go up to the altar** as a common expression of his culture to mean “offer sacrifices on the altar.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [serve at the altar of Yahweh] or [offer sacrifices on the altar of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 23:9 (#4)

כִּֽי־אִם־אָכְל֥וּ מַצּ֛וֹת

“Rather, they ate unleavened bread”

The author is using one kind of food that the priests received as their share of sacrifices, the **unleavened bread** that they made from grain offerings, to mean all of the food that the priests received from sacrifices for their support. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [However, they were allowed to live off the food from the priests’ share of the sacrifices]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 23:9 (#5)

בְּתוֹךְ֙ אֲחֵיהֶ֔ם

“in the midst of their brothers”

The author is speaking as if the other priests were actually the **brothers** of these priests who had been serving at hilltop shrines. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [together with their fellow priests]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 23:10 (#1)

לְבִלְתִּ֗י לְהַעֲבִ֛יר אִ֥ישׁ אֶת־בְּנ֖וֹ וְאֶת־בִּתּ֑וֹ בָּאֵ֣שׁ לַמֹּלֶךְ֒

“so that a man could not make his son or his daughter pass through the fire to Molech”

See how you translated the similar expression in 16:3. Alternate translation: [so that no one could burn up his son or his daughter completely as an offering to Molech]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 23:11 (#1)

וְאֶת־מַרְכְּבֹ֣ת הַשֶּׁ֔מֶשׁ שָׂרַ֖ף בָּאֵ֑שׁ

“And he burned the chariots of the sun with fire”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can use an expression that would be natural. Alternate translation: [And he burned up the chariots of the sun]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 23:12 (#1)

אֲשֶׁ֣ר עַל־הַגָּג֮ עֲלִיַּ֣ת אָחָז֒

“that {were} on the roof, the upper chamber of Ahaz”

This could mean: (1) that these **altars** were on the **roof** of an **upper chamber** that **Ahaz** had built somewhere in the palace complex. Alternate translation: [that were on the roof of the upper chamber of Ahaz] or (2) that these **altars** were on the **roof** of the palace, near an **upper chamber** that **Ahaz** had built. Alternate translation: [that were on the palace roof near the upper chamber of Ahaz]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 23:12 (#2)

וַיֵּ֣רֶץ מִשָּׁ֔ם וְהִשְׁלִ֖יךְ אֶת־עֲפָרָ֑ם אֶל־נַ֖חַל קִדְרֽוֹן

“And he ran from there and threw their dust into the Valley of Kidron”

The verbs **ran** and **threw** together express a single idea. The word **ran** tells in what way Josiah removed the dust and **threw** it into the Kidron Valley (or had his servants do this). If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [And he hastened to have their dust thrown into the Valley of Kidron]

See: Hendiadys

2 Kings 23:13 (#1)

אֲשֶׁ֣ר ׀ עַל־פְּנֵ֣י יְרוּשָׁלִַ֗ם

“that {were} on the face of Jerusalem”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:12. Alternate translation: [that were in front of Jerusalem] or [that were opposite Jerusalem]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 23:13 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר֙ מִימִ֣ין

“which {were} on the right of”

The author is speaking of directions in the way characteristic of his culture, in which people described directions as if a person were facing east, toward the sunrise. The south would be to the right of such a person. So the author means these **high places** were on the south side of the mountain. Alternate translation: [that were on the south side of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 23:13 (#3)

לְהַר־הַמַּשְׁחִית֙

“the Mount of Destruction”

See the discussion of this name in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [the Mount of Olives]

See: How to Translate Names

2 Kings 23:13 (#4)

בְּנֵי־עַמּ֔וֹן

“the sons of Ammon”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:12. Alternate translation: [the Ammonites]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 23:14 (#1)

וַיְמַלֵּ֛א אֶת־מְקוֹמָ֖ם עַצְמ֥וֹת אָדָֽם

“and he filled their place with bones of man”

Since contact with a dead body caused ritual uncleanness, putting human bones on the sites of these high places made them unsuitable for any further use in worship. See how you explained the significance of Josiah’s similar action of scattering the dust of the vessels of Baal and Asherah on human graves in 23:6.

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 23:16 (#1)

כִּדְבַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה

“according to the word of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:7. Alternate translation: [according to the message from Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 23:16 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֣ר קָרָ֔א אִ֖ישׁ הָאֱלֹהִ֑ים אֲשֶׁ֣ר קָרָ֗א אֶת־הַדְּבָרִ֛ים הָאֵֽלֶּה

“that the man of God proclaimed who had proclaimed these things”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [about these things that the man of God had proclaimed]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 23:17 (#1)

הַקֶּ֣בֶר אִישׁ־הָאֱלֹהִ֗ים

“The grave of the man of God”

The men of the city are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [That monument is the grave of the man of God]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 23:18 (#1)

הַנִּ֣יחוּ לוֹ֮ אִ֣ישׁ אַל־יָנַ֣ע עַצְמֹתָיו֒

“Let him stay. Let not a man disturb his bones”

Josiah is using two phrases to say basically the same thing, first positively and then negatively. The repetition emphasizes the idea that the phrases convey. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Let no one disturb his bones at all]

See: Parallelism

2 Kings 23:18 (#2)

וְיִמְלְט֖וּ עַצְמֹתָ֑יו

“And they rescued his bones”

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [So the men of the city rescued his bones]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 23:18 (#3)

הַנָּבִיא אֲשֶׁר־בָּבָא מִשֹּׁמְרוֹן

“the prophet who came from Samaria”

To translate the name **Samaria**, meaning the northern kingdom of Israel, here and in the next verse, see how you decided to represent it in 17:24. Alternate translation: [the prophet who was from the northern kingdom]

See: How to Translate Names

2 Kings 23:19 (#1)

בָּתֵּי הַבָּמֹות

“the houses of the high places”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:18. Alternate translation: [the shrines on high places]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 23:19 (#2)

לְהַכְעִיס

“provoking anger”

The author assumes that readers will understand that by **provoking anger**, he means that the **kings of Israel** provoked Yahweh’s anger when they made these shrines. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [provoking Yahweh’s anger]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 23:20 (#1)

וַיִּזְבַּח

“And he sacrificed”

The author does not mean that Josiah **sacrificed** these **priests** to Yahweh. He did not offer them on these **altars** as human sacrifices. Rather, he means that Josiah slaughtered them right on their pagan altars as if they had been sacrifices. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And he slaughtered]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 23:21 (#1)

כַּכָּתוּב עַל סֵפֶר הַבְּרִית הַזֶּה

“as written in this scroll of the covenant”

The expression **written** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [as this scroll of the covenant specifies]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 23:22 (#1)

כִּי לֹא נֶעֱשָׂה כַּפֶּסַח הַזֶּה

“Now like this Passover was not done”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand the significance of what Josiah did in this instance. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

2 Kings 23:22 (#2)

לֹא נֶעֱשָׂה כַּפֶּסַח הַזֶּה

“like this Passover was not done”

The expression **had not been done** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [no one had observed the Passover in this way]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 23:22 (#3)

מִימֵי הַשֹּׁפְטִים

“from the days of the judges”

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:36. Alternate translation: [from the time of the judges]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 23:22 (#4)

הַשֹּׁפְטִים אֲשֶׁר שָׁפְטוּ אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the judges who judged Israel”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [the Israelite judges]

See: Poetry

2 Kings 23:23 (#1)

כִּי אִם־בִּשְׁמֹנֶה עֶשְׂרֵהׇ שָׁנָה לַמֶּלֶךְ יֹאשִׁיָּ֔הוּ נַעֲשָׂ֥תָה הַפֶּ֖סַח הַזֶּ֑ה לַיהוָ֖ה בִּירוּשָׁלָֽם

“except in the eighteenth year of King Josiah this Passover was done for Yahweh in Jerusalem”

If it would appear in your language that the author was making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement, combining verses 22 and 23. Alternate translation: [The only occasion on which the Israelites celebrated Passover during the whole time that the judges judged Israel and kings ruled in Israel and Judah was in the eighteenth year of King Josiah, when the people of Jerusalem observed Passover for Yahweh]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

2 Kings 23:23 (#2)

נַעֲשָׂ֥תָה הַפֶּ֖סַח הַזֶּ֑ה

“this Passover was done”

The expression **was done** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the people observed this Passover]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 23:24 (#1)

אֶת־הָאֹבֹ֥ת וְאֶת־הַיִּדְּעֹנִ֖ים

“the ritual pits and the familiar spirits”

See how you translated these expressions in 21:6.

See: Translate Unknowns

2 Kings 23:24 (#2)

וְאֶת־הַתְּרָפִ֔ים

“and the teraphim”

The term **teraphim** describes idols that people in this culture kept in their homes. If your readers would not be familiar with what these were, in your translation you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a general expression. If you have already translated the book of 1 Samuel, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Samuel 15:23. Alternate translation: [and the household idols]

See: Translate Unknowns

2 Kings 23:24 (#3)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר נִרְאוּ֙

“that were seen”

The author is using the term **seen** in a way characteristic of his language and culture to mean that these **abominations** could be seen, that is, they were present in **Judah** and **Jerusalem**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the comparable expression “that was found” in 20:13. Alternate translation: [that were]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 23:24 (#4)

לְהָקִ֗ים & עַל

“in order to raise up & in”

See how you translated the similar expression in 23:3. Alternate translation: [in order to bring back into effect]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 23:24 (#5)

הַכְּתֻבִ֔ים עַל־הַסֵּ֖פֶר

“written in the scroll”

See how you translated the similar expression in 23:3. Alternate translation: [that the scroll recorded]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 23:25 (#1)

לְפָנָ֑יו

“to his face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 17:2. Alternate translation: [before him]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 23:25 (#2)

בְּכָל־לְבָבְוֹ֙ וּבְכָל־נַפְשׁ֔וֹ וּבְכָל־מְאֹדֹ֖וֹ

“with all of his heart and with all of his soul and with all of his strength”

See how you translated the similar expression in 23:3. Alternate translation: [energetically with his entire being]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 23:25 (#3)

לֹא־קָ֥ם כָּמֹ֖הוּ

“one has not arisen like him”

The author is speaking as if a later king might have physically **arisen**, or gone up into the air or to an elevated location. In contexts such as this, this expression describes a person assuming a powerful position. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Kings 14:7. Alternate translation: [one like him has not come to power] or [one like him has not reigned]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 23:26 (#1)

לֹא־שָׁ֣ב יְהוָ֗ה מֵחֲר֤וֹן אַפּוֹ֙ הַגָּדֹ֔ול אֲשֶׁר־חָרָ֥ה אַפּ֖וֹ בִּיהוּדָ֑ה

“Yahweh did not turn from the great burning of his nose {with} which his nose burned against Judah”

See how you translated the similar expression in 13:13. Alternate translation: [Yahweh remained very angry with the anger that he felt against Judah]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 23:26 (#2)

לֹא־שָׁ֣ב יְהוָ֗ה מֵחֲר֤וֹן אַפּוֹ֙ הַגָּדֹ֔ול אֲשֶׁר־חָרָ֥ה אַפּ֖וֹ בִּיהוּדָ֑ה

“Yahweh did not turn from the great burning of his nose {with} which his nose burned against Judah”

The author is using a construction in which a verb (**burned**) and its object (**burning**) come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, whether or not you retain some or all of the image in your translation, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [Yahweh’s anger continued to burn greatly against Judah] or [Yahweh continued to feel very great anger against Judah]

See: Poetry

2 Kings 23:26 (#3)

כֹּל־הַכְּעָסִ֔ים אֲשֶׁ֥ר הִכְעִיסָ֖ו מְנַשֶּׁ֑ה

“all of the provocations {by} which Manasseh had provoked him”

In this instance as well, the author is using a construction in which a verb (**provoked**) and its object (**provocations**) come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [all that things that Manasseh had done that made him angry]

See: Poetry

2 Kings 23:27 (#1)

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר יְהוָ֗ה גַּ֣ם אֶת־יְהוּדָה֮ אָסִ֣יר מֵעַ֣ל פָּנַ֒י כַּאֲשֶׁ֣ר הֵסַ֔רְתִּי אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“And Yahweh had said, “I will also remove Judah away from my face, just as I removed Israel”

The author seems to be rephrasing what Yahweh said in 21:13, “I will stretch over Jerusalem the measuring line of Samaria.” So it would be appropriate to use a verbal form in your language, as the ULT does, that shows that this is something Yahweh had said in the past, not something that he said even after Josiah made all of his reforms.

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

2 Kings 23:27 (#2)

מֵעַ֣ל פָּנַ֒י

“away from my face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 13:23. Alternate translation: [away from this land]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 23:27 (#3)

אָמַ֔רְתִּי יִהְיֶ֥ה שְׁמִ֖י שָֽׁם

“I said, ‘My name will be there”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [I said that my name would be there]

See: Quotes within Quotes

2 Kings 23:27 (#4)

יִהְיֶ֥ה שְׁמִ֖י שָֽׁם

“My name will be there”

See how you translated the similar expression in 21:7. Alternate translation: [It will be a special place for people to worship me]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 23:28 (#1)

וְיֶתֶר֙ דִּבְרֵ֣י יֹאשִׁיָּ֔הוּ וְכָל־אֲשֶׁ֥ר עָשָׂ֖ה הֲלֹא־הֵ֣ם כְּתוּבִ֑ים עַל־סֵ֚פֶר דִּבְרֵ֣י הַיָּמִ֔ים לְמַלְכֵ֖י יְהוּדָֽה

“Now the rest of the matters of Josiah and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Judah”

In this verse and the next two verses, the author is concluding the story of Josiah. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar phrases in 1:18.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 23:29 (#1)

בְּיָמָ֔יו

“In his days”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:20. Alternate translation: [During his reign]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 23:29 (#2)

לִקְרָאתֹ֖ו

“to meet him”

In this context, the word **meet** has the sense of “oppose.” Josiah was not coming to greet or support Neco but to fight him in order to keep him from marching his army through Judean territory. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [to oppose him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 23:29 (#3)

וַיְמִיתֵ֥הוּ

“but he killed him”

The pronoun **he** refers to Neco, while the pronoun **him** refers to Josiah. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [but Neco killed Josiah]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 23:29 (#4)

כִּרְאֹתֹ֖ו אֹתֹ֑ו

“when he saw him”

In this context, the word **saw** has the sense of “encounter.” Josiah and Neco did not have a face-to-face meeting at or after which Neco killed Josiah. When their armies fought, Josiah was killed in the battle. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [when he encountered him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 23:30 (#1)

וַיִּקְבְּרֻ֥הוּ

“And they buried him”

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people such as Josiah’s **servants** or soldiers, who are the subject in the previous sentence. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And he was buried] or [And people buried him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 23:31 (#1)

בֶּן־עֶשְׂרִ֣ים וְשָׁלֹ֣שׁ שָׁנָ֔ה יְהֹואָחָ֖ז בְּמָלְכֹ֑ו וּשְׁלֹשָׁ֥ה חֳדָשִׁ֛ים מָלַ֥ךְ בִּירוּשָׁלִָ֖ם וְשֵׁ֣ם אִמֹּ֔ו חֲמוּטַ֥ל בַּת־יִרְמְיָ֖הוּ מִלִּבְנָֽה

“Jehoahaz {was} a son of 23 years when he reigned, and he reigned three months in Jerusalem. And the name of his mother {was} Hamutal, the daughter of Jeremiah, from Libnah”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is introducing **Jehoahaz** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Judah**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:26.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 23:32 (#1)

וַיַּ֣עַשׂ הָרַ֔ע בְּעֵינֵ֖י יְהוָֽה

“And he did evil in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:2. Alternate translation: [And he did what Yahweh considered to be evil]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 23:32 (#2)

אֲבֹתָ֖יו

“his fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [his ancestors]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 23:33 (#1)

מֵאָ֣ה כִכַּר־כֶּ֔סֶף וְכִכַּ֥ר זָהָֽב

“100 kikkars of silver and a kikkar of gold”

See how you decided to represent the weight of a kikkar in 5:5.

See: Biblical Weight

2 Kings 23:34 (#1)

וַיַּסֵּב אֶת־שְׁמוֹ יְהוֹיָקִים

“and he changed his name {to} Jehoiakim”

Changing Eliakim’s name was a symbolic action by which Neco asserted his sovereignty over Judah and its ruler. (Since Eliakim means “God will establish” while Jehoiakim means “Yahweh will establish,” it is possible that Neco allowed Eliakim to choose his own new name. The symbolic significance was in the fact that Neco forced him to change his name.) If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and he changed his name to Jehoiakim to assert his sovereignty over him]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 23:35 (#1)

אַךְ֩ הֶעֱרִ֨יךְ אֶת־הָאָ֜רֶץ

“but he assessed the land”

Here, **the land** represents the people who lived in the land of Judah. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [but he assessed the people of the land] or [but he determined how much each person should pay]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 23:35 (#2)

אֶת־הַכֶּ֙סֶף֙ עַל־פִּ֣י פַרְעֹ֔ה

“the silver according to the mouth of Pharoah”

Here, Pharoah’s **mouth** represents what he said by using his mouth. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the amount of silver that Pharaoh had demanded]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 23:35 (#3)

וְהַכֶּ֙סֶף֙

“And & the silver”

The author is using one thing that Neco had demanded, the **silver**, to mean both things that Neco demanded, the silver and the gold. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the silver and gold]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 23:36 (#1)

בֶּן־עֶשְׂרִ֤ים וְחָמֵשׁ֙ שָׁנָ֣ה יְהוֹיָקִ֔ים בְּמָלְכֹ֖ו וְאַחַ֣ת עֶשְׂרֵ֑ה שָׁנָ֖ה מָלַ֣ךְ בִּירוּשָׁלָ֗͏ִם וְשֵׁ֨ם אִמּ֜וֹ זבידה בַּת־פְּדָיָ֧ה מִן־רוּמָֽה

“Jehoiakim {was} a son of 25 years when he reigned, and he reigned 11 years in Jerusalem. And the name of his mother {was} Zebidah, the daughter of Pedaiah, from Rumah”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is introducing **Jehoiakim** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Judah**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:26.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 23:37 (#1)

וַיַּ֣עַשׂ הָרַ֔ע בְּעֵינֵ֖י יְהוָֽה

“And he did evil in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:2. Alternate translation: [And he did what Yahweh considered to be evil]

See: Idiom

2 Kings - Chapter 24 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

In this chapter (continuing from the previous chapter and into the next chapter), the author tells what the last three kings were like who ruled the kingdom of Judah.

1. King Jehoiakim of Judah (23:36–24:7)
2. King Jehoiachin of Judah (24:8–17)
3. King Zedekiah of Judah (24:18–25:7)

2 Kings 24:1 (#1)

בְּיָמָ֣יו

“In his days”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:20. Alternate translation: [During his reign]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 24:1 (#2)

עָלָ֣ה

“came up”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [came] or [invaded]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 24:1 (#3)

וַיָּ֥שָׁב

“Then he returned”

The author is speaking as if Jehoiakim had been away somewhere and **returned**. He means that he decided to become a vassal of Egypt once again and so stopped serving Nebuchadnezzar. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Then he resumed his previous loyalty to Egypt]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 24:2 (#1)

כַּשְׂדִּ֔ים

“Chaldeans”

The term **Chaldeans** is another name for the people group also known as Babylonians. If you have decided to use the same names in your translation that the biblical author does in each place, you may wish to use the name Chaldeans here. If you have decided to use the same names for people and groups throughout your translation, you may wish to use the name Babylonians here.

See: How to Translate Names

2 Kings 24:2 (#2)

וְאֶת־גְּדוּדֵ֣י אֲרָ֔ם וְאֵ֖ת ׀ גְּדוּדֵ֣י מוֹאָ֑ב

“and raiding bands of Aram and raiding bands of Moab”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:1. Alternate translation: [and raiding bands of Arameans and raiding bands of Moabites]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 24:2 (#3)

בְּנֵ֥י־עַמּ֖וֹן

“the sons of Ammon”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:12. Alternate translation: [Ammonites]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 24:2 (#4)

כִּדְבַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה

“according to the word of Yahweh”

Since the author has already used the name Yahweh earlier in this verse, it may be more natural in your language to use a pronoun here. Alternate translation: [according to his word]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 24:2 (#5)

בְּיַ֣ד עֲבָדָ֔יו הַנְּבִיאִֽים

“by the hand of his servants the prophets”

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:36. Alternate translation: [through the agency of his servants the prophets]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 24:3 (#1)

עַל־פִּ֖י יְהוָ֑ה

“at the mouth of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 23:35. Alternate translation: [to fulfill what Yahweh had said]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 24:3 (#2)

הָיְתָ֥ה ׀ בִּיהוּדָ֖ה

“it was against Judah”

The author is speaking in a way that is characteristic of his culture by using a feminine verb, **it was**, to refer to a general situation. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [this came upon Judah] or [all of this happened to Judah]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 24:3 (#3)

מֵעַ֥ל פָּנָ֖יו

“away from his face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 13:23. Alternate translation: [away from their land]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 24:4 (#1)

דַּם־הַנָּקִ֑י אֲשֶׁ֥ר שָׁפָ֖ךְ

“for} the innocent blood that he poured out”

See how you translated the similar expression in 21:16. Alternate translation: [because he had killed many innocent people]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 24:4 (#2)

וַיְמַלֵּא אֶת־יְרוּשָׁלַ͏ִם דָּ֫ם נָקִי

“for he had filled Jerusalem {with} innocent blood”

See how you translated the similar expression in 21:16. Alternate translation: [for he had killed innocent people violently in every part of Jerusalem]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 24:5 (#1)

וְיֶ֣תֶר דִּבְרֵ֣י יְהוֹיָקִ֗ים וְכָל־אֲשֶׁ֤ר עָשָׂה֙ הֲלֹא־הֵ֣ם כְּתוּבִ֔ים עַל־סֵ֖פֶר דִּבְרֵ֣י הַיָּמִ֑ים לְמַלְכֵ֖י יְהוּדָֽה

“Now the rest of the matters of Jehoiakim and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the matters of the days of the kings of Judah”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is concluding the story of Jehoiakim. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar phrases in 1:18.

See: End of Story

2 Kings 24:6 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכַּ֥ב יְהוֹיָקִ֖ים עִם־אֲבֹתָ֑יו

“And Jehoiakim lay down with his fathers”

See how you translated the same expression in 8:24. Alternate translation: [And Jehoiakim passed away] or [And Jehoiakim died]

See: Euphemism

2 Kings 24:7 (#1)

וְלֹא־הֹסִ֥יף עוֹד֙ מֶ֣לֶךְ מִצְרַ֔יִם לָצֵ֖את מֵאַרְצ֑וֹ כִּי־לָקַ֤ח מֶֽלֶךְ־בָּבֶל֙ מִנַּ֣חַל מִצְרַ֔יִם עַד־נְהַר־פְּרָ֖ת כֹּ֥ל אֲשֶׁר֙ הָיְתָ֣ה לְמֶֽלֶךְ מִצְרָ֔יִם

“And the king of Egypt did not resume again to go out from his land, because the king of Babylon took all that had been to the king of Egypt from the wadi of Egypt to the Euphrates River”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And since the king of Babylon took all that had been to the king of Egypt from the wadi of Egypt to the Euphrates River the king of Egypt did not resume again to go out from his land]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 24:7 (#2)

וְלֹא־הֹסִ֥יף עוֹד֙ מֶ֣לֶךְ מִצְרַ֔יִם לָצֵ֖את מֵאַרְצ֑וֹ

“And the king of Egypt did not resume again to go out from his land”

It might seem that the expression **did not resume again** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [And the king of Egypt did not go out from his land anymore]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 24:8 (#1)

בֶּן־שְׁמֹנֶ֣ה עֶשְׂרֵ֣ה שָׁנָ֔ה יְהוֹיָכִ֖ין בְּמָלְכ֑וֹ וּשְׁלֹשָׁ֣ה חֳדָשִׁ֔ים מָלַ֖ךְ בִּירוּשָׁלָ͏ִם וְשֵׁ֣ם אִמּ֔וֹ נְחֻשְׁתָּ֖א בַּת־אֶלְנָתָ֥ן מִירוּשָׁלָֽ͏ִם

“Jehoiachin {was} a son of 18 years when he reigned, and he reigned in Jerusalem three months. And the name of his mother {was} Nehushta, the daughter of Elnathan, from Jerusalem”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is introducing **Jehoiachin** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Judah**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:26.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 24:9 (#1)

וַיַּ֣עַשׂ הָרַ֔ע בְּעֵינֵ֖י יְהוָֽה

“And he did evil in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:2. Alternate translation: [And he did what Yahweh considered to be evil]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 24:10 (#1)

וַתָּבֹ֥א הָעִ֖יר בַּמָּצֽוֹר

“and the city entered into siege”

The author is using **entered into siege** as a common expression of his culture to mean that the **servants of Nebuchadnezzar** (his military commanders) besieged the city. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or

you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the city came under siege] or [and they besieged the city]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 24:12 (#1)

בִּשְׁנַ֣ת שְׁמֹנֶ֔ה לְמָלְכֽוֹ

“in the year of eight to his reigning”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:25. Alternate translation: [in the eighth year of his reign]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 24:13 (#1)

אֶת־כָּל־אֹוצְרוֹת֙ בֵּ֣ית יְהוָ֔ה וְאֹוצְרֹ֖ות בֵּ֣ית הַמֶּ֑לֶךְ

“all of the treasuries of the house of Yahweh and the treasuries of the house of the king”

The plural form **treasuries** suggests that these terms represent the valuable items that were in the treasury of each building. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all of the valuable items that were in the treasury of the house of Yahweh and the treasury of the house of the king]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 24:13 (#2)

בֵּ֣ית יְהוָ֔ה

“the house of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:18. Alternate translation: [the temple of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 24:13 (#3)

וַיְקַצֵּ֕ץ אֶת־כָּל־כְּלֵ֥י הַזָּהָ֖ב

“and he cut off all of the furnishings of gold”

As the use of the verb translated as **cut off** in 16:17 and 18:16 indicates, the author means that Nebuchadnezzar had his men cut the **gold** off of these **furnishings**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and he cut the gold off all of the furnishings]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 24:14 (#1)

וְהִגְלֶ֗ה אֶת־כָּל־יְרוּשָׁלִַ֜ם וְאֶת־כָּל־הַשָּׂרִ֤ים וְאֵת֙ ׀ כָּל־גִּבֹּורֵ֣י הַחַ֔יִל עֲשֶׂ֥רֶת אֲלָפִ֖ים גֹּולֶ֑ה וְכָל־הֶחָרָ֣שׁ וְהַמַּסְגֵּ֔ר

“And he exiled all of Jerusalem and all of the commanders and all of the mighty of valor, exiling 10,000 and every craftsman and smith”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about **every craftsman and smith** with the information about the **commanders** and **warriors**. Alternate translation: [And he exiled all of Jerusalem and all of the commanders and all of the mighty of valor and every craftsman and smith, exiling 10,000]

See: Information Structure

2 Kings 24:14 (#2)

וְהִגְלֶ֗ה אֶת־כָּל־יְרוּשָׁלִַ֜ם וְאֶת־כָּל־הַשָּׂרִ֤ים וְאֵת֙ ׀ כָּל־גִּבֹּורֵ֣י הַחַ֔יִל וְכָל־הֶחָרָ֣שׁ וְהַמַּסְגֵּ֔ר &

“And he exiled all of Jerusalem and all of the commanders and all of the mighty of valor & and every craftsman and smith”

By **all of Jerusalem**, the author means everyone in the city in the categories he then describes. In other words, the phrases that follow limit the meaning of that phrase. Alternate translation: [And he exiled all of Jerusalem, that is, all of the commanders and all of the mighty of valor and every craftsman and smith] or [And he exiled all of the commanders and the mighty of valor and every craftsman and smith from Jerusalem]

See: Hyperbole

2 Kings 24:14 (#3)

גִּבֹּורֵ֣י הַחַ֔יִל

“the mighty of valor”

While this expression can describe great soldiers, that does not seem to be the meaning in this context. The author says in verse 16 that the Babylonians exiled 7,000 such people, and the Judean army would have had many more great soldiers than that. So the meaning seems instead to be the same as in 15:20, that these were wealthy and powerful citizens. See how you translated the expression there in order to determine how to translate it here and the similar one in verse 16 (“the men of valor”). Alternate translation: [the wealthy citizens]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 24:14 (#4)

עֲשֶׂ֥רֶת אֲלָפִ֖ים

“10,000”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language, here and in verse 16. Alternate translation: [10,000 people]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 24:14 (#5)

לֹ֣א נִשְׁאַ֔ר זוּלַ֖ת דַּלַּ֣ת עַם־הָאָֽרֶץ

“One was not left except the poor of the people of the land”

If it would appear in your language that the author was making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [The only ones left were the poor of the people of the land]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

2 Kings 24:14 (#6)

דַּלַּ֣ת עַם־הָאָֽרֶץ

“the poor of the people of the land”

The author is using the adjective **poor** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the poor people who lived in the land]

See: Nominal Adjectives

2 Kings 24:16 (#1)

וְהֶחָרָ֥שׁ וְהַמַּסְגֵּ֖רֹ

“and the craftsman and the smith”

The author is not referring to a specific **craftsman** or **smith**. He means those workers in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the craftsmen and the smiths]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

2 Kings 24:16 (#2)

הַכֹּ֖ל גִּבּוֹרֵ֣י עֹ֑שֶׂי מִלְחָמָ֔ה

“the whole, the mighty, the makers of war”

This seems to be a summary statement of all the categories of people listed in verses 14–16 whom the Babylonians took into exile. The idea seems to be that Nebuchadnezzar exiled all the Judeans who together could have made **war** against him. Alternate translation: [all those who together had the capacity to make war against him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 24:17 (#1)

דֹּדָ֖ו

“his uncle”

The pronoun **his** refers to Jehoiachin, not to Nebuchadnezzar, the **king of Babylon**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Jehoiachin’s uncle]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 24:17 (#2)

וַיַּסֵּ֥ב אֶת־שְׁמֹֽו

“and he changed his name”

See how you indicated the symbolic significance of this action in 23:34.

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 24:18 (#1)

בֶּן־עֶשְׂרִ֣ים וְאַחַ֔ת שָׁנָ֖ה צִדְקִיָּ֣הוּ בְמָלְכֹ֑ו וְאַחַ֤ת עֶשְׂרֵה֙ שָׁנָ֔ה מָלַ֖ךְ בִּירוּשָׁלָ֑ם וְשֵׁ֣ם אִמֹּ֔ו חמיטל בַּת־יִרְמְיָ֖הוּ מִלִּבְנָֽה

“Zedekiah {was} a son of 21 years when he reigned, and he reigned 11 years in Jerusalem. And the name of his mother {was} Hamutal, the daughter of Jeremiah, from Libnah”

In this verse and the next verse, the author is introducing **Zedekiah** as a participant in the story as the new king of **Judah**. To translate this verse, see how you translated the similar expressions in 8:26.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

2 Kings 24:19 (#1)

וַיַּ֣עַשׂ הָרַ֔ע בְּעֵינֵ֖י יְהוָֽה

“And he did evil in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:2. Alternate translation: [And he did what Yahweh considered to be evil]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 24:20 (#1)

אַ֥ף יְהוָ֖ה

“the nose of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 13:3. Alternate translation: [the anger of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 24:20 (#2)

הָיְתָה בִירוּשָׁלַ֙͏ִם וּבִֽיהוּדָ֔ה

“it was against Jerusalem and against Judah”

See how you translated the similar expression in 24:3. Alternate translation: [this came upon Jerusalem and Judah] or [this happened to Jerusalem and Judah]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 24:20 (#3)

עַד־הִשְׁלִיכוֹ אֹתָ֥ם מֵעַ֖ל פָּנָ֑יו

“until he cast them away from his face”

See how you translated the similar expression “to remove {them} away from his face” in 24:3. Alternate translation: [until he removed them from their land]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings - Chapter 25 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. King Zedekiah of Judah (24:18–25:7)
2. Destruction of Jerusalem by the Babylonians (25:8–21)
3. The remaining Judeans flee to Egypt (25:22–26)
4. The Babylonian king shows favor to imprisoned King Jehoiachin (25:27–30)

In this chapter, by completing his account of the reign of Zedekiah, the author concludes the story of the kings who ruled the kingdom of Judah. He also concludes the entire story that is told throughout the books of 1 and 2 Samuel and 1 and 2 Kings. That is the story of how the Israelites of both kingdoms disobeyed Yahweh so seriously that Yahweh allowed enemies to conquer them and take them into exile away from their land. As the author describes the conquest and destruction of Judah and the exile of its people, he does not say specifically that this was the result of the people breaking their covenant with Yahweh, as he did in the case of the northern kingdom in 17:7–23. That is because he has already made that point by quoting Yahweh’s decree of judgment in 21:10–15 and saying in 23:26 that Yahweh did not rescind that decree even after the thorough reforms of Josiah. The overall message of this long historical account is nevertheless clear. Yahweh was not at fault when the Israelites were conquered and exiled from their land. Instead, this happened because the people disobeyed Yahweh and broke their covenant with him.

2 Kings 25:1 (#1)

וַיְהִי֩

“And it happened”

The author is using this phrase to introduce a new event. See how you translated it in 2:1.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 25:1 (#2)

בִּשְׁנַ֨ת הַתְּשִׁיעִ֜ית לְמָלְכֹ֗ו בַּחֹ֨דֶשׁ֙ הָעֲשִׂירִ֔י

“in the ninth year of his reigning, in the tenth month”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **ninth** or **tenth**, you could represent these numbers in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [in year nine of his reign, in month ten]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 25:1 (#3)

לְמָלְכֹ֗ו

“of his reigning”

The pronoun **his** refers to Zedekiah, not to Nebuchadnezzar. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [of Zedekiah’s reign]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 25:1 (#4)

בֶּעָשׂ֣וֹר לַחֹ֔דֶשׁ

“on ten of the month”

The author is using the adjective **ten** as a noun to mean a certain day. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [on day ten of the month] or [on the tenth day of the month]

See: Nominal Adjectives

2 Kings 25:1 (#5)

וַיִּבְנ֨וּ

“and they built”

The pronoun **they** refers to Nebuchadnezzar's **army**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and his army built] or [and his soldiers built]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 25:2 (#1)

וַתָּבֹא הָעִיר בַּמָּצֻר

"And the city entered into siege"

See how you translated the similar expression in 24:10. Alternate translation: [And the city came under siege] or [And they besieged the city]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 25:2 (#2)

עַשְׁתֵּי עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה

"the eleventh year"

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **eleventh**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [year 11]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 25:3 (#1)

בְּתִשְׁעָה לַחֹדֶשׁ

"On nine of the month"

The author is using the adjective **nine** as a noun to mean a certain day. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [on day nine of the month] or [on the ninth day of the month]

See: Nominal Adjectives

2 Kings 25:3 (#2)

בְּתִשְׁעָה לַחֹדֶשׁ

"On nine of the month"

The author assumes that readers will know that by **the month**, he means the fourth month of the year he is describing. Zechariah 8:9 indicates that later generations fasted during the fourth month of each year because that was the month in which the Babylonians conquered Jerusalem. So the author could expect readers to know what month he meant. You could indicate the month explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [On the ninth day of the fourth month]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 25:3 (#3)

וַיֶּחֱזַק הָרָעָב בָּעִיר

"then famine seized the city"

The author is speaking of **famine** as if it were a living thing that could have **seized the city**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the famine in the city became very severe]

See: Personification

2 Kings 25:3 (#4)

לֶחֶם

"bread"

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:8. Alternate translation: [food]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 25:4 (#1)

וַתִּבָּקַע הָעִיר

"And the city was breached"

The expression **was breached** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the Babylonians breached the city] or [And the Chaldeans breached the city]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 25:4 (#2)

הַלָּיְלָה

"at night"

The author is leaving out a word (or perhaps the word was lost in the process of scribal transmission) that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply this word from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [fled at night]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 25:4 (#3)

וְכַשְׂדִּים עַל־הָעִיר סָבִיב

"now the Chaldeans {were} against the city all around"

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

2 Kings 25:4 (#4)

וְכַשְׂדִּים

“now the Chaldeans”

To translate the term **Chaldeans** here and in the rest of this chapter, see how you decided to translate it in 24:2. Alternate translation: [now the Babylonians]

See: How to Translate Names

2 Kings 25:4 (#5)

וַיֵּ֫לֶךְ

“and he went”

As the next verse indicates, the pronoun **he** refers to King Zedekiah. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Since it is clear that the king fled the city with **all the men of war**, you could also use a plural pronoun here. Alternate translation: [and King Zedekiah went] or [and they went]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 25:5 (#1)

נָפֹ֫צוּ

“were scattered”

The expression **were scattered** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [scattered]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 25:6 (#1)

וַיַּעֲל֫וּ אֹתָ֥ו

“and they brought him up”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [and they brought him]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 25:6 (#2)

וַיְדַבְּר֥וּ אִתּ֛וֹ מִשְׁפָּט

“And they pronounced judgment on him”

The pronoun **they** could refer to a council or court of officials that Nebuchadnezzar assembled to put Zedekiah on trial for rebellion. However, the parallel passage in Jeremiah 39:5 reads “and he pronounced judgment on him.” So the author may be using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And judgment was pronounced on him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 25:7 (#1)

וְאֶת־בְּנֵי֙ & שָׁחֲט֔וּ

“And they slaughtered the sons of”

The pronoun **they** refers to Nebuchadnezzar’s soldiers. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Nebuchadnezzar’s soldiers slaughtered]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 25:7 (#2)

לְעֵינָ֑יו

“to his eyes”

Here, **eyes** represent “sight.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in his sight]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 25:7 (#3)

וְאֶת־עֵינֵ֣י & עִוֵּ֔ר וַיַּאַסְרֵ֥הוּ֙ & וַיְבִיאֵ֖הוּ

“And he blinded the eyes of & and he bound him & and he brought him”

The author is using one person who was involved in doing these things, Nebuchadnezzar, who commanded them, to mean everyone who was involved. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use plural pronouns, which would refer back to Nebuchadnezzar’s soldiers. Alternate translation: [And they blinded … and they bound him … and they brought him]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 25:8 (#1)

וּבַחֹ֣דֶשׁ הַֽחֲמִישִׁי֮

“And in the fifth month”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **fifth**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [And in month five]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 25:8 (#2)

בְּשִׁבְעָ֥ה לַחֹ֖דֶשׁ

“on seven of the month”

The author is using the adjective **seven** as a noun to mean a certain day. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [on day seven of the month] or [on the seventh day of the month]

See: Nominal Adjectives

2 Kings 25:8 (#3)

הִ֣יא שְׁנַת֩ תְּשַׁע־עֶשְׂרֵ֨ה שָׁנָ֜ה לַמֶּ֤לֶךְ נְבֻכַדְנֶאצַּר

“it {was} the year of 19, the year to King Nebuchadnezzar”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:25. Alternate translation: [it was the nineteenth year of King Nebuchadnezzar]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 25:9 (#1)

אֶת־בֵּ֣ית יְהוָ֗ה

“the house of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:18. Alternate translation: [the temple of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 25:9 (#2)

וְאֵ֖ת כָּל־בָּתֵּ֣י יְרוּשָׁלַ֑͏ִם וְאֵת֙ כָּל־בֵּ֣ית גָּד֔וֹל

“And all of the houses of Jerusalem and every house of the great”

As in 24:14, the second phrase limits the meaning of the first phrase. Alternate translation: [And all of the houses of Jerusalem, that is, every house of the great]

See: Hyperbole

2 Kings 25:9 (#3)

וְאֵת֙ כָּל־בֵּ֣ית גָּד֔וֹל

“and every house of the great”

The author is using the adjective **great** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [every house that belonged to a great person] or [every great house]

See: Nominal Adjectives

2 Kings 25:9 (#4)

שָׂרַ֥ף בָּאֵֽשׁ

“he burned with fire”

See how you translated the similar expression in 23:11. Alternate translation: [he burned up]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 25:11 (#1)

הַנִּשְׁאָרִ֔ים

“left”

The expression **left** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [remaining]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 25:11 (#2)

וְאֶת־הַנֹּפְלִ֖ים אֲשֶׁ֣ר נָפְל֑וּ עַל־הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ בָּבֶֽל

“and the ones having fallen, who had fallen to the king of Babylon”

See how you translated the similar expression in 7:4. Alternate translation: [and the ones having gone over, who had gone over to the king of Babylon] or [and the ones having deserted, who had deserted to the king of Babylon]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 25:11 (#3)

וְאֶת־הַנֹּפְלִ֖ים אֲשֶׁ֣ר נָפְל֑וּ עַל־הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ בָּבֶֽל

“and the ones having fallen, who had fallen to the king of Babylon”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [and the ones who had deserted to the king of Babylon]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 25:11 (#4)

וְאֵת֙ יֶ֣תֶר הֶהָמ֔וֹן

“and the rest of the multitude”

By **the multitude**, the author probably means the people of Judah who lived in places other than Jerusalem. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the Judeans who lived in places other than Jerusalem]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 25:12 (#1)

וּמִדַּלַּ֥ת הָאָ֖רֶץ

“But & some of the poor of the land”

See how you translated the similar expression in 24:14. Alternate translation: [the poor people who lived in the land]

See: Nominal Adjectives

2 Kings 25:13 (#1)

וְאֶת־עַמּוּדֵ֣י הַנְּחֹ֔שֶׁת אֲשֶׁ֖ר בֵּ֣ית־יְהוָ֑ה וְאֶת־הַמְּכֹנ֣וֹת וְאֶת־יָ֣ם הַנְּחֹ֔שֶׁת אֲשֶׁ֖ר בְּבֵ֣ית־יְהוָ֑ה

“And & the pillars of bronze that {were in} the house of Yahweh and the stands and the sea of bronze that {were} in the house of Yahweh”

It might seem that repeating the information that these things were in **the house of Yahweh** would be to express extra information in a way that would not be natural in your language. If so, you can provide the information only once. Alternate translation: [the pillars of bronze and the stands and the sea of bronze that were in the house of Yahweh]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 25:14 (#1)

וְאֶת־הַכְּפֹּר֔וֹת

“and the palms”

The author is using the term **palms** to mean some implement that the priests used in the temple area that had a cupped shape. If you have already translated the book of 1 Kings, see how you translated the similar expression in 1 Kings 7:50. This could mean: (1) Alternate translation: [incense dishes] or (2) Alternate translation: [spoons] or [ladles]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 25:14 (#2)

יְשָׁרְת֖וּ

“they served”

The pronoun **they** refers to the priests who **served** at the temple. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the priests served] or [the priests did their work]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 25:15 (#1)

וְאֶת־הַמַּחְתּוֹת֙ וְאֶת־הַמִּזְרָקִ֔ות אֲשֶׁ֥ר זָהָ֖ב זָהָ֑ב וַאֲשֶׁר־כֶּ֥סֶף כֶּ֖סֶף

“And & the firepans and the bowls that {were} gold gold and that {were} silver silver”

The author is repeating the words **gold** and **silver** in order to indicate that these articles were made of pure gold and pure silver. The description of them in 1 Kings 7:50 says that plainly, and you could do the same here in your translation. Alternate translation: [the firepans and the bowls that were pure gold and that were pure silver]

See: Reduplication

2 Kings 25:15 (#2)

וְאֶת־הַמַּחְתּוֹת֙ וְאֶת־הַמִּזְרָקִ֔ות אֲשֶׁ֥ר זָהָ֖ב זָהָ֑ב וַאֲשֶׁר־כֶּ֥סֶף כֶּ֖סֶף

“And & the firepans and the bowls that {were} gold gold and that {were} silver silver”

Since the **firepans** and **bowls** were both **gold**, the author seems to be using these articles to represent all of the articles that the priests used that were either pure gold or pure silver. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all of the articles that were pure gold or pure silver]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 25:17 (#1)

וְכָאֵ֣לֶּה לָעַמּ֗וּד הַשֵּׁנִי֙ עַל־הַשְּׁבָכָ֔ה

“And like these {were} to the second pillar, with a network”

The demonstrative pronoun **these** refers not just to the **pomegranates** but to all of the features and dimensions of the first pillar. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the

second pillar had the same features and dimensions, including a network]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 25:17 (#2)

לָעַמּוּד הַשֵּׁנִי

“were} to the second pillar”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **second**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [to the other pillar]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 25:19 (#1)

וַחֲמִשָּׁה אֲנָשִׁים מֵרֹאֵי פְנֵי־הַמֶּלֶךְ

“and five men from the seers of the face of the king”

The author is using the phrase **seers of the face of the king** to describe royal advisors, since they regularly spoke with the king in person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [five royal advisors]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 25:19 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר נִמְצְאוּ בָעִיר & הַנִּמְצְאִים בָּעִיר

“who were found in the city & found in the city”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:18. Alternate translation: [who were in the city ... who were in the city]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 25:21 (#1)

וַיַּךְ אֹתָם֙ מֶ֣לֶךְ בָּבֶ֔ל וַיְמִיתֵ֖ם

“And the king of Babylon struck them and killed them”

The verbs **struck** and **killed** together express a single idea. The verb **struck** tells in what way the king of Babylon **killed** these men. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [violently killed] or [executed]

See: Hendiadys

2 Kings 25:21 (#2)

וַיַּךְ אֹתָם֙ מֶ֣לֶךְ בָּבֶ֔ל וַיְמִיתֵ֖ם

“And the king of Babylon struck them and killed them”

It is unlikely that **the king of Babylon** did this personally. The author is likely using the king, who ordered this, to represent everyone who was involved, including the soldiers who carried out his order. Alternate translation: [the king of Babylon ordered his soldiers to execute them]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 25:22 (#1)

וְהָעָ֗ם הַנִּשְׁאָר֙ בְּאֶ֣רֶץ יְהוּדָ֔ה אֲשֶׁ֥ר הִשְׁאִ֖יר נְבוּכַדְנֶאצַּ֣ר מֶֽלֶךְ בָּבֶ֑ל וַיַּפְקֵ֣ד עֲלֵיהֶ֗ם אֶת־גְּדַלְיָ֤הוּ בֶן־אֲחִיקָם֙ בֶּן־שָׁפָֽן

“Now {as for} the people having been left in the land of Judah, whom Nebuchadnezzar, the king of Babylon, left, he appointed Gedaliah, the son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, over them”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

2 Kings 25:22 (#2)

הַנִּשְׁאָר֙

“having been left”

The expression **having been left** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [who remained]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 25:23 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁמְעוּ֩ כָל־שָׂרֵ֨י הַחֲיָלִ֜ים

“And all of the captains of the armies & heard”

As in 24:14 and 25:9, what the author says later in this verse limits the meaning of the general term **all** that he uses at the beginning of the verse. Alternate translation: [And all of the captains of armies whom the Babylonians had not captured]

See: Hyperbole

2 Kings 25:23 (#2)

וְיִשְׁמָעֵאל

“and Ishmael”

The author is using the term translated as **and** to introduce a list of the **captains of armies** who brought their men to Gedaliah at Mizpah. If that would not be clear in your language, you may want to use a different connecting word to introduce the list. Alternate translation: [namely, Ishmael]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Kings 25:25 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“But it happened”

The author is using the phrase **And it happened** to introduce a new development in this event. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new development. See how you translated the phrase in the similar context in 2:9.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 25:25 (#2)

בַּחֹדֶשׁ הַשְּׁבִיעִי

“in the seventh month”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **seventh**, you could represent these numbers in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [in month seven]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 25:25 (#3)

מִזֶּרַע הַמְּלוּכָה

“from the seed of the kingdom”

See how you translated this expression in 11:1. Alternate translation: [who was of royal descent]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 25:25 (#4)

וַיַּכֻּהוּ

“and he struck”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [and he attacked]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 25:25 (#5)

וְאֶת־הַיְּהוּדִים֙ וְאֶת־הַכַּשְׂדִּ֔ים

“and the Judeans and the Chaldeans”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and they also struck and killed the Judeans and the Chaldeans]

See: Ellipsis

2 Kings 25:25 (#6)

וְאֶת־הַיְּהוּדִים֙

“and the Judeans”

Since the author says in the next verse that “all the people” fled to Egypt after this, he does not mean here that Ishmael and his men killed all of the “people having been left in the land of Judah” mentioned in verse 22 who were living in the area of Mizpah. Rather, he is using the term **Judeans** to mean people who were serving the Babylonians with Gedaliah in his government. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 25:26 (#1)

וַיָּקֻ֣מוּ כָל־הָעָ֗ם מִקְּטֹנָ֛ן וְעַד־גָּד֥וֹל וְשָׂרֵ֖י הַחֲיָלִ֑ים וַיָּבֹ֣אוּ מִצְרָ֔יְמָה כִּֽי־יָרְא֥וּ מִפְּנֵ֖י כַּשְׂדִּֽים

“Then all of the people from small and to great and the captains of the armies arose and went {to} Egypt, for they were afraid from the face of the Chaldeans”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Then, because they were afraid from the face of the Chaldeans, all of the people from small and to great and the captains of the armies arose and went {to} Egypt]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Kings 25:26 (#2)

וַיָּקֻ֣מוּ כָל־הָעָ֗ם מִקְּטֹנָ֛ן וְעַד־גָּד֥וֹל וְשָׂרֵ֖י הַחֲיָלִֽים

“Then all of the people from small and to great and the captains of the armies arose”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:24. Alternate translation: [Then all of the people from

small and to great and the captains of the armies took action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Kings 25:26 (#3)

כָּל־הָעָ֖ם מִקָּטֹ֣ן וְעַד־גָּד֑וֹל

“all of the people from small and to great”

See how you translated the similar expression in 23:2. Alternate translation: [people from a wide range of ages and classes]

See: Merism

2 Kings 25:26 (#4)

מִפְּנֵ֖י כַּשְׂדִּֽים

“from the face of the Chaldeans”

See how you translated the similar expression in 16:3. Alternate translation: [on account of the Chaldeans]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 25:27 (#1)

וַיְהִי֙

“And it happened”

The author is using this phrase to introduce a new event. See how you translated it in 2:1.

See: Introduction of a New Event

2 Kings 25:27 (#2)

בִּשְׁלֹשִׁ֣ים וְשִׁשָּׁ֗בַע שָׁנָה֙ לְגָלוּתֹ֣ יְהוֹיָכִ֣ין מֶֽלֶךְ־יְהוּדָ֔ה בִּשְׁנֵ֥ים עָשָׂ֖ר חֹ֣דֶשׁ בְּעֶשְׂרִ֣ים וְשִׁבְעָ֔ה לַחֹ֖דֶשׁ

“in year 37 of the exile of Jehoiachin, the king of Judah, in month 12, on 27 of the month”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:25. Alternate translation: [in the thirty-seventh year of the exile of Jehoiachin, the king of Judah, in the twelfth month, on the twenty-seventh day of the month]

See: Ordinal Numbers

2 Kings 25:27 (#3)

נָשָׂ֣א & אֶת־רֹ֣אשׁ יְהוֹיָכִ֔ין

“lifted the head of Jehoiachin”

The author is using **lifted the head** as a common expression of his culture to mean that Evil Merodach brought Jehoiachin from a lower position to a higher position. In this context, it means specifically that he “released Jehoiachin” from prison. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of Genesis, see how you translated the similar expression in Genesis 40:13. Alternate translation: [set free Jehoiachin]

See: Idiom

2 Kings 25:28 (#1)

טֹבֹ֑וֹת

“good {things”

The author is using the adjective **good**, which is plural, as a noun to mean things of a certain kind. The ULT shows that by supplying the word **things**. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent word or phrase. Alternate translation: [kindly]

See: Nominal Adjectives

2 Kings 25:28 (#2)

וַיִּתֵּ֣ן אֶת־כִּסְא֔וֹ מֵעַ֖ל כִּסֵּ֣א הַמְּלָכִ֑ים

“and he put his seat above the seat of the kings”

The author may not mean that Jehoiachin’s seat was **above** or physically higher than that of other kings. He may be saying **above** to mean “more honorable.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he gave him a more honored place than the other kings]

See: Metaphor

2 Kings 25:28 (#3)

כִּסֵּ֣א הַמְּלָכִ֔ים

“the seat of the kings”

In this verse, the word **seat** is singular in form, but it refers to the seats of all of these **kings**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “text.” Alternate translation: [the seats of the kings]

See: Collective Nouns

2 Kings 25:29 (#1)

וְשִׁנָּ֖א אֵ֣ת בִּגְדֵ֑י כִּלְאֹֽו

“And he changed the clothes of his imprisonment”

The pronoun **he** refers to Evil Merodach, while the pronoun **his** refers to Jehoiachin. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Evil Merodach changed the clothes of Jehoiachin’s im-

prisonment] or [And Evil Merodach allowed Jehoiachin to wear the clothes of a courtier rather than those of a prisoner]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 25:29 (#2)

וְשִׁנָּ֣א אֵ֔את בִּגְדֵ֖י כִּלְאָ֑וֹ

“And he changed the clothes of his imprisonment”

Giving Jehoiachin different clothes to wear was a symbolic action by which Evil Merodach showed that Jehoiachin’s status had changed from prisoner to honored guest. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And he changed the clothes of his imprisonment to show that he was no longer a prisoner]

See: Symbolic Action

2 Kings 25:29 (#3)

וְאָכַ֥ל לֶ֙חֶם֙ תָּמִ֣יד לְפָנָ֔יו

“and he ate bread regularly to his face”

The pronoun **he** refers to Jehoiachin, while the pronoun **his** refers to Evil Merodach. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and Jehoiachin ate bread regularly to the face of Evil Merodach]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Kings 25:29 (#4)

לֶ֙חֶם֙

“bread”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:8. Alternate translation: [meals]

See: Synecdoche

2 Kings 25:29 (#5)

לְפָנָ֔יו

“to his face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:14. Alternate translation: [in his presence]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 25:29 (#6)

כָּל־יְמֵ֥י חַיָּֽיו

“all of the days of his life”

To translate this expression here and in the next verse, see how you translated the similar expression in 10:36. Alternate translation: [throughout his lifetime]

See: Metonymy

2 Kings 25:30 (#1)

וַאֲרֻחָתֹ֗ו אֲרֻחַ֤ת תָּמִיד֙ נִתְּנָה־לֹּ֣ו מֵאֵ֔את הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ

“And his allowance, a continual allowance, was given to him from the king”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [And a continual allowance was given to him from the king]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

2 Kings 25:30 (#2)

וַאֲרֻחָתֹ֗ו אֲרֻחַ֤ת תָּמִיד֙ נִתְּנָה־לֹּ֣ו מֵאֵ֔את הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ

“And his allowance, a continual allowance, was given to him from the king”

The expression **was given** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the king gave him a continual allowance]

See: Active or Passive

2 Kings 25:30 (#3)

הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ דְּבַר־יֹ֥ום בְּיֹומֹ֖ו

“the king, a matter of a day in its day”

The author is using **the matter of a day in its day** as a common expression of his culture to mean “at a fixed daily rate.” (He does not necessarily mean that the **allowance** was paid out each day, but that it was calculated at a daily rate.) If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. If you have already translated the book of Nehemiah, see how you translated the same expression in Nehemiah 11:23. Alternate translation: [at a fixed daily rate]

See: Idiom